





# The Writings and Utterances of the Central Figures of the Bahá'í Faith

PROVISIONAL PARALLEL-TEXT STUDY SERIES

Volume 10:

The Bab: Middle Writings of the second period  
(Shiraz, April-August 1846)



Version: 1.01 • Revision date 15-Sep-2026

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# Series preface

This series of volumes presents, in approximate chronological order and, where possible, in parallel-text format, the available writings and reported utterances of the three Central Figures of the Bahá'í Faith: the Báb (1819–1850), Bahá'u'lláh (1817–1892), and ‘Abdu’l-Bahá (1844–1921). The majority of the texts appear here in English for the first time.

What follows is an independent scholarly and documentary undertaking, with the purpose of facilitating closer engagement with the textual record of the Bahá'í Faith by readers working across Arabic, Persian, Ottoman Turkish, and English. It is not prepared under the direction of Bahá'í institutions and does not constitute an official edition of the texts. The relevant Bahá'í institutions are the final authority with respect to authenticated texts and authorized translations. Accordingly, this series is envisioned as a provisional research aid and reference tool—a scouting expedition to uncharted domains, that defers to finalized texts and translations wherever these are available.

Altogether, the series comprises over 29,000 authored works and reported utterances spanning the years 1843 to 1921. Despite its length—over 10,000,000 words without double-counting the translations—it is not a comprehensive corpus. Rather, it represents the material presently known to the compiler to be publicly obtainable in the original and/or in translation. It is estimated to represent somewhat more than half of the known total, the remainder being held in the International Baha'i Archives in Haifa, Israel.

The series proceeds on a principle of maximal inclusion within the constraints of public accessibility. It therefore brings together texts of unequal status and differing degrees of reliability. Some items are authenticated; others are not. Some survive in stable typed or printed form; others are preserved through imperfect transcription, excerpted publication, or secondhand report. The reader should therefore approach the corpus with appropriate source-critical caution. Inclusion in the series should not be taken to imply authenticity, completeness, or accuracy.

Where authorized English translations issued by the Bahá'í World Centre are available in full, they are rendered in blue text and can be regarded as possessing a distinct status from other translations in the series. Such translations embody a high degree of fidelity, terminological consistency, and editorial care. Readers new to the Bahá'í writings are well advised to begin with the World Centre's own published collection of authorized translations, among them the one-volume thematic anthology *Bahá'í Sacred Writings*, available at [bahai.org/library](http://bahai.org/library). In the present series, newly published authorized translations will be incorporated as they become available. When only a portion of a translation is authorized (individual sentences or paragraphs), it will be demarcated at the paragraph level, although work on this is ongoing.

The remaining translations in the series are provisional. Some are taken from older publications and documents where the English translation may be the only available text; a few are the work

of human translators working independently; the majority have been produced with the assistance of large language models and subsequently reviewed to varying degrees by the compiler. Given the scale of the corpus, the extent of detailed human oversight has necessarily been uneven, and readers should not assume uniform quality across the series. These translations are offered not as definitive renderings but as provisional points of access intended to invite a deeper study of the texts. In the case of difficult, textually uncertain, or context-dependent passages, the original sources should always be consulted where available.

The series will be of greatest benefit to readers able to work comparatively between the English and the original Arabic, Persian, or Ottoman Turkish. Towards this end, translations and original texts have been aligned at the paragraph level where possible. The paragraphing of provisional translations should also be treated as tentative and subject to future revision.

Items representing reported utterances are distinguished typographically—rendered in grey text—from items transmitted as authored texts. This distinction assists the reader in quickly assessing differences of textual status. It does not by itself resolve questions of authenticity or historical reliability, which require separate evaluation.

The original-language texts reproduced here may also contain errors, lacunae, or other imperfections inherited from manuscripts, printed editions, digital transcription, or optical character recognition. This is particularly true of texts deriving from difficult or damaged manuscript sources. The present series is not a critical edition and makes no claim to establish definitive texts through comparison of multiple manuscript witnesses. Rather, it reproduces and organizes the best textual forms available to the compiler, in whatever state, at the time of compilation.

Each item is identified by a code assigned in the Partial Inventory project, including the initial letters BB for the Báb, BH for Bahá'u'lláh, and AB for ‘Abdu’l-Bahá, and the optional letter "U" to indicate reported utterances. These codes provide a stable means of reference across the series. Volume assignments, paragraphing, metadata, and translations may change in future revisions, but the Inventory codes are intended to remain constant. A cumulative catalog appended to the end of the series records these items in sequence and may also include further information such as abstracts, notes, subjects, and musical interpretations.

For further technical notes and cautions on the texts and translations, see the appendix to volume 1 of this series.

The volume introductions and study guides which serve as bookends to each volume have also been prepared with the assistance of large language models, and as such merely offer potentially useful points of entry into an otherwise overwhelmingly vast collection of material.

This series is conceived as a living scholarly instrument, subject to continual correction and expansion as new material becomes available and as errors in existing entries are identified. Corrections of significance may be communicated to the compiler at [loom.of.reality@gmail.com](mailto:loom.of.reality@gmail.com). Revised versions of individual volumes will be issued as corrections are incorporated. The latest versions can be downloaded at [blog.loomofreality.org](http://blog.loomofreality.org).

# Series outline

The present volume forms part of a larger series arranged, in approximate chronological order, by author, period, and, where useful, by major work or thematic grouping. The outline below is intended to help readers locate the volume within the overall architecture of the series. Titles, chronological placements, and volume divisions remain provisional in some cases and may be revised as the corpus is refined.

## The Báb

### I. First period (Shiraz, Bushihr and the Hajj)

1. Pre-declaration writings (to May 1844)
2. Qayyumu'l-Asma' (Commentary on the Surah of Joseph, May 1844)
3. Early post-declaration writings (mid-late 1844)
4. The Hajj and Bushihr (late 1844–July 1845)
5. Kitab-i-Ruh (Book of the Spirit, composed at sea)
6. Shiraz: Later writings of the first period (June–August 1845)
7. Shiraz: Period of retirement (later 1845)

### II. Second period (Shiraz and Isfahan)

8. Shiraz: Early writings of the second period (early-mid 1846)
9. Tafsir-i-Suratu'l-Kawthar (Commentary on the Surah of Abundance, April 1846)
10. Shiraz: Middle writings of the second period (April–August 1846)
11. Tafsir-i-Suratu'l-Va'l-Asr and Nubuwwat-i-Khassih (Commentaries on Surah of the Afternoon and Specific Prophethood, late 1846)
12. Isfahan: Late writings of the second period (Aug 1846–March 1847)

### III. Third period (Maku and Chihriq)

13. Bayan-i-Farsi (The Persian Bayan, Maku 1847)
14. The Seven Proofs and the Arabic Bayan (Maku 1847)
15. Maku: Early writings of the third period (Maku 1847)
- 16–17. Commentary on the Qur'an I and II (Maku 1847?) (place-holder volumes)
- 18–19. Kitab-i-Asma' (The Book of Names, Chihriq 1848–1849)
20. Kitab-i-Jaza' (The Book of the Reckoning, Chihriq 1848)
21. Themes of declaration, affirmation and negation (Chihriq 1848–1850)
22. Writings on Tabarsi and Zanzan (Chihriq 1848–1850)
23. Prayers and visitation tablets (Chihriq 1848–1850)
24. Anticipation of He Whom God Will Make Manifest (Chihriq 1848–1850)
25. Panj Sha'n (Book of the Five Modes, 1850)
26. Matters of transition and succession (Chihriq 1848–1850)
27. Misc. works and correspondence

## **Bahá'u'lláh**

### **I. Baghdad period**

- 28. Early Baghdad and Sulaymaniyyih (to 1856)
- 29. Middle Baghdad (1856–1860)
- 30. The Kitab-i-Iqan (The Book of Certitude, 1860)
- 31. Late Baghdad (1860–1863)
- 32. Baghdad, year unknown (to 1863)

### **II. Edirne period**

- 33. Istanbul and early Edirne (mid-1863 to March 1866)
- 34. Middle Edirne and the year of withdrawal (March 1866–Sept. 1867)
- 35. The Kitab-i-Badi' (1866)
- 36. Late Edirne (Sept. 1867–August 1868)
- 37–39. Edirne, year unknown (1864–1868) I-III

### **III. 'Akka period**

- 40. Summons to Kings and Rulers (1868)
- 41–42. Writings in early 'Akka (1868–1873) I-II
- 43–46. Writings prior to 1290 A.H. (< 1873) I-IV
- 47–49. Writings in 'Akka, year ca. 1289 A.H. (1872–1873) I-III
- 50. The Kitab-i-Aqdas (The Most Holy Book, 1873)
- 51. Writings in the year 1290 A.H. (ca. 1873)
- 52. Writings in the year 1291 A.H. (ca. 1874)
- 53. Writings in the year 1292 A.H. (ca. 1875)
- 54–55. Writings in the year 1293 A.H. (ca. 1876) I-II
- 56. Writings in the year 1294 A.H. (ca. 1877)
- 57. Writings in the year 1295 A.H. (ca. 1878)
- 58–59. Writings in the year 1296 A.H. (ca. 1879) I-II
- 60–61. Writings in the year 1297 A.H. (ca. 1880) I-II
- 62–65. Writings in the year 1298 A.H. (ca. 1880–1881) I-IV
- 66–69. Writings in the year 1299 A.H. (ca. 1881–1882) I-IV
- 70–72. Writings in the year 1300 A.H. (ca. 1882–1883) I-III
- 73–74. Writings in the year 1301 A.H. (ca. 1883–1884) I-II
- 75–76. Writings in the year 1302 A.H. (ca. 1884–1885) I-II
- 77–79. Writings in the year 1303 A.H. (ca. 1885–1886) I-III
- 80–83. Writings in the year 1304 A.H. (ca. 1886–1887) I-IV
- 84–87. Writings in the year 1305 A.H. (ca. 1887–1888) I-IV
- 88–92. Writings in the year 1306 A.H. (ca. 1888–1889) I-IV
- 93–97. Writings in the year 1307 A.H. (ca. 1889–1890) I-IV
- 98. Lawh-i-Ibn-i-Dhi'b (Epistle to the Son of the Wolf, 1891)
- 99–100. Writings in the years 1308–1309 A.H. (ca. 1890–1892) I-II
- 101–102. Writings of Bahá'u'lláh in 'Akka, year unknown (1873–1892) I-II
- 103–106. Writings of Bahá'u'lláh in 'Akka, year unknown (1868–1892) I-IV
- 107. Writings of Bahá'u'lláh, year unknown

## **‘Abdu’l-Bahá**

### **I. Pre- and early ministry**

- 108. Pre-ministry letters and writings (before June 1892)
- 109. The Secret of Divine Civilization (1875)
- 110. A Traveller’s Narrative (ca. 1886)
- 111. Letters and utterances in the year 1892
- 112. Letters and utterances in the year 1893
- 113. Letters and utterances in the year 1894
- 114. Letters and utterances in the year 1895
- 115. Letters and utterances in the year 1896
- 116–117. Letters and utterances in the year 1897 I–II
- 118. Letters and utterances in the year 1898
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- 120–122. Letters and utterances in the year 1900 I–III
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- 125–126. Letters and utterances in the year 1902 I–II
- 127–129. Letters and utterances in the year 1903 I–III
- 130–131. Letters and utterances in the year 1904 I–II
- 132. Some Answered Questions, 1906–1907
- 133–134. Letters and utterances in the year 1905 I–II
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### **II. Travels to Egypt and the West**

- 145–146. Letters and utterances in the year 1910 I–II
- 147–149. Letters and utterances in the year 1911 I–III
- 150–156. Letters and utterances in the year 1912 I–VII
- 157. Letters and utterances, Dec. 1912 – Jan. 1913
- 158–162. Letters and utterances in the year 1913 I–V

### **III. Late ministry**

- 163–166. Letters and utterances in the year 1914 I–IV
- 167–168. Letters and utterances in the year 1915 I–II
- 169. Memorials of the Faithful (1916)
- 170. Letters and utterances in the year 1916
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# Introduction to volume 10

This volume captures a dense late-Shiraz moment in the Bab's second-period writings—texts composed in the months immediately preceding His departure for Isfahan—when speculative theology, community formation, and devotional practice are being pressed into a more self-conscious unity. Its organizing center is not narrative but architecture: a sustained effort to disclose the deep structure of reality (cosmological, spiritual, and scriptural) through symbolic exegesis, while simultaneously delimiting what counts as decisive proof and what constitutes faithful reception of the new revelation.

The intellectual apex is reached in the paired commentaries on Ha'—BB00021 (Tafsir al-Ha' I / Tafsir-i-Alifayn) and BB00029 (Tafsir al-Ha' II / Tafsir sirr al-ha')—where the Bab treats a single letter as a key to the metaphysics of divine action and spiritual station. The first explicitly aligns a sevenfold schema of creative “action” with a sevenfold hierarchy of spiritual stations, presenting these as refracted disclosures of the Bab's own reality rather than merely abstract cosmological stages. The second, written as a complement, shifts the emphasis from structural mapping to recognition: the surest testimony is located in the Bab's own revealed discourse, and to recognize His station is to recognize the immanence of revelation as the hidden truth within all beings. Around these two pieces the volume repeatedly returns to the relationship between sign and certainty—how “proof” is apprehended, how inner vision is disciplined, and how scriptural disclosure simultaneously unveils and protects “mystery.”

Alongside this doctrinal core runs a more outward-facing set of letters and brief tablets that illuminate the Bab's pastoral governance of an emerging community. In BB00073 (Letter to Mulla Muhammad Ja'far Kirmani), traditional identifying marks associated with the Bab are addressed but subordinated to a more radical criterion: the mode and potency of revelation itself as the decisive evidence, coupled with a sharp boundary against rival claimants and corrupted writings, and a practical insistence that believers circulate and possess a small canon of foundational works. That same canonizing impulse appears in the short BB00473, which underscores the special weight of the Kitabu'l-'Adl. Other Tablets (e.g., BB00503) show the Bab directing teaching activity with caution and wisdom and summoning key figures to His presence, evidencing both strategic discretion and intensifying claims upon allegiance. Interleaved throughout are prayers, ziyarats, and supplicatory texts (including a visitation tablet for the Gates and Imams, BB00113), which translate the volume's high metaphysics into a lived devotional regimen—an implicit reminder that, in this corpus, cosmology and community are ultimately joined by worship.



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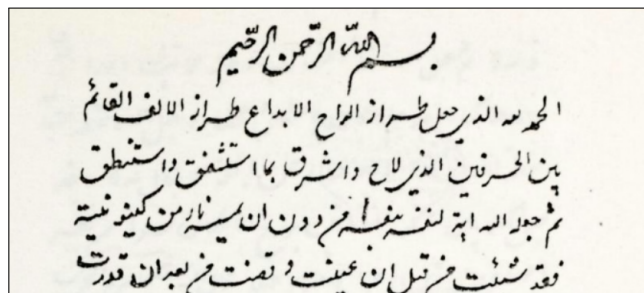


## BB00021

*Tafsir al-Ha I (Tafsir-i-Alifayn: Commentary on the Letter Ha')*

To: Abu'l-Hasani'l-Husayni

Date: unknown (late Shiraz)



INBA53

- 1 In the name of God, the Most Merciful, the Most Compassionate  
1 بسم الله الرحمن الرحيم
- 2 Praise be to God Who hath made the embellishment of the Tablets of Creation to be the embellishment of the upright Alif between the two letters, which hath shone forth and radiated through that which was compassionate and articulate. Then God made it a sign unto Himself by Himself without the fire of His Essence touching it. Verily it was willed before it was determined, ordained after it was decreed, executed when it was ordained, then set forth and permitted and made firm. Then the horizons were filled therewith.  
2 الحمد لله الذى جعل طرز الواح الابداع طراز الالف القائم بين الحرفين الذى لاح واستشرق واستنطق ثم جعله الله اية لنفسه بنفسه من دون ان يمسسه نار من كينونته فقد شئت من قبل ان عيئت وقضت من بعد ما قدرت وامضت حين ما قضت ثم اجلت واذنت واحكمت ثم ملائت بها الافاق
- 3 And praise be to God Who hath formed that letter with the two letters through the shining forth of that which shone from the light of the Sun of Eternity, which was determined after it was willed, and ordained after it was decreed, and brought near when it was set forth and reckoned. Then through it He revealed Himself unto all who dwell in the kingdom of Command and Creation, until he who was thunderstruck at the first Mount recovered and awakened.  
3 والحمد لله الذى قد تكعب ذلك الحرف بالحرفين بما لاح ما لاح من نور شمس الازل التى عيئت بعد ما شئت وقضت بعد ما قدرت وادنت حين ما اجلت واحصيت ثم بها تجلى على من فى ملكوت الامر والخلق حتى تاب من صمق فى الطور الاول ثم افاق
- 4 Praise be to God Who hath joined through His Command between that letter through the existence of the point beneath the Ba, then through the creation of the Ba after the Alif, that He might distinguish between all according to their station in the Cause, and make happy those who are made happy through their faithfulness to the Covenant, and make wretched those who are made wretched through following their desires and going astray on the Day of the Covenant. For on that Day shall the leg be bared by the leg, and God shall judge between all according to what their hands have wrought, and thy Lord is not unjust to His servants. Verily He shall recompense all for what their hands have done on the Day of Meeting.  
4 الحمد لله الذى قد اتصل بامره بين ذلك الحرف بوجود النقطة تحت الباء ثم بخلق الباء بعد الالف ليميز بين الكل بما هم عليه من الامر ويسعد من يسعد بما وفى بالميثاق ويشقى من يشقى بما اتبع هواه ويضى يوم الميثاق فان يومئذ يكشف الساق بالساق ويفصل الله بين الكل بما اكتسبت ايديهم وما الله ربك بظلام للعباد وانه ليجزى الكل بما عملت ايديهم فى يوم التلاق
- 5 Praised be God – He from Whom there shone forth that which dawned, and from Whose radiance burst the light that cleft the firmaments from the Realm of the Cloud; that it might be  
5 والحمد لله الذى اشراق ما اطلع والاح نور ما فتق بين الاجواء من عالم العماء ليدقق بعد صفت

enfolded, after the ranks were arrayed, in the thicket of the Godhead as the Bird of Destiny, in the grove of Might as the Cock of Praise, and in the gardens of the Kingdom and the Dominion as the Peacock of Glory – there to quiver with its melodies upon the branches of the Tree of Manifestation, and to sound its peals amid the hosts of the bees of Sinai. Every thing abideth in its station; and all shall hear the clamour of that which gleamed forth from the light of the morn of pre-eternity – whatsoever great or small upon which the name “thing” hath fallen. Praised be God!

- 6 And praised be God – He from Whom that which was uttered found its rising, Who showed compassion upon that which dawned, Who shed radiance upon that which was dispersed and drawn together, and Who assigned unto it a governance and a tenderness which became manifest and exalted after abasement, after kindling and submission; which grew mighty, glittered, trembled, separated and conjoined, aided and opposed, confronted and distinguished – according as it stood firm, proclaimed, revolved, illumined, became evident, willed, was thunder-struck, was established, surged, flashed, blazed, was recalled, gasped, proclaimed again, was made weak and revived – until it cried, like a bewildered fish cast upon the dust: “There is no God but Thee! Glory be to Thee! Unto Thee have I turned in repentance, and I am the first of those who repent.”

- 7 And now – there hath descended unto the remembrancer the wondrous Remembrance from One of lofty lineage and exalted rank, of surpassing honor and inviolable might. Such was not its form in the Book; He is the Mighty. O my Lord! Bestow upon me the grace of lifting the veil from the countenance of the Cause, by whatsoever face Thou wilt; for my plight hath grown severe, and by God, my purpose is naught but the unveiling of the state. Here stand I before God, saying: Peace be upon Thee, as long as the Sun of creation riseth by creation, and the sun of invention setteth by invention.

- 8 I have read that which thou didst send down from the clouds of the heaven of Thy Will, and I have discerned that to which Thou didst allude in the inward recesses of Thy verses – as though Thou didst intend, by the unveiling of the secret, to disclose the countenance of that which is concealed. Otherwise, that which is hidden in the lines lay before Thee like a parchment spread open. If the secret be a secret whose veil may be lifted from its face, then verily it standeth, between the lines, disclosed before Thy dawning like the light of manifestation. But if it be a secret enwrapped – benefited only by secrecy, profited only by concealment, and whose countenance

طير القضاء في اجمة اللاهوت و ديك الثناء في  
اجمة الجبروت و طائوس البهاء في اجمة الملك و  
الملوك ليتلجلجن بفنائه على اغصان شجرة الظهور  
ورنائه في عساكر نحل الطور كلشي في رتبته و  
ليسمعن ضجيج ما لاح عن نور صبح الازل كل  
ما وقع عليه اسم ما جل و دق

6 والحمد لله الذي استشرق ما استنطق واستشفق  
ما استشرق والاح ما استغرق واستشوق وجعل  
له حكم ورقة التي جلت و علت بعدما خشعت و  
ذكت وخضعت وعظمت وتلثت وتلجلجت و  
تفارقت وتقارنت وتعاونت وتعاكست وتقابلت  
وتفاضلت بما استقامت و انادت و استدارت  
واضأت و استبان و ارادت و استصعقت  
واقامت و استلجلجت و الاح و استنعت  
واقالت و استشقت و انادت و استضعفت و  
افاقت و قالت بمثل حوت متبلبل في التراب لا  
اله الا انت سبحانك ثبت اليك وانا اول التائبين

7 وبعد فقد نزل للذاكر ذكر البديع من ذى الحسب  
الشامخ الرفيع و ذى الشرف الباذخ المنيع ما كان  
هذا صورته في الكتاب هو العزيز سيدى من علي  
بكشف الستور عن وجه الامر باى وجه تريد فان  
الحال قد اشتد على و ليس و الله مقصودى الا  
كشف الحال و انا ذا بين يدى الله اقول سلام  
الله عليك بما طلعت شمس الابداع بالابداع و بما  
غربت شمس الاختراع بالاختراع

8 قد قرئت ما نزلت من سحاب سماء مشيتك و  
عرفت ما اشرت في بواطن مستيرات اياتك  
كانك اردت ان تكشف بكشف السر عن وجه  
المستور و الا ما هو المستور في السطور كان بين  
يديك بمثل رق منشور و ان كان السر سرا يمكن  
ان يكشف عن وجهه حجاب المستور فانه هو في  
بين السطور مكشوف عند طلعتك بمثل نور الظهور  
و ان كان سر مجمل لا ينفعه الا السر ولا يفيدده الا  
الستر و لا يكشف عن وجهه غوامض الاشارة  
في الامر فكيف يمكن ان اشير اليه و ان اول  
رتبة كشفه هو نفى الاشارة عنه

the subtleties of allusion cannot unveil – how then can I point unto it? For the first station of its disclosure is the denial of all allusion to it.

- 9 Today I possess no unveiling of that secret, no command, no means, save what was taught to Kumayl in secret in the prayer of Khidr: “Lord, forgive him who possesses naught save prayer, for Thou doest what Thou wilt. O Thou Whose Name is healing, Whose remembrance is cure, and Whose obedience is wealth! Have mercy on him whose capital is hope and whose weapon is tears! O Bestower of blessings! O Repeller of adversities! O Light of those who are lonely in darkness! O Knower Who art not known! Bless Muhammad and the family of Muhammad, and do with us what is worthy of Thee! Thou art worthy to be feared and worthy to forgive!”

9 وليس لي اليوم لذلك السر كشف ولا امر ولا سبب الا ما ادب على كميل الخفي في دعاء لخضر رب اغفر لمن لا يملك الا الدعاء فانك فعال لما تشاء يا من اسمه دواء وذكره شفاء وطاعته غنى ارحم من راس ما له الرجاء وسلاحه البكاء يا سابع النعم ويا دافع النقم ويا نور المستوحشين في الظلم يا عالما لا يعلم صل على محمد وال محمد وافعل بنا ما انت اهله انك اهل التقوى واهل المغفرة

- 10 And since every letter of Thy Book hath, in the path of knowledge, infinite outer and inner meanings, I indicate with a drop that which overflows from the ocean of the elixir through what God hath graciously bestowed upon me. Though I know that these recorded principles and known allusions are unveiled before thee, yet perchance God may reveal in the inner meanings of the allusions that which floweth from the pen of ink in such wise as to draw thee to the holy precincts of the heart. I seek God's forgiveness for what the Book recordeth before the All-Merciful. Verily we are God's, and unto our Lord do we return.

10 ولما كان لكل حرف من كتابك في سبيل العلم ظواهر وبواطن بما لا نهاية لها اشير برشح بمثل ما يطفح من بحر الاكسير بما اكرمني الله بمنه ولو اني لا علم ان تلك القواعد المسطورة والاشارات المعلومه عند جنابك مكشوفة ولكن عسى الله ان ينزل في بواطن الاشارات ما يجري من قلم المداد بما يجذبك الى ساحة القدس والقواد استغفر الله عما يحصى الكتاب في بين يدي الرحمن وانا لله وانا الى ربنا لمنقلبون

- 11 O my God! How can I praise Thy praise or speak before the presence of Thy grandeur? Thou hast ever been, without the description of aught, and wilt ever exist, without the attribute of aught. None shall ever know Thee as Thou art, and naught shall ever describe Thee as Thou deservest, for Thy very Essence cutteth off all substances from expression, and Thy very Being preventeth all realities from knowing Thee. If I say “Thou art Thou,” I have likened the similar to the similar, and Thou at once beliest me - nay, all created things - for how can that which was brought into being through creation describe That which cannot be described by the attributes of invention? And if I say “He is He,” I have indicated the Oneness of Thy Will and the Reality of Thy Purpose, which are cut off from Thee by Thy creation of them from nothing, and are prevented from knowing Thee by their need, at every moment, of something. Thus whenever I ascend toward Thee, I see no means for myself save descent into despair and prevention; and whenever I fall silent and seek forgiveness, I find naught but a sin greater than the first.

11 يا الهى كيف اثني ثنائك وانطق بين يدي طلعة كبرياتك وانت لم تزل كنت بلا وصف شئ ولا تزال انك كائن بلا نعت شئ لن يعرفك بما انت عليه احد ولن يوصفك بما انت اهله شئ اذ ذاتيتك مقطعة الجوهريات عن البيان واثبتك مسددة الكينونيات عن العرفان ان قلت انت انت فقد حكى المثل بالمثل وانك في الحين تكذبني بل كل المكائت بان من وجد بحكم الابداع يقدر ان يذكر ما لا ينعت بوصف الاختراع وان قلت انه هو هو فقد دلت الاحدية ذات مشيتك وحكم الولاية كينونة ارادتك و هي منقطعة عنك بابداعك لا من شئ وممتعة عن عرفانك باحتياجها في كل ان من شئ فكما اصعد اليك ما ارى لنفسى بلاغا الا الهبوط الى الياس والمنع وكما اصمت واستغفر ما اجد الا ذنبا اعظم من ذنب الاول

12 فبعتك وجلالتك ما ارى السبيل ولا اجد المقام للدليل وانك رب غفور جليل فاغفر لي فانك انت

12 By Thy might and Thy majesty! I perceive no path, nor do I find for proof any abiding place; and Thou art indeed a forgiving and august Lord. Forgive me, then, for Thou art the All-Forgiving, the All-Merciful. O God! I call Thee to witness by that wherewith Thou bearest witness unto Thine own Self, and by that whereunto Thy Book testifieth – according to that which Thy knowledge hath encompassed, and according to that which hath even now descended upon me in a Book inscribed and a parchment spread open, and from a Book endowed with manifest authority – seeking thereby to unveil the secret that is concealed, to tremble at that which was revealed upon Sinai, and to drink of the pure Water of Kawthar amid those deaf, dark, and impenetrable gloom-filled shadows, through the balance of exposition bestowed by a forgiving Lord, from the hands of a servant whom He appointed on that Day as the twofold witness within a hidden House. O my Lord! Nothing escapeth Thy knowledge, nor is aught in the heavens or on the earth too great for Thee. Thou art, verily, the Knower of all things and the Almighty over all things. Confirm, then, O God, his heart upon Thy religion as Thou willest; and I am content with whatsoever Thou willest – verily Thou art the Mighty, the All-Powerful.

13 O man! I have borne witness unto that which flowed from thy pen, and have discerned that which thou didst intend in the allusions of thy words. No doubt God is thy true aim; yet in this Day one such as thou doth not cleave unto one such as I, save whomsoever God may choose to assist by His command and make a guardian of His ordinance. Nevertheless, when I behold the fluctuation of thy state and the disquiet of thy inmost being concerning the Cause of thy Lord, the sea of my stillness is stirred, by reason of my love for thee and the sincerity of thy service unto God, thy Creator – though I perceive the veil that lieth between thee and me. Yet I hope from God, exalted be He, that He will decree for me that which He willeth and will give me rest through His promise. Verily He is the Generous, the Merciful.

14 O thou who ascendest unto the ladder of inner realities, and who gazest upon those subtle splendors! That which thou dost seek at this moment is the majesty of glory in its beginning and its end. The truth can never be attained save by the negation of all else beside it; and the essential realities of the verses of knowledge profit not him whose desire is the station of his Lord, through the removal of veils and allusions, signs and indications. Thus hath it been plainly declared by Him Who dwelt in the deep of names and attributes: that truth is the unveiling of the veils without allusion. That station abideth

الغفور الرحيم اللهم اني اشهدك بما تشهد لنفسك و تشهد لما يحصى كتابك بما قد احاط علمك و بما نزل علي الان في كتاب مسطور ورق منشور و من كتاب ذي حكم مشهور بما اراد ان يكشف سر المستور و يتلجلج لما تجلى على الطور و يشرب ماء الكوثر الطهور في تلك الظلمات الصماء الصيلم الديجور بما يعرف من قسطاس البيان من رب غفور من يدى عبد الذى جعله العتدين في ذلك اليوم في بيت مستور رب لا يعزب من علمك شئ و لا يتعاضمك في السموات و الارض شئ و انك بكل شئ عليم و على كل شئ قدير فثبت اللهم قلبه على دينك بما شئت و انى بما شئت انك انت العزيز المقتدر

13 فيا ايها الانسان قد شهدت بما جرى من مدادك و عرفت ما اردت في اشارات كلامك و لا شك ان الله هو مرادك و الا ان اليوم لا ينقطع مثلك الى مثلى الا من شاء الله ان يؤيده بامرہ و يجعله من حفاظ حكمه و لكن لما اجد تقلب حالك و اضطراب سرك لامر ربك قد تلاطم بحر سكوني لحبي لك و خلوص عملي لله بارئك لما ارى الحجاب بيني و بينك و لكن ارجوا من الله سبحانه ان يقضى لى ما اراد و يسكننى بوعده انه جواد رحيم

14 فيا ايها المعارج الى معارج الحقائق و الناظر الى تلك السبحات الدقائق ان الذى انت اردته في الحال هو شان الجلال في المبدء و المال و ان الحقيقة لن يدرك الا بنفى ما سواها و ان جوهريات ايات العلم لم ينفع لمن اراده مقام ربه في نفى السبحات و الاشارات و العلامات و الدلالات كما صرح بذلك قول من سكن في لجه الاسماء و الصفات بان الحقيقة هو كشف السبحات من غير اشاره و ان تلك الرتبة موجوده في غيبك و حضرتك بل لا ظهور لك الا به

within thy hidden being and within thy presence; nay, thou hast no manifestation save through it.

- 15 And since the minds of the followers of Mulla Sadra were confounded, and the feet of some divine philosophers faltered in explaining this station, I shall indicate through wisdom's proof the reality of this supreme creation: God hath ever been, and there was naught else besides Him. And now God is even as He was; nothing existeth at His level. Whoso claimeth to know Him through the existence of aught else - his knowledge is rendered void, for He hath never been associated with His creation nor can He be described through His servants.
- 16 Whoso desireth to proclaim His unity doth at that very moment associate partners with Him, for as He is, none but He can know Him, and none but He can proclaim His unity. All that His near servants have claimed regarding His knowledge is but knowledge of His creation through which He hath manifested Himself to it in the realm of His dominion. This is the utmost knowledge possible to contingent beings, for they can never ascend to the holy court of their Creator.
- 17 As 'Ali - peace be upon him - hath declared in the Orphan Sermon: "If thou sayest He is He, thou hast distinguished Him from all things, so He is He. And if thou sayest He is He, the letters 'He' are but attributes by which to prove Him, not attributes that reveal Him. If thou assigneth Him limits, such limits pertain to other than Him. If thou sayest the air is His relation, the air is of His creation." Thus description returneth unto description. The heart is blinded from understanding, and understanding from comprehension, and comprehension from deduction. The dominion is established in the kingdom, creation returneth unto its like, and seeking findeth its form. Investigation leadeth unto impotence, exposition unto loss, striving unto despair, and attainment unto severance. The way is barred and seeking rejected. His proof is His signs and His existence His affirmation.
- 18 Verily God created the Will through itself, not from anything else. Then through it He created whatsoever beareth the name of a thing. The cause of its existence is itself and naught else. Whoso maintaineth that the Divine Essence was the cause of creation hath unknowingly associated partners with his Lord, for as He is, He cannot be associated with anything, nor doth anything exist with Him. It hath been established in wisdom that between cause and effect there must needs be similarity. Therefore did the Imam say that the cause of things is His handiwork, and He hath no cause. Some philosophers have stumbled in explaining this station according to their beliefs,
- و لما ان ذهلت العقول من حكايا الصدرائين و ذلت الاقدام من بعض حكايا الالهيين في بيان ذلك المقام فاني انا اشير بدليل الحكمة في حقيقته ذلك الصنع الاكبر و هو ان الله لم يزل كان و لم يك معه شئ و ان الان كان الله بمثل ما كان لم يك في رتبته شئ و من ادعى معرفته بوجود غيره يبطل عرفانه لانه لم يزل لن يقترب بخلقه و لا يوصف بعباده
- و من اراد ان يوحد ففى الحين ليشرك بنفسه لانه كما هو عليه لم يعرفه غيره حتى يوحد و لا يوحد سواه حتى يعرفه و ان كلها ادعى عباده المقربون في معرفته هي كانت معرفة ابداعه الذي تجلى له به في مقام ملكه و هي حق معرفة الممكن في الامكان و انه لم يزل لا يصعد الى ساحة قدس موجد
- كما صرح بذلك على عليه السلام في خطبة اليتيمية ان قلت هو هو فقد باين الاشياء كلها فهو هو و ان قلت هو هو فالحاء و الواو من كلامه صفة استدلال عليه لا صفة تكشف له و ان قلت له حد فالحد لغيره و ان قلت الهواء نسبته فالحواء من صناعه رجع من الوصف الى الوصف و عمى القلب عن الفهم و الفهم عن الادراك و الادراك عن الاستنباط و دام الملك في الملك انتهى المخلوق الى مثله و الجاه الطلب الى شكله و هجم له الفحص الى العجز و البيان على الفقد و الجهد على الياس و البلاغ على القطع و السبيل مسدود و الطلب مردود دليله اياته و وجوده اثباته
- و ان الله خلق المشية لا من شئ بنفسها ثم خلق بها كل ما وقع عليه اسم شئ و ان العلة لوجودها هي نفسها لا سواها و ان الذي ذهب من ان الذات هو كان علة الابداع اشرك بربه من حيث لا يعلم لانه كما هو عليه لن يقترب بشئ و لا وجود لشيء معه و لقد ثبت في الحكمة بان يكون فرض بين العلة و المعلوم حكم المشابهة و لذا قال الامام ان علة الاشياء صناعه و هو لا علة له و قد ذلت اقدام بعض الحكماء في بيان ذلك المقام بما يعتقد

which God hath not intended in His Book. May God forgive them through His grace, for He is the Forgiving, the Merciful.

- 19 Whoso maintaineth a connection between Truth and creation hath followed his idle fancy as did the first. This is error in the doctrine of the people of infallibility, for if the connection be the Essence itself, this hath no place in the doctrine of the family of God and is association according to what was recited unto thee before. And if it be creation, the people of the Bayan have no need to prove it. Therefore did the Imam, peace be upon him, say: "Truth and creation, with no third between them, nor any third besides them." This is witnessed by whomsoever God hath caused to witness the creation of the heavens and earth. Then He created His own self, and God sufficeth Me as witness.

- 20 Whoso maintaineth the existence of fixed archetypes in the Divine Essence to prove His exalted knowledge, as most have done save whom God willeth, this is pure association in the doctrine of the family of God. For mention of their otherness in existence testifieth to separation and indicateth division. God is the Eternal who hath ever been in one state. If the archetypes be the Essence itself, it changeth not eternally and unity would be impossible even for itself. All such essential abstractions have no existence with God, exalted be His mention. I seek refuge with God from what Muhyi'd-Din al-'Arabi maintained - may God hasten His vengeance.

- 21 Verily God is the Eternal who begetteth not nor is begotten. He hath no likeness in creation nor proof in contingent being, for proof is proof for that which indicateth not itself by itself. Description is for that which describeth not itself by itself. Glory be to God above what they who liken Him to creation have falsely claimed about the unity of existence! God witnesseth no word more remote than their saying, for mention of the non-existent is subsidiary to the existent. The Essence hath ever been free of His creation, and His creation when they came into being had no mention with Him.

- 22 That which compelled the philosophers to speak of fixed archetypes and the uncompounded reality is their station of affirmation in the knowledge of God, glorified be He. The uncompounded reality is their affirmation in the knowledge of God, glory be to Him, the Most High. Indeed, to affirm that God's knowledge comes from creation is falsehood and untruth, for God's knowledge has ever been for Himself alone, and there was no object of knowledge with Him, and none knoweth how He is save Him. Whoso desireth to comprehend His knowledge hath at that moment denied his Lord, for

وان امرا ما لا اراد الله في الكتاب عسى الله ان يعفو عنهم بفضلله انه غفور رحيم

- 19 وان الذى ذهب بالربط بين الحق والخلق فقد اتبع هواه بمثل ما اتبع الاول وان ذلك في مذهب اهل العصمة خطأ لان الربط ان كان هو الذات فليس في مذهب ال الله بحق و انه هو شرك بحكم ما قرئت عليك من قبل وان كان خلق لا حاجة عند اهل البيان باثباته ولذا قال الامام عليه السلام حق وخلق لا ثالث بينهما ولا ثالث غيرها وان ذلك مشهود عند من اشهده الله خلق السموات والارض ثم خلق نفسه وكفى بالله علي شهيدا

- 20 وان الذى ذهب بالاعيان الثابتة في الذات لاثبات علمه تعالى كما ذهب الكل الا من شاء الله شرك محض في مذهب ال الله لان ذكر الغيريه بوجودها شاهدة بالتفريق ودالة بالتقطيع وان الله هو الصمد الذى لم يزل كان على حالة واحدة فان كان الاعيان هو نفس الذات لم يزل لا يتغير ولا يمكن التوحيد لاحد حتى لنفسه وان كل اشباه الجوهريات لا وجود لها مع الله عز ذكره فاعوز بالله مما ذهب محي الدين الاعرابي اجل الله في نعمته

- 21 وان الله هو الصمد الذى لم يلد ولم يولد ولم يكن له في الخلق مثال ولا له دليل في الامكان لان الدليل دليل لمن لا يدل بذاته لذاته وان النعت وصف لمن لا يوصف بنفسه لنفسه فسبحان الله عما عما افترى المشبهون في وحدة الوجود وما يشهد الله على كلمة ابعد من قولهم لان ذكر المفقود فرع الموجود وان الذات هو لم يزل خلو من خلقه و خلقه حين وجدوا لا ذكر لهم عنده

- 22 وان الذى اضطرت الحكماء بذكر اعيان الثابتة والحقيقة البسيطة هو المقام اثباتهم في علم الله سبحانه وتعالى وان اثبات علم الله من الخلق كذب وافك لان الله لم يزل كان علمه لنفسه و ما كان معلوم معه ولا يعلم كيف هو الا هو فن اراد ان يعرف علمه ففى الحين ليكفر بربه لان الذى وجد حقيقته بابداعه الذى بدع لا من شئ افكيف يقدر ان يعرف علم ربه وهو لم يزل كان

how can one who hath found his reality through His creation, which was created from nothing, hope to know the knowledge of his Lord? He hath ever been All-Knowing, and there was naught with Him, and now He is All-Knowing, and there is naught at His level.

عالمًا ولم يك معه شيء والآن ليكون عالمًا ولم يك في رتبته شيء

- 23 The mention of power, knowledge, and all names and attributes are but signs for His creation and a means of sweeping away the vain imaginings of His servants, lest they doubt aught about their Creator. His knowledge is His Essence, free from His creation, and none can encompass His knowledge. The knowledge He hath attributed to Himself, which those who reason have deduced in the station of His justice, is the reality of creation, and its relation to Him is but an honorific relation, like the relation of creation to Him.

23 وان ذكر القدرة والعلم وكل الاسماء والصفات ايات لخلقه ومكنسة لا وهام عباده الا يشكوا في بارئهم بشئ وان علمه هو ذاته خلو من خلقه ولا يقدر ان يحيط بعلمه احد وان علمه الذي نسب الى نفسه واستدل المستدلون في مقام عدله هو حقيقه الابداع وان نسبتها اليه هي نسبة التشريف بمثل نسبة الابداع اليه

- 24 Otherwise, O thou who gazest from the most exalted perspective and dwellest in the supreme horizon, when thou lookest with the eye of truth, God hath no attribute apart from His Essence and no description apart from His presence. He knoweth all things as they are, whether universals or particulars, substances or accidents, after their creation just as on the day He had not created them. He knoweth them because knowledge is life, and just as God, glory be to Him, is Ever-Living in the eternity of eternities, and needeth not the existence of any living thing to prove His life, He was All-Knowing of all things without there being any object of knowledge.

24 والا اذا نظرت يا ايها الناظر بالمنظر الاعلى و الساكن في افق الكبرى بطرف الحقيقة ليس لله وصف دون ذاته ولا نعت دون جنابه وانه عالم بكلشي بما هو شيء من الكليات والجزئيات والجوهريات والعرضيات بعد خلقها بمثل يوم الذي لم يخلقها وهو عالم بها لان العلم هو الحيات فكما ان الله سبحانه هو حي في ازل الازال ولا حاجة في اثبات حياته بوجود ذي حي فكان عالمًا بكلشي من دون ان يكون معروفًا

- 25 Glory be to Him and exalted is He! He was ever All-Knowing when there was no object of knowledge, and now God is as He was, All-Knowing of all things, though no object of knowledge existeth at His level. The reality of knowledge at the level of the contingent is the object of knowledge itself, as al-Sadiq (peace be upon him) clearly stated in his words, exalted be his remembrance: "Knowledge is the perfection of what is known, and power and might are the perfection of action." Were the universals of wisdom not complete in their inward and outward aspects, wisdom would not be perfect from the All-Wise, even were He powerful.

25 فسبحانه وتعالى كان عالمًا لم يزل ولا معلوم ان الان كان الله بمثل ما كان يكون عالمًا بكلشي ولا وجود لمعلوم في رتبته وان حقيقة العلم في مقام الممكن هو المعلوم كما صرح به الصادق عليه السلام في قوله حيث قال عز ذكره العلم تمام المعلوم والقدرة والعزة تمام الفعل ولو لم يكن كليات الحكمة تامة في بطونها وتامة في ظهورها لم يكن الحكمة تامة من الحكيم ولو كان قادرا

- 26 When thou considerest this exposition and knowest the reality of what exists in creation through this explanation, thou wilt be convinced that the secret reality mentioned in the traditions, by which the learned excel one another in explaining mysteries, is but a created and contingent sign unto which God hath manifested Himself through it, making it a sign of Himself that one might thereby advance toward His knowledge and attain to the reality of what is possible in contingent existence through God's grace. It is a contingent sign like the letters

26 واذا لاحظت بالبيان وعرفت حقيقة ما في الكيان بذكر البيان لتوقن بان سر الحقيقة التي وردت في الاخبار وبها يتفاضل العلماء في بيان الاسرار هي اية مخلوفة حادثة تجلى الله لها بها وجعلها اية لنفسه ليتلجلج بها الى معرفته ويبلغ بها الى حقيقة ما يمكن في الامكان عن فيض الله و هي اية حادثة بمثل احرف لا اله الا الله كما هو انها يدل على الله وهي حروف مجتمعة

of "There is no god but God," which, while being assembled letters, indicate God.

- 27 Likewise is the sign of thy reality when thou hast removed from it the veils and allusions, and entered the house of majesty through the effacement of vision and the sobriety of station, and the attraction of oneness and stillness in the ocean of eternity. Then hast thou attained to the ultimate bounty of God in contingent existence, and I find no suspension in God's bounty. Verily, the matter which thy presence hath been granted in the Book through mercy is the mystery of obligation and the ultimate station of recognition. Were I to interpret but one letter of thy allusions, all the seas of ink would be exhausted, for God hath created within everything the wisdom of all things. And he whom God, glorified be He, hath aided through His grace, is not veiled by anything in the heavens or on earth from the wisdom of any thing. The first letter of thy book is the letter "Ha" and I shall now indicate in its interpretation that which God hath written for me, and I beseech thy pardon for aught else.

- 28 Know that the letter "Ha" is the fifth rank of the manifestations of divine unity and the conditions of abstraction, and it is the letter of unity in the heart. And when it revolved in the four temples through the four witnessings, the letter "Kaf" appeared, which is the first word of the Command whereby all things were established. God, glorified be He, created the stations of unity in the letter "Ha." Among them is the station of the Point, which is the station of Muhammad, the Messenger of God, where he dwelt in the station of unity from the realm of creation, retaining no mention of self beside Him. In this station he is unique, without likeness, exalted above any similitude, and detached from all connection and separation. This is the station which God specially reserved for His Beloved and chose for His Prophet, making him in this station the manifestation of His Self in expression, inasmuch as God was and is eternally unconnected with the creation of things. He standeth in the station of true divine unity wherein none in all contingent existence can possibly attain save him, nor hath any other any portion of that wherewith God hath honored him and guided him. In that station he is absolute poverty incarnate and pure manifestation in the station of dust. Therefore my spirit and all who dwell in the kingdoms of Command and Creation glory in his poverty before all who dwell in the kingdom of names and attributes. This is the station of the mention of that Reality which no veils can conceal, which no proofs can match, which no signs can depart from, and which nothing among the verses can approach.

27 وكذلك اية حقيقتك اذا كشفت عنها السُّبُحات والاشارات ودخلت بيت الجلال بحو العيان و صحو المقام و جذب الاحدية و السكون في البحر الصمديه فقد بلغت الى غاية فيض الله في الامكان وما اجد لفيض الله تعطيلًا وان امر الذي نزلت جنابك في الكتاب بالرحمة هو سر التكليف ومنتى مقام التعريف و انى لو اردت ان افسر حرفا من اشاراتك لتفى كل البحر بالمدايه لان الله قد خلق في كلشئ حكم كلشئ وان الذى هو الله سبحانه ايداه بفضل لم يحجب شئ في السموات و لا في الارض من حكم شئ وان حرف الاول من كتابك هو حرف الهاء وانا ذا اشير في تفسيره ما كتب الله لي واسئل من جنابك العفو عن غيره

28 و هو ان حرف الهاء هو رتبة خامس ظهورات التوحيد و شئون التوحيد و هو حرف التوحيد في القواد و لما دار في هياكل الاربعه بالمشاهده الاربعه ظهر حرف الكاف و هو اول كلمة الامر الذى به قام كلشئ وان الله سبحانه خلق مقامات التوحيد في حرف الهاء و ان منها مقام النقطة و هو مقام محمد رسول الله حيث قد سكن في مقام التوحيد من الابداع لا بقى لنفسه ذكرا دونه و انه في هذا المقام منفرد عن الشبه و متعالى عن المثل و منقطع عنه كل ذى و صل و فصل و هو مقام الذى اختصه الله لحبيبه و اختاره لنبيه و جعله في هذا المقام مقام نفسه في الاداء اذ كان الله لم يزل لا يقترن بجعل الاشياء و هو الواقف في مقام توحيد الحق الذى لا يمكن في الامكان لاحد سواه و لا لغيره نصيب بما اكرمه الله و هداه و هو في ذلك المقام هو الفقير البحت البات و صرف الظهور في مقام التراب و لذا افتخره روحى و من في ملكوت الامر و الخلق فداء بقره لمن في ملكوت الاسماء و الصفات و هذا مقام ذكر الحقيقه التى لا يوارىها الحجابات و لا يعادلها الدلالات و لا يفارقها العلامات و لا يقارنها شئ من الايات

29 Glorified be its Originator! The eye of creation hath never seen the like of Muhammad, the Messenger of God, in all existence. All that others have said in his description is falsehood in his holy court and calumny against his sanctified glory. He is as God said on the night of the Ascension: "Thou art the Beloved and the Loved One." And he himself said concerning his station: "None knoweth me save God and thou, O Ali." And Ali, peace be upon him, said concerning him in his sermon on the Day of Ghadir and Friday: "And I bear witness that Muhammad is His servant and His Messenger, whom He chose in pre-eternity above all nations, unique without similarity or likeness among the sons of his kind or peers. He established him in His station throughout all His worlds in expression, since vision comprehendeth Him not, nor can thoughts of mind encompass Him, while He comprehendeth all vision, and He is the All-Subtle, the All-Informed." This is the station of the Primal Will in contingent existence, where God manifested Himself to it through it for itself, and made it the sign of His kingdom that those who reflect might take lesson in the mention of the Most Beautiful Names and the Most Exalted Attributes - though all these are detached from His presence and withheld from His station. For He is as He is, none knowing how He is save God Who created him. So glorified be God above what they describe!

30 And among them is the station of the gentle Alif, and the mystery of eternity, and the divine reed, and the heavenly leaf. The Celestial Leaf and the Heavenly Tree and the Universal Guardianship through which God is known in the second station, and after the station of Muhammad, the Apostle of God, peace be upon Him, there is no true unity save through 'Ali, peace be upon him. All others know God as would an ant - nay, I seek God's forgiveness for even this limitation. There exists no unity save his unity, as he himself, exalted be his remembrance, hath said in his last sermon: "I am the meaning upon which no name nor likeness can be placed, and I am the Gate of Remission, and there is no power nor strength save in God, the Most High, the Most Great." And verily he, may my spirit be a sacrifice unto him, as the Most Great Lord hath testified, is known only to God and to himself. Sufficient proof of his excellence is that were it not for him, none like him would exist. And glorified be God, his Creator, above all description.

31 And among them is the station of Divine Unity, of the extended Alif; this is the station of the letters of "There is none other God but He"—eleven souls, the Imams of justice, the honored servants, who act not save by the command of God and who, in their fear of Him, are filled with awe. Verily, they do magnify the unity of God through stations pertaining unto 'Ali, peace

29 جل مبدعه لم تر عين الاختراع بمثل محمد رسول الله في الانشاء و كل ما قال في وصفه سواء هو كذب في ساحة قدسه وافك لجلال تنزيهه وهو كما قال الله في ليلة المعراج انت الحبيب والمحبوب وقال بنفسه في حقه ما يعرفني الا الله وانت يا علي وقال علي عليه السلام في حقه في خطبة يوم الغدير والجمعة واشهد ان محمدا عبده ورسوله استخلصه في القدم على سائر الامم منفرد عن التشابه والتشاكل عن ابناء الجنس والمثل اقامه مقامه في سائر عوالمه في الاداء اذ كان لا تدركه الابصار ولا تحويه خواطر الافكار وهو يدرك الابصار وهو اللطيف الخبير وان ذلك مقام المشية في الامكان حيث قد تجلى الله لها بها لنفسها وجعلها اية ملكه وليتعب المتعبرون في ذكر الاسماء حسنى وصفات عليا وكل ذلك منقطعة عن جنبه وممتعة عن مقامه فهو كما هو لا يعلم كيف هو الا الله الذي خلقه فسبحان الله عما يصفون

30 ومنها مقام الف اللينيه وسر الازلية والقصبة اللاهوتية والورقة الجبروتية والشجرة الملكوتية والولاية الكلية التي يوحد الله ربه في مراتب الثاني وليس في الامكان بعد مقام محمد رسول الله ص توحيد واقعي الا لعل عليه السلام وكل ما سواء يوحدون الله بمثل النمل بل استغفر الله عن ذلك التحديد الكثير لا وجود لتوحيد غيره لديه حيث قال بنفسه عز ذكره في اخر خطبته انا المعنى الذي لا يقع عليه اسم ولا شبه وانا باب حظه ولا حول ولا قوة الا بالله العلي العظيم وانه هو روحى فداه كما شهد بذلك سيد الاكبر لا يعرفه الا الله ونفسه وكفى في فضله لولاه لم يك مثله وسبحان الله موجهه عما يصفون

31 ومنها مقام توحيد الف المبسوطه وهى مقام احرف لا اله الا هو احد عشر نفسا ائمة العدل عباد المكرمون الذين لا يعملون الا بامر الله وهم من خشيته يشفقون وانهم ليوحدون الله بمرات

be upon him, and none save themselves can attain unto them. All who are beside them are, in their sight, mentioned only through that unity whereby they themselves bear witness unto God.

علي عليه السلام ولا يصل اليهم احد غيرهم و  
ان ما سواهم عندهم ليذكرون بما هم يوحدون

- 32 Sufficient testimony to the excellence of their remembrance is that which shone forth from the holy precinct unto 'Uthman ibn Muhammad al-'Amri, in the visitation of the Family of God, where He Himself hath said concerning the irrevocable decree and the effacement: "The fixed decree is that which your will hath reserved unto itself, and the effacement is that which your practice hath reserved unto itself." And every mention joined with the mention of others is, before their presence, but calumny against their holiness and falsehood in the face of their power.

32 وكفى في ذكر فضلهم ما طلع من ناحية المقدسة  
الى عثمان بن محمد العمري في زيارة ال الله حيث  
قال بنفسه عن ذكره القضاء المثبت ما استاثرت  
به مشيتكم والحو ما لا استاثرت به سنتكم وان  
كل ذكر بذكر غيرهم افك لحضرتهم و كذب في  
قدرتهم

- 33 Yet, since it hath ever been God's wont to show forth beneficence, while the condition of contingent being is helplessness and want, God hath, through the bounty of His grace, accepted in behalf of the friends of those hallowed names. Otherwise, no one would have any portion in the knowledge of them, nor would any created thing possess any share in making mention of them. Glorified be God, their Creator, above all that they describe.

33 ولكن الله لما كان عادته هو الاحسان و شان  
الامكان هو العجز والبيان قد قبل الله في حق  
اولياء تلك الاسماء المقدسة جودا لفضله و الا لا  
نصيب لاحد في معرفتهم ولا حظ لشي في ذكرهم  
و سبحان الله موجدهم عما يصفون

- 34 Among these is the station of the combined letters, which is the station of unity of Fatimih, the blessings of God be upon her. She speaks of God and indicates God through what God hath revealed to her through numbered mirrors. Through her light were created the realities of the Prophets, and through her were brought into being the essential gems of the successors from among God's chosen ones and His Messengers. None among the Prophets and successors below her station have any share in her unity. The deeds of her physical form are purer and more elevated than the hearts of the Prophets and the essence of the successors. None knoweth her as she truly is save God and the Letters of Unity. Glorified be God above all description.

34 ومنها مقام حروف المجتمعة و هي مقام توحيد  
فاطمه صلوات الله عليها وانها هي تحكي عن الله  
وتدل على الله بما تجلي الله لها بها بمرآة معدودة و  
ان نورها قد وجدت حقايق الانبياء وذوت بها  
جواهر ذاتيات اوصياء من اولياء الله ورسله ولا  
نصيب لمن كان في دونها من الانبياء والاوصياء  
عن توحيدها وان عمل جسمها هو ازكي و ارفع  
من عمل افئدة النبيين وجوهريات الوصيين ولا  
يعرفها كما هي اهلها الا الله و احرف التوحيد و  
سبحان الله عما يصفون

- 35 Among these is the station of the Words, which is the station of unity of the Prophets and the believers among humanity, who indicate God through the shadow of the light of Fatimih's physical form, the blessings of God be upon her. They enter the sea of Oneness and the depths of Eternity and the Throne of Glory and Grandeur through the excellence of Fatimih's remembrance, the blessings of God be upon her. None save them has any share in their unity and their knowledge of God, glorified be He. These are the cherubim of whom al-Sadiq spoke, saying: "They are a people from among our followers from the first creation whom God hath placed behind the Throne. Were

35 ومنها مقام الكلمات و هو مقام توحيد الانبياء و  
المؤمنين من الانس حيث يدلون على الله بظل  
نور جسد فاطمه صلوات الله عليها و يدخلون  
بحر الاحدية ولجة الصمدانية و عرش الجلال  
والعظمة بفاضل ذكر فاطمه صلوات الله عليها  
وليس لاحد ممن سواهم حظ في توحيدهم و  
عرفانهم لله سبحانه و انهم الكروبيون الذين قال  
الصادق في شانهم ما قال انهم قوم من شيعتنا من

the light of but one of them to be divided among the people of the earth, it would suffice them.”

- 36 When Moses asked of his Lord what he asked, He commanded one among them, and He revealed Himself to him in the measure of a needle's eye, whereupon the mountain crumbled and Moses fell down in a swoon. These five degrees all return to the negation of unity from unity, and though each of these degrees hath four stations which return to a single point. Among these is the unity of the Essence, in that as He is what He is, none knoweth Him save Him, and none can prove Him save Him, and none can say He is He save Him, for whatsoever is besides Him, should it speak or describe, pointeth to the station of its own self and telleth of the limits of its own geometry. And He, as He is in Himself, hath no name nor attribute, nor can anything prove Him, for proof is contingent upon conjunction, and all describe their own selves and adduce evidence of their own reality through their own signs. Glorified be God above what they describe!

- 37 And among these is the unity of attributes, in that God hath no attribute apart from His Essence, and no name apart from His presence, by the testimony of His Essence unto His Essence that He cannot be described by the attributes of His creation, and by the testimony of His creation unto His creation that the attribute, by its own testimony unto itself, returneth to the station of limitation. The existence of description itself is the greatest proof that God hath no attribute nor description. All names are signs of His Will, all similitudes are likenesses of His Purpose, all attributes are tokens of His Dominion, and all proofs are stations of His Grandeur. Thus glorified and exalted is God Who hath described Himself as having no description, and Who hath described Himself to His creation through what He hath revealed in His Book that they might know Him thereby and worship Him, not associating anyone with His worship.

- 38 And among these is the unity of deeds, wherein all feet have stumbled in understanding the matter between the two matters, which is the mystery of destiny, and whereby the servants recognize their Creator in the station of deeds. All who have addressed the question of destiny, whether through compulsion or delegation, including all the philosophers who have confessed their powerlessness to explain the reality of this matter - this indeed is the true state of affairs. For the philosophers desired to explain God's command regarding the matter between the two matters through rational proof, which is impossible, since reason, even at the utmost degree of its abstraction, comprehendeth naught but that which is limited. And until the servant

الخالق الاول جعلهم الله خلف العرش لو قسم نور واحد منهم على اهل الارض لكفاهم

- 36 و لما سئل موسى ربه ما سئل امر رجلا منهم فتجلى له بقدر سم الابره فذلك الجبل و خر موسى صعبا وان تلك المراتب الخمسة هي ترجع الى نفى التوحيد عن التوحيد وان كان لكل تلك المراتب مقامات اربعة التي ترجع الى نقطة واحدة فنها توحيد الذات بانه كما هو هو لن يعرفه الا هو ولن يدل عليه الا هو ولا يقدر احد ان يقول انه هو هو الا هو لان ما سواه لو قال وصف يشير الى مقام نفسه ويحكي عن حدود هندسته و هو كما هو عليه لا اسم له ولا صفة ولا يدل عليه شئ اذ الدلالة فرع الاقتران و كل يصفون انفسهم و يستدلون في اياتهم بنعت حقايقهم سبحانه الله عما يصفون

- 37 و منها توحيد الصفات بان لا صفة لله دون ذاته و لا له اسم دون جنابه بشهادة ذاته بانه لم يك موصوفا بصفات خلقه و بشهادة خلقه بان الصفة بشهادة نفسها نفسها مردودة الى مقام الحد و ان وجود الوصف بنفسه اعظم دليل الا صفة الله و لا نعت و كل الاسماء سمة لمشيته و كل الامثال مثل لارادته و كل الصفات علامات لجبروتيته و كل الدلالات مقامات لكبريائيته فسبحان الله و تعالى و صف نفسه بان لا وصف له و و صف نفسه لخلقها بما نزل في كتابه ليعرفوه به و يعبدوه و لا يشركون بعبادته احدا

- 38 و منها توحيد الافعال و ان في ذلك المقام ذلت اقدام الكل في معرفة الامر بين الامرين الذي هو سر القدر و به يوحف العباد موجدتهم في مقام الافعال و كل من بين مسئلة القدر من الجبر و التفويض حيث قد اعترف كل الحكماء العجز في بيان حقيقة ذلك المسئلة و ان ذلك هو الامر في الواقع لان الحكماء ارادوا ان يبينوا امر الله في بين الامرين بدليل العقل و ان ذلك ممنوع لان العقل في منتهى مقام تجرده لا يدرك الا شيئا محدودا و ان لم يبلغ العبد الى ذروة حظ الفواد فلا مفر لمن استقر على كرسي سلطنة العقل بان يعترف

reacheth the summit of the heart's portion, whoever sitteth upon the throne of reason's sovereignty must needs confess either to delegation or compulsion, for that which lieth between them - the matter between the two matters, the station more expansive than what lieth between the heaven of receptivities and the earth of acceptances - can only be comprehended by the heart which God hath created for the knowledge of His unity and the sanctification of his Lord. The servant recognizeth God's unity in the station of deeds and becometh certain of the truth of that verse from the Most Exalted: "Is there any Creator other than God who provideth for you from heaven and earth? There is no God but He!" "This is God's creation; now show Me what those beside Him have created." Nay, the wrongdoers are in manifest error.

بالتفويض او الجبر اذ ما سوى ذلك الذى هو الامر بين الامرين والمنزلة الا وسعة عن ما بين سماء القابليات والارض المقبولات لا يدرك الا الفواد الذى خلقه الله لمعرفة توحيده وتنزيه ربه يوحد الله فى مقام الافعال ويوقن العبد بحقيقة تلك الاية من العلي المتعال فهل من خالق غيركم يدعوكم الى الله ان كنتم تعقلون هذا خلق الله فارونى ماذا خلق الذى من دونه بل الظالمون فى ظلال مبين

39 Without this awareness, the servant comprehendeth not what is incumbent upon him in wisdom. Therefore did the Imam say: "Destiny is a secret among God's secrets, a protection among God's protections, raised up in God's veil, concealed from God's creation, sealed with God's seal, foreknown in God's knowledge. God hath relieved His servants of its knowledge."

39 ومن دون ذلك المشعر لم يدرك العبد ما وجب عليه فى الحكمة ولذا قال الامام ان القدر سر من سر الله وحرز من حرز الله مرفوع فى حجاب الله مطوى عن خلق الله مختم بخاتم الله سابق فى علم الله

40 God has lifted His knowledge above His servants and raised it above their testimonies and the extent of their minds, for they cannot attain it through divine reality, nor through eternal power, nor through luminous grandeur, nor through the might of oneness. It is a surging, overflowing sea, purely for God, the Mighty and Glorious. Its depth extends between heaven and earth, its width between east and west, black as the darkest night, full of serpents and whales, rising at times and sinking at others. In its depths shines a sun which none should seek to discover except the One, the Single. Whoever attempts to discover it has opposed God, the Mighty and Glorious, in His wisdom, contested His sovereignty, unveiled His secret and His covering, and has incurred God's wrath - his abode is hell, an evil destination.

40 وضع الله عن العباد علمه ورفع فوق شهادتهم ومبلغ عقولهم لانهم لا ينالونه بحقيقة الربانية ولا بقدرة الصمدانية ولا بعظمة التوراتية ولا بعزة الوجدانية بحر ذاخر مواج خالص لله عز وجل عمقه ما بين السماء والارض عرضه ما بين المشرق والمغرب اسود كالليل الدامس الكثير الحيات والحيتان يعلو مرة ويسفل اخرى فى قعره شمس تضى لا ينبغى ان يطلع عليها الا الواحد الفرد فن تطلع عليها فقد ضاد الله عز وجل فى حكمه ونازعه فى سلطانه وكشف عن سره وستره وباؤ بغضب من الله وماويه جهنم وبئس المصير

41 The secret of the matter is that none should see the manifestation of things' actions as they truly are except the soul that manifests the choices of things as they are and as they continue infinitely in what has no end. None should see any light except His light, nor any decree except His decree, for nothing exists in the heavens or earth except through seven stages which are the stations of the Family of God, peace be upon them. The servant, at the time of action, acts through the action of destiny from One All-Knowing and All-Wise, for God, glorified be He, has always known the choices of all and how they proceed therein, recompensing them according to their qualities and giving them their due.

41 وان سر الامر هو ان لا يرى احد ظهور فعل الاشياء بما هو عليه الا نفس تجلى اختيارات الاشياء بما هم عليه وما هم سائرون الى ما لا نهاية بما لا نهاية لها ولا يرى نورا الا نوره ولا حكم الا حكمه لان لا يوجد شئ فى السموات ولا فى الارض الا بمراتب سبعة التى هى مقامات ال الله سلام الله عليهم وان العبد فى حين الفعل هو يفعل بفعل القدر من لدن خبير علم لان الله سبحانه كان عالما باختيارات الكل وماهم سائرون على ذلك يجزيهم وصفهم ويعطيهم حقهم

- 42 This choice accompanies the existence of things, and nothing exists except through its choice, for at the time of the choice's existence when God the Exalted said "Am I not your Lord?", had there not been choice, the response "Yea" would not have been given. Similarly is the decree in every aspect and every matter. If the observer truly looks, he sees the manifestation of "Am I not your Lord?" only in himself through the mention of "Yea" or in manifestation through the mention of "Nay" - and it is a mystery. They see no influencer except God, witness no command except God's command, worship nothing alongside Him, and believe regarding the right of the Family of God neither in delegation nor in suspension. Rather, God has never ceased to create what He wills, how He wills, through what He wills. He has no partner in His action, no protecting friend in His command, and He is as He is in His action - none knows how He is except Him.
- 43 God has taught in the Qur'an through His exalted word: "Whatever good befalls thee is from God, and whatever evil befalls thee is from thyself. We have sent thee as a Messenger to mankind and God suffices as a witness." Then His exalted word: "Say: All is from God." This indeed is the secret of the unity of actions. God has not revealed any verse mentioning this truth more perfectly and completely than the words "There is no power nor strength except through God." Glory be to God above what they describe. And from this comes the unity of worship, where God, exalted be His mention, said: "Say: I am but a mortal like you. It is revealed to me that your God is one God. So whoever hopes to meet his Lord, let him do righteous work and not associate anyone in the worship of his Lord." And this unity is identical to the unity of the Essence.
- 44 That Unity is itself the unity of Essence, Attributes and Deeds. Whosoever uniteth God through unity of Essence hath indeed unified Him according to how He hath described Himself in the station of Attributes, Deeds and Worship. And whosoever worshippeth God through attribute or name hath not worshipped Him and is indeed a polytheist. And whosoever worshippeth Him through mention of His Self is like unto the first, a polytheist. And whosoever worshippeth God according to how He hath described Himself through His names and attributes which God hath revealed in His Book, hath worshipped Him in the manner possible within the bounds of contingent existence. Otherwise, as He is in Himself and as beseemeth Him, none besides Him hath known Him so as to worship Him. He hath ever been beyond description through signs, beyond characterization through tokens, and none but He can indicate His own Self.
- وان ذلك الاختيار هو مساوق وجود الشيء ولا يوجد شيء الا باختياره لان حين وجود الاختيار لما قال الله تعالى الست بربكم لو لم يكن مختارا لم يقل بلى اولاً وكذلك الحكم في كل شأن وفي كل امر وان الناظر لو ينظر بالحقيقة لا يرى تجلى نفس الست بربكم الا في نفسه بذكر بلى او في ظهور بذكر لا وهو سر ولا يرون مؤثرا الا الله ولا يشهدون بامر الا بامر الله ولا يعبدون معه شيء ولا يعتقدون في حق الله تفويضا ولا تعطيلاً بل ان الله هو لم يزل يدع ما يشاء بما يشاء بما يشاء وليس له شريك في فعله ولا ولي بالذل في امره وهو كما هو عليه في فعله لا يعلم كيف هو الا هو
- 43 ولقد ادب الله في القرآن بقوله عز ذكره ما اصابك من حسنة فمن الله وما اصابك من سيئة فمن نفسك وارسلك للناس رسولا وكفى بالله شهيدا ثم قوله عز ذكره قل كل من عند الله وان ذلك لهو السر في توحيد الافعال ولا ينزل الله اية في ذكر ذلك البيان اكمل واتم من كلمة لا حول ولا قوة الا بالله سبحانه الله عما يصفون ومنها توحيد العبادة حيث قال الله عز ذكره قل انما انا بشر مثلكم يوحى الى انما الحكم اله واحد فمن كان يرجوا لقاء ربه فليعمل عملا صالحا ولا يشرك بعباده ربه احدا
- 44 وان ذلك التوحيد هو بعينها توحيد الذات والصفات والافعال فمن وحد الله بتوحيد الذات فقد وحده بما وصف له نفسه في مقام الصفات والافعال والعبادة ومن عبد الله بوصف او اسم فلم يعبدته وكان مشركا ومن عبده بذكر نفسه فهو بمثل الاول مشرك ومن عبد الله بما وصف نفسه باسمائه وصفاته التي نزل الله في كتابه فقد عبده بما يمكن في حق الا مكان والا كما انه هو عليه ويستحق به لم يعرفه احد غيره حتى يعبدته وهو لم يزل لا يوصف بالايات ولا يتعت بالعلامات ولا يدل عليه احد سواه

45 Verily the servant cannot worship God in any way save as He willeth. In God's Cause there is the decree of Bada, and in God's Book it hath two stations: the Bada of justice, which departeth not from the essence of anything, and from which nothing is secure - it is God's Cause which all things fear, and if God desired to destroy all creation, by this Bada would He destroy it instantly, and none can resist His Will, none can question His deed, none can thwart His decree, and none can comprehend His purpose. He doeth what He willeth through what He willeth, and nothing in the heavens or earth is too great for Him, and He is the Mighty, the Wise. And the Bada of grace is in the rank of destiny, and it is grace and favor for the believers whereby God changeth their evil deeds to good deeds and eraseth from the pages of their works the bounds of transgression, bestowing upon whomsoever He willeth whatsoever He willeth, and He is the Self-Sufficient, the All-Praised.

46 Verily these four ranks are in truth a single manifestation in five stations, and in the fifth rank wherein the Prophets, people, believers and angels affirm His unity, it is as al-Sadiq, peace be upon him, indicated in his words, exalted be his remembrance: "We are the root of all good, and our branches are all righteousness, and of righteousness is the unity whereby God is unified." The Imams, peace be upon them, have derived from the manifestation of Fatimih's form, God's blessings be upon her, and thus the Imam was attributed to His Cause for it is the first station of deed. And this station was revealed through the four stations of unity in His words, exalted be His remembrance: "Our Cause is the mystery, and mystery enshrouded in mystery, and mystery veiled by mystery, and mystery that only mystery can reveal." Then His words, exalted be His remembrance: "Our Cause is the truth, and truth of truth, and it is the manifest, and manifest of the manifest, and hidden of the hidden, and it is the mystery, and mystery of mystery, and mystery enshrouded in mystery, and mystery veiled by mystery."

47 And all this pertaineth to the stations of limitation and the path of the limited. But for those detached unto God in the depths of oneness, and those dwelling upon the throne of might and eternality, verily the inscribed enshrouded mystery is the manifest witnessed sign, and the unseen with them is the very essence of witnessing, and none knoweth them in this station save God. They are a people who look not upon anything except through the gaze of the Lord, judge not anything except through His judgment, and alter no decree save by His leave. These are the ambassadors of the Faith.

45 وان العبد لم يعبد الله بشئ بمثل ما يشاء هو في امر الله حكم البداء وانه له في كتاب الله مقامين بداء عدل وهو لا يفارق ذات شئ ولا يامن منه شئ وهو امر الله الذي يخاف منه كلشئ ولو اراد الله ان يهلك كل من خلق فبذلك البداء فيهلك في الحين ولا مرد لارادته ولا يسئل احد من فعله ولا راد لقضائه ولا هندسة لمشيته يفعل ما يشاء بما يشاء ولا يتعاطمه شئ في السموات ولا في الارض وهو العزيز الحكيم وبداء فضل في رتبة القضاء وهو فضل واحسان للمؤمنين حيث يبدل الله سيئاتهم بالحسنات ويحو الله عن صحايف اعمالهم حدود الجريرات ويمن على من يشاء بما يشاء وهو الغني الحميد

46 وان تلك المراتب الاربعه هو في الحقيقة تجلي واحد في مقامات خمس وان في رتبة الخامس التي يوحد الانبياء والناس والمؤمنين والملائكة هو ما اشار الصادق عليه السلام في قوله حيث قال عز ذكره نحن اصل كل خير وفروعنا كل البر ومن البر التوحيد الذي يوحد الله به ما سواى الاثمه سلام الله عليهم قد ذوت من تجلى جسم فاطمه صلوات الله عليها ولذا نسب الامام بامرته لانه اول مقام الفعل وكشف عن هذا المقام بمقامات توحيد الاربعه قوله عز ذكره ان امرنا هو السر وسر مستسر بالسر وسر مقنع بالسر وسر لا يفيد الا السر ثم قوله عز ذكره بان امرنا هو الحق وحق الحق وهو الظاهر وظاهر الظاهر وباطن الباطن وهو السر وسر السر وسر المستسر والسر المقنع بالسر

47 وان كل ذلك في مقامات الحدود وسبيل الحدود والا فلهنقطعين الى الله في لجة الاحدية والساكنين على عرش العزة والصمدانية ان السر المستسر المسطور هو الاية الظاهرة المشهوده وان الغيب عندهم هو نفس الشهادة ولا يعرفهم في المقام احد غير الله وهم قوم لا ينظرون الى شئ الا بنظر الرب ولا يحكمون بشئ الا بحكمه

- 48 That which they ordained was not changed except by His leave, and these are the ambassadors of the Faith and pillars of certitude. Were it not for them, no rain would descend from heaven nor would vegetation spring forth from the earth. May God grant me their companionship in the gardens of Eden, and those who are righteous among their fathers and their offspring, through His grace - verily He is the Mighty, the Forgiving.
- 48 ولا يبدلون حكماً الا باذنه و اولئك هم سفراء الدين و اركان اليقين و لولاهم لم ينزل الماء من السماء و لا يخرج النبات من الارض رزقني الله مرافقتهم في جنات عدن و من صلح من ابائهم و ذرياتهم بفضلله انه عزيز غفور
- 49 We have indeed alluded in the depths of these allusions that the matter which thou didst desire cannot be realized except through the negation of allusions. Nay, the veil is more subtle than that, and the mirrors of reality more delicate than that glass. The negation of allusion is itself a form of allusion. To-day, if thou dost not cast away what is in thy right hand and thy left of the veils of subtleties and signs of delicacies, thou canst not journey unto God in the land of the crimson sand.
- 49 و لقد اشرنا في غياهب تلك الاشارات ان امر الذي انت اردت لن يخلص الا بنفي الاشارات بل ان الحجاب لكان الطف من ذلك و ان مرات الحقيقة اذق من تلك الزجاجة و ان نفي الاشارة هو شان من الاشارة و انت اليوم لو لم تلق ما في يمينك و الشمال من سبحات الدقائق و اشارات الرقائق لم تقدر ان تسلك الى الله في ارض كتيب الاحمر
- 50 For one such as thee, this matter is indeed difficult and arduous, for the darkness of the words of the people of veils hath encompassed thy inner being. Though such deeds may be counted as good deeds for the believers and blessings for the distressed, yet since thou hast desired this greatest path and mightiest station, I have ventured to mention these words unto thee, that the holy fragrances might draw thee to the summit of attributes and these allusions might free thee from what thou hast perceived from the allusions of the people of veils.
- 50 و ان على مثل جنابك ذلك الشان صعب مستصعب لان ظلمات كلمات اهل السبحات قد احاطت في باطنك و لو كان ان تلك السيئة عن مثلك حسنات للمؤمنين و خيرات للمستوحشين و لكن لما اردت ذلك المسلك الاكبر و الموقف الاعظم اجترحت على مثل جنابك بذكر الكلمات لتجذبك نفحات قدس الى ذروة الصفات و يخلصك تلك الاشارات عما ادركت نفسك من اشارات اهل السبحات
- 51 When thou turnest unto God, the Lord of lords, the allusions, veils, signs and stations are unveiled, and in the moment of heedlessness therefrom, thou enterest the Throne of Glory. This station, despite its grandeur and majesty, is nearer than the twinkling of an eye and more subtle than the closest glance. This indeed is the honor for one who was at the Greatest Scene when the Hour drew nigh and the moon was cleft asunder.
- 51 و انك حين توجهك بالله رب الارباب تكشف الاشارة و السبحات و العلامات و المقامات و تدخل حين الغفلة منها عرش الجلال و ان ذلك المقام مع عظم امره و كبر شانه لكان اقرب من لمح البصر و الطف من قرب النظر و ان ذلك هو الشرف لمن كان بالمنظر الاكبر و اقترب حكم الساعة و انشق القمر
- 52 Verily God hath placed honor in the knowledge of this station and in deeds performed in its vicinity, as al-Sadiq indicated in his words - exalted be his remembrance - when asked about the vision of God in the hereafter. He said: "Nay, the believers shall see Him before the Day of Resurrection." It was asked: "How is this so?" He replied: "When He said 'Am I not your Lord?' Then the veil was lifted." He said: "Dost thou not see Him at this very moment?"
- 52 و ان الله قد جعل الشرف في علم ذلك المقام و العمل في حوله كما اشار الصادق في قول نفسه عز ذكره حين سئل عن رؤية الله في دار الآخرة فقال بل يروه المؤمنون قبل يوم القيمة قيل فكيف ذلك قال حين قال الست بربكم ثم كشف الغطاء قال اولست تراه في وقتك هذا
- 53 And Ali's indication in his Tutunjiyyih sermon where he said - and his word is the truth: "I saw God and Paradise with the eye of certainty." By his vision - may my spirit be a sacrifice for him - he meant the vision of His manifestation unto him
- 53 و اشار علي في خطبته الطنجنجيه حيث قال و قوله الحق رايت الله و الفردوس راى العين و قد اراد روحى فداه من رويته رؤية تجليه له به في كل حين حيث بين الصادق في قوله عز ذكره

through Him at every moment, as al-Sadiq explained in his renowned tradition: "Servitude is a substance whose essence is Lordship," until he said "Present in thy absence and thy presence." And his martyred father indicated in his prayer on the Day of Arafah: "Other than Thee has an appearance that Thou hast not," until he said: "Blind is the eye that seeth Thee not, while Thou art ever watchful over it, and at loss is the servant whom Thou hast not granted a share of Thy love."

في حديث المشهور العبودية جوهره كنهها الربوبية الى ان قال موجود في غيبتك وحضرتك و اشار اباه الشهيد روى فداه في دعائه يوم العرفة الغيرك من الظهور ما ليس لك الى ان قال عميت عين لا تراك ولا تزال عليها رقيباً وخسرت صفقه عبد لم تجعل له من حبك نصيباً

54 This station is indeed the ultimate portion of contingent being at the point of conjunction, where God manifests Himself to the servant through Him in every moment with what pertains to might and glory. O thou who gazest upon the countenance of glory, magnify the Cause of God within thyself and observe thy Lord's mercy toward thee, for thy need in every condition is like unto thy need at the beginning of thy existence, when thou wert not even mentioned. Verily God manifesteth Himself unto thee through thee at every moment, just as He manifested Himself on the first day, for the servant's need for sustenance hath never ceased nor shall it ever be lifted.

54 وان ذلك المقام هو منتهى حظ الامكان في نقطة الاقتران حيث تجلى الله للعبد له به في كل الان بما هو من العزة والجلال وانك يا ايها الناظر الى وجه الجلال عظم امر الله في نفسك و لاحظ رحمة ربك فيك بان احتياجك في كل شان لكان بمثل احتياجك في بدء وجودك الذي من قبل لم يكن مذكوراً و

55 Verily, God revealeth Himself unto thee, through thine own self, in every instant, with a revelation like unto His revelation on the First Day; for the servant's need of sustaining grace hath ever been, and shall never be, removed. And God, in every state, revealeth Himself unto every state, through every state, with a revelation like unto His revelation unto them, through themselves, on the First Day. Nay rather, were man to behold the mystery of Reality, he would behold his own self—and indeed all his states—as a creation of the First Day. He would perceive in no state any light save His Light, nor any decree save through His Justice, nor any affliction save by His Ordainment, nor any Origination (bada') save by His Sanction.

55 ان الله تجلى لك بك في كل حين بمثل تجليه في يوم الاول لان احتياج المدد من العبد لم يزل لن يرفع وان الله في كل شان تجلى لكل شان بكل شان بمثل تجليه لهم بهم في يوم الاول بل ان الانسان لو شاهد سر الحقيقه يشاهد نفسه بل كل شئونه تخلق يوم الاول ولا يرى في شان نورا الا نوره ولا حكماً الا بعدله ولا بلاء الا بقضائه لا بداء الا بامضائه

56 Indeed, were the servant to remain steadfast in this condition, the attributes of divine lordship would flow through him, even as revealed in the sacred tradition: "My servant draweth nigh unto Me through supererogatory acts until I love him; and when I love him, I become the ear wherewith he heareth, and the eye wherewith he seeth, and the hand wherewith he graspeth. When he calleth upon Me, I answer him; when he asketh of Me, I grant his request; and when he is silent before Me, I initiate discourse with him." Thus are all his conditions, both hidden and manifest. His self becometh His Self, his deed His Deed, his command His Command, his prohibition His Prohibition, his obedience His Obedience, his disobedience His Disobedience, his love His Love - and likewise all that is attributed to him, even as the Sacred House is attributed to God, without similitude, for that which is being compared becometh

56 بل لو استقام العبد على ذلك الشان يجري عليه احكام الربوبية بمثل ما نزل في حديث القدسي ما زال العبد يتقرب الى بالنوافل حتى احبه فاذا احبه كنت سمعه الذي يسمع به وبصره الذي يبصر به ويده التي يبطش بها ان دعاني اجبته وان ستلني اعطيته وان سكت عنى ابتدائه و كذلك كان كل شئونه في السر والعلانية فكان على حكم ذلك نفسه نفسه وفعله فعله وامره امره ونهيه نهيه وطاعته طاعته ومعصيته معصيته و محبته محبته و كذلك كما نسب اليه بمثل نسبت بيت الحرام الى الله من دون تشبيه لان المشبه به كان عين المشبه كما نطق بذلك سر الحديث تجلى لها بها فالقى في هويتها مثاله فظهر عنها افعاله

identical with that to which it is compared, as indicated in the mystery of the tradition: "He revealed Himself to her through her, casting His image upon her essence, thus manifesting His acts through her."

57 Blessed, then, is he whom God hath raised unto Himself, freed from the conditions of his self and the transgressions of his days, and preserved upon the throne of His oneness, seeing none besides Him, asking naught save through His remembrance, finding solace in none save His nearness, seeing no glory save in His good-pleasure, no wrath save in His punishment, no spirit save in His splendor, no tranquility save in His praise. And thou, O noble one, knowest well the paths of remembrance and guidance, and I fear not for thee when thou findest intimacy in the sacred precincts with thy glorious Lord.

58 Verily this matter possesseth such subtlety that none can reckon it save God. If thou art veiled from it by the slightest hint, thou shalt be removed from it to a degree none knoweth save God. Even as when Kumayl questioned Ali (upon him be peace), he, may my spirit be his sacrifice, turned him away for that which he asked, since He about Whom he inquired was nearer to him than himself. How can one who perceiveth not the Light that encompasseth his inner and outer being - such that no other light existeth - possibly behold Reality through Reality and witness the mystery of Divine Unity through the Eternal Light? Verily this is as manifest to one such as thyself as the sun at its zenith.

59 And since God knew that some people, through their love for that station wherein whoso standeth hath stood by God's command, created for those who gaze upon His countenance in the eternity of eternities and who abide with Him at every instant, signs and tokens whereby may be distinguished him in whom that station is confounded from him who standeth in certitude in the Sacred Mosque, lest people be removed from the effulgences of the glory of His sovereignty and all might know the revelations of His mighty power, and none might say "Had God acquainted me with His signs, I would surely have been among the thankful."

60 When thou art certain of this matter, look to the proof and be patient concerning the signs of the All-Glorious, for the mystery of this ocean is profound, most profound, and the wisdom of that mystery is exquisite, most exquisite, and the veil of that Cause is subtle, most subtle, and the attributes of that servant are delicate, most delicate. And when thou didst desire in that station the mention of the Balance and the measure of utterance and the proof of man in utterance, I loved that thou shouldst be endeared with the knowledge thereof.

57 فيا طوبى لمن ارفعه الله اليه وخلصه من شئوناته  
نفسه وجريرات ايامه و احفظه على كرسي  
توحيده من ان لا يرى احدا سواه لا يستلثه بشئ  
من دون ذكره و لا يستانس باحد دون قرب  
جواره و لا يرى عزا الا في رضائه و لا سخطا  
الا في عقابه و لا روحا الا في بهائه و لا سكونا  
الا في ثنائه و انت يا ايها الجليل لتعرف سبل  
الذكر و الدليل و لا اخاف عليك اذا استانست  
في ساحة القدس برب جليل

58 و ان الامر بذلك اللطافة التي لا يحصيها احد الا  
الله اذا حجت عنه باشاره لتبعه منه ما لا يعلمه احد  
الا الله كما حين سئل الكميل عن علي عليه السلام  
اطرده روحى فداه بما سئل عنه لان المسئول عنه  
هو اقرب اليه منه و من لم يرى نور الذى قد احاط  
سره و علانيته بحيث لم يك نورا سواه فكيف يقدر  
ان يرى الحقيقة بالحقيقة و يشاهد سر الصمدانية  
بالنور الازلية و ان ذلك مشهود عند مثل جنابك  
بمثل هذا الشمس في نقطة الزوال

59 و لما علم الله ان بعض الناس لمحبتهم بذلك المقام  
الذى من قام فيه قام بامر الله خلق للناظرين الى  
وجهه في ازل الازال و المستقرين عنده في كل  
ان ايات و علامات التي بها يميز من يشبهه على  
انفسهم ذلك المقام بمن هو قائم باليقين في المسجد  
الحرام لتلا يبعد الناس من انوار سبحات عزته و  
يعرف الكل تجليات عز قدرته و لا يقول احد لو  
عرفنى الله اياته لكنت من الشاكرين

60 فاذا ايقنت بذلك الامر انظر بالدليل و اصبر على  
ايات الجليل فان سر هذا البحر عميق عميق و  
حكم ذلك السر انيق و ان حجاب ذلك الامر  
دقيق دقيق و ان شئون ذلك العبد رقيق رقيق  
و لما ما اردت في ذلك المقام بذكر القسطاس و  
ميزان البيان و حجة الانسان في البيان فاني احببت  
ان تحببت بعلم ذلك فانظر الى ما نزلنا في شرح

Wherefore look unto what We have sent down in explanation of the Kawthar to him who hath turned and given thanks, and warn every one who hath waxed proud and disbelieved.

الكوثر لمن اقبل وشكر وانذر كل من استكبر وكفر

- 61 But I adjure thee by God to look upon Our signs with the eye of love and insight, for the proof of that Cause is naught but the truth and none can uphold it save whom God willeth. Forget not what God hath ordained for thee, for today thou knowest My weakness and art able to remove My distress. I do not complain to thee, but since I know what lieth beyond that Cause, I desire that thou shouldst be as God created thee, and be unto God's creation as God hath been unto thee.

61 ولكن اقسمك بالله ان تنظر الى اشاراتنا بعين المحبة والبصيرة فان حجة ذلك الامر لاهو الحق ولا يقوم به احد الا من شاء الله ولا تنس ما قدر الله لك فان اليوم انت تعلم ضعفى وتقدر على كشف ضرى ولا اشكو اليك ولكن لما اعلم ما وراء ذلك الامر احب ان تكون كما خلقك الله وانت كن خلقت الله بمثل ما كان الله لك

- 62 I know that these forms of knowledge and contrary conditions grieve thee and keep thee from attaining unto divine decrees and the mystery of eternity and the sign of oneness in the word of the All-Merciful. But read some of Our pages, for through thy communion with God thou shalt find what hath never occurred to the heart of any mortal, and thou shalt know divine knowledge that no pen hath ever recorded in the chain of creation. And whatsoever doubts and accidents occur to thy heart, dispel them through the Balance of the measure, for God hath created utterance for man, and had God known anything more noble than speech He would have made it the means between Him and His Messengers.

62 و انى لا علم ان تلك الصور العلية والشؤون الضدية يحزنك ويشغلك عن الورود على حكم الريانيه وسر الصمدانيه واية الوجدانية فى كلمة الرحمانية ولكن اقرأ بعض صحايفنا فان بمناجاتك مع الله تجد ما لا يخطر بقلب بشر من قبل و تعرف معارف حقه لا تجربها قلم احد فى سلسلة الرعية بمثلها وان كلما يخطر بقلبك من الشبهات والعرضيات تدفعها بقسطاس الميزان فان الله قد خلق البيان للانسان ولو علم الله شيئا اشرف من الكلام ليجعله بينه وبين رسله

- 63 Glorified be God! How perfect is His favor, how great His proof, how mighty His Call! He accepteth from His servants what none else would accept. Verily, I was aforesaid in such condition that I knew not a letter of what I know this day. God hath made the proof such that none can turn away from it save by submission, and should they desire to turn away, it would be as though they turned away from that which they believed before, for the handiwork of the Lord cannot be confused with the work of creation, and the proof of the Book cannot be nullified by the lies of men.

63 فسيحان الله ماتم نعمته وعظم حجه وكبر دعوته يقبل من العباد ما لا يقبل احد سواه واننى انا كنت من قبل بشأن لا اعلم حرفا مما انا عالم به فى ذلك اليوم وقد جعل الله الحجة حجة لن يقدر الناس ان يعرضوا عنها الا ان يسلبوا وان ارادوا ان يعرضوا فكانهم اعرضوا مما امنوا من قبل لان صنع الرب لم يشبهه بشأن الخلق وحجة الكتاب لم يبطل بكذب الناس

- 64 For in God Who created all things is the sign of His unity in the reality of all things. The Christians say "the third of three," and some people today are like unto them in the station of worship, for they see a deity, then themselves, then an attribute, and verily this deed is the saying of the Christians where divinity entered into humanity. Exalted is God above what the wrongdoers say! And for every light there must needs be darkness, but God promised aforesaid in the Qur'an that He would vindicate the truth through His signs and bring to naught the deeds of the idolaters though they be averse.

64 لان فى الله الذى خلق الله اية توحيده فى حقيقته كلشئ قال النصارى ثالث ثلثه وان بعض الناس اليوم ليكونون بمثلهم فى مقام العبادة لانهم يرون معبودا ثم انفسهم ثم وصفا وان ذلك العمل هو قول النصارى حيث حل اللاهوت فى الناسوت وتعالى الله عما يقول الظالمون وان فى تلقاء كل نور لا بد من ظلمه ولكن وعد الله فى القران من قبل بان يحقق الحق باياته ويبطل عمل المشركين ولو هم كانوا كارهين

- 65 Verily, I have spoken to men only of the favor of my Lord, of what God hath honored me with of verses, prayers, sermons and realities of knowledge through what God hath ordained behind the veils. Verily, I have not denied a single letter of the Faith, nor added thereto a letter, nor have I said aught save what God said aforetime in the Qur'an: "Fear God and He will give you knowledge of distinction," and His mighty Word: "Fear God and God will teach you." People have indeed fabricated falsehoods, following their idle fancies, and they speak naught but lies.
- 66 Verily that which God hath bestowed upon him who contendeth for the Faith against those who deny the Leaders of Justice from the Mother City and its environs consisteth of four signs in the realm of outward manifestation.
- 67 The first is the station of verses which I recite without reflection and write without pause of the pen according to the will of God, my Lord. This is a proof which none can withstand, nor can any bring forth the like thereof. Were God to know that I abide not in His love and good-pleasure, He would create another being who would recite as I recite from the Book of God - and God sufficeth as a witness.
- 68 The second is the station of prayers and supplications unto God, the All-Glorious, whereby, should He will it, there would flow from My pen in six hours less than a thousand, without thought or pause of the pen.
- 69 The third is the station of sermons, the like of which none but I have ever uttered.
- 70 The fourth is the station of knowledge, whereby there hath flowed from My pen in times past numerous pages, recorded epistles, and preserved books. The glory in these words lieth not in the words themselves, nor in their allusions and correlations, but rather in the divine mystery and the manifestation of the eternal which is the source of all good within My soul and upon which every matter turneth. This matter sufficeth for this Faith, and God sufficeth as a guardian. And should [...] command Me to unveil a mystery from this Cause, were I not to desire to interpret but a single letter "ha" at the beginning of the Book, what I would mention in that word would be such that all the seas of the heavens and earth would not suffice to contain it, should God choose to reveal its interpretation through one of His servants. Yet I shall mention concerning the mystery of the letter "ha" some interpretation of what I intended.
- 65 و اننى انا ما حدثت الناس الا بنعمة ربي مما اكرمنى الله من الايات والدعوات والخطب و حقايق العلوم بما قدر الله في وراء الحجب واننى انا ما انكرت حرفا من الدين و ما زدت عنها حرفا و ما قلت الا ما قال الله في القرآن من قبل اتقوا الله يجعل لكم فرقا ثم قوله عز ذكره اتقوا الله يعلمكم الله و لقد اقترى الناس بما اتبعوا هواهم و انهم ما يقولون الا كذبا
- 66 و ان ما انعم الله على الذى به احتج في الدين للذين يكفرون بائمة العدل من ام القرى و حولها هو اربعة ايات في مقام الآثار
- 67 فالوها شان الايات التى اقرء من دون تأمل و اكتب من دون سكون قلم بما شاء الله ربي و هو حجة لا يقوم بها احد و لا يقدر ان يوتى بمثلها و لو علم الله بانى لم اك في حبه و رضاه ليخلق الله بشرا يقرء بمثل ما انا اقرء من كتاب الله و كفى بالله على شهيدا
- 68 و الثانية شان الدعوات و المناجات مع الله سبحانه الذى لو شاء الله ليجرى من قلمي في ستة ساعات اقل من عدة الف من دون فكر و لا سكون قلم
- 69 و الثالثة شان الخطب التى لم تنطق بمثلها احد غيرى
- 70 و الرابعه شان العلم حيث قد جرى من قلمي من تلك المده الماضيه صحايف معدودة و رسائل مسطوره و كتب محفوظه و ان الشرف في تلك الكلمات لم يك من جهت الكلمات و الاشارات و الاقترانات بل هو من سر الربانيه و ظهور الصمدانيه التى هو اصل كل خير في نفسى و عليه يدور كل امر و كفى ذلك الامر ذلك الدين و كفى بالله على و كيفا و ان ؟ مرتنى بكشف سر من الامر و لو انى ما اردت تفسير دون حرف الهاء في اول حرف الكتاب ما اذكر في تلك الكلمة لما لم يكفها بحور السموات و الارضين اذا شاء الله ان ينزل تفسيره بيد احد من عباده و لكن اذكر في سر الهاء ببعض تفسير ما اردت و هو

71 Know thou that a mystery remaineth ever concealed, and if revealed, it ceaseth to be a mystery. Knowledge in the station of mysteries is, as commanded by 'Ali ibn al-Husayn, peace be upon them both, unto Jabir, in seven degrees, as he said, exalted be his mention: "O Jabir, knowest thou what knowledge is? Knowledge is first the affirmation of Divine Unity, second the knowledge of meanings, third the knowledge of the Gates, fourth the knowledge of the Imam, fifth the knowledge of the Pillars, sixth the knowledge of the Chiefs, and seventh the knowledge of the Nobles." This is in accordance with His words, exalted be He: "Say: If the ocean were ink for the words of my Lord, the ocean would be exhausted before the words of my Lord would be exhausted, even if We brought another ocean like it as support." He also recited: "And if all the trees on earth were pens, and the ocean, with seven more oceans to aid it, were ink, yet would not the words of God be exhausted. Verily God is Mighty, Wise." O Jabir! The affirmation of Divine Unity and the knowledge of meanings - as for the affirmation of Divine Unity, it is the knowledge of God, the Ancient, the Ultimate, Whom vision comprehendeth not while He comprehendeth all vision, and He is the Subtle, the All-Informed. He is the Hidden, the Concealed; thou shalt know Him as He hath described Himself. As for the meanings, We are His meanings and His manifestation among you, created from the light of His Essence.

72 We created from the light of His Essence that which is manifest among you, and He delegated unto Us the affairs of His servants. We act by His leave as We please, and when We will, God willeth, and when We desire, God desireth. God the Almighty hath established Us in this station and chosen Us from among His servants, making Us a proof in His lands. Whoso denieth aught thereof hath denied God, glorified be His name, and disbelieved in God and His Prophets and His Messengers...

73 These seven are themselves the stages of action and the manifestations of creation, as He, exalted be His mention, hath said: Nothing existeth in earth or heaven save through seven: through Will, Purpose, Destiny, Decree, Permission, Term, and Book. Whoso claimeth that God can dispense with even one of these hath indeed disbelieved. Most people have perished through their failure to comprehend what God hath ordained for them. He hath judged through the tradition of His chosen ones, in the station of the inner meaning, that whoso diminisheth one of these hath disbelieved. I seek refuge with God from the misleading trials and beseech God through His grace for the inner meanings of the traditions.

71 ان السر لم يزل لم يكشف و ان كشف لم يك  
سرا و ان المعرفة في مقام الاسرار كما امر على بن  
الحسين عليهم السلام بجابر هو في سبعة مراتب  
كما قال عز ذكره يا جابر او تدري ما المعرفة  
المعرفة اثبات التوحيد اولا ثم معرفة المعاني ثانيا  
ثم معرفة الابواب ثالثا ثم معرفة الامام رابعا ثم  
معرفة الاركان خامسا ثم معرفة التقيا سادسا ثم  
معرفة النجباء سابعا و هو قوله تعالى قل لو كان  
البحر مداد الكلمات ربي لنفد البحر قبل ان تنفذ  
كلمات ربي و لو جئنا بمثله مددا و تلا ايضا و  
لوان ما في الارض من شجرة من اقلام و البحر  
يمده من بعده سبعة ابحر ما نفدت كلمات الله ان  
الله عزيز حكيم يا جابر اثبات التوحيد و معرفة  
المعاني اما اثبات التوحيد فمعرفة الله القديم الغاية  
الذي لا تدركه الابصار و هو يدرك الابصار و هو  
اللطيف الخبير و هو غيب باطن ستدركه كما به و  
صف نفسه

72 و اما المعاني فنحن معانيه و ظاهره فيكم اخترعنا  
من نور ذاته و فرض علينا امور عباده فنحن نفعل  
باذنه ما نشاء و نحن اذا شئنا شاء الله و اذا اردنا  
اراد الله و نحن احلنا الله عز و جل هذا المحل و  
اصطغانا من بين عباده و جعلنا حجة في بلاده فمن  
انكر شيئا ورده فقد رد على الله جل اسمه و كفر  
بالله و انبيائه و رسله الحديث

73 و تلك السبعة بعينها مراتب الفعل و ظهورات  
الصنع كما قال عز ذكره لا يكون شيئا في الارض  
ولا في السماء الا بسبعة بمشيئة و ارادة و قدر  
و قضا و اذن و اجل و كتاب و من زعم ان  
الله يقدر بنقص واحدة منهم فقد كفر و لقد  
هلك اكثر الناس من عدم معرفتهم بما فرض الله  
لهم و حكم بالسنة اوليائه في مقام الباطن لمن نقص  
واحدة منهم بكفره فاعوذ بالله من مضلات الفتن  
و اسئل الله بفضله من بواطن السنن

- 74 The mystery in the Bayan pointeth to the knowledge of God, glorified be He, and He is His own mystery, His very Self and none other, for God's mystery is identical with His outward manifestation, and His outward manifestation identical with His being, His beginning identical with His end, and His eternity identical with His perpetuity. None knoweth His mystery save Him, and He hath no mystery apart from His Essence, no attribute apart from His presence. Glorified be God, Lord of the Throne, above what they describe.
- 74 وان السر في البيان اشارة عن معرفة الله سبحانه وانه هو سره كان نفسه لا سواه لان الله كان سره عين علانيته وعلانيته عين كينونيته واوليته عين اخريته وابديته عين ازلته لم يعرف سره غيره ولم يك له سر دون ذاته ولا وصف دون جنباه و سبحان الله رب العرش عما يصفون
- 75 As to the mystery of the meanings, it is to know what was previously detailed concerning the decree of the Point in the station of unity, and what floweth by God's leave from the water of that spring - the water of life - and it is the Unknown whereof God, exalted be His mention, hath said: "None knoweth the Unknown save He." Glorified and exalted be He above what they describe.
- 75 و اما سر المعاني هو ان يعرف ما فصلت من قبل من حكم النقطة في مقام التوحيد وما يجري باذن الله من ماء ذلك العين ماء الحيوان وهو الغيب الذي قال الله عز ذكره ولا يعلم الغيب الا هو سبحانه وتعالى عما يصفون
- 76 As for the mystery in the station of the Gates, it is the mystery in the universal Guardianship whereof God, glorified be He, hath said: "Here guardianship belongeth unto God, the Truth. He is best in reward, and best in consequence." It is the mystery of manifestation, the camphor tree, the purifying water, the frequented House, the garments of light, the pure zealous Essence, the lofty witnessed Glory, the hidden concealed Symbol, and the Fire borrowed from the Mount, which is the mystery of the First and the First is none other than He, and God maketh no distinction between them save the distinction of attribute not separation, even as God hath placed between motion and rest, or between the Kaf and the Nun, and between separation and union. None knoweth His mystery save He, and glorified be God above what they describe.
- 76 و اما سر في مقام الابواب هو السر في الولاية الكلية التي قال الله سبحانه هناك الولاية لله الحق هو خير ثوابا وخير عقبا وهو السر الظهور وشجرة الكافور والماء الطهور البيت المعمور والقمص النور والذات الساجز الغيور والعز الشاخص المشهود والرمز المستر المستور والنار المتببس في الطور الذي هو سر الاول والاول سواه ولا يجعل الله الفرق بينهما الا بفرق بينونة الصفة لا العزلة كما قد جعل الله بين الحركة والسكون او بين الكاف والنون وبين الفصل والوصل ولا يعلم سره الا هو و سبحان الله عما يصفون
- 77 As for the mystery of the Imamate, it is the mystery of the letters of "There is no God but God" in the inscribed lines, then in the Scriptures and Verses, then in the reeds of the Divine Realm and the Throne of Names and Attributes, then in the thicket of the Realm of Power and the Seat of Glory and Kingdom, then in the mention of essential realities, material things, the separate, the connected, the united, the severed, the manifest, the concealed, the radiant, and the darkened, where none comprehendeth their knowledge save the pure Family of God, the signs of abstraction, the pillars of unity, the tokens of glorification, and the proofs of praise. Glorified be God, their Creator, above what they describe.
- 77 و اما سر الامامة هو سر حروف لا اله الا الله في الرقوم المسطرات ثم في الزبر والايات ثم في قصبات اللاهوت وعرش الاسماء والصفات ثم في اجمة الجبروت وكرسى المجد والملكوت ثم ذكر الجوهريات والماديات والمفارقات والمقارنات والمجتمعات والمنقطعات والمتجليات والمتلجلجات والمثلثات والمكفهرات حيث لا يحيط بعلها احد غير الله الاطهار وايات التجريد و اركان التوحيد وعلامات التمجيد ودلالات التحميد و سبحان الله بارئهم عما يصفون
- 78 As for the mystery in the station of the Pillars, it is the light manifested from the sun of Fatimih's form, the blessings of God be upon her, in the realities of the Prophets; it is from the mystery of the manifestation of the Prophets.
- 78 و اما السر في مقام الاركان هو نور المتجلية من شمس جسم فاطمة صلوات الله عليها في حقايق الانبياء هو من سر تجلي الانبيا

- 79 And as for the mystery in the station of the Chiefs, it is from the mystery of the manifestation of the Prophets, and they are thirty souls who were in the presence of the Imam, as that tradition explicitly states, saying: "How excellent is this goodly station, and there is no loneliness with thirty." Verily, recognition of them and acknowledgment of them is obligatory, for they are the bearers of grace in creation and legislation. Their mystery is the mystery of the Imam, and whosoever today turns to anyone besides them is truly among the ignorant ones.
- 79 واما السر في مقام النقباء وهو من سر تجلى الانبياء وهم ثلثون نفسا كانوا في حضور الامام كما صرح بذلك ذلك الحديث فنعلم منزلة الطيبة وما بثلاثين من وحشة وان معرفتهم والاقرار بهم فرض وانهم حملة الفيض في التكوين والتشريع وان سرهم سر الامام ومن يتول اليوم احدا منهم فانه هو من الجاهلین
- 80 As for the mystery in the station of the Nobles, it is from the manifestation of the light of the hearts of the Chiefs. Were they to discover the mystery of the Chiefs, they would surely slay them, as is explicitly stated in the tradition wherein He, exalted be His mention, said: "If Abu Dharr knew what was in Salman's heart, he would surely have slain him." Verily that mystery exists, is witnessed, and is hidden in all seven ranks, and God does not judge concerning these mysteries in those verses except according to what their souls have accepted. God will surely reward all through His grace, and there is no God but Him, the Possessor of great bounty.
- 80 واما السر في مقام النجباء هو من تجلى نور فؤاد النقباء وانهم لو اطلعوا بسر النقباء ليقتلوهم كما صرح بذلك حديث الذي قال عز ذكره لو علم ابا ذر ما في قلب سلمان لقتله وان ذلك السر في كل مراتب السبعة لموجود ومشهود ومفقود ولا يحكم الله بتلك الاسرار في تلك الايات الا بما قبلت انفسهم وان الله ليجزى الكل بفضله ولا اله الا هو ذو فضل عظيم
- 81 The mystery in these seven ranks is the reality within them whereby they know the unity of God their Creator. The proportion of God's manifestation through all of them is equal. The dwellers in the depths of the Bayan know God's unity, and He unifies them through the unity of His own Self. None of creation precedes them, nor have they any veil save their own existence, nor any book save their own souls. He who knows God's unity in the station of meanings knows the seven mirrors of the Bayan, even if he perceives not those mirrors, yet knows his station as one who beholds God in the second mirrors. Likewise are the servants who know God's unity in the five mirrors - each knows God's unity according to what pertains to unity, might, glory, divinity, power and dominion.
- 81 وان السر في تلك المراتب السبعة هو الحقيقة فيها التي بها يوحدون الله بآرائهم وان نسبة تجلى الله بكلمهم لكان على حد سواء وان اشرق؟ هو انه ان السالكين في لجة البيان يوحدون الله وليوحدهم بتوحيد نفسه ولا يستقيم احد من الخلق ولا لهم حجاب دون وجودهم ولا كتاب دون انفسهم وان الذي يوحد الله في مقام المعاني سبعة مرات البيان وانه ولم لم يشعر بذلك المرات ولكن كان عالما مقامه وهو الناظر الى الله في المرات الثانية وكذلك عباد الذين يوحدون الله في مرايا خمسة كل يوحدون الله بما هو عليه من الوحدة والجبروت والعزة واللاهوت والقدرة والملكو
- 82 They behold no mirrors between them in the state of unity, but God, from behind them, knows their stations and bears witness to what their hands have earned. Though this station has no likeness, I allude to what is most subtle in the realm of physicality: Consider the manifested form of a standing Alif, and before it mirrors, then before those mirrors more mirrors until reaching seven. Do the seventh mirrors reflect aught but the form of the Alif? Nay, by thy Lord! All call upon God, indicate Him, judge by His greatness, fear His dominion, rule by His leave, act by His command, and intercede by His permission.
- 82 ولا يشاهدون مرايا في حالة التوحيد بينهم ولكن الله من ورائهم يعلم مقاماتهم ويشهد عليهم بما اكتسبت ايديهم وان مثال المثل في ذلك الحكم ولو لم يكن ذلك المقام لا مثل له ولكن اشير بما هو اللطف في مقام الجسمانيات وهوانت فاجعل المتجلى صورة الالف قائم وان في تلقائها مرات ثم في تلقاء المرات مرات الى ان اتصل العدة الى السبعة فهل يحكى مرات السابع الا عن صورة الالف لا وربك كل يدعون عن الله ويدلون

83 The difference is that what is reflected in the seventh mirrors resembles proportionally what is reflected in the sixth mirrors, and thus some excel others. There is no greater nobility in the perfection of good qualities and virtuous attributes, for that is the station of the effect of the deed. The station of the essence of the servant is what I have indicated to thee in the series of seven, which flows in a series of eight from the world of Command to the world of Creation. All the worlds are confined to these eight, for the first determination of the first Kaf is the station of Muhammadhood, which is the Garden of Eternity wherein through manifestation it entered and has not emerged, and whereunto He hath never entered from without. Then verily that Paradise is the portion of the Family of God, who are the Imams of Justice, and no one among creation hath any share therein.

84 And the second is the station of the unity of the Prophets, and the third is the station of the unity of humanity, and the fourth is the station of the unity of the jinn, and the fifth is the station of the unity of the angels, and the sixth is the station of the unity of animals, wherein the ant supposeth that God hath two antennae, just as man supposeth that He hath knowledge and power and likewise all attributes and names. And just as people invalidate the unity of the ant, so too doth he who standeth in a rank above invalidate their unity. And the seventh is the station of the unity of plants, and the eighth is the station of the unity of minerals. And verily that rank revealeth what is above it save what is in its outward manifestation.

85 And verily the eight paradises which God hath created for those who love Him are these stations indicated. The wayfarer beholdeth in the land of the highest heaven all his stations and witnesseth the bliss of the hereafter which hath been tasted from the fruit of the mystery of Reality in this world, in a station as though he were in the land of the Paradise of Glory and under the shade of the darkened Paradise of Beauty. And verily one such as thee understandeth these allusions, and there is no need in exposition to mention the evidences, the verses, the signs, and the stations, for the Command of God in all things is nearer than the twinkling of an eye, and the Beginning of God upon all things is through the Greatest Vision.

86 And verily I intended not in mentioning these words save to manifest the divine attributes to the people of glory. And verily one such as thee is more exalted in station than to look upon them and mention therein the decree of differences. And when thou art apprised of that which was not with thee from

عليه ويحكمون عن عظمتهم ويشفقون من سطوته  
ويحكمون بأذنه ويعملون لأمره ويشفعون بأذنه

83 وان الفرق هو ان الذي يحكى في المرات السابعة هو  
شبه بالنسبة عما يحكى في المرات السادسة وبذلك  
يتفاضل البعض على البعض وليس اشرف في  
اكال الطيبات والشئون الحسان لانها مقام  
اثر الفعل وان مقام ذات العبد هو ما اشترت  
لك في سلسلة السبعة وهو يجري في سلسلة الثمانية  
من عالم الامر الى عالم الخلق وان كليات العوالم  
هي منحصره بتلك الثمانية لان اول تعين كاف  
الاول هو مقام محمدية هو جنة الازلية التي داخلها  
بالتجلى لم يخرج و خارجها لم يدخل ثم ان تلك  
الجنة نصيب ال الله الذين هم ائمة العدل ولا  
نصيب لاحد من الخلق فيها

84 والثاني مقام توحيد الانبياء والثالثة مقام توحيد  
الانس والرابعة مقام توحيد الجن والخامس مقام  
توحيد الملك والسادس مقام توحيد الحيوان و  
ان في ذلك المقام ان النملة تزعم ان الله زبائنتين  
كما ان الانسان يزعم ان له علم و قدرة وكذلك  
كل الصفات والاسماء كما ان الناس يبطل توحيد  
النملة فن كان واقفا في رتبة فوقه يبطل توحيد  
السابعة مقام توحيد النبات والثامنة مقام توحيد  
الجماد وان تلك الرتبة تظهر ما في فوقها الا ما في  
علايتها

85 وان ما خلق الله من جنات الثمانية للمحبين  
هي تلك المراتب المشيرة يرى السالك في ارض  
الرفرف كل مقامه ويشاهد نعيم الاخره التي  
تذوت من ثمرة سر الحقيقه في الدنيا في مقام  
كانه هو في ارض الفردوس الجلال وفي ظلال  
مكفهرات افريدوس الجمال وان مثل جنابك  
يعرف الاشارات ولا حاجة في البيان بذكر  
الدلالات والايات والعلامات والمقامات  
لان امر الله في كلشي اقرب من لمح البصر و  
بداء الله على كلشي هو بالمنظر الاكبر

86 و اني انا ما اردت في ذكر تلك الكلمات الا  
لاظهار الشئون لاهل السبحات وان بمثل  
جنابك اجل مقاما من ان تنظر اليها وتذكر فيها  
حكم الاختلافات و اذ اطلعت بما لم يك عندك

the decisive verses, then pardon thyself, for verily that water floweth by the leave of God, the Lord of Names and Attributes. I seek forgiveness of God, my Lord, then I ask pardon of thee for what the Pen hath set down in mentioning the allusions in the depths of these words, for the station of the servant is that of the element of dust, and these allusions befit not the presence of Him Who possesseth the Names and Attributes. Glory be to God, thy Lord, the Lord of the Throne, above what they describe.

من المحكمات فاعف عن نفسك فان عين ذلك الماء تجري باذن الله رب الاسماء والصفات واستغفر الله ربي ثم اسئل من جنابك العفو عما اجرى القلم في ذكر الاشارات في غياهب تلك الكلمات لان شان العبد هو عنصر التراب ولا يليق لساحة من كان ذ الاسماء والصفات تلك الاشارات و سبحان الله ربك رب العرش عما يصفون

- 87 And since the matter was concealed in words, and the glories in the world of indications are not unveiled save through the mention of stations, I make mention in that station that shouldst thou arrive, thou wouldst witness the lights in the reality of mysteries. And it is that when the servant arriveth at the station of Reality, which is the station of the manifestation of the knowledge of God to him through Him, he witnesseth all things as they are and seeth naught in the countenance of multiplicities save the manifestation of the unity of the Essence.

87 و لما كان الامر مستورا في الكلمات و ان السبحات في عالم الدلالات لا ينكشف الا بذكر المقامات اذكر ذكرا في ذلك المقام لو وصلت لتشاهد الانوار في حقيقه الاسرار و هو ان العبد اذا وصل الى مقام حقيقه الذي هو مقام ظهور معرفة الله له به يشاهد الكل على ما هو عليه و لا يرى في طلعة الكثرات الا تجلى وحدة الذات

- 88 And verily that station is thy Most Holy Sanctuary, and thy Most Exalted Paradise, and the station of thy love and thy beloved and thy Best-Beloved, and the station of the unity of thy word and the word of the Act of God in thy mystery, and the station of thy subsistence in God, and the station wherein all thy attributes and thy names and thy manifestations appear from what was beneath the rank of thine essence, and the station of thy existence through God and thy effacement in God, and the station of thy circumambulation around thine essence through the seven ranks of thine act, and the station of thy putting on the garment, and in the station of casting off the pebbles of thine intimations, stations, indications, signs and verses, and in the station through which was manifested what was manifest in thy rank, and was concealed what was hidden in thy mystery, and rose what rose in thy reality, and gleamed what gleamed in thine essence, and shone what shone in thy spirit, and was magnified what was exalted in thine identity, and dawned what dawned in the station of thy physical being - where no veils can conceal it and no verses of scripture can equal it - it is the first light wherewith God revealed Himself to thee through thee, and at every moment He revealeth Himself to thee through thee by that light when thou didst behold the Tree of Sinai in the presence of the Frequented Fane.

88 و ان ذلك المقام هو مسجدك الاقصى و جنتك الاعلى و مقام حبك و حبيبك و محبوبك و مقام اتحاد قولك و قول فعل الله في شرك و مقام بقاءك بالله و مقام بك ظهر كل صفاتك واسمائك و تجلياتك مما كان في تحت رتبة ذاتك و مقام وجودك بالله و فئاتك في الله و مقام طوافك حول ذاتك بسبعة مراتب فعلك و مقام تجليك في مقام رمي جمراتك من اشاراتك و مقاماتك و دلالاتك و علاماتك و اياتك و مقام الذي بك ظهر ما ظهر في ربتك و بطن ما بطن في شرك و طلع ما طلع في حقيقتك و الاح ما الاح في ذاتيتك و اشرق ما اشرق في نفسانيتك و اعظم ما اجل في ايتك و افاق ما افاق في مقام جسمانيتك حيث لا يوارىها الحجب و لا يعادلها ايات الصحف و هو اول نور الذي تجلى الله لك بك و في كل ان انه يتجلى لك بك بذلك النور اذا شاهدت شجرة الطور في تلقاء بيت المعمور

- 89 And these intimations are the portion of the heedless who see not the Truth in the darkness of night. Otherwise, one like thyself seeth all words as one Word, and all differences as a specific geometry, and all intimations as a single indication, and all verses as a clear mirror that telleth of the oneness of

89 و ان تلك الاشارات نصيب اهل الفتور لمن لم ير الحق في الظلمات الديجور و الا بمثل جنابك ترى كل الكلمات كلمة واحدة و كل الاختلافات هندسة معينة و كل الاشارات دلالة واحدة و كل الايات امراه صافية التي تحكي عن وحدة

the Essence and proclaimeth divinity upon the throne of names and attributes.

الذات و تصرح باللاهوتية على عرش الاسماء و الصفات

- 90 And for one like thyself the indications cause no confusion, for the Command of God in all things is one, and the decree of God reacheth all things. Verily those who veil themselves from recognition of the Glory in the mystery of wealth are certain of God's Cause yet deny it unjustly through what their hands have earned aforetime.

90 و ان على مثل جنابك لا تشبه الدلالات لان امر الله في كل شئ واحد و حكم الله لكل شئ بالغ و ان الذين يحجبون انفسهم عن عرفان الجلال في سر المال ليوقنون بامر الله و يحجدونه ظلما لما اكتسبت ايديهم من قبل

- 91 And from one like thyself is not concealed what hath occurred before. Unto God do we complain, then unto Muhammad, the Chosen One, and unto Him returneth the judgment of the Hereafter and of former times. And verily He is in the Most Exalted Horizon, speaking on behalf of the Lord Most High. The heart lied not in what it saw. Will ye then dispute with Him concerning what He saw? He speaketh not from mere impulse. It is naught but a revelation revealed.

91 و ان على جنابك لا يخفى عما وقع من قبل و ان الى الله المشتكى ثم الى محمد المصطفى و اليه يرجع حكم الآخرة و الاولى و انه هو بالنظر الاعلى و الناطق عن رب العلي ما كذب الفواد ما رى افتمارونه على ما يرى و ما ينطق عن الهوى ان هو الا و حى يوحى

- 92 And verily I have unveiled from the face of mystery the decree of mystery and the intimations of the Command, and this is truly mystery upon mystery, where today none can raise it save the mystery, and naught can benefit it save the unveiling. In God do I trust, and I say: "Naught shall befall us save what God hath decreed. He is our Master; in Him do we trust, and in Him let the believers place their trust."

92 و لقد كشفت عن وجه السر حكم السر اشارات الامر و ان ذلك بالحقيقة هو سر على سر حيث ان اليوم لا يرفعه الا السر و لا يفيد الا الكشف و على الله اتكل و اقول لن يصيبنا الا ما كتب الله لنا هو مولينا عليه توكلت و عليه يتوكل المؤمنون

- 93 And what I have interpreted of the interpretation of the letter Ha is a mention from the praise of the Tree of Glory, whereby the people of divine decree know through the principle of origination in the crimson pillar. And verily it is the mystery of creation, for the element of fire in the world of origination cannot exist save through the element of earth, for naught besides God exists independently in its essence except that it is compound.

93 و ان ما فسرت من تفسير الهاء حرف هو ذكر من ثناء شجرة البهاء حيث يعرف اهل القضاء بحكم البدء في ركن الحمراء و انه هو سر الانشاء لان عنصر النار في عالم الابداع لن يوجد الا بعنصر التراب لان من دون الله لم يك شيئا قائما بذاته الا و هو مركب

- 94 When the decree of duality is established, the decree of connection is established, for a thing is not a thing except through its existence, which is the aspect of revelation therein, and through its identity, which is the aspect of receptivity, and through the connection that occurs between the conjunction. These three ranks are the rank of trinity in the first name God chose for Himself.

94 فلما ثبت حكم الاثنينية ثبت حكم الربط لان الشئ لم يك شيئا الا بوجوده الذى هو جهة التجلي فيه و بانيتها التى هى جهة القبول و بالربط الذى يحصل بين الاقتران و تلك المراتب الثلاثة هى رتبة الثلاث في اول اسم اختار الله لنفسه

- 95 From this the Christians took the form of the cross and the indwelling of divinity in humanity. Exalted is God above what the people of the human realm know of the warbling of the birds of the divine cloud upon the branches of the Tree of Divinity. And that is the decree of the triangle of modality in the Name of the Eternal, Radiant, Holy Providence which points at every moment to His breast and says by God's leave:

95 و من هذا اخذت النصرارى شكل الصليب و حل اللاهوت في الناسوت و تعالى الله عما يعرف اهل الناسوت من تغنيات طيور العماء على اغصان شجرة اللاهوت و ان ذلك حكم مثلث الكيفوفيه في اسم الولاية الازلية المتشعشه المقدسه التى تشير في كل حين الى صدره

“There the sovereignty belongeth unto God, the Truth. He is best for reward.”

- 96 By God's leave He says: There is the divine authority which belongs to God, the Truth - He is the best in reward and the best in punishment. Indeed, the three primary names in the beginning of action are Will, Purpose and Determination, which the people of the Bayan interpret in their exposition as Creation, Origination, Invention, Bringing into Being, and Generation. Nothing can exist except through the indicative elements, even if the Command itself were within the Will, for contingent existence is impossible except through two pairs. Once duality is established, the mention of attributes extends infinitely with what has no end.
- 97 The element of earth which is interpreted at the level of Will is of the nature of its realm, which is the pillar of the acceptance of the fire of existence after these: the fire of non-existence and the water of ink. In this pattern has God created all things and decreed in every world according to that pattern.
- 98 Look at Purpose, which is the primal Eve of Adam and the Throne upon which Will was established through the All-Merciful, how God created it with four pillars - among them the pillar of Destiny which is the element of fire and the manifestation of the First Cause. Its color is white due to pure simplicity from the attributes of multiplicities, indications and signs. From it was whitened what was in the thicket of the Divine Realm from unpolluted water from the rivers of Paradise. The word of glorification was found in the realm of Might, and through it all whiteness in the thicket of Dominion, then Kingdom, then the mortal world is raised and lowered. The attributes of that pillar are not encompassed by the knowledge of any created being - among them the Sacred House of God, the Sacred Month, the mention of glorification at the ground of the Sacred Monument and Station, and the obligation of the pillar of Unity in the words “There is no God but God” where whoever did not say “yea” in the Primal Scene was not brought into being. Through one such as yourself endowed with insight are known the attributes of that pillar which none can encompass save whom God wills - verily there is no God but Him, the Possessor of tremendous grace.
- 99 And among them is the pillar of Permission which is the element of air and manifestation of the Material Cause. Its color is yellow from what is appointed, and from it yellowness became yellow in all things, and by its light does God provide
- 96 ويقول باذن الله هنالك الولاية لله الحق هو خير ثوابا وخير عقابا وان اسماء تلك الثلاثة في بدء الفعل هي المشية والارادة والقدر الذي يعبر اهل البيان عند التبيان بالانشاء والابداع والاختراع والاحداث والانفعال ولا يمكن ان يوجد شئ الا بالعناصر المشيرة ولو كان الامر ولو كان الامر في النفس المشية لان وجود الامكان لا يمكن الا بزوجين اثنين ولما ثبت ذكر الاثنينية يتصل ذكر الشئون الى ما لا نهاية بما لا نهاية لها
- 97 وان عنصر التراب الذي عبر في رتبة المشية هو كان من جنس عالمها الذي هو ركن نفس قبول نار الابداع بعد هؤلاء نار الانوجداد وماء المداد وان على ذلك المثال قد خلق الله كل شئ وحكم في كل عالم على طبق ذلك المثال
- 98 انظر الى الارادة التي هو حواء ادم الاولى وعرش التي عليها استوت المشية بشأن الرحمن كيف قد خلق الله باركان اربعة ركن منها رتبة القضا وهو عنصر النار وظهور علة الاولى وانه لونه البيضاء لصرف بساطة من شئون الكثرات والدلالات والعلامات وان منه ابيض ما كان في اجمة اللاهوت من ماء غير اسن من ماء انهار الرضوان ووجدت كلمة التسبيح في عالم الجبروت ورازاته يرفع وينزل كل بياض بما كان في اجمة الملك ثم الملكوت ثم الناسوت وان شئون ذلك الركن لا يحيط بها علم احد من الخلق منها بيت الله الحرام ومنها شهر الله الحرام ومنها ذكر التسبيح على ارض المشعر والمقام ومنها فرض ركن التوحيد كلمة لا اله الا الله حيث من يقل بلى في المشهد الاولى لم يوجد وان بمثل جنابك ذي نظري يعرف شئون ذلك الركن حيث لا يحيط بها احد الا من شاء الله انه لا اله الا هو ذو من عظيم
- 99 و ركن منها رتبة الاذن وهو عنصر الهواء وظهور علة المادية وان لونه الصفراء لما يعين ومنه اصفرت الصفرة في كل شئ وبنوره يرزق الله كل شئ لان ركن الاول الذي هو علة الفاعلية علة الحياه حيث قال الله عز ذكره هو الذي خلقكم

sustenance to all things, for the First Pillar which is the Efficient Cause is the cause of life, as God, exalted be His mention, has said: "He it is Who created you, then provided sustenance for you, then causes you to die, then brings you to life." The bearer of that pillar is the Exalted One, and thus appeared the yellow color in his countenance at the time of his passing, and that is evidence for the day of his beginning, for the Seal is precisely the Beginning according to the people of the Bayan. And whoever curses the sun and moon in their calculated courses - that is the station of praise and the pillar opposite the Yemeni pillar. It has attributes in limited examples, existing geometry, numbered signs and lost knowledge. The one who gazes upon the Countenance of Glory surely recognizes the attributes of that pillar as God has willed - verily He is the Possessor of ancient grace.

ثم الذي رزقكم ثم يميتكم ثم يحييكم وان حامل ذلك الركن هو العلى ولذا ظهرت لون الصفرة في وجهه حين وفاته وان ذلك دليل ليوم بدئه لان الختم بعينه هو البدء عند اهل البيان ومن يلعب الشمس والقمر بحسبان وذلك رتبة التحميد وركن تلقاء ركن ايمانى وله شئون في الامثلة المحدودة والهندسة الموجودة والعلامات المعدودة والمعلومات المفقودة وان الناظر الى وجه الجلال ليوقن بشئون ذلك الركن كما شاء الله انه ذو من قديم

- 100 And among them is the pillar of the Appointed Time which is the element of water and manifestation of the Formal Cause and the Primal, Eternal Reed and the third leaf from the Divine Tree which is neither of the East nor of the West, its color is green, and from it everything has derived its verdancy, and through it God causes all things to die in the third manifestation, and it is the highest lower pillar of the Throne and the manifestation of His mention in the rank of creation and the word of unity, and thus multiplicities appeared in that rank as do the multiplicity of letters in the mention of "There is no god but God." And it has infinite aspects with infinite manifestations, wherein the one who gazes upon God witnesses all that the All-Merciful has willed in that pillar. And if one possessed of true insight wished to correlate what has been ordained by the Imams with the letters of "There is no god but God," he would be able to do so, and that would not be difficult for Us if God should will it and permit it, and I am but a penitent servant.

100 و ركن منها رتبة الاجل وهو عنصر الماء و ظهور علة الصورية و القصبة الاولى الازلية و الورقة الثالثة من شجرة الالهية التي ما هي بشرقية و لا غربية وان لونه الاخضر و منه اخضرت الخضر في كلشي و به يميت الله كل الاشياء في المشهد الثالث و هو ركن الاسفل الاعلى من العرش و ظهور ذكره في رتبة الخلق و كلمة التهليل و لذا ظهرت الكثرات في ذلك الرتبة كثرة الاحرف في ذكر لا اله الا الله وله شئون ما لا نهاية بما لا نهاية لها حيث يشهد الناظر الى الله بكل ما شاء الرحمن في ذلك الركن و لو اراد ذو فراسه حق بان يطابق ما قضى من الائمة باحرف لا اله الا الله ليقدر بذلك و ان ذلك ما كان علينا بعزير اذا شاء الله و اذن و ما انا الا عبد منيب

- 101 And one of its pillars is the rank of the Book, and it is the element of earth and the manifestation of the final cause in the world of names and attributes, and its color is red, and from it everything has derived its redness, and geometry has been established in the mystery of all things, and destiny has been determined in the decree of all things, and through it the earth is quickened after its death, and the earth shines with the light of its Lord, and on that Day the earth shall relate its tidings, for thy Lord will have inspired it. And through it God quickens in the fourth manifestation the changing hearts, the determined souls, the dead spirits, and the corrupt bodies, and makes them living beings like unto the steadfast hearts, the firm souls, the good spirits, and the pure bodies.

101 و ركن منها رتبة الكتاب و هو عنصر التراب و ظهور علة الغائية في عالم الاسماء و الصفات و ان لونه احمر و منه احمرت الحجرة في كل شئ و ذوت الهندسة في سر كلشي و عينت القدر في حكم كلشي و ان به يحي الارض بعد موتها و يشرق الارض بنور ربها و ان يومئذ يحدث الناس اخبارها بان ربك اوحى لها و ان به يحي الله في مشهد ذر الرابع افئدة المتغيرة و القلوب المتعينة و النفوس الميتة و الاجساد الخبيثة و يجعلها حيوانا بمثل افئدة المستقره و القلوب الثابتة و النفوس الطيبة و الاجساد الطاهرة

102 And today God desires this matter for mankind because the pillar of finality, which is the fruit of creation and the mystery of invention and the manifestation of the three causes in origination, has appeared like unto some of the aspects of the three pillars with the supreme proofs of knowledge and the most great holy manifestations, whereby one whose nature is human nature knows that these aspects could not have been fashioned by man except by leave of the All-Merciful. For one who speaks a word and says that if all were to gather together to produce the like thereof, they would not be able to do so and would never succeed - this is no simple matter nor light utterance, for the letters of the alphabet are in everyone's possession, so how is it they cannot do it, and if they could do it, why have they not done so? Nay, by thy Lord, the Lord of the heavens and earth, were all those on earth from the chain of subjects to gather together, they would not be able to produce a single verse like unto what I read and write. And this is witnessed by every just one, that the work of creation allows for human endeavor, while the work of the Lord Himself is distinguished from the work of creation, and people today cannot say a word concerning this proof except that the same word is found in the Qur'an, so that truth may be established by God's command, even though the polytheists detest it.

103 And God, glorified be He, through His subtle craftsmanship and His mighty favor, has manifested the mystery of that hidden pillar among the non-Arabs, lest it be difficult for anyone to acknowledge Him and His Cause, that He is the servant of God, confirming what was in the Book and the Tradition, even letter by letter. And God has made this matter clear through one whom no one ever imagined was among those possessed of knowledge and clear and decisive verses and evident proofs. Through him God has tested the souls of the believers, just as occurred what occurred after what was manifested was manifested, and they stand firm in their obedience to God's religion like mountains. Through this Cause, those who were destined for felicity in the first particle are made happy, and those destined for wretchedness in the fourth particle are made wretched.

104 According to what has been revealed in the traditions from the mines of mysteries, during the Occultation of the Proof (peace be upon him) there must needs be a dark, blind, deaf and hellish test, so that those created from the clay of light may be purified and those not of that clay may be condemned by the decree of the wicked. This is clearly stated in that sacred verse of the Qur'an: "Do men think that they will be left alone on saying 'We believe' and not be tried?" And the Imam, exalted be His mention, said: "By God, you shall be broken as glass

102 وان اليوم اراد الله ذلك الامر للناس لان ركن الغائية التي هي ثمرة الابداع و سر الاختراع و ظهور علل الثلاثة في الانشاء قد ظهر بمثل بعض شئون اركان الثلاثة بالحجج العلمية الكبرى و الشئون القدسية العظمى حيث يعرف من كان طينته طينة الانسان بان تلك الشئون لم يك من صنع الانسان الا باذن الرحمن لان الذي يتكلم بكلمة و يقول لو اجتمع الكل على ان ياتوا بمثلها لن يستطيعوا و لن يقدروا ليس امر سهل و لا كلمة خفيفة لان حرف الهجائية كانت بيد الكل و انهم كيف لم يقدروا و ان يقدروا فكيف لم ياتوا لا و ربك رب السموات و الارض لو اجتمع من على الارض من سلسلة الرعية كلهم لن يقدروا ان ياتوا بآية مثل ما اننى انا اقرء و اكتب و ان ذلك مشهود عند كل ذى عدل بان صنعة الخلق يمكن فيه العمل و ان صنع الرب بنفسه يميز عن بين صنع الخلق و لن يقدر الناس اليوم ان يقولوا فى تلك الهجة حرفا الا و يرد القول عليهم بمثله فى القران حتى يثبت الحق بامر الله و لو كره المشركون

103 و ان الله سبحانه من لطيف صنعته و عظيم احسانه قد اظهر سر ذلك الركن المكنون فى الاعجميين لئلا يصعب على احد الاقرار به و بامر به بانه عبد الله مصدقا لما كان الكتاب و السنة حتى الحرف بالحرف و قد بين الله ذلك الامر من عند نفس لم يخطر بقلب احد انه كان من اولى العلم و اولى الايات المحكمات و البينات البالغات و امتحن الله به نفوس المؤمنين كما و قع ما و قع بعد ما بلغ ما بلغ و انهم ليقومون على طاعتهم فى دين الله بمثل الجبال و ان بذلك الامر يسعد من يسعد فى ذر الاول و يشقى من يشقى فى ذر الرابع

104 و ان بحكم ما نزلت الاخبار من معادن الاسرار لا بد فى غيبة الهجة عليه السلام بفتنه دهاء صماء عمياء صيلم مظلم جهنم ليخلص من خلق من طينة الانوار و يشقى من غير طينه بحكم الاشرار كما صرح بذلك تلك آية المقدسة من القران احسب الناس ان يتركوا ان يقولوا امنا و هم لا يفتنون و قال الامام عز ذكره و الله لتكسرن كسر الزجاج

is broken, but glass can be restored as it was. By God, you shall be broken as pottery is broken, and pottery cannot be restored as it was. By God, He shall surely distinguish! By God, He shall surely sift as darnel is sifted from wheat!" Then the words of al-Sadiq, exalted be His holiness: "The Master of this Cause has an occultation, and one who holds fast to his religion during it is like one who grasps thorns." Then His words, exalted be His glory, to Mansur: "O Mansur! This Cause shall not come to you except after despair. Nay, by God, not until you are distinguished! Nay, by God, not until you are tested! Nay, by God, not until the wretched are made wretched and the fortunate are made fortunate!" As spoken in the traditions: "The people shall be so tested that nine-tenths of them shall fall away." As He, exalted be His mention, said: "This shall not be until they are distinguished and tested, until none remain among you save the fewest" - then He made His palm small.

وان الزجاج يعاد فيعود كما كان والله لتكسرن  
كسر الفخار وان الفخار لا يعود كما كان والله  
ليميزن والله ليغربلن كما تغربل الزوان من القمح  
ثم قول الصادق عز قدسه ان لصاحب هذا الامر  
غيبه فالتمسك فيها بدينه كالخارط للقتاد ثم قوله  
عز شأنه لمنصور يا منصور ان هذا الامر لا ياتيكم  
الا بعد ياس لا والله حتى يميزوا لا والله حتى  
تخصوا لا والله حتى يشقى من يشقى ويسعد من  
يسعد كما نطق به الاخبار يحص الناس حتى يخرج  
تسعة اعشار منهم كما قال عز ذكره ما يكون ذلك  
حتى يميزوا ويخصوا وحتى لا يبقى منكم الا اقل  
ثم صغر كفه

105 And there is no doubt that trials shall not appear until people curse one another and disavow one another, as is clearly stated in His words, exalted be His glory: "The matter which you await shall not be until some of you disavow others, and some spit in the faces of others, and until some curse others, and some call others liars." God and His chosen ones have spoken truly. I complain of my grief and sorrow to God, and I am innocent of the polytheists. There is no doubt that in this trial God's Cause is clearer than the sun at high noon, otherwise God's proof would not be complete upon His servants.

105 ولا شك ان الفتن لم يظهر حتى تلعن الناس بعضهم بعضا ويتبرء الناس بعضهم من بعض كما صرح بذلك قوله عز شأنه لا يكون امر الذي تنتظرون حتى يتبرء بعضكم من بعض ويتفل بعضكم في وجوه بعض و حتى تلعن بعضكم بعضا و حتى يسمى بعضكم بعضا كذابين صدق الله و اوليائه اشكوا حزني و بئى الى الله و انا برئى من المشركين ولا شك ان فى تلك الفتنة امر الله اوضح من الشمس فى وسط الزوال والام لم يك حجة الله بالغه على العباد

106 And by every proof that people use to establish the existence of the Imams, they establish the existence of an emissary from the Proof who held in his hands evidence from his Master that none could match. And there is no doubt that in the Greater Occultation, whoever claims to have seen him claiming to be the Gate, his claim is false, as was clearly stated in that sublime directive from that Holy and Elevated One which shone forth from the eastern direction to the fourth of the four gates, Ali ibn Muhammad al-Samarri: "Hear - may God increase the reward of your brethren through you - you shall die within six days. So gather your affairs and do not appoint anyone to take your place after your death, for the complete Occultation has begun. There shall be no appearance except by God's permission, exalted be His mention, and that shall be after a long time when hearts have hardened, when the earth is filled with oppression. There will come from among my followers those who claim direct witness - but whosoever claims direct witness before the appearance of the Sufyani and the Call is a

106 وان بكل دليل يثبت الناس بوجود الائمة يثبت بوجود سفير من الحجة الذى كان فى يديه حجة من مولاه حيث لن يقدر احد ان ياتى بمثله ولا ريب ان فى غيبة الكبرى من ادعى الروية بحكم البابية فبطل دعواه كما نطق بذلك ذلك التوقيع المتبع من ذلك القدوس الرفيع الذى لاح و طلع من ناحية المشرق الى باب الرابع من ابواب الاربعة على بن محمد السميرى اسمع اعظم الله اجر اخوانك فيك فانك ميت ما بينك وبين سته ايام فاجمع امرك ولا توص الى احد يقوم مقامك بعد و فانك فقد وقعت الغيبة التامة فلا ظهور الا بعد اذن الله تعالى ذكره وذلك بعد طول الامل و قسوة القلوب و امتلا الارض جورا و سياقا من شيعتى من يدعى المشاهدة الا من ادعى المشاهدة قبل خروج السفينى والصيحة فهو كذاب مفتر ولا حول ولا قوة الا بالله العلى العظيم

lying impostor. There is no power nor might save in God, the Exalted, the Great.”

107 Yet there is no doubt that he - may my spirit be his sacrifice - has deputies on earth and nobles in authority. But by the evidence of wisdom and the nullification of gaps and the avoidance of sudden leaps, these close ones must necessarily return to a single soul who was the bearer of universal grace, specific ordinances, holy attributes and new subsidiary matters. Today there is no doubt that some of the learned claim this station, and there is no question that the world has not abandoned the virtuous when his virtue becomes apparent. There is no doubt that in every age there must be one who excels all others. By the proof that negates any gap in divine unity, the following of the lower is nullified unless the higher is recognized. Otherwise the earth would surely not be devoid of an ambassador standing by God's command, to whom the elevated returns and whom the follower joins - one who serves as the balance of justice, able to answer all the world's scholars if he wishes and nullify the work of the negligent.

108 When doubt arises in religion, he can dispel it with decisive proofs, firm evidence, clear verses and established signs, such that people need nothing else and doubt nothing. Those scholars whom the Imam commanded to follow and learn from, whose denial he made equivalent to denying God and whose obedience he made equivalent to obeying God - these are upon truth when they follow that single soul, for pure truth appears at the time of proof only through a single soul. The mystery in reality was thus, as the philosophers maintained regarding the origin of abstraction - that from the One proceeds only one. This is evident by the wisdom through which truth is established by truth and falsehood is nullified by truth, as is witnessed by one such as yourself, with no need to mention proofs or evidence against independence.

109 One such as yourself, possessed of proofs from among the people of wisdom and discourse, knows that in mentioning these allusions I intended only God's decree in the world of names and attributes. By your life, if you were certain of the mystery of majesty, witnessed the decrees of the Day of Reckoning, turned away from those who seek mere words and arguments, and became aware of what decree has befallen me from the Lord of Glory and Beauty, you would sigh deeply for my sake and weep for God's good pleasure over one imprisoned in his house without sin or dispute.

107 و لكن لا شك ان له روحى فذاه نقباء فى الارض و نجباء فى الحكم و لكن بدليل الحكمة و ابطال الفرجه و الفرار عن الطفره لابد ان يكون رجوع هؤلاء المقربين الى نفس واحده و انه كان حامل فيض الكليه و الاحكام الجزئيه و الشئون القدسيه و الامور الجديدة الفرعية و ان اليوم لا شك ان بعض العلماء يدعون ذلك المقام و لا ريب ان العالم لم يترك الفاضل حين اطلع بفضلله و لا شبهة فى ذلك بان فى كل زمان يكون احد كان افضل من كل و ان بدليل الذى تبطل الفرجه فى التوحيد فابطل تبعية الادنى ما لم تكن عرفت اعلى و الا لا شك لم تخلوا الارض من سفير قائم بامر الله الذى يرجع اليه العالى و يلحق به التالى و كان قسطاس عدل بحيث يقدر ان يجيب علماء الارض كلهم اذا شاء و يبطل عمل المفرطين

108 و اذا نزل فى الدين شبهة ليقدر يرفعه بدلائل محكمة و براهين متقنه و ايات محكمة و علامات ثابتة حتى لا يحتاج الناس بشئ و لا يشكون فى شئ و ان العلماء الذين امر الامام باتباعه و الاخذ عنهم و جعل بحمدهم مجد الله و طاعتهم طاعة الله فاولئك على حق اذا اتبعوا ذلك النفس الواحد لان الحق الخالص لم يظهر فى حين الاحتجاج الا نفس واحدة و ان السر فى الحقيقة كان كذلك كما ذهب الحكماء فى مبدء التجرد بان من الواحد لا يصدر الا الواحد و ان ذلك بدليل الحكمة التى بها يثبت الحق بالحق و يبطل الباطل بالحق مشهود عند مثل جنابك و لا حاجة بذكر الاستدلال و لا الدليل على نفي الاستقلال

109 و ان يمثل جنابك ذو الدلائل من اهل الحكم و الجدال لتعرف انى ما قصدت فى ذكر تلك الاشارات الاحكام الله فى عالم الاسماء و الصفات و لعمرك لو ايقنت بسر الجلال و شاهدت احكام يوم المال و اعرضت عن طلب القيل و القال و اطلعت بما جرى على القضاء من ذى الجلال و الجمال لتنفس فى حقى بمثل تنفس الصعداء و تبكى فى رضاء الله لمن سجن فى البيت من غير ذنب و لا جدال و لا بذكر ما اعطاه الله فى يوم المال

- 110 Lord, had I been patient in the presence of the might of Your Medina it would have been from my weakness, but with one like You being all-powerful, I did not remain patient. Your dominion and decree confined me. No, by Your might, despite my weakness, were I not to witness Your deed I could neither be patient nor have any power therein. But when I knew that time had decreed paradise in this world for one who denies Thee, and for one who believes in Thee two dates sweeter than I desire - I seek only Thy good pleasure and see no glory except in praising Thee by night and by day, and abasement only in disobeying Thee when Thou hast ordained Thy decree.
- 111 Through Thee, O my God, I am content with all besides Thee, and I desire naught save what Thou hast desired for me. Indeed, Thy knowledge of my contentment in remembering Thee is dearer to me than the dominion of both worlds. Thou knowest that in all conditions I fear Thy justice. And how should I not fear, when if Thou didst will to chastise me with all Thy punishments eternally, without end, by the perpetuity of Thine Essence, I would still deserve it even in my good deeds? Thou art praised in Thy deeds, obeyed in Thy command, and sovereign in Thy dominion.
- 112 For my very profession of Thy oneness is before Thee the greatest sin, since it derives from my existence. Sufficient is it as my sin that I should make mention of my existence before the dawning of Thy countenance, the majesty of Thy being, the beauty of Thine essence, the glory of Thy self-subsistence, the praise of Thy nature, the power of Thy reality, the encompassing nature of Thy mercy, the justice of Thy oneness, and the grace of Thy might. Glorified art Thou, glorified art Thou! I confess my sin even as Thy knowledge encompasseth all things, and I seek Thy forgiveness and turn unto Thee. Verily, Thou art the Munificent, the Merciful.
- 113 When thou hast understood what I have confessed before God, thou wilt surely know that all people have falsely accused me, even while they imagine themselves to be guided. Should anyone today claim authority beyond the authority of the Qur'an, or make statements outside the paths of the people of the Bayan, none should consider such a one human. Rather, it is incumbent upon all to choose for themselves what God hath chosen for them and what He hath pronounced in His judgment before He manifested it through 'Ali, peace be upon him, in his hidden sermons, then in the "Speechless Sermon" with its strange allusions and beautiful intimations.
- 114 If man were to be fair before God, he would not need mention of proof and evidence, for he who came with the command of the Glorious One, were he to change a decree, would need to
- رب لو انى صبرت فى تلقاء مدين عزتك لكان من عجزى ولكن بمثلك مقتدرا لما صبرت اسكننى ملك و حكمك لا و عزتك انى مع عجزى لو لا اشاهد فعلك لا اصبر ولا قدرة لى فيه ولكن لما علمت بان الدهر قد قضى لمثل كافر بك بجنة الدنيا ولمثل مؤمن بك بشقين تمر احدى ما اريد الا رضاك ولا ارى العز الا فى ثنائك بالليل والنهار ولا الذل الا فى عصيانك اذ امددت القضاء
- فبك ارضى يا الهى عن سواك ولا اردت شيئا الا ما اردت لى وان علمك برضاك فى ذكرى لك احب الى من ملك الاخرة والاولى وانك لتعلم بانى فى كل شان خائف من عدلك وكيف لا اخاف وانك لو اردت ان تعذبني بكل نعماتك سرمدا لا بد بدوام ذاتك لكنت مستحقا فى حسناى وانك كنت محمودا فى فعلك و مطاعا فى امرك و سلطانا فى ملكك
- لان توحيدى لك لديك اعظم ذنب لانه قد عيّن من وجودى و كفى بذنبى ذكر وجودى فى تلقاء طاعتك و جلال كينونيتك و جمال ذاتيتك و بهاء صمدانيتك و ثناء نفسانيتك و قدرة ايتك و احاطة رحمانيتك و عدل وحدانيتك و فضل جباريتك فسبحانك سبحانك اعترف بذنبى بمثل ما انت احاطت عليك و استغفرك و اتوب اليك انك انت الجواد الرحيم
- فاذا عرفت ما اقررت بين يدى الله لتوقن بان الناس كلهم قد كذبوا على من حيث يحسبون انهم مهتدون فاذا ادعى اليوم احد بحكم دون حكم القرآن او ببيان من غير سبل اهل البيان فليس لاحد ان يقول هذا انسان ولكن على الكل فرض ان يختاروا لانفسهم ما اختاره الله لهم و نطق بحكمه من قبل ان يظهره الله فى العيان على عليه السلام فى خطبه الخزون ثم فى الخطبة العجماء بالاشارات الغريبة والتلويحات الجميله
- وان الانسان لو انصف بين يدى الله لم يحتاج بذكر البرهان و الدليل لان الذى جاء بامر الجليل لو

present proof, and since he confirmed what all the true sect believed, nothing is required of him while all are obliged to derive their paths of knowledge from the Tree that speaketh in his breast. For the knowledge of people today containeth all contradictions and embraceth all opposing views, but he whom God hath taught the knowledge of the Bayan from His presence - his judgment floweth not as floweth the judgment in the sciences of all. This indeed is the evidence for those who gaze upon the throne of holiness and majesty.

بدل حكما فرض عليه بذكر الدليل ولما كان مصدقا لما كان الكل عليه من فرقة الحق فليس عليه شيء وعلى الكل حق ان يخذوا طرق علمهم من شجرة التي تنطق في صدره بان علم الناس اليوم فيه كل الاختلافات ثابتة وكل المتعارضات جامعة ولكن من علمه الله من عنده علم البيان لم يجر في حكمه علم ما يجري الحكم في علوم الكل وان ذلك بيان الاستدلال لناظرين الى عرش القدس والجلال

115 In thy present state, these proofs benefit thee not unless thou effacest from around thy heart the paths of reasoning from all sources, for there is no end to matters of knowledge, and no limit to the ways of reasoning. This is in regard to when thou makest the balance in forms of knowledge, but when thou makest the balance the mystery of divinity, the manifestation of eternality, and the resplendent, shining verses that gleamed from the Morn of Eternity, the veils shall be lifted from thee and nothing shall withhold thee from the scrolls.

115 وان بحال جنباك اليوم لا تنفع تلك الدلائل الا اذا تنفنى من حول قلبك سبل الاستدلال من جامع الوسائل لان شئون العلية لا نهاية لها وان طرق الاستدلال لا غاية لها ذلك في شان اذا جعلت القسطاس في صور العلية ولكن اذا تجعل القسطاس سر الربانية وظهور الصمدانية و ايات الشعشعانية الالامعة التي لاحت عن صبح الازل كشف لك الحجب ولا يمنعك شيء عن الصحف

116 In these words, I desired naught for thee save the rending of veils, that the raptures of holiness and the breaths of justice might establish thee at the summit of grace and attributes. And when thou didst mention before, in the depths of allusion, the interpretation of the first letter of thy book, I mention an aspect from the forms of the knowledge of the Bayan: that the letter Ha is the spirit of the letter. The ultimate purpose of the servant's remembrance of the Beloved is like unto the letter which is the red elixir among letters, purifying all words, symbols, signs and allusions. Through it is established the unity of God and negated the law of multiplicity. The people of understanding, since they can know naught of that realm save through what is here, deduce through this letter in all the worlds. It completes the numerical value of the Word than which God hath revealed none lighter in the Qur'an, and it is identical with it in the world of manifestation.

116 واننى انا في تلك الكلمات ما اردت لجنباك الا بكشف السبحات لتستقر جذبات القدس و نفحات العدل الى ذروة الفضل والصفات و لما ذكرت من قبل في غياهب الاشارات بتفسير حرف الاول من كتاب جنباك اذكر شانا من صور علم البيان بان حرف الهاء هو روح الحرف و غاية ذكر العبد للمحبيب وانه هو حرف اكسير الاحمر في الحروف لتخليص كل الكلمات والدلالات والعلامات والاشارات وان به يثبت التوحيد ونفى حكم التكثير وان اولى الابواب لما لا يعلم ما هنالك الا بما ها هنا يستدلون بذلك الحرف في كل العوالم وهو تمام عدة كلمة التي ما نزل الله في القرآن اخف منها وانه هو بعينها في عالم الظهور و

117 The inmost reality of that Word is completed because the origin of all letters is the Point, and when the Point was divided it became an Alif, and when the Alif bowed before its Lord it became the letter Ba itself, hence the Point was found beneath it. That Word was naught but an Alif between two Bas, and it is a sign of God's command between two Names. Should one of insight contemplate the reality of that Word, he would know what no one else has conceived.

117 تمام البطون هي تلك الكلمة لان اصل الحروف هو النقطة وان النقطة لما فصلت صارت الفا و ان الالف لما خضع لربه صار حرف الباء بعينها ولذا وجدت النقطة في تحتها وان تلك الكلمة لم تك الا الفا في بين البائين وهو اشارة بامر الله في بين الاسمين واذا لاحظ ذو لحظه في حقيقة تلك الكلمة ليعرف ما لا يخطر به علم احد

118 Therefore God hath not assigned to that Word, as with other words, a half, third or quarter, for it is the manifestation of

118 ولذا ما جعل الله لتلك الكلمة بمثل الكلمات نصف وثلث وربع لانها مظهر نور الصمدانية

the light of the Divine Eternality from which nothing emerges. God hath ordained the Fifth (Khums) for wisdom, and due to the glory of the numerical value of that Word, He hath attributed it to Himself. God hath created within that Word matters which none can comprehend save whom He willeth. Among these is that He made two letters in that Word from the dark letters, lest people become confused about the law of unity except in the station of the Alif in its state of oneness, for it is from the luminous letters. Glory be to God, how great is His power and how mighty His proof!

لم يخرج منه شيء وان الله قد فرض الخمس لحكمه  
ولعزة عده تلك الكلمة قد نسبها الى نفسه و قد  
خلق الله في تلك الكلمة امورا لا يحيط بها احد  
الا من شاء الله ومنها ما جعل الحرفين في تلك  
الكلمة من احرف الظلمات لئلا يشتبه على الناس  
حكم التوحيد الا في حكم الالف في مقام الوحدة  
وانه هو من احرف النورانية فسبحان الله ما اعظم  
قدرته واكبر حجته

- 119 Should you open the door of the knowledge of letters in that Word, you would discover from the lights of the heaven of Divinity, the effulgences of the Throne of Might, and the fragrances of the heaven of sovereignty and dominion that which no limited knowledge can encompass. For the spirit in words is like the spirit in bodies, and between them is an essential relationship when considering their essences and accidents, and pure severance when describing God, the Lord of all names and attributes. For names have infinite ranks, and the named of all things is in its own rank.

وانك اذا فتحت باب علم الحروف في تلك الكلمة  
لتجد من انوار سماء الالهوت و تجليات عرش  
الجبروت و نفحات سماء الملك و الملكوت ما لا  
يحيط به علم الحدود لان الروح في الالفاظ هو  
بمثل روح في الاجساد وان بينهما مناسبة ذاتية  
اذا لاحظت في الجوهريات والعرضيات و قطع  
محض اذا وصف الله رب الاسماء والصفات  
لان الاسم مراتب ما لا نهاية وان مسمى كل شيء  
هو في مرتبته

- 120 Behold the spirit of the people of God and their bodies, then look at their words. Though all may utter the word 'justice', when God, exalted be His mention, speaks it, it is that justice which was the source of justice's existence in the Divine Will. When it descends from on high it indicates the named, hence it is written in the Law that none shall touch it save the purified ones. Were all to gather to produce the like of this form of justice, they could not, for what they bring forth from the letters 'ayn, dal and lam is but its body at their rank, while its spirit is non-existent compared to the justice which God hath brought forth for Himself.

انظر الى روح ال الله و اجسامهم ثم انظر الى  
كلماتهم ولو كان كلمة عدل هذه كل يقولون بها  
ولكن اذا قال الله عز ذكره هو عدل الذي كان  
مبدء وجود العدل في المشيه و اذا نزل من ملاء  
الاعلى يدل على مسمى ولذا قد ورد في الشريعة  
بما لا يحصى الا المطهرون ولو اجتمع الكل على ان  
ياتوا بمثل صورته العدل هذه لم يقدروا لان الذي  
هم ياتون من حرف العين وال دال وال لام هو  
جسده كان في رتبته وان روحه معدوم عند  
عدل الذي ابدع الله لنفسه

- 121 Likewise is the decree of justice uttered by the Messenger of God, for its spirit was from His spirit and its utterance from His body. Were all to gather to speak like the word spoken by the Messenger of God, they could not, for its spirit was at His station and its body like unto His, yet most people know not and are powerless.

وكذلك حكم عدل الذي نطق به رسول الله لان  
روحه كان من روحه ولفظه كان من جسده و  
لو اجتمع الكل على ان يتكلموا بمثل كلمة التي كلم  
بها رسول الله لم يقدروا لان روحه كان في مقامه  
و جسده بمثله وان اكثر الناس لا يعرفون ولا  
يقدررون

- 122 Such is the decree in every series of eight, for the word 'justice' spoken of by the Gates is its spirit, while its body was in their station. Neither its body nor its spirit can attain to the Word uttered by him who dwelt in the realm of inner meanings, and likewise he who dwelt in the realm of inner meanings in relation to him who spoke in the Bayan from the All-Merciful.

وكذلك الحكم في كل سلسلة الثمانية لان كلمة  
عدل التي تكلم بها الابواب هي روحه و جسده  
كان في مقامهم ولم يصل جسده ولا روحه بكلمة  
التي ينطق بها من كان في عالم المعاني وكذلك  
من كان في عالم المعاني بالنسبة الى من نطق في  
بيان عن الرحمن

- 123 Observe all the letters as you observe people, and recognize the words of the Imams, the Pillars, the Chiefs, and the Nobles just as they have been distilled from the Ocean of Glory upon those signs from the vast sea of majesty. Through knowledge of that station, one recognizes the miracle of the Qur'an and the paths of the people of the Bayan and exposition from among the people of vision.
- 123 وانت انظر الى كل الحروف بمثل ما تنظر الى الناس وتعرف كلمات الاثمة والاركان والنقاء والتجاء بمثل ما ارشحت من يم الجلال على تلك الاشارات من طمطم يم الجلال وان بعلم تلك الرتبة يعرف الانسان معجزة القران وسبل اهل البيان والتبيان من اهل العيان
- 124 Most people are dead in the knowledge of that station, as they recognize and hear all words through similar forms, and that is pure polytheism in the religion of the Family of God. For God said "Verily I am He," which indicates His eternity, and that Word in letters is the primordial essence of letters. Nothing resembles Him in the heavens or on earth, and all who uttered that Word did not attain to His presence in what God said, for words are like bodies.
- 124 وان اكثر الناس في علم ذلك المقام اموات حيث يعرفون ويسمعون كل الكلمات بالصّور المشاكل وان ذلك شرك محض في مذهب ال الله لان الله قال اني انا وهو يدل على ازليته وان تلك الكلمة في الحروف انية ازل الحروف ولا يشابهه شئ في السموات ولا في الارض وكل من قال تلك الكلمة لم يصل الى ساحتها ما قال الله لان الالفاظ بمثل الاجساد
- 125 Just as no one can be like the body of the Imam, peace be upon him, no letter can be like the letters spoken by the Family of God in the Bayan, even if the forms appear similar in shape. Rather, it is as I have imparted to you - all are in human form, but the Imam is the most abstract form and the divine light that calls from its essence to its essence, proclaims divinity, and speaks from the realm of might. Such is the decree regarding letters.
- 125 كما ان في الناس لا يمكن ان يكون احد مثل جسم الامام عليه السلام لا يمكن ان يكون حرفا مثل حروف التي نطقوا ال الله في البيان ولو كان الصور يشابه في الاشكال ولكن هو بمثل ما القيت عليك كل على صورة انسان ولكن ان الامام هو الصورة الاتزعية والنور الالهية التي يدعوا من ذاتها الى ذاتها ويصرح باللاهوتية وينطق عن الجبروتية وكذلك الحكم في الحروف
- 126 By thy Lord, the Lord of the heavens and earth, were all to gather to produce the like of an alif that came from 'Ali, peace be upon him, in letters, they would be powerless. Nay, the alif they produce has no existence in the presence of His alif. Thus do you recognize all deeds, conditions, letters and signs in the series of eight.
- 126 فربك رب السموات والارض لو اجتمع الكل على ان ياتوا بمثل الف ما ات على عليه السلام في الحروف لن يقدروا بل لا وجود للالف الذي ياتون الناس في ساحة وجود الفه وكذلك انت تعرف كل الاعمال والشؤون والاحرف والاشارات في سلسلة الثمانية و
- 127 Today, were people to gather to produce the like of a single letter of what was written in that Tablet, they could not, for he who brought it - his spirit and body were in his station, and he through whom I spoke - his spirit and body were in the station of one whom God aided through His grace.
- 127 ان اليوم لو اجتمع الناس ان ياتوا بمثل حرف مما كتبت في ذلك اللوح لم يستطيعوا لان الذي هو ياتي روحه وجسده كان في مقامه وان الذي اني نطقت كان روحه وجسده في مقام من ايده الله بفضله
- 128 Through knowledge of these details, the witness recognizes the greatness of the words of the Family of God and their followers, for they were like their bodies which no creation resembled and no mention equaled. So glory be to God, the Lord of the Throne, above what the speakers describe. He is beyond what the mystics know and independent of what people do. Peace
- 128 وان بعلم ذلك التفصيل يعرف الشاهد عظمة كلمات ال الله وشيعتهم بانهما كانت بمثل اجسادهم لم يشابه كل الخلق ولم يعادل كل الذكر فسبحان الله رب العرش عما يصف القائلون وانه هو فوق ما يعرف العارفون وغنى عما كان

be upon the Messengers, and praise be to God, the Lord of the worlds.

الناس يعملون و سلام على المرسلين و الحمد لله  
رب العالمين

GOH.211-214x, GOH.222-223x, MNP.209x, LOIR06.052x, BLO\_PT#079.1.3x,  
BLO\_PT#079.1.6x

INBA14:231-283, INBA53:081-125,  
INBA67:004-052, INBA86:099-154,  
INBA\_3006C:002-058, INBA\_6010C:221-  
274, INBA\_4002C, PR02.181r22-  
193v13, PR07.078r-092v, AADA.138x,  
ASAT1.189x, ASAT3.214x, AVK1.100-  
102x, HNMI.080-081x

## BB00029

*Tafsir al-Ha II (Tafsir sirr al-ha) (Commentary on the Mystery of Ha')*

*Date: unknown (late Shiraz)*

1 In the name of God, the Most Merciful, the Most Compassionate

1 بسم الله الرحمن الرحيم

2 All praise be to God Who hath sanctified His own Essence above the comprehension of the most exalted abstracted realities of the Divine Realm and all that resembleth them. All praise be to God Who hath transcended in the sublimity of His Being above the description of the most lofty pinnacles of existence and all that compareth with them. All praise be to God Who hath distinguished Himself in the uniqueness of His Identity above all mention of contingent being and whatsoever existeth through creation in the depths of the Realm of Might and all that equalleth them. All praise be to God Who hath magnified Himself in the grandeur of His Self above the judgment of outward vision concerning contingent beings and whatsoever resembleth His judgment therein without mention of aught that accompanieth it.

2 الحمد لله الذى تقدر بقدس كينونته عن  
عرفان اعلى مجردات اللاهوت و من يشابهها  
والحمد لله الذى تعالى بعلو ذاتيته عن تبين اعلى  
شواخ الموجودات و من يقارنها و الحمد لله الذى  
تفرد بنفسانيته عن ذكر الامكان و ما يوجد  
بالابداع فى اجمة الجبروت و من يعادلها و الحمد  
لله الذى تكبر بتكبر انيته عن حكم العيان فى  
الكينونيات الممكنات و من يشابه حكمه فيها بها  
من دون ذكر يساوقها

3 Glorified and exalted be He! He hath created the Will from naught through the existence of contingent things, then Purpose for the determination of essential realities, then Destiny for the geometry of material things, then Decree for the judgment of origination in beings, then Term for the limits of quiddities, then Permission for the manifestation of universals and particulars in the world of names and attributes, then the Book to encompass all that His knowledge hath encompassed in the realm of possibility.

3 فسبحانه و تعالى قد خلق المشية لا من شئ  
بوجود الممكنات ثم الارادة لتعين الجوهريات ثم  
القدر لهندسة الماديات ثم القضاء لحكم البداء فى  
الكينونيات ثم الاجل لحدود الماهيات ثم الاذن  
لظهور الكليات و الجزئيات فى عالم الاسماء و  
الصفات ثم الكتاب ليحصى كل ما احاط علمه  
فى صقع الامكان

- 4 Exalted be the Most Merciful Who created the Point and made it the ornament of the tablets of creation and invention, which determined what was detailed, decreed what was appointed, permitted what was established, and made manifest what was illumined. Then through it was made to speak what was made to speak, and was made joyous; was elevated what was elevated, and was made sublime; was made distinct what was made distinct, and was made beneficial; was joined what was joined, and was separated; was made successive what was made successive, and was made non-existent; was magnified what was magnified, and was made mighty; was made resplendent what was made resplendent, and was made to sob; was struck down what was struck down, and was made pure; was made to cry what was made to cry, and was confounded what was confounded.
- 5 And it declared that the signs in the essential realities of the Divine Realm are cut off in their being from inference, and that the evidences in the material things of the Realm of Might are prevented in their essence from independence, and that things crying out are in themselves witness to their severance from the knowledge of identities, and that the radiant things are in themselves witness to their prevention from mention of the explanation of selfhoods.
- 6 Exalted be God their Originator, Who cannot be described by where, nor qualified by how, nor indicated by other, nor worshipped in His Essence, for His Being in the very Eternity hath severed the separate things from conjunction, and His Self in the very Eternality hath prevented the disparate things from separation, and the Identity of Oneness in the very Self-Subsistence hath distinguished essential realities from derivation, and the Selfhood of the Identity in the very Lordship hath directed material things from utterance.
- 7 Glorified be God, the Originator of creation, above mention of what He hath split between the atmospheres, and what is mentioned by praise and radiance, then decree and execution, then origination and cloud, by all the people of creation, for verily He, as He is He, none knoweth Him save He, and none is able to praise Muhammad or the Family of God before Him according to what He hath determined and encompassed concerning their station. Verily, He is the Most Great, the Most Exalted.
- 8 Thereafter, when what God my Lord willed was detailed in the interpretation of the letter Ha' in the first copy, I desired to interpret concerning its mystery through some of what I interpreted concerning its outward meaning, that it might be light
- 4 فتعالى الرحمن الذي خلق النقطة و جعلها طراز  
الواح الابداع والاختراع التي قدرت ما فصلت  
وقضت ما اجلت و اذنت ما احكت و  
تلجلجت ما تثلثت ثم بها استنطق ما استنطق  
واستبشرت واسترفعت ما استرفعت واستعال  
ما استعال واستبان واستفادت ما استفادت  
واستقارنت ما استقارنت واستفارت ما  
استفادت ما استرادفت واستعدمت ما  
استعدمت واستكبرت ما استكبرت واستعظمت  
ما استعظمت واستلجلجت ما استلجلجت واستشبهت  
ما استشبهت واستصعقت ما استصعقت واستخلصت  
ما استخلصت واستصيصت ما استصيصت واستبليت  
ما استبليت
- 5 وقالت ان الاشارات في جوهريات الالهوتيات  
منقطعة الكينونيات عن الاستدلال و ان  
الدلالات في ماديات الجبروتيات ممتنعه  
الذاتيات عن الاستقلال و ان المستصيصات  
بنفسها شاهدة بالانقطاع عن عرفان النفسانيات  
و ان الشعشعيات بنفسها شاهدة بالامتناع عن  
ذكر بيان الانيات
- 6 فتعالى الله موجدها حيث لا يوصف بالاي و  
لا ينعت بالكيف و لا يشير بالغير و لن يعبد  
بالكنه اذ ذاتيته بنفس الازلية مقطعة المفترقات  
عن الاقتران و ان ائنيته بنفس الصمدية ممتنعه  
المفترقات عن الاقتران و ان نفسانيه الاحدية  
بنفس القيومية مفرقة الجوهريات عن الاشتقاق  
و ان ائنيته الهوية بنفس الربانية مسدده الماديات  
عن الاستنطاق
- 7 فسبحان الله موجد الخلق عن ذكر ما فتح بين  
الاجواء و ما ذكر بالثناء و السناء ثم القضاء و  
الامضاء ثم البداء و العماء من كل اهل الانشاء  
اذ انه كما هو هو لن يعرفه الا هو و لا يقدر احد  
ان يثني محمد او ال الله بين يديه بما هو قدر و  
احصى في شانهم انه هو كبير المتعال
- 8 و بعد لما فصلت في تفسير الهاء ما شاء الله ربي  
في نسخة الاولى فانا اذا اريد ان افسر في سره  
ببعض ما فسر في علانيته ليكون نورا بعد نور  
لمن استقر على بساط الظهور و اراد ان يشرب ماء

upon light for whoso hath settled upon the carpet of manifestation and desired to drink the water of purity from the decree of the right hand of the Tree of Sinai. Verily we are God's, and verily unto our Lord do we return.

الطهور عن حكم يمين شجرة الطور فانا لله وانا الى ربنا منقلبون

- 9 I have mentioned in the signs of before that the Cause in truth, were it not complete in its outward manifestation, would not be complete in its concealment, from the All-Wise from Whose knowledge nothing escapeth and Who is never powerless to create one thing from another, though He is indeed the All-Powerful.
- 9 ولقد ذكرت في اشارات القيل بان الامر في الحقيقه لو لم يكن تامه في ظهورها لم يك تامه في بطونها من الحكيم الذي لا يعزب من علمه شيء ولا يعجزه بدع شيء عن شيء ولو كان قادرا
- 10 Strange it is that people of understanding should imagine that that which can proceed from none save by God's command could be attained through extreme asceticism, the attractions of possibility, power of memory, or study of revealed books. This is naught but the conjecture of the discerning and the speculation of the perspicacious regarding the signs of knowledge. Otherwise, concerning the judgment of verses, invocations and sermons, such thoughts would never occur to them.
- 10 وان العجب من ذو الالباب هو ان امر الذي لا يمكن ان يصدر من احد الا بامر الله ربما انهم يظنون بغاية الرياضه وجذبات الممكنة وقوة الحافظه ومشاهده كتب المنزلة وما كان ذلك الا لعبد المتفرس وظن المتفطن في اشارات العلوم والا في حكم الايات والدعوات والخطب لا يخطر بباله ذلك الظن
- 11 This assumption is a grievous sin, for reason itself rebels against its own kind in maintaining that if the station of verses could proceed from anyone without God's leave and command, then from the Day of Resurrection until now someone would surely have produced such words and proven them to be of human origin. How then could the judgment of the Qur'an stand as the supreme proof?
- 11 هو اثم عظيم لان العقل يكابر حسه في مقابلة ابناء جنسه بان شان الايات لو كان يمكن ان يصدر من احد بغير اذن الله وامره فلا بد من يوم البعثه الى يومك هذا جاء احد بتلك الكلمات وان يثبت فيها صنع البشر فكيف يثبت حكم القرآن حجة الاكبر
- 12 This is among the contentions of the people of disputation, but for one like thee among the people of spiritual states, thou wouldst see that whoso claims God's Cause and His judgment, then His verses and His command – were he not acting with God's good pleasure, God would be obligated to raise up another with similar proof, for God is the Ever-Living, the All-Powerful, the All-Knowing, and He is the Protector of His religion and His judgment. When this is not the case, there is no doubt that the Cause is established through God's knowledge and power, not through the impotence and schemes of creation.
- 12 وان ذلك من محاريب اهل الجدل والا بمثلك اهل الحال لترى بان الذي يدعى امر الله وحكمه ثم اياته وامره لو كان على غير رضاء الله فعلى الله حق ان يظهر بشرا بمثل حجتة لان الله حي قادر عليم وانه هو حافظ دينه وحكمه واذا لم يكن لاشك ان الامر يثبت بعلم الله وقدرته من دون عجز الخلق وهندستهم
- 13 Concerning this proof, were God to manifest it, I would not wish to mention to thee in this book aught save what I would read in thy presence when God lifteth the fear and the veil, that thou mayest know with thine own eyes that human proof is naught but from the All-Merciful in the manner of the Bayan. Previously I mentioned in the explanation of Kawthar, at the balance of justice, a true sprinkling to manifest what God hath created in existence unto vision.
- 13 وان تلك الحجة لو شاء الله ليظهرها ما احب ان اذكر لك في ذلك الكتاب الا بقرائتي بين طلعتك اذا ارفع الله الخوف والحجاب لتعلم بالعيان بان حجة الانسان لم يك الا من الرحمن بشأن البيان ولقد ذكرت من قبل في بيان الكوثر عند ميزان القسطاس رشحا حقيقيا لاظهار ما خلق الله في الكيان الى العيان

- 14 By thy Lord, the Lord of the heavens and earth, were I to recite God's verses or what was revealed in the Book, there would be none closer to me than the most excellent judgment of knowledge among the people, yet most people are not grateful. O man! This Cause is not dubious to anyone, nor can anyone flee from it, for none came with such proof save Muhammad the Messenger of God, and every proof in every station is established through this proof from God.
- 14 فوربك رب السموات والارض لو اتل آيات الله او انزل في الكتاب لا قرب لدى من افضل حكم العلم بين الناس ولكن اكثر الناس لا يشكرون فيا ايها الانسان ان هذا الامر لا يشتبه على احد ولا يقدر ان يفر منه احد لان بتلك الحجة ما جاء الا محمد رسول الله وان كل الدليل في كل مقام يثبت بتلك الحجة من الله
- 15 None can utter a word concerning it unless he wisheth to deny his Lord, for one who speaketh a word which all on earth combined could not produce the like thereof – this is not the creation of creatures but rather the creation of God. Show me then what those who are called upon besides Him have created.
- 15 ولا يمكن لاحد ان يقول فيه حرفا الا ان اراد ان يكفر بربه لان الذي يتكلم بكلمة وان من على الارض كلهم لو اجتمعوا لم يقدرُوا ان ياتوا بمثله ليس صنع الخلق بل هذا خلق الله فارونى ماذا خلق الذين يدعون من دونه
- 16 Mighty is God's Cause, for the proof of this Cause is like unto the supreme proof of God's Messenger, and through this proof God nullified the deeds of the people of the towns and the divines who exchange truth for falsehood. If thou wouldst today look with the eye of truth, thou wouldst see those who spread corruption in that land without right are in the fire. Indeed, thou wouldst recite unto them the verse of the Subduer: "Did ye but know with certainty of knowledge, ye would behold the Hell-fire, then would ye see it with certainty of sight, then on that Day shall ye be questioned concerning the delights."
- 16 عظم امر الله فان حجة ذلك الامر هو كان بمثل اعظم حجة رسول الله وان بتلك الحجة ابطل الله عمل اهل القرى والعلماء الذين يدلون الحق بالباطل وان جنابك اليوم لو تنظر بطرف الحقيقة لترى الذين يفسدون على تلك الارض بغير حق في النار بل تقرأ عليهم آية القهار لو تعلمون عليم اليقين لترون الحميم ثم لترونها عين اليقين ثم لتسئلن يومئذ عن النعيم
- 17 For those who committed it aforetime performed, in the sight of God, a deed more base than the deed of Pharaoh and of the bedouins of pagan ignorance. For when Pharaoh purposed to deny the proof of his Lord, he brought forth a kind of sorcery; and the Arabs, in the early days of Islām, composed odes about the House. Yet these men deny the Cause of God at the very time they imagine themselves rightly guided. God confound them! Evil indeed is that which their hands have wrought, and grievous is that which they do.
- 17 لان الذين هم ارتكبه من قبل كان ادنى عملا عند الله من عمل فرعون واعراب الجاهلية لانه لما اراد ان ييحد حجة ربه اتى بشئ من السحر وان الاعراب في صدر الاسلام اتوا بقصائد حول البيت وانهم ييحدون امر الله من حيث يحسبون انهم مهتدون قتلهم الله بئس ما اكتسبت ايديهم وساء ما هم يفعلون
- 18 O man! How shall I unveil this Cause, which in its grandeur is like unto the pillar of Prophethood? It possesseth proof in the Bayan even as God revealed unto Muhammad in the Qur'an. Belittle not the Cause of God, doubt not the power of God, and follow not the forms of learning lest they lead thee astray from the path of God. For I swear by thy life, I have not read a single letter of that outward knowledge, nor do I know today a single rule from the principles of the people of the Bayan. I possessed no books of learning beforehand from which to memorize words, nor had I any means to this bestowal from the All-Merciful save through God's grace and bounty. Indeed, were one such as thyself to question me today concerning the technical matters of learning recorded in books, by thy Lord, I
- 18 فيا ايها الانسان فكيف اكشف القناع عن راس ذلك الامر وانه لامر في العظمة مثل ركن النبوة وله الحجة في البيان بمثل ما نزل الله لحمد في القرآن ولا تصغر امر الله ولا تشك في قدرة الله ولا تتبع صور العلية ليضلك عن سبيل الله فاني و لعمرك ما قرئت حرفا من ذلك العلم العيان ولا اعلم اليوم حرفا من قواعد اهل البيان وما كان عندي من قبل كتب علم حتى استحفظ الكلمات ولا لى سبب في هذا العطاء من الرحمن الا فضل الله وجوده وان اليوم لو يسئل مثل جنابك عنى من شئون العلية المسطورة في الكتب فوربك

would know not - nay, not even grammar and syntax. In this do I glory, and by this will God adduce proof against all on the Day of Resurrection, for he who is aided by God's grace is more worthy to be followed than those who are unable to comprehend His wisdom and His signs.

- 19 It behooveth one such as thyself to arise with the balance of the Bayan, to be convinced by the proof of the All-Merciful, and to observe in that Bayan through the light of clear vision the mystery of all created things. Though I be in fear today of Satan and his brethren, yet by thy Lord, the Lord of the heavens and earth, were all to gather with all their might to deny Me, I would not see it as even equal to the blackness in the eye of a dead ant, than which nothing smaller exists in mention among created things. For the proof is in My hand like unto this sun at high noon, brilliant and radiant. Yea, were anyone, even an infidel, to read a verse in its pristine nature, My back would be broken - though this is impossible, I mention it only to unveil souls and cleanse hearts, like unto His words, exalted be His mention: "Call your witnesses besides God if ye be truthful."

- 20 Indeed, such utterance from one like Me is not befitting, for its time hath not yet come. But since I see thee among those who desire the pure religion, I have sprinkled from that surging ocean a sprinkling of that which was about to overflow from Me. Though My fear for that land is evident to thee, yet since My hope in God exceeds My fear of them, I have mentioned what thou knowest. Conceal that which God hath commanded to be concealed until they witness what they were promised. Say: Their appointed time is the morning - is not the morning near? Sufficient unto them is the mention of deeds in this world and religion.

- 21 Know that it is obvious to you that in the science of allusions and realities, the heroes of Ahmadiyya and the mystics of Kazmiyya have risen up against me more than other divines, since some of them have ascended the ladder of allusions to such a degree that they can split hairs, yet they have recognized the Cause of God. I do not think that you know any of their leaders except the one who came before to that land, and he is today truly a vast ocean of knowledge, as both the Shaykh and the Siyyid - may God sanctify their dust - have explicitly acknowledged his excellence and diligence.

- 22 Although one such as I should not cite his writing as evidence, I have sent his letter to you so that you may know that he became certain merely upon seeing the verses. Most of the

لا أعلم بل ولا صرف والنحو وبذلك افتخر  
وبه احتج الله يوم القيمة على الكل لان الذي  
يؤيد بفضل الله احق من ان يتبع عن الذين لا  
يقدر ان يعرفوا حكمه و اشاراته

- 19 وان على مثل جنابك ان تطلع بقسطاس البيان  
وتوقن بحجة الرحمن وتلاحظ في ذلك البيان  
بنور العيان سر الاكوان والاعيان ولو ان اليوم  
اتى في خوف من الشيطان واخويه ولكن فو  
ربك رب السموات والارض لو اجتمع الكل  
بكل صيبتهم على محمد فليس لدى وما ارى  
بمثل سواد عين ثملة ميتة حيث لم يك في الوجود  
اصغر منه في ذكر الموجود لان الحجة في يدى بمثل  
هذه الشمس في رابعة النهار شعشعانية لامعة بلى  
ان قرء احد ولو كان من اهل الكفر اية على  
الفطره فينكسر ظهرى وان ذلك امر ممتنع  
قد ذكرته لافك النفوس ومكنسة القلوب مثل  
قوله عز ذكره فادعوا شهداءكم من دون الله ان  
كنتم صادقين

- 20 وان ذلك البيان من مثلى لا ينبغي لما حان  
وقته ولكنى لما اراك من الذين تريدون الدين  
الخالص قد ارشحت من ذلك الطمطمم الداخر  
رشحا لما اراد ان يطفح منى ولو ان خوفى على  
تلك الارض مشهود عند جنابك ولكن لما كان  
رجائى من الله اكثر من خوفى عنهم ذكرت ما  
انت تعلم به فاستر ما امر الله فيه بستره حتى راو  
ما يوعدون قل ان موعدهم الصبح اليس الصبح  
بقريب وكفى لهم ذكر العمل في الدنيا والدين

- 21 وان على جنابك لا يخفى ان في علم الاشارات  
والحقائق ابطال الاحدية وذوبان الكاظميه قد  
ارتفعوا على اكثر من العلماء حيث ان بعضا منهم  
قد عرجوا في معراج الاشارات بحيث ياخذون  
الشعر عن الشعر وانهم قد صدقوا امر الله ولا  
اظن ان جنابك تعرف احدا من روائهم الا  
الذى جاء من قبل على تلك الارض وانه اليوم  
بالحقيقه طمطمم داخر في العلم حيث قد صرح  
الشيخ والسيد قدس الله تربتهما بفضلهم واجتهاده

- 22 ولو ان مثلى لا ينبغي ان يستشهد بكاتبه ولكن  
ارسلت الى جنابك كتابه لتعلم انه ايقن بمجرد رويت

divines who possessed a human spirit have acknowledged this wondrous Cause, this brilliant honor from this religion. Those who deny this Cause are dead - their deeds have no validity, for one who believes not in God's Cause has no standing, nor does one who fears not knowledge. It is as though they perceive not what their hands have wrought.

الايات و ان اكثر علماء الذين كان فيهم روح  
الانسان قد صدقوا ذلك الامر البديع الشرف  
الباهر من ذلك الدين و ان الذين ينكرون ذلك  
الامر اموات لا حكم بعملهم لان ليس لمن لا  
يؤمن بامر الله حكم ولا لمن ليس يخشى علم كانهم  
لا يشعرون بما عملت ايديهم

- 23 O God! The compiler of the Seas has mentioned, regarding the miracle of the Family of God, the Sahifah-i-Sajjadiyyih, saying that all agree it resembles the heavenly scriptures and the psalms of the Family of Muhammad in composition, and this treatise suffices as praise for whoever wishes to believe in them. How then can the authority of the Wilayat be established through a decisive treatise, yet my servitude to the Family of God not be established through numerous treatises that have filled the East and West of the earth?

23 فيا الله ان جامع البحار قد ذكر في معجزة ال  
الله صحيفة السجادية حيث قال ذهب الكل بانها  
مشابهة بصحف السماء وزبورال محمد في الانشاء  
و كفى لمن اراد ان يؤمن بهم تلك الصحيفة في  
الثناء فكيف يثبت حكم الولاية بصحيفة محكمة و  
لا يثبت حكم عبوديتي لال الله بصحائف معدودة  
التي ملأت شرق الارض و غربها

- 24 Nay, were God to will it and lift the veil, I would show you my power in composition, such that my pen could produce a treatise in mere hours. What proof could be greater than this power, what blessing greater than this gift? Such is the majesty of its allusions that none can distinguish between them and the supplications of the Family of God, and such is the grandeur of its stations that none can comprehend their outer meanings.

24 بل لو شاء الله و ارفع الحجاب لاشاهدنك قدرتي  
في الانشاء بان يجري من قلبي صحيفة في ساعات  
معدودة فاي حجة اكبر من هذا القدرة و اي نعمة  
اكبر من هذه العطية فمن جلاله اشاراتها لم يعرف  
الفرق احد بينها و بين مناجات ال الله و من  
عظمة مقاماتها لم يقدر احد ان يعرف ظواهرها

- 25 The proof against me would only be valid if I had abrogated a law of the Shariah. Otherwise, since I believe in the decree of the Qur'an and the allusions of the people of the Bayan and that resplendent proof in the Bayan, how could anyone be content to deny me based on evil suspicions and the calumnies of the deluded ones?

25 و ان الحجة علي فرض اذا نسخت حكما من الشريعة  
و الا لو كنت مصدقا بحكم القران و اشارات اهل  
البيان و تلك الحجة البيضاء في البيان فكيف يرضى  
احد بمجدي بظن السوء و اقترأ اهل الغرور

- 26 Lord! I complain to Thee and cry out before Thee, and Thou knowest my sorrow in this worldly life. Pour upon me patience and grant me victory over the wrongdoing people.

26 رب اشكوا اليك و اضح بين يديك و انت تعلم  
حزني في الحيوه الدنيا افرغ على صبرا و انصرني  
على القوم الظالمين

- 27 O man! How can I not complain of the children of the human race, whose lot God has made only impotence and submission, for they have fabricated against me what they fabricated not against the ancients, claiming that I have claimed the station of the Wilayat and its conditions. I seek refuge in God from their deeds and am innocent of what they have fabricated against me in their souls.

27 يا ايها الانسان كيف لا اشكوا من ابناء الجنس  
الذين ما جعل الله حضهم ان صدقوا الا العجز و  
التسليم بان اقترأوا على ما لا اقترأوا على الاولين بانه  
ادعى حكم الولاية و شئونها فاني اعوذ بالله من  
عملهم و برئ عما اقترأوا على في انفسهم

- 28 It is not for me to claim that I am a servant of the Remnant of God, for my existence before the dawning-place of His Essence is non-existence, and if it were mentioned it would be like the mention of an ant presuming to know its Lord's unity and recognize its Imam - it sees only the limits of itself and reads

28 وليس لي ان اقول اني عبد بقية الله لان وجودي  
عند طلعة كينونتيه معدوم و ان ذكر لكان بمثل  
ذكر الذي يزعم النملة في التوحيد ربه و معرفة  
امامه فلا يرى الى حد نفسه ولا يقرء الا حروف

only the letters of its own book. So glory be to God from the deeds of people, and I seek refuge in God from what the slinking whisperer whispers in people's breasts.

كُتِبَ فَنَسِجُحَانُ اللَّهِ مِنْ عَمَلِ النَّاسِ وَاعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِمَّا  
يُوسُوسُ الْخَنَاسُ فِي صُدُورِ النَّاسِ

- 29 The divines of both the masses and the elite have all maintained that Ali's words in his sermons are a miracle of eloquence, and none can utter their like in exposition due to their sublime eloquence. And none can speak like it in exposition due to the height of its eloquence, the grandeur of its rhetoric, and the majesty of its allusions therein and its indications in its depths, where the people of meaning and exposition mention regarding his sermon that which the people of vision cannot comprehend except after explanation.

29 ان علماء العامة و الخاصة كلهم قد ذهبوا بان  
كلمات على في الخطب هي معجزة في البيان ولا  
ينطق احد بمثلها في البيان لعلو فصاحته و عظمة  
بلاغته و جلالة اشاراته فيها و دلالاته في غياها  
حيث يذكر اهل المعاني و البيان في حق خطبته  
ما لا يدرك اهل العيان الا بعد البيان

- 30 Indeed, the reality of the science of exposition is the noblest of stations and the most sublime of degrees, for God does not present any proof to His creation except through His Word, as He, exalted be His mention, said: "Say: Bring forth a discourse like it, if ye be truthful." And this is evidence of the greatness of its rank and the majesty of its reality, that God chose from among all that He created and fashioned to manifest the beauty that lies in His Word through the mention of exposition.

30 و ان الحقيقة علم البيان هو اشرف المقامات و اثني  
الدرجات حيث لا يحتاج الله بشئ على خلقه الا  
بكلامه حيث قال عز ذكره قل فاتوا بحديث مثله  
ان كانوا صادقين و ان ذلك دليل لعظمه رتبته  
و جلالة حقيقته بان الله اختار من بين كل ما  
خلق و برء باظهار حسن الذي يكن في كلامه  
بذكر البيان

- 31 And though the creation of the heavens and earth and all between them is greater, He presents no proof except in exposition. This is evidence of the mystery of contingent existence, that God has placed the secret of the subtlety of all He created in the heavens and earths and what lies between them in exposition. Therefore God presents no proof through anything else, and it is greater than the creation of the heavens and earth and weightier than them to one who looks with vision to the reality of contingent existence and knows the power of the All-Merciful in the creation of exposition.

31 و لو ان خلق السموات و الارض و ما بينهما  
اكبر و لكن لم يحتاج الا في البيان و ان ذلك  
دليل بسر الامكان بان الله جعل سر لطافة كل  
ما خلق في السموات و الارضين و ما بينهما في  
البيان و لذا لم يحتاج الله بشئ سواه و انه لا كبر  
عن خلق السموات و الارض و اثقل منها لمن  
نظر بالعيان الى حقيقة الامكان و عرف قدرة  
الرحمن في خلق البيان

- 32 Glory be to God! Some people realize that in early Islam, if a stone had spoken, a soul would have believed in God. And now one who was born among the Persians and raised among the nations speaks like those sermons, and from his pen flow seas in mention of every station and grandeur, yet none perceives it except one from whom God took a covenant on the first day and the four witnessings. This has been God's way from before, as when God sent down the Qur'an among the eloquent Arabs of the Hijaz, they all mocked it saying "These are but tales of the ancients," and some said "These are but stories of the ancients," until ten years passed and none believed in it except Ali. And this is indeed a vast knowledge that none encompasses save whom God wills.

32 فسبحان الله من يدرك بعض الناس ان في صدر  
الاسلام هنا لك لو ينطق حجر يومن بالله نفس و  
ان الان من ولد في العجم و ربي بينهم بالامم  
لينطق مثل تلك الخطب و يجري من قلبه البحور  
في ذكر كل شان و عظمه و لا يشعر به احد الا من  
اخذ الله ميثاقه في يوم الاول و المشاهدة الاربعه  
و ان ذلك كان سنة الله من قبل كما حين نزل الله  
القران بين فصحاء اعراب الحجاز فكل قد استهزؤا  
به فقالوا ما هذا الا اساطير الاولين و بعضهم قالوا  
ما هذا الا من قصص الاولين حتى مضى عشر  
سنة و لا يومن به الا علي و ان ذلك لعلم جم لا  
يحيط به احد الا من شاء الله

- 33 But today is not like early Islam - all have read the Qur'an and know the station of exposition and have found proof in exposition through the mystery of vision. And whoever reads Our verses and knows Our allusions will know the wisdom of exposition. But the copies that were among the people contained fabrications and lies from those who disbelieve in God's verses, and these are the lost. If you wish to observe the station of exposition, seek the sermons from the men and reflect on their allusions - how could one born among the non-Arabs speak with such station?
- 34 And all this exposition and what was mentioned in the books is the station of flight, for people cannot bear to carry the pinnacle of mysteries and arrive at the court of holiness and majesty. Otherwise God's Cause has no veil, God's religion has no cover, God's light has no shadow, and God's love has no displeasure in it - glory be to Him and exalted is He above what they describe.
- 35 The cause of most people's confusion is their lack of recognition of the stations when they witness the signs of the Divine in the realm of humanity and do not distinguish between the affairs of might from the indications of the kingdom. And in the school of the family of God, peace be upon them, there is a universal principle through knowledge of which doubts are lifted from the people of glory and opposing things are brought together under harmonious judgement. This principle is that one should see all things as they truly are, just as Muhammad, the Messenger of God, taught all people when he said "O Lord! Show me the realities of all things as they are."
- 36 The knowledge of this station is not fully manifest except through understanding destiny and the judgement of the Ordainer, for man cannot perceive the reality of things merely through their form, since he cannot know the whole, as all things share the human form and divine temple in this world. How then can man distinguish between the Word of God, the words of Muhammad the Messenger of God, the words of the Family of God, the words of their followers whom God has placed in their station, and the words of people according to their ranks and stations - all in a single word? For the form of the phrase "There is no god but God" spoken by those in the chain of eight is outwardly the same, though in truth the rank of the first is as lord in relation to the second in all its stations.
- 37 Through this principle one can distinguish between the forms of the exalted ones in clear explanation and recognize the falsity of base forms in expression. Through knowledge of this station,
- 33 و لكن اليوم ليس مثل صدر الاسلام كل قد  
قرء القرآن وعرفوا شان البيان واستدلوا في البيان  
بسر العيان ومن قرء اياتنا وعرف اشارتنا ليعلم  
حكم البيان ولكن ان نسخ التي كانت بين الناس  
فيها افتراء وكذب من الذين يكفرون بايات الله و  
اولئك هم الخاسرون فان اردت ان تلاحظ شان  
البيان فاطلب الخطب من عند الرجال وفكر في  
اشاراتها فهل يمكن ان ينطق من ولد في الاجميين  
بمثل ذلك الشان
- 34 وان كل ذلك البيان وما ذكرت في الكتب هو  
شان الفرار لما لا يتحمل الناس ان يتحملوا ذرورة  
الاسرار ويردوا على ساحة القدس والجلال و  
الا ان امر الله لا حجاب له ودين الله لا ستر عليه  
ونور الله لا ظل معه وحب الله لا ينخط فيه  
فسبحانه وتعالى عما يصفون
- 35 وان علة تحير اكثر الناس هي عدم عرفان  
المقامات لما يشهدون ايات اللاهوت في ارض  
الناسوت ولا يميزون بين شئون الجبروت عن  
دلالات الملكوت وان في مذهب ال الله سلام  
الله عليهم قاعدة كلية بمعرفتها ترفع الشبهات  
عن اهل السبحات ويجمع المتضادات الى حكم  
المتفقات وهي ان يرى الانسان كل الاشياء بما  
هم عليه على ما هم عليه كما ادب محمد رسول الله  
كل الناس بقوله اللهم ارني حقايق الاشياء كما  
هي
- 36 وان علم ذلك الرتبة لم يظهر ب كله الا بعلم القدر  
وحكم المقدربان لا يرى الانسان حقيقة الاشياء  
ب صورتها لانها كما هي لا يقدر ان يعرف الكل  
لان الكل على صورت الانسانيه وهيكال الربانيه  
في هذا العالم سواء فن اين يعرف ويميز الانسان  
بين صورة كلام الله ثم كلام محمد رسول الله  
ثم كلام ال الله ثم كلام شيعتهم الذين جعلهم  
الله في مقامهم ثم كلام الناس بحسب مراتبهم و  
مقاماتهم في كلمة واحدة مع ان صورة كلمة لا  
اله الا الله التي نطق المتكلم في سلسلة الثمانية سواء  
مع ان الواقع والحق ان صورة رتبة المقدم رب  
بالنسبة الى كلمة الثاني في كل مقاماتها
- 37 وبها يميز الانسان بين صور العليين في التبيان و  
يعرف ابطال صور السجين في البيان وان بعلم  
ذلك المقام يعرف الانسان مراتب توحيد الكلمات

one understands the degrees of unity in words, verses, signs and stations. Whoever claims that the word of unity spoken by Fatima, peace be upon her, is the same as that spoken by the prophets has associated partners with his Lord.

والآيات والدلالات والمقامات ومن يعرف  
او يقول ان كلمة التي نطقت فاطمة صلوات الله  
عليها في التوحيد قال الانبياء فاتوا بمثله فقد اشرك  
بربه

- 38 Indeed, you could expound further on this matter, but since most people are veiled from knowledge of this station and associate partners with God and His signs due to their ignorance of this exalted rank, I will indicate a drop from this vast ocean of knowledge, so that all may be illumined by the glorious lights of the divine sanctuary and all may resound with the reverberating lights of the heaven of divine unity in the throne of the paradise of beauty.

38 بل ان الامر جنابك تقدر ان تبسط ولكن لما  
كان اكثر الناس محجوبين عن علم ذلك المقام  
و يشركون بالله و آياته بعدم علمهم تلك الرتبة  
العلية اشير برشح من علم ذلك الطمطمم الذاخر  
الذاخر ليتلثث الكل بتلا انوار ظلال مكفهرات  
افريدوس الجلال و ليتلجلجن الكل بتلجلج انوار  
سما العماء في عرش فردوس الجمال

- 39 O observer of the throne of glory and praise! Know with certainty that the aspects of the primal chain are essentially distinct from all else in their station and their realities are unreachable by others in their domain. Every letter uttered by the Primal Tree has sovereignty over all else, such that a single letter of the Qur'an cannot be equaled by anything in the kingdom of names and attributes. Consider the word "Command" in the Qur'an - though others may attempt to reveal similar words, none can match it, for its form exists in the rank of its spirit, and just as its spirit is the cause of all things, so too is its form the cause of all causes.

39 فيا ايها الناظر الى عرش البهاء و الثناء فايقن ان  
شؤونات سلسلة الاولى مقطعة الجوهريات عن  
غيرها في مقامها و متمتعة الكينونيات عن دونها في  
تلقاها و ان كل حروف نطقت شجرة الاولى له  
سلطنة على ما سواه بحيث ان حرفا من القران لم  
يعدله شئ في ملكوت الاسماء و الصفات انظر الى  
كلمة المرا في القران و ان ما سوى نفس المشيه  
لو شاؤا ان يزلوا و لكن كلها ليس بمثلها لان  
جسدها هي موجودة في رتبة روحها و كما ان  
روحها علة كلشئ فكذلك كان جسدها هي علة  
كل علة

- 40 For the letter through which God said "Be!" unifies through its spirit all that exists and will exist infinitely, and its form is the cause of everything named. Even if all were to say "Be!", their spirit would not resemble its spirit, nor their form its form.

40 لان حرف الذي قال الله كن بروحه ليوحد كل  
موجود و ما هو كائن بما لا نهاية الى ما لا نهاية لها  
و ان صورته هي علة كل ذى اسم و لو قال الكل  
كن لم يشبه روحه و روحه و لا صورته صورته

- 41 Similarly, you can understand this principle in the chain of meanings, then the gates, then the Imams, then the pillars, then the angels, then the chiefs, then the nobles. Just as the spirit of the letters Kaf and Nun in the station of the chiefs has sovereignty and dominion over the spirit of Kaf and Nun in the station of the nobles, so too is this true of their forms, though all say "Be!"

41 و كذلك انت تعرف مثل تلك الكلمة في سلسلة  
المعاني ثم الابواب ثم الائمة ثم الاركان ثم الملائكة  
ثم النقباء ثم النجباء فكما ان الروح حرف الكاف  
و النون في مقام النقباء له سلطنة و هيمنة على  
روح حرف الكاف و النون الذي في مقام النجباء  
فكذلك كان الحكم في صورتها فكل قالوا كن و

- 42 But the word "Be" which the Messenger of God (peace be upon Him) spoke is like His utterance between all the Kaf and the Nun, unique among its kind, and in the Book it has transcendent glory and impregnable majesty. Likewise are all the deeds from the second chain, for the works of the second chain, both universal and particular, are but accidents and similitudes in relation to the first chain.

42 لكن كلمة كن التي قال رسول الله ص هي بمثل  
منطقه في بين كل الكاف و النون منفرد عن  
الشباهة من ابناء جنسه و له في الكتاب عز شاخ  
و مجد مانع و كذلك كل الاعمال من سلسلة  
الثانية لان عمل سلسلة الثانية كلياتها و جزئياتها  
عرض و شبه بالنسبة الى السلسلة الاولى

- 43 Through knowledge of this rank one recognizes the truth of the words of the Family of God and their followers who speak by their leave. And through knowledge of this station one

43 و ان بعلم ذلك الرتبة يعرف حق كلمات ال الله  
و شيعتهم الذين ينطقون باذنهم و ان بعلم ذلك

witnesses that if all were to gather to speak like unto a single letter of the words spoken by Salman, they would be powerless, for weakness is like unto spirits – just as his body preceded all subjects in the rank of bodies, likewise were his words the lord of words among the letters and scriptures of others. Never did God send down upon anyone in the chain of subjects the like of a letter spoken by Salman.

المقام يشهد بان لو اجتمع الكل على ان يتكلموا  
بمثل حرف من كلمات التي كلم بها سلمان لن  
يقدروا لان الفتور بمثل الارواح فكما كان جسده  
مقدم كل الرعية في رتبة الاجساد فكذلك كان  
كلماته سيد الكلمات بين الحروف والزيرات من  
غيره ولم ينزل الله بمثل حرف كلم بها سلمان قط  
على احد في سلسلة الرعية

- 44 The decree in every station is that the second station sees the Manifested One in its mirror through the first mirror. Likewise in the decree of the letters, the phrase “There is no God but God” when spoken by one of the nobles reflects God in the seventh mirror, and when spoken by one of the pillars reflects God in the fifth mirror. The observer of the extremity of the heart sees their difference and judges between them and bears witness to them. God will gather them on the Day of Resurrection just as they were gathered on that day.

44 وان الحكم في كل مقام هو ان المقام الثاني يرى  
المتجلي في مرآته بالمرات الاولى وكذلك في حكم  
الحروف ان كلمة لا اله الا الله التي ينطق احد  
من النجباء يحكي في المرات السابعة عن الله و  
ان كلمة لا اله الا الله التي تنطق بها احد من  
الاركان يحكي في المرات الخامسة عن الله سبحانه  
وان الناظر الى طرف القواد يرى فرقها ويحكم  
بينهما ويشهد عليهما وان الله يوم القيمة يحشرهما  
بمثل حشرهما في ذلك اليوم

- 45 If you would sharpen your vision and purify your sight, you would see the letters spoken by the Messenger of God in the first Paradise and the letters spoken by one of the nobles in the seventh Paradise, and between them was a distance as God had ordained, which none can comprehend save whom God willeth. The distance between the Orient of Beginning and the Occident of Ending is as nothing in His sight, for beginnings in manifestations have no beginning and endings in extensions have no end.

45 وان جنابك لو تدق نظرك وتصفي بصرك لترى  
احرف التي كلم بها رسول الله في الجنة الاولى  
واحرف التي كلم بها احد من النجباء في الجنة  
السابعة وان بينهما كان بعد بمثل ما قدر الله بينهما  
حيث لا يحيط به علم احد الا من شاء الله وان  
بعد مشرق البدء والمغرب الختم عنده في رتبة  
معدومة لان البدايات في التجليات لا بدء لها و  
ان النهايات في الامدادات لا ختم لها

- 46 But those veiled from meeting the Manifested One in this worldly life see the form of “There is no God but God” as equal in all stations, and this is pure infidelity in the sight of the pure Family of God, for this Word in letters when spoken by the Manifestation of the Bayan is in the letters of the Word of the Bayan, then in the rank of meanings it is the Word of meanings, then in the rank of the Gates it is the Word of the Gates, then in the rank of the Imamate it is the Word of the Imamate, then in the rank of the Pillars it is the Word of the Pillars, then in the rank of the Chiefs it is the Word of the Chiefs, then in the rank of the Nobles it is the Word of the Nobles.

46 ولكن المحجوبين عن لقاء المتجلي في الحياة الدنيا  
يرون صورة لا اله الا الله في كل المقامات بحد  
سواء وان ذلك كفر محض عند الله الاطهار  
لان هذه الكلمة في الحروف اذا نطق بها ظهور  
البيان هي في حروف كلمة البيان ثم في رتبة المعاني  
كلمة المعاني ثم في رتبة الابواب كلمة الابواب ثم  
في رتبة الامامة كلمة الامامة ثم في رتبة الاركان  
كلمة الاركان ثم في رتبة النجباء كلمة النجباء ثم في  
رتبة النجباء كلمة النجباء

- 47 The decree of knowledge which ‘Ali ibn al-Husayn (peace be upon them both) commanded Jabir in the tradition which was read to you in that Book – his rank cannot be fully known except through its conditions, signs, manifestations, stations, tokens, indications, words, and what encompasses beyond these

47 وان حكم معرفة التي امر على بن الحسين عليهما  
السلام بجابر في حديث الذي قرئت عليك في ذلك  
الكتاب لم يتم معرفة رتبته الا بشئونها واياتها و  
تجلياتها ومقاماتها وعلاماتها ودلالاتها وكلماتها  
وما احاط ورائها مما لا يحيط به علم احد سواه

of that which none can comprehend save Him. Through knowledge of this station the learned excel one another, as 'Ali (peace be upon him) clearly stated in his words: "Names are either manifest or hidden, or neither manifest nor hidden. The learned ones only surpass one another in their knowledge of that which is neither manifest nor hidden" – which is the mystery of divine decree to which I alluded before.

48 According to this firm decree, if anyone were to say "I have uttered that word in the same way as he uttered it," God would not place him above his station, and he would be considered an unbeliever at once, for though the words "There is no God but God" which the Shi'ih utter may appear the same in form as the words uttered by one of the family of God, peace be upon them, yet the decree applies similarly to deeds. Thus the Prophets were unable to perform any deed like unto the deed of the body of Fatimih.

49 Likewise, all knowledge and conditions of the lower hierarchy are not mentioned in relation to the higher hierarchy. Therefore, from the lower hierarchy emerge, in the form of the word of the exalted one, all ranks and conditions. And at the time of reversal was the station of the manifestation of the Essence in the countenance of the attributes, where in the interpretation of the letter "Ha" all its letters would be most great and its meanings most glorious and subtle.

50 This indeed is the nobility of which al-Sadiq spoke, saying: "Whoso attaineth unto the stations of the attributes hath attained unto the resting-place of true knowledge. And whoso recognizeth the sign in the proof needeth not the sign in the account. And whoso knoweth separation from union will know that to which I have alluded in these proofs." And he who gazeth upon the Lord of attributes will be freed from mention of the glories, the proofs, the accounts, the stations, the tokens and the signs, by the decree of his Lord – verily there is no God but He, the Possessor of great bounty.

51 Among the stations for explaining this mystery are those which have never occurred to the hearts of some people, nor are they befitting to their station. But since I see thee among those endowed with knowledge and exposition, I shall allude to a drop from this deep, abundant, surging, wave-tossed ocean, that it may be a gateway to the knowledge of that station.

52 It is that thou shouldst see no multiplicities having existence before the sign of the Essence, and shouldst regard them as on the day when none of them was worthy of mention. And in that condition, when thou art established in the truth, thou wilt

وان بعلم ذلك المقام يتفاضل العلماء بعضهم على بعض كما صرح بذلك على عليه السلام في قوله و ان الاسماء اما ظاهر او مضمرة او ليس بظاهر و لا مضمرة و انما يتفاضل العلماء في معرفة ما ليس بظاهر و لا مضمرة و هو سر القدر الذي اشرت من قبل فيه

48 و ان بذلك الحكم المتقن لو قال احد اني نطقت بتلك الكلمة بمثل ما نطق ما جعله الله فوق رتبتي فيكفر في الحين لان كلمة لا اله الا الله التي يتكلم بها الشيعة صورتها شيعة صوره كلمة التي نطق احد من ال الله سلام الله عليهم و كذلك الحكم كان في الافعال و لذا ان الانبياء لم يقدرُوا ان يعملوا بمثل عمل جسم فاطمه

49 و كذلك كل العلم و الشئون من سلسلة السافل لم يذكر عند سلسلة العالی و لذا يخرج في سلسلة السافل من صورة كلمة العالی كل المراتب و الشئون و ان حين العكس كان مقام ظهور الذات في طلعة الصفات حيث انه ينزل في تفسير الهاء الذي كل حروفاته لكان اعظم و معانيه لاجلي و اللطف

50 و ان ذلك هو الشرف الذي قال الصادق في قوله من بلغ مواقع الصفه بلغ قرار المعرفة و من عرف الاشارة في الدلالة استغنى عن الاشارة في الحكاية و من عرف الفصل من الوصل فيعرف ما اشرت في تلك الدلالات و يعفو للذي هو ناظر برب الصفات عن ذكر السباحات و الدلالات و الحكايات و المقامات و العلامات و الايات بحكم ربه انه لا اله الا هو ذو فضل عظيم

51 و ان من مقامات بيان ذلك السر هو ما لا يخطر بافئدة بعض الناس و لا يليق بشأن احد منهم و لكني لما اراك من اولى العلم و البيان اشير برشح من هذا الطمطمم الداخر المتلاطم المواج ليكون بابا لمعرفة ذلك المقام

52 و هو ان لا ترى الكثرات في تلقاء اية الذات ذي وجود و تنظر اليهم كيوم الذي لم يك منهم شيئا مذكورا و بذلك الشأن لما استقرت بالحقيقة ترى السر في طلعة المتجلي نفس العلانية نفس السر في حضرت التجلي

see the mystery in the countenance of the One revealed – the manifest itself being the mystery in the presence of revelation.

- 53 And thou shouldst not rejoice in knowledge of anything, nor in thy power over anything, nor in thy possession of what God hath placed in thy grasp, nor in spirit, nor in fragrance, nor in mention, nor in exposition, nor in the blessings of Paradise, nor in knowledge thereof. And when thou rememberest any of these things, thou shouldst not pause in its mention nor in its mystery save to behold the countenance of thy Revealer, and thou shouldst see Him manifest and existent where nothing was with Him, nor is anything mentioned in His rank.
- 53 ولا تفرح بعلم شئ ولا بقدرتك على شئ ولا بملك ما جعل الله في قبضتك ولا بروح ولا ريحان ولا بذكر ولا ببيان ولا بالاء الجنة ولا بعرفانها واذا تذكر شيئا منها ما ترد في ذكره ولا في سره الا طلعة متجليك و تراه ظاهرا موجودا حيث لم يك معه شئ ولا يذكر في رتبته شئ
- 54 And to this did 'Ali, peace be upon him, allude in his prayer on the day of Sha'ban: "My God! Grant me complete severance unto Thee and illuminate the vision of our hearts with the light of their gazing upon Thee, until the vision of the hearts penetrates the veils of light, attaining unto the Source of Grandeur, and our spirits become suspended in the glory of Thy sanctity. Make me one of those whom Thou didst call and who responded to Thee, whom Thou didst behold and who swooned before Thy majesty, and who conversed with Thee secretly while working for Thee openly."
- 54 و بذلك اشار على عليه السلام في مناجاته يوم شعبان الهى هب لى كمال الانقطاع اليك و انر ابصار قلوبنا بضياء نظرها اليك حتى تحرق ابصار القلوب حجب النور فتصل الى معدن العظمة و تصير ارواحنا معلقة بعز قدسك و اجعلنى ممن ناديت فاجابك و لاحظة فصعق لجلالك و ناجيته سرا فعمل لك جهرا
- 55 And if thou hast reached before, or wilt reach hereafter, unto the station of grandeur and the mystery of identity and the identity of oneness and the manifestation of eternity and the beauty of divinity, thou shalt recite all remembrances in the manner He, exalted be His mention, hath interpreted in His prayer following the Witr prayer: "Thou art God, the Support of the heavens and earth, and Thou art God, the Beauty of the heavens and earth," unto what he, peace be upon him, hath said.
- 55 و انت اذا بلغت من قبل او تصل من بعد بمقام العظمة و سر الهوية و هوية الاحدية و ظهور الصمدانية و جمال الربانية تقرأ كل الاذكار بمثل ما فسر عز ذكره في دعائه بعد صلوة الوتر انت الله عماد السموات و الارض و انت الله جمال السموات و الارض الى ما قال عليه السلام
- 56 Blessed then is he who drinketh the water of living wine in this earthly life and maketh himself even as God created him without imposing hardship upon himself.
- 56 فيا طوبى لمن شرب ماء انحر الحيوان في الحياة الدنيا و يجعل نفسه بمثل ما خلقه الله من دون كلفة على نفسه
- 57 God hath prescribed for him who ascendeth to the station of His knowledge and love ordinances that none can comprehend save His knowledge. Among these, it is prescribed for him who journeyeth from the Truth to creation in the Most Great Hope that he should not fear for himself, even should he bear every sin encompassed by God's knowledge, for God is the Self-Sufficient, possessed of expansive mercy, forgiving whom He willeth as He willeth. None can reverse His judgment or repeal His command.
- 57 و ان الله قد فرض للمتعارج الى مقام معرفته و حبه احكاما لا يسعها الا علمه فتها فرض على الذى يسافر من الحق الى الخلق رجاء الاكبر بان لا يخاف من نفسه و لو احتمل كل ذنب قد احاط علم الله لان الله غنى ذو رحمة واسعة يغفر لمن يشاء بما يشاء و لا راد لحكمه و لا معقب لامره
- 58 And among these, it is prescribed for him who journeyeth from creation to the Truth that he should not feel secure in himself,
- 58 و منها فرض على الذى يسافر من الخلق الى الحق الا يطمئن بنفسه و لو علمت كل الخير لان الله

even should he know every good, for God is possessed of perpetual justice, and were He to desire for something the decree of justice, the heavens and earth could not withstand it. His is the power to change in the kingdom of command and creation. Sufficient unto thee in this path is what Abu Abdullah hath indicated in his address, exalted be his mention: "O Isaac! Fear God as though thou seest Him, and if thou seest Him not, verily He seeth thee. If thou believest He seeth thee not, thou hast disbelieved, and if thou knowest He seeth thee, yet still committest disobedience before Him, thou hast made Him the least of those who observe."

ذو عدل دائم ولو اراد بشئ حكم العدل لا يقوم به السموات والارض وانه له البدء في ملكوت الامر والخلق وكفاك في ذلك السبيل ما اشار ابو عبدالله في خطابه قال عز ذكره يا اسحق خف عن الله كانك تراه وان كنت لا تراه فانه يراك وان كنت ترى انه لا يريك فقد كفرت وان كنت تعلم انه يريك ثم برزت له بالمعصية فقد جعلته من اهون الناظرين

59 I bear witness in this path, O noble one, that if thou fearest thy Lord, all people will fear thee, as indicated in His address, exalted be His mention: "Whoso feareth God, everything feareth him, and whoso feareth not God, God maketh him to fear everything." Then He said, exalted be His mention: "Whoso knoweth God feareth God, and whoso feareth God detacheth himself from the world."

59 واشهد في ذلك السبيل يا ايها الجليل بانك ان خفت من ربك يخاف منك كل الناس حيث اشار عز ذكره في خطابه من خاف الله خاف منه كل شئ ومن لم يخف الله اخافه الله من كل شئ ثم قال عز ذكره من عرف الله خاف الله ومن خاف الله سلخت نفسه من الدنيا

60 Verily the servant attaineth not perfection in the station of servitude until he feareth not the people and seeth all things, compared to God's decree, as like unto the black of the eye of a dead ant, and praise to him is God's good pleasure and blame His displeasure, as indicated by al-Sadiq in his saying that love of eminence dwelleth not in the heart of one who is fearful and in awe.

60 وان العبد لم يكمل في مقام العبودية حتى لا يخاف من الناس ويرى الكل في جنب حكم الله كمثل سواد عين نملة ميتة و كان المدح عنده رضاء الله والذم تنخطه كما اشار الصادق في قوله بان حب الشرف لا يكون في قلب الخائف الراهب

61 Verily the wayfarer unto God on the white path and the crimson pillar in that journey reacheth not the station of his homeland save through empty hands from what is in people's possession and what is attributed to them. The most knowing of people regarding God and His signs are those most content with His decree. It behooveth the wayfarer in that station to fix in his heart the decree of that tradition wherein He, exalted be His mention, saith: "I marvel at the Muslim who, whatever God - exalted and glorified be He - decreeth for him is good for him: if he be cut with scissors it is good for him, and if he possess the east and west of the earth it is good for him."

61 وان السالك الى الله في المنهج البيضاء والركن الحمراء في ذلك السفر لم يوصل الى مقام وطنه الا بكف الصفر عما في ايدي الناس وما ينسب اليهم وان اعلم الناس بالله وباياته ارضاهم بقضائه وعلى السالك في ذلك المقام حق ان يجعل حكم ذلك الحديث في قلبه حيث قال عز ذكره عجبت لمراء مسلم لا يقضى الله عز وجل له قضاء الا كان خيرا له ان قرض بالمقاريض كان خيرا له وان ملك مشارق الارض ومغاربها كان خيرا له

62 And he witnesseth his contentment with death in all his conditions, for the servant's heart is not content nor doth he detest the world save in the state of death, and it behooveth the sincere believer to remember death twenty-five times each day and night, for He, exalted be His remembrance, hath said that whosoever doeth this, God will record for him the reward of one who is martyred in His path. If the servant were to refine his vision, he would see no glory save in the love of God, for the cause of people's love for pearls and gold is that their love originates in the love of God, and therefore all people love them.

62 ويشاهد رضائه للموت في كل شؤناته لان العبد لم يرض قلبه ولا يكره الدنيا الا بحالة الموت وحق على المؤمن الخالص ان يذكر نفسه بذكر الموت في كل يوم وليلة خمس وعشرين مرة حيث قال عز ذكره من فعل ذلك يكتب الله له ثواب الذي يستشهد في سبيله وان العبد لو يلفظ نظره لم ير عزا الا في حب الله وان علة حب الناس بالثألي والذهب هم كانت لاجل حبها حب

Likewise, the opposite holds true for its opposite. Ask God to take the hands of His servants upon that path, for it is rugged, bare, and harsh, from which none can escape save those whom God willeth. Verily those who enter the fire enter it only by this path. Therefore have I ventured to make these allusions, hoping for forgiveness from him whose heart is saddened by reading these intimations.

- 63 Among these is the obligation upon one who journeys from Truth to Ultimate Truth not to retain within himself any limited ego, for if his possible ego is mentioned with him, he is not of the people of that path. This station is reserved for the family of God and for whomsoever God willeth among those who recline upon couches in the gardens of the Divine Realm, who drink pure water from the cup of grandeur in the gardens of might, and who delight in tender meat in the gardens of sovereignty and dominion. These allusions are not hidden from thee, for they have no remembrance save the remembrance of God. Though at their station mention be made of attributes, names and blessings, these are but the sweepings of vain imaginings. They are pure signs, absolute manifestations, definitive appearances, and conditions of the essences and qualities of God, Creator of names and attributes. Thus did Ali, peace be upon him, allude to their station in himself, saying: "Verily, I am the Essence of essences, I am the Essence within essences for the Essence." And the poet said in his praise: "O Substance through whom existence standeth firm, all people after thee are but accidents." And Abdul-Hamid ibn Abil-Hadid addressed him thus: "Thy attributes are names, and Thy essence here is a substance 'free of meanings from the attributes of substances,' beyond accidents, quality and time, 'greater than comparison with the elements.'"

- 64 All of these are but names and attributes in exposition of their exalted remembrance and majesty. The servant entereth not the depths of Oneness unless he journeyeth from it unto it and maketh its remembrance and its bliss itself and naught else. This is the Paradise that hath no shadow, and none entereth it save its people. Therefore have the hells become seven and the paradises eight, though it entereth not into numbers even if mentioned among them. O man! The secret whereby thy heart findeth rest is thy arrival at those depths. Deprive not thyself of thy portion in this worldly life, though it is vain and hath no standing with the people of truth. Turn wholly unto God, forget all else in thy love for Him, and journey from Him unto Him upon that Most Great Path and Most Enduring Way. For if thou performest a deed in those depths, the seven paradises and all that God hath created therein equal it not. Belittle not

الله و لذا يحبونها كل الناس و كذلك الحكم في العكس بالعكس للعكس فاسئل الله ان ياخذ ايدى عباده في ذلك السبيل لانه و عر ذكوان اجرد خشن لا ينحوا منه الا من شاء الله و ان الذين يدخلون النار ما يدخلون الا في هذا السبيل و لذلك اجترحت بذكر الاشارات رجاء لعفو من يحزن قلبه بقرائة تلك الدلالات

- 63 و منها فرض على الذى يسافر من الحق الى الاحق الا يبقى فيه انية محدودة لان لو ذكر معه في شان انيته ممكنه لم يك من اهل ذلك السبيل و ان ذلك مختص لال الله و من شاء الله من الذى يستقرون على الارائك المتكئة في جنات اللاهوت و الذين يشربون ماء الخالص من كاس العظمة في جنات الجبروت و الذين يتنعمون بلحم الطري في جنات الملك و المملوك و ان الاشارات لا تشبه على جنابك فان لهم لا ذكر الا ذكر الله و ان عبر في مقامهم ذكر الصفات و الاسماء و الالاء هى مكنسة الالهام و الا انهم ايات الصرف و التجليات البحت و ظهورات البات و شئونات الذات و كينونيات الصفات لله الخالق الاسماء و الصفات حيث اشار على عليه السلام عن مقامهم في نفسه بقوله الحق انا ذات الذات انا الذات في الذات للذات و قال الشاعر في مدحه يا جوهر اقام الوجود به و الناس بعدك كلهم عرض و اشار عبد الحميد ابن ابى الحديد في خطابه اليه صفاتك اسماء و ذاتك هنا شعر جوهر " برى المعانى عن صفات الجواهر" يحل عن الاعراض و الكيف و المتى " و يكبر عن التشبيه بالعناصر

- 64 و ان كل ذلك اسماء و صفات في البيان لعلو ذكرهم و جلالتهم و ان العبد لم يدخل لجة الاحدية الا اذا سافر منها اليها و جعل ذكرها و نعيمها هى نفسها لا سواها و هى الجنة التى لا ظل لها و لا يدخل فيها احد غير اهلها و لذا صارت الجحيم سبعة و الجنان ثمانية و هى لا تدخل في الاعداد و لو تذكر معها فيا ايها الانسان ان سر الذى به يسكن فؤادك هو ورودك على تلك اللجة فلا تحرم نصيب نفسك في الحيوه الدنيا فانها باطلة لا حكم لها عند اهل الحقيقة فاقبل الى الله بكلك و انس ما سواه بحبك و سافر منه اليه في ذلك السبيل الاعظم و الصراط الادوم فانك لو تعمل في تلك اللجة عملا لم يعادلها بها جنات السبعة و ما خلق الله فيها

the right of that path, for thou hast not valued it as it should be valued except when thou interest it by God's leave. And when thou interest it, thou canst not depart from it.

- 65 Belittle not the right of that Path, for thou hast not esteemed it as it should be esteemed until thou interest therein by God's leave. When thou hast entered it, thou canst not depart from it, nor speak therein except by thy Lord's command, nor dwell except through Him, nor utter except through His power, nor take delight save in His countenance which is manifested unto thee through thee, nor point to aught besides Him, nor canst thou desire anything, for desire belongeth to the realm of action, while that station is the station of thine essence, from which are severed all names, deeds, manifestations and attributes. When thou attainest unto it, thy innermost reality shall speak forth all that Ali - peace be upon him - spoke forth openly, including what he said in the Tutunjiyyih Sermon: "I saw God and Paradise with mine own eyes." Verily the Truth intended not the Essence of the Lord, due to its inaccessibility and state of severance, but rather meant His Identity which was manifested unto him through him in his station, concerning which he spoke in his words about the supreme realm: "He was manifested unto it through it, and it became illumined; He appeared unto it, and it shone forth; He cast His likeness into its identity, and His deeds were made manifest through it."

- 66 The decree of that Path is not due to the absence of proof. He is God, sufficient unto me in that Path. He is the Lord - how excellent a Majestic One! He is the Lord - how excellent a Beauteous One! He is the Lord - how excellent a Friend! He is the Lord - how excellent a Guardian!

- 67 Among its requirements is that one who journeyeth from creation with the eye of Truth, or vice versa, must see no light except His light, and no creation except His creation. All the affairs of that station revolve around that Word. The wayfarer on that Path beholdeth along his way the wonders of dominion and the vicissitudes of time in every world according to what God hath ordained therein. Were I to lift the veil, thou wouldst say concerning me that which the decree determineth in its inception: "This is naught but a wondrous thing!"

- 68 The wayfarer in these journeys must needs know the letter of each world among the inscribed letters, lest any decree veil him from all things. He must perceive the correspondence of the worlds to this world.

- 69 I have known from human wisdom that in the station of abjad, alif is the letter of the Universal Spirit, ba is the letter of the Universal Soul - therefore did he who is referred to in the

65 ولا تصغر حق ذلك السبيل فانك ما قدره حق قدره الا اذا تدخل باذن الله فيها فاذا دخلت لا تقدر ان تخرج عنها ولا تحكى فيها الا من ربك ولا تسكن الا به ولا تنطق الا في قدرته ولا تستلذ الا بطلعته المتجلية لك بك ولا تشير الى شئ سواه ولا تقدر ان تريد شيئا لان الارادة رتبة الفعل وان ذلك المقام رتبة ذاتك ومنقطعه عنه الاسماء والافعال والظهورات والصفات واذا بلغت ينطق سرك بكل ما نطق على عليه السلام في علانيته ومنها ما قال في خطبة الطنجية رايت الله والفردوس راى العين ولا شك ان الحق ما قصد ذات الرب لحكم الامتناع و شان الانقطاع بل اراد ظهور هويته المتجلية له به في رتبته التي نطق في حقها في كلامه عن عالم العلوى تجلى لها بها فاشرفت وطالعها فتثلثت فالتى في هويتها مثاله فاطهر عنها افعاله

66 ليس حكم ذلك السبيل لعدم جريان الدليل وهو الله حسبي في ذلك السبيل وهو المولى فنعم الجليل وهو المولى فنعم الجليل وهو المولى فنعم الخليل وهو المولى فنعم الوكيل

67 ومنها فرض على الذى يسافر من الخلق بعين الحق او العكس الا يرى نورا الا نوره ولا خلقا الا خلقه ويدور كل شئون تلك الرتبة في حول تلك الكلمة وان المسافر في ذلك السبيل يرى في طريقه عجائب الملك و جراسيم الدهر في كل عالم بما قدر الله فيها وانا لو اكشف الغطاء لتقول في حقى ما يجرى القضاء في البداء ما هذا الا شئ عجاب

68 وعلى السالك فى تلك الاسفار حق ان يعرف حرف كل عالم فى الحروف المسطرات لئلا يحجبه حكم عن كلشئ ويرى تطابق العوالم بمثل هذا العالم

69 وانا بما عرفت من الحكم الانسان وهو ان الالف فى مقام ابجد حرف روح الكليه ثم الباء حرف

Qur'an as "ourselves" say "I am the point beneath the ba" - jim is the letter of Universal Nature, dal is the letter of Universal Matter, ha is the letter of Universal Form, waw is the letter of Universal Body, zay is the letter determining the directions of the crystalline sphere, ha is the letter of the sphere of the Throne, ta is the letter of the sphere of the zodiac, ya is the letter of the sphere of the mansions, kaf is the letter of the sphere of Saturn, lam is the letter of the sphere of Jupiter, mim is the letter of the sphere of Mars - therefore did the poet say in the oration: "Until the ha of its descent from the mim of its center connected with the essence of the neck vein; the tha of heaviness clung to it, and it became the most humble between the landmarks and heights" - nun is the letter of the sphere of the Sun, sin is the letter of the sphere of Venus, 'ayn is the letter of the sphere of Mercury, fa is the letter of the sphere of the Moon, then sad for fire, and for air, water and earth.

نفس الكليه ولذا قال نفس الذي نزل الله حكمه في القرآن بقوله و انفسنا و انفسكم قال انا نقطه تحت الباء ثم الجيم حرف طبيعة الكليه ثم الدال حرف مادة الكليه ثم الهاء حرف شكل الكل ثم الواو حرف جسم الكل ثم الزاء حرف محدد الجهات فلك اطلس ثم حاء حرف فلك الكرسي ثم الطاء حرف فلك البروج ثم الياء حرف فلك المنازل ثم الكاف حرف فلك الزحل ثم اللام حرف فلك المشتري ثم الميم حرف فلك المريخ و لذا قال الشاعر في الخطابه حتى اتصلت هاء هبوطها من ميم مركزها بذات الاخدع علقت بها ثاء الثقيل فاصبحت بين العالم والطول اخضع ثم النون حرف فلك الشمس ثم السين حرف فلك الزهره ثم العين حرف فلك العطارده ثم الفاء حرف فلك القمر ثم للنار الصاد وللواء وللواء وللتراب

70 These are the stages of the journey of one who travels from Truth to creation, and in the ascent, its first station is the letter Ta, which is the letter of mineral, then the letter of plant which is Tha, then the letter of animal which is Kha, then the letter of jinn which is Dhal, then the letter of angel which is Dad, then the letter of human which is Za. And to this end are the ranks of letters in the decree of ascent and descent.

70 و ان ذلك مراتب سفر الذي يسافر من الحق الى الخلق و ان في الصعود فاول مقامه حرف التاء و هو حرف المعدن ثم حرف النبات و هو التاء ثم حرف الحيوان و هو الخاء ثم حرف الجن و هو الدال ثم حرف الملك و هو الضاد ثم حرف الانسان و هو الظاء و ان الى ذلك تنتهي رتبة الحروف في حكم الصعود و النزول

71 And all that I indicated in the interpretation of Ha, the first letter of your mighty Book, for unveiling the mystery - I have no knowledge that unveils the veil from the face of the mystery, rather the veils increase through mention of indications, decrees of signs, allusion of verses and intimations. And here I am with my transgressions before God, and unveiling the veil from the face of the mystery, I commune with God my Lord with these words of my tongue, that God may answer my prayer regarding you and bring you to the station of your address in your Book, and that your soul may pardon me for what you have discovered of my offenses, and that you may seek forgiveness from your Lord for me and for those who follow me, for I am indeed the Ever-Relenting, the Forbearing.

71 و ان كل ما اشرت في تفسير الهاء اول حرف من كتابك العزيز لكشف السر اني لا علم لا يكشف الستر عن وجه السر بل تزيد الحجب بذكر الدلالات و حكم العلامات و اشاره الايات و الاشارات و انا ذا لاجترأ حتى بين يدي الله و كشف الستر عن وجه السر اناجي الله ربي بهذه الكال لسانى ليجيب الله دعائى في حقك و يبلغك الى مقام خطابك في كتابك و يعفو نفسك عني عما اطلعت من جرياتي و تستغفر ربك لي و للذين اتبعوني فاني انا التواب الحليم

72 And let this be the musk-scented conclusion of these words, for herein let the competitors compete. O Friend! Know thou the truth of these days, for the sun has never risen upon their like, and for each is a portion in the Book of thy Lord, and God will recompense all according to what their hands have earned, and nothing escapes His knowledge in the heavens or on earth, and He is independent of what people do.

72 و ليكون بذلك ختام الكلام مسكا لان فيه فليتنافس المتنافسون فيا ايها الخليل فاعرف حق تلك الايام فان الشمس ما طلعت عليها بمثلها و ان لكل نصيب في كتاب ربك و ان الله ليجزي الكل بما اكتسبت ايديهم و لا يعزب من علمه شئ في السموات و لا في الارض و انه لغني عما هم كان الناس يعملون

- 73 And it is the right of everyone who knows the Truth to proclaim it and nullify the work of those who wish to extinguish the light of God with their mouths, but God refuses except to perfect His light, though the polytheists may detest it.
- 74 In the Name of God, the Most Merciful, the Most Compassionate. Praise be to God Who bestows favor in the Book upon those who believe in God and His verses, that He may admit them to Gardens of perpetual residence as secure dwellers.
- 75 O my God! I bear witness before Thee to that which Thou dost witness for Thyself when nothing existed besides Thee, that Thou art God, there is no God but Thee, alone with no partner. Thy Essential Reality has never been known save through Thine eternal Essence, and Thy Being cannot be described save through Thine Own Oneness, for Thou hast never been known through other than Thyself, nor associated with Thy creation, nor described by other than Thee, nor can any description or attribute of anything encompass Thee.
- 76 For the Essential Reality of Thy Power severs all essences from knowing Thee, and the Being of Thy Will prevents all material things from describing Thee, and the Reality of Thy Creation separates all beings from explaining Thee, and the Identity of Thy Innovation limits all geometries from mentioning direct vision.
- 77 Glory be to Thee, O my God! If I say "Thou," then likeness has imitated likeness, yet Thou canst not be described thus. And if I say "He is Thou," then majesty has indicated majesty, yet Thou canst not be characterized thus.
- 78 For Thou didst create Will before all things from no thing, by itself, without connection to Thy Essence, nor association with Thy Being, nor reflection from Thy Reality, nor knowledge from Thine Identity, but rather through Thy Power which Thou manifested to it thereby, causing it to shine forth without how or where or indication.
- 79 Then Thou didst establish creation in its course that the radiant ones might shimmer with the knowledge of separation in the midst of union, and that the hesitant ones might stammer with the knowledge of prevention in the being of separation.
- 80 Glory be to Thee! When I discovered creation in Thy Countenance and invention in Thy Presence, the contingent beings became confused in their recognition of Thy power through Thine own Self, and therefore they described Thee - had they truly known Thee they would not have described Thee. Therefore, O my God, they do not sanctify Thee. Glory be to Thee, Glory be to Thee, O my God!
- 73 وان لكل من عرف الحق حق بان يعلنه و يبطل عمل الذين يريدون ان يطفئوا نور الله بافواههم و ابى الله الا ان يتم نوره ولو كره المشركين
- 74 بسم الله الرحمن الرحيم الحمد لله الذى يمن فى الكتاب على الذين امنوا بالله و اياته بان يدخلهم فى جنات عدن لا منين
- 75 يا الهى انى اشهدك بما انت تشهد لنفسك حين لا وجود لشيء عند بانك انت الله لا اله الا انت وحدك لا شريك لك لم تزل لن تعرف ذاتيتك الا ذاتية ازليتك ولا توصف كينونيتك الا انية احديتك لانك لم تزل لن تعرف بغيرك ولا تقترن بخلقك ولا توصف بسواك ولا ياخذك وصف من شيء ولا نعت عن شيء
- 76 اذ ذاتية قدرتك مقطعة الجوهريات عن العرفان وان كينونية مشيتك ممتنعه الماديات عن البيان و ان انية ابداعك مفرقة الكينونيات عن التبيان و ان نفسانية اختراعك محددة الهندسيات عن ذكر العيان
- 77 فسبحانك يا الهى ان قلت انت فقد حكمت المثل بالمثال و انك لن توصف بها و ان قلت انه هو انت فقد دلت الجلال بالجلال و انك لن تمتع بها
- 78 لانك قد خلقت المشية قبل كلشيى لا من شيء بنفسها من دون ربط بذاتك ولا اقتران بكينونيتك ولا انعكاس من ذاتيتك ولا عرفان من ايتك بل بقدرتك التى تجليت لها بها فاشرقها من دون كيف ولا اين ولا اشارة
- 79 ثم قد اقلت الخلق فى منهاجها ليتلاى المتلثلثات بعلم القطع فى مجبوحه الوصل و ليتجلج المتجلجات بعلم المنع فى كينونية الفصل
- 80 فسبحانك لما وجدت الابداع بطلعتها و الاختراع بحضرتها قد اشتبهت على الممكات عرفان قدرتك بذاتك و لذا قد وصفوك و لو عرفوك ما وصفوك و من ثم ذا يا الهى لم ينزهون ف

- 81 Thou art He Who cannot be unified through Thine essence, nor sanctified through Thy Countenance, nor described through Thine Identity, nor characterized through Thine eternity, nor indicated through Thy Being, nor worshipped through Thy Self, for Thou hast ever been without the mention of anything, and Thou wilt ever be as Thou wert in the eternity of eternities.
- 82 Nothing existed at Thy level, and when Thou didst create creation for Thy knowledge, Thou didst describe Thyself to them according to their capacity, that all might receive their portion and creation might attain to the ultimate purpose of the outpouring of Thy creation and the existence of Thine invention. And Thou didst characterize Thy chosen ones with what Thou hadst ordained for their station.
- 83 And now that Thou hast created me and provided for me, I acknowledge before Thee that Muhammad was Thy servant whom Thou didst choose from the midst of eternity above all peoples, distinguished among the sons of men above all humanity, and made him the station of Thyself in the execution and origination of every decree and destiny, for Thou canst not be perceived by sight though Thou wert at the Greatest Vista. And I bear witness regarding the fruit of his heart and his successors to what Thou hast specially bestowed upon them of Thy bounties, of which none knoweth save Thee. And I beseech Thee, O Creator of names and attributes, to send blessings upon Muhammad and the family of Muhammad through the essences of the divine realm in creation, and the realities of the realm of might in glory, and the identity of the heavenly kingdom in praise, and the being of the earthly kingdom in sublimity, and the geometry of the subtle ones in decree, and the luminosity of the radiant ones in origination, and the reflection of the illumined ones in the manifestations of the fragments of the tablets of ruby in execution, the wonder of the sanctified ones in the conditions of the human realm from the people of the cloud. Verily Thou art God, the Great, the Exalted.
- 84 O my God! How can I call upon Thee when my very existence is a sin, and it hath acquired without right what Thou didst not permit of errors and sins which have come between it and Thee, and clothed it in the garment of abasement before Thy face, and rent asunder what Thou didst place between it and obedience to Thee of the veils of Thy mercy and the pavilions of Thy oneness? The sins have encompassed it from every direction such that it cannot emerge from them save to enter into them again. And Thou, O my God, knowest its station and art able to remove its affliction, and unto Thee alone is the complaint, there is no God but Thee.
- 81 سبحانك سبحانك يا الهى انت الذى لن توحده ذاتك و لن تقدس بطاعتك و لن توصف بانيتك و لن تمتع بازليتك و لن تشير بكنونيتك و لن تعبد بنفسانيتك لانك لم تزل كنت بلا ذكر شئ و لا تزال انك كائن بمثل ما كنت فى ازل الازال
- 82 لم يك فى ربتك شئ و لما خلقت الخلق لمعرفتك و صفت لهم نفسك بما يمكن فى انفسهم لياخذ الكل حظه و يبلغ الخلق الى غاية من فيض ابداعك وجود اختراعك و نعت اوليائك بما انت قد قدرت فى شانهم
- 83 و انا ذا لما خلقتنى و رزقتنى اعترف بين يديك بان محمدا لكان عبدك الذى انتجتبه من بحبوحة القدم على سائر الامم منفردا من ابناء الجنس على سائر البشر و جعلته مقام نفسك فى الاداء و البداء من كل حكم و قدر اذ انت لن تدرك بالبصر لما كنت بالمنظر الاكبر و اشهد فى حق ثمرة فواده و اوصيائه بما انت قد خصصتهم من كراماتك بما لا يحيط بعلمها احد سواك و اسئلك يا خالق الاسماء و الصفات ان تصلى على محمد و آل محمد بكنونيات اللاهوتيات فى الانشاء و ذاتيات الجبروتيات فى البهاء و نفسانية الملكوتيات فى الثناء و انية الملكات فى السناء و هندسة المتلجلجات فى القضاء و نورية المتلثلات فى البداء و عكسية المتنورات فى ظهورات قطعات الواح الياقوت فى الامضاء عجيبة المتقدسات فى شئون الناسوتيات من اهل العماء انك انت الله الكبير المتعال
- 84 يا الهى كيف ادعوك و ان وجودى ذنب و قد اكتسب بغير حق ما لا اذنت له من الخطايا و الذنوب التى حالت بينه و بينك و البسته ثوب المذلة فى تلقاء وجهك و خرقت ما انت جعلت بينه و بين طاعتك من حجابات رحمانيتك و سرادقات وحدانيتك كان الخطايا قد احاطته من كل شطر بشأن لا يقدر ان يخرج منها الا و ان يدخل عليها و انت يا الهى تعلم مقامه و تقدر على كشف بلائه و اليك المشتكى وحدك لا اله الا انت

- 85 And how can I call upon Thee when Thy mercy hath encompassed all things and Thy providence hath surrounded me from every direction, and verily Thy deed indicateth Thy grace toward me? It is as though Thy knowledge hath not encompassed any evil from me, nor Thy book any offense from myself. Glory be to Thee! How excellent is Thy deed and how great is Thy handiwork regarding me! Thou didst create me when I was nothing, and nurture me through Thy Will without seeing any good from me. Glory be to Thee! Exalted and sanctified is Thine Essence from my praising Thee according to what Thou art in might and unity and majesty and power, for praise from me would be according to my incapacity and poverty, and it becometh not Thy presence nor ascendeth to Thy holy court, for whatsoever is besides Thee is not mentioned before Thee.
- 85 وكيف ادعوك وان رحمتك قد وسعت كل شيء وعنايتك قد احاطتني من كل شطر وان فعلك دال على فضلك لي كان علمك ما احاط بسية مني ولا كتابك بجزيرة من نفسي فسبحانك ما احسن فعلك وما اكبر صنعك في حتى خلقتني ولم اك شيئا وريبتني بمشيتك من دون ان ترى مني خيرا فسبحانك وتعاليت و قدست ذاتيتك من ان احمذك بما انت عليه من العز والوحدة والجلال والقدرة لان الحمد مني ليكون على قدر عجزى وفقرى وهو لا يليق بجنانك ولا يرفع الى ساحة قدسك
- 86 Naught can ascend unto the realm of Thy sanctity, for whatsoever existeth besides Thee is never mentioned in Thy presence, and if mentioned, hath no standing to describe Thee, as all things were brought into being from nothingness by Thy creation.
- 86 لان ما سواك لا يذكر عندك وان ذكر في رتبة لا شان لهم بان توصفك بهم لانهم قد وجدوا لا من شئ باخترائك
- 87 Glorified art Thou, O my God! I see no portion save in obedience to Thee, and no honor save in Thy love, that I might venture before Thee to praise Thine own Self, perchance my heart might be cooled like snow before the vast ocean of Thy Self-Subsistence, and my soul find tranquility like a mountain before the sea of Thy Divine Unity, lest I be as the cattle among Thy servants.
- 87 فسبحانك يا الهى لا ارى حظا الا في طاعتك ولا شرفا الا في محبتك لاجترح عليك بين يديك بناء نفسك نفسك لعل يبرد فوادى بمثل الثلج في تلقاء طمطمم يم صمدانيتك وطمطم قلبي بمثل جبل المحيط في تلقاء قلزم عز وحدانيتك ولا اكون بمثل الانعام بين عبادك
- 88 Glorified, glorified art Thou! I testify that there is no God but Thee, alone with no partner. Thou hast ever been, when nothing else existed, and wilt ever remain as Thou hast been. Nothing existeth at Thy level, for Thy Essence hath no description - it is in itself beyond all expression of substance, and Thy Being hath no attribute - it is in its reality beyond all material comprehension.
- 88 فسبحانك سبحانك اشهد ان لا اله الا انت وحدك لا شريك لك لم تزل قد كنت بلا وجود شئ ولا تزال انك كائن بمثل ما كنت لم يك في ربتك شئ اذ ذاتيتك لا وصف لها وهى بنفسها مقطعة الجوهرات عن البيان وان كينونتك لا نعت لها وهى بانيتها ممتعة الماديات عن العرفان
- 89 None save Thee shall ever know Thee, and none but Thyself shall ever unify Thee, for knowledge implieth conjunction and unity implieth separation, which is impossible in the realm of certitude, as Thou hast ever been with no description possible, and wilt ever remain as Thou art with no attribute in existence.
- 89 لم تزل لن يعرفك سواك ولن يوحدك غيرك اذ حكم العرفان بعد الاقتران وذكر التوحيد بعد الافتراق وان ذلك ممتنع في رتبة الايقان لانك لم تزل كنت ولا وصف لك في الامكان ولا تزال انك كائن بمثل ما كنت ولا لك نعت في الاعيان
- 90 If I say "Thou art Thou," I have merely compared like with like, and if I say "He is He," Identity itself would draw near to creation and Providence to invention, which in itself separateth creation from Thy Being and preventeth all from the path of Thy knowledge.
- 90 ان قلت انت انت فقد حكى المثال بالمثال وان قلت انه هو هو دنت الهوية ذات الابداع والولاية مقام الاختراع وهى بنفسها مفرقة الخلق عن ايتك ومسددة الكل عن سبيل معرفتك

- 91 Glorified art Thou, O my God! If I say Thou art All-Knowing, I mean but to declare Thy sanctity from the existence of any known thing in relation to Thy knowledge, and if I say Thou art All-Powerful, I seek but to proclaim Thy holiness from mention of anything ruled alongside Thee. Thou art as Thou art - no description, no attribute, no quality belongeth to Thy Court, no measure, no name to Thy Being, no mark, for Thy Essence is known through Thy Being and Thy Being described through Thine Essence.
- 92 This is the station of Thy Self and none other, and Thy creation hath no portion in knowing Thy Self save through the negation of all else, for Thine Essence hath no path in the realm of expression, nor Thy Being any attribute in existence. I beseech Thee, O God, by Thy might, to bring me to the most radiant light of Thy creation and sever me from all else through the manifestation of Thy attractive power, that I might attain through Thy Will the station of Thy holiness and enter the depths of the sea of Oneness through the splendor of Thy countenance.
- 93 Glorified art Thou, O Beloved! Thou art He Who hath made Thyself known to all things through the manifestation of Thy creation and hath transcended all things through the appearance of Thy invention. None can point to Thy Being, for nothing hath existence at Thy level nor mention with Thee in Thy grandeur.
- 94 Glorified and exalted art Thou! When Thou didst manifest Thyself to all contingent things through the appearance of Thy creation, essences took on their essential nature by Thy command, and thus they described Thee in ways incapable of knowing Thine Essence. Glorified art Thou, O my God! Had they known Thee, they would not have described Thee, and thus, O my God, they have not unified Thee.
- 95 I beseech Thee therefore, O God, O my God, by the might of Thy Being, the sanctity of Thine Essence, and the uniqueness of Thy Celestial Dominion, to bring me to the highest station Thou hast ordained in creation and of what Thy knowledge hath encompassed in the realm of invention. Lo, I seek refuge with Thee, turn repentant unto Thee through Thy grace, and beseech Thee through Thine Own Self, for I have no refuge save in Thee.
- 96 Teach me, then, what lieth concealed within Thy knowledge, and aid me through that which is treasured in Thy mystery, for I am poor and in need of Thy mercy, while Thou art self-sufficient, having no need of my chastisement. Nothing in the
- 91 فسبحانك يا الهى ان قلت انت عليم فما اردت الا تنزيهك عن وجود المعلوم فى رتبة علمك و ان قلت انت قدير فما اريد الا تقديسك عن ذكر المقدور معك وانك كما انت عليه لا وصف لك ولا صفة ولا نعت لجناحك ولا هندسة ولا اسم لكيونيتك ولا سمة اذ ذاتيتك معروفة بانيتك و كيونيتك موصوفة بذاتيتك
- 92 و ان ذلك كان شان نفسك لا سواك ولا حظ لخلقك فى عرفان نفسك الا بنفى ما سواك لان ذاتيتك لا سبيل لها فى مقام البيان ولا لكيونيتك نعت فى الاعيان فاستلك اللهم بعزتك ان تبلغنى الى نور الابهج من ابداعك وانقطعنى عن سواك بظهور طلعة التجذباك لان اتصل الى مقام قدسك بمشيتك و ادخل لجة بحر الاحدية ببهاء طلعتك
- 93 فسبحانك يا محبوب انت الذى تعرفت لكلشئ بظهور ابداعك و تعاليت على كلشئ بطلة اختراعك و لا يقدر ان يشير الى كيونيتك احد لانه لا وجود له فى ربتك و لا ذكر له معك فى كبريائيتك
- 94 فسبحانك و تعاليت لما تجليت للممكات بطلة ابداعك تذوت المتذوات بامرك و لذا نعتوك بما لا يقدر ان يعرفوا ذاتك فسبحانك يا الهى ان يعرفوا ذاتك فسبحانك يا الهى ان يعرفوا ذاتك فسبحانك يا الهى لو عرفوك ما و صفوك و من ثم ذا يا الهى لم يوحدوك
- 95 فاستلك اللهم يا الهى بعزة كيونيتك و تقدس ذاتيتك و تفرد جبروتيتك بان تبلغنى الى مقام ذروة ما قدرت لى الابداع و ما احاط علمك فى حظ الاختراع فاننى انا لاثد بجناحك و تائب اليك بجودك و مستشفع بك الى نفسك و لا مفر لى الا اليك
- 96 فعلنى ما هو المكنون فى علمك و ايدنى ما هو الخزون فى غيبك فانى فقير الى رحمتك و انك غنى عن عذابى لا يعاظمك شئ فى السموات و لا فى الارض و انك انت الغنى الحميد

heavens or on earth can overwhelm Thee, for Thou art the Self-Sufficient, the All-Praised.

- 97 O my God! I bear witness before Thee and before those who stand in Thy presence that even if Thou shouldst cause the manifestation of Thy power in contingent being to become as molten iron, and shouldst enlarge my body through Thy might until it filled all space like unto an iron ingot, and shouldst maintain me in that fire through the eternity of Thy might, the holiness of Thy Self-Subsistence, the glory of Thy Most Merciful nature, and the majesty of Thy grandeur - sustaining me at every moment with a new spirit - yet would I acknowledge, by Thy might, that Thou art praiseworthy in Thy deeds, obeyed in Thy decree, and just in Thy judgment. I would have no argument to ask "Why, O my God?" or "How, O my Lord?" For I truly deserve this as recompense for having mentioned my own self - a consequence of my misdeeds and transgressions which none save Thee can encompass.
- 98 Alas, alas for what Thy knowledge hath decreed and what Thy Book hath recorded concerning the mention of my transgressions! Were I to mention but one of them, it would suffice to condemn all who dwell in the kingdoms of heaven and earth, and none, after learning of it, would dare approach the might of Thy sovereignty and the power of Thy grandeur.
- 99 Glorified art Thou, glorified art Thou, O my God! Thou art He Who created me, Who blessed me, Who gave me life, Who causeth me to die, Who sustaineth me, Who inspireth me, Who honoreth me, Who giveth unto me, Who strengtheneth me, and Who exalteth me. Not a thing escapeth Thy knowledge, nor can aught be concealed from Thy countenance.
- 100 Alas, alas! How can I say "I," when this is the greatest sin and the most ancient transgression, which no sin in Thy knowledge can equal, nor can any error in Thy Book compare with it in rank, for it springeth from the tree of self, speaking "I" in Thy presence. Alas, alas! I am the one who was content before Thy face to speak of myself saying "I," who bore to utter before the presence of Thy court the word "I," who was neglectful in my duty toward Thee by mentioning "I," who disobeyed Thy presence by mentioning that selfhood which Thou hadst forbidden any to approach before the glory of Thy Lordship, and who said "I" and felt no shame before Thy face to cease saying thereafter in Thy presence that I am I.
- 101 Alas, alas! Were I to weep throughout eternity over what my soul hath borne, my heart would not be relieved, nor my inner being quieted, nor my outer being find rest. Yet when I witness how Thou dealest with the sinners among Thy servants, I
- 97 فيا الهى انى اشهدك و من لديك من الاشهاد بانك لو تجعل احاطة قدرتك فى الامكان نار الحديد و تكبر جسمى بما تقدر قدرتك حتى احاطت الفضاء كلها بمثل سبكة حديد و تمدنى فى النار بدوام عز ازليتك و قدس صدائيتك و بهاء رحمانيتك و جلال كبريائيتك فى كل ان بروح جديد لكنت بعزتك محمودا فى فعلك و مطاعا فى حكمك و عادلا فى قضائك و ليس لى حجة بان اقول لم يا الهى ثم بم يا مولائى و انى لمستحق بذلك جزاء ذكرى نفسك من سيئاتى و جريرائى التى لا يحيط بها احد سواك
- 98 فاه اه عما قضى فى علمك و احصى كتابك من ذكريات نفسى و لو انى ذكرت احدى منها ليكفى فى العصيان من فى ملكوت السموات و الارض و لا يرغب بعد علمه احد ان يقرب الى من سطوة جبروتيتك و قهر كبريائيتك
- 99 فسبحانك سبحانك يا الهى انت الذى خلقتنى و انت الذى انعمتنى و انت الذى احييتنى و انت الذى امتتنى و انت الذى رزقتنى و انت الذى اهتمتنى و انت الذى اكرمتنى و انت الذى اعطيتنى و انت الذى ايدتنى و انت الذى شرفتنى لم يزل لا يعزب من علمك شئ لا يحجب عن طلعته شئ
- 100 فاه اه كيف اقول انا و ان هذا هو ذنب العظيم و عصيان القديم حيث لا يعادله ذنب فى علمك و لا يساويه فى المرتبة خطيئته فى كتابك لانه هو من شجرة الانية ينطق بين يديك فاه اه انا الذى رضيت فى تلقاء وجهك بان اقول فى نفسى قول انا و انا الذى الذى احتملت القول فى تلقاء طلعة حضرتك بقولى انا و انا الذى فرطت فى جنبك بذكرى انا و انا الذى عصيت حضرتك بذكر الانية التى نهيت الكل بان لا يقربها احد فى تلقاء عز ربوبيتك و انا الذى قلت انا و لا استحي عن وجهك بان لا اقول بعد ذلك فى بين يديك باننى انا
- 101 فاه اه لو ابكى على ما احتملت نفسى سرمد الابد فى عمرى ما يفرغ فوادى و لا يسكن سرى و لا يروح علانيتى و لكن لما شاهدت معاملتك مع

am assured that Thou wilt not withhold from me the majesty of Thy mercy, nor wilt Thou be wroth with me through the sovereignty of Thy grace and might. For though I disobeyed Thee, I meant not to disobey, nor did I deny the signs of Thy mercy. Rather, my passions overcame me when they found love in Thy bounties, and destiny aided me in this when I desired to manifest Thy self-sufficiency through the free will of Thy servants.

المذنبين من عبادك لايقن انك لا تستحظ على  
بجالة رحمتك و لا تغضب على بعلو عنايتك و  
سلطنتك لاني لو عصيتك ما اردت عصيانك و  
لا جاحدت اثار رحمانيتك بل غلبني هواي لما وجد  
الحب في الاثك

- 102 O my Lord! Destiny hath aided me in this, for Thou didst desire to manifest Thy bounty through the choice of Thy servants. Were it otherwise, my desires would not prevail over the love of Thy Will, for it standeth sovereign over every soul according to its deserts, and nothing in the heavens or earth can overpower it. Thou knowest, O my God, both my secret and manifest thoughts. In all things I have desired naught but Thy love and good-pleasure, and wished only what Thou wishest. If Thy knowledge of me showeth otherwise, then by the greatness of Thy Being and the sanctity of Thy glory, it was not to deny Thy Lordship, nor to reject Thy Unity, nor to be heedless of Thy power, nor to rely on aught save Thy mercy. Rather, since Thou didst create within my soul the means of power, and it desired what it was inclined toward, it exceeded its bounds through what Thou bestowed of Thy generosity. Though this may be pure disobedience in Thy Book, it arose only from its love of itself, without knowing Thy love in aught else, or waiting for the days wherein Thou wouldst send down what Thou hadst promised it.

102 و مددني القضاء بذلك لما اردت اظهار غنائك  
باختيار عبادك و لو كان دون ذلك لا يغلب  
هواي و لا على حب مشيتك لانها قائمة على كل  
نفس بما كسبت و لا يتعاضدها شيء في السموات  
و لا في الارض و انك يا الهى لتعلم سرى و  
علايتي ما اردت في شيء الا حبك و رضاك و  
لا ان اشاء الا بما تشاء و ان لو احاط عليك بى  
دون ذلك فبعظمة ذاتك و تقدر كبريائك ما  
كان لمجدى ربوبيتك و لا لانكارى صمدانيتك و  
لا لاغفالى من سطواتك و لا لا تكالى بشئ سوى  
رحمانيتك بل لما خلقت في نفسى اسباب القدرة  
و انها قد اشتت بما يميل اليها قد ارتفعت عن  
حدها بما اعطيتها من كرامتك و ان ذلك و لو كان  
عصيان محض في كتابك و لكن لم يك عندها الا  
لحبها بها من دون ان تعرف حبك في غيرها او ان  
تصير الى الايام التى انت تنزل عليها ما وعدت لها

- 103 Glorified and exalted art Thou, O my God, that I should say Thou art Thou, or that I could bear separation from the court of Thy nearness, or remain silent and offer no excuse before the presence of Thy countenance. As I find no remembrance with Thee save the remembrance of Muhammad and His family - Thy blessings be upon them - I beseech Thee, O God, by Thy remembrance of them in every condition, to bless Muhammad and the family of Muhammad, the repositories of Thy knowledge, the treasuries of Thy bounty, the seats of Thy Lordship, and the pillars of Thy unity - the Imams of religion and guides of the people of certitude. These are the servants whose will Thou hast made identical with Thy Will in creation, whose desire is one with Thy Desire in origination, whose decree is Thy Decree in bringing forth, and whose judgment is Thy Decision in invention. All that is attributed to them is the supreme attribution through its relation to Thee alone, Who hath no partner.

103 فُسُحَانُكَ وَ تَعَالَيْتَ يَا هَلِىَ مِنْ اَنْ اَقُولَ اَنْكَ اَنْتَ  
اَنْتَ اَوْ اَنْ اَقْدِرَ اَنْ اَصْبِرَ فِى بَعْدِى عَنْ سَاحَةِ  
قُرْبِكَ اَوْ اَنْ اَصْمِتَ وَ لَا اَعْتَذِرَ فِى تَلَقُّاءِ طَلْعَةِ  
حَضْرَتِكَ وَ لِمَا لَا اَجِدُ ذِكْرًا دُونَ ذِكْرِ اَلِ مُحَمَّدٍ  
عِنْدَكَ صَلَوَاتُكَ عَلَيْهِمْ فَاسْأَلْكَ اَللّهُمَّ بِذِكْرِكَ لَهُمْ  
فِى كُلِّ شَأْنٍ اَنْ تَصَلِّىَ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَ اَلِ مُحَمَّدٍ مَحَالٍ  
مَعْرِفَتِكَ وَ مَعَادِنِ كَرَامَتِكَ وَ مَوَاقِعِ رُبُوبِيَّتِكَ وَ  
اَرْكَانِ وَحْدَانِيَّتِكَ اُتَمِّمُ الدِّينَ وَ هِدَاةَ اَهْلِ الْيَقِيْنِ  
عِبَادِ الدِّينِ قَدْ جَعَلْتَ مَشِيَّتَهُمْ ذَاتَ مَشِيَّتِكَ فِى  
الْاَنْشَاءِ وَ ارَادَتَهُمْ ذَاتَ ارَادَتِكَ فِى الْاِبْدَاعِ وَ  
حَكْمِ قُدْرَتِهِمْ ذَاتَ قُدْرَتِكَ فِى الْاِحْدَاثِ وَ قَضَائِهِمْ  
ذَاتَ بَدَائِكَ فِى الْاِخْتِرَاعِ وَ كُلِّ مَا نَسَبَ إِلَيْهِمْ  
ذَاتَ نِسْبَةِ الْكِبَرِىِّ بِنِسْبَتِهَا إِلَيْكَ وَحْدَكَ لَا شَرِيكَ  
لَكَ

- 104 I beseech Thee by their right that Thou make us among those who are certain of their virtue, patient under their decree,

104 و اسألك بحقهم ان تجعلنا من الموقنين بفضلهم  
و الصابرين على حكمهم و الذاكرين بذكرهم و

mindful in their remembrance, yearning for their countenance, awaiting the days of their return, holding fast to their cord, seeking forgiveness through them, taking refuge in their presence, established in their love, relying upon them, seeking their intercession, content with their judgment, and obedient to their commands. O Thou Who art the Lord of bounty and beneficence, of proof and exposition!

المشتاقين الى طلعتهم و المنتظرين لايام رجعتهم  
و المعتمدين بحبلهم و المستغفرين اليهم و الالائدين  
بحضرتهم و المستقرين في محبتهم و المتوكلين عليهم  
و المستشفين بهم اليهم و الراضين بقضائهم و  
المطيعين لاحكامهم منك يا ذا الجود و الاحسان  
و الحجة و البيان

- 105 Thou knowest that I desire to know naught but Thy love. Therefore, send down unto me the means that will bring me to the station of nearness to Thy names and attributes. I declare: God is sufficient for me, then Muhammad the Messenger of God is sufficient for me, then the Family of God and the Imams of justice are sufficient for me, then those who believe in their truth are sufficient for me - and Thou art behind them all - then the Qur'an is sufficient for me. Upon Thee do I rely, and upon Thee let the believers rely.

105 انك تعلم اني لا احب ان اعلم الا حبك فانت انزل  
لى الاسباب و ما يبلغنى الى مقام قرب الاسماء  
و الصفات فاني انا اقول انت الله حسبي ثم محمد  
رسول الله حسبي ثم ال الله و ائمة العدل حسبي  
ثم الذين يؤمنون بحقهم حسبي و انك من ورائهم  
ثم القرآن حسبي عليك توكلت و عليك فليتوكل  
المؤمنون

- 106 O God! Forgive the one who taught me this prayer, and who seeth naught else, then myself, then those who love to be mentioned before Thee. Verily, Thou art the Mighty, the Merciful. Glorified be God, the Lord of the Throne, above what they describe. Peace be upon the Messengers, and praise be to God, the Lord of the worlds.

106 و اغفر اللهم لمن علمنى تلك المناجاة و لا يرى  
ثم لنفسى ثم الذين يحبون ان يذكروا بين يديك  
انك انت العزيز الرحيم و سبحان الله رب العرش  
عما يصفون و سلام على المرسلين و الحمد لله رب  
العالمين

- 107 In His Name, the Most High, the Most Great! All praise and glory befit the Eternal One, Whose Holy Presence is sanctified above the description of all else, and all magnificence and splendor befit the Manifestations of Justice, through Whom are known in every age the highest essences of abstract realities with certainty. Glory and splendor are due to the Manifestations of justice Who recognize, in all times, the highest spiritual essences among abstract realities through absolute detachment from the realm of their own knowledge.

107 بسمه العلى العظيم ان الحمد و الثناء يستحق ذات  
الازل الذى كان طلعة حضرته مقدسة عن و  
صف ما سواه و ان المجد و البهاء يستحق مظاهر  
عدل الذى يعرف اعلى جوهريات المجردات فى  
كل حين بالقطع و المنع عن ساحة عرفانه

- 108 When I beheld the trace of your pen in your letter, I was moved by the radiance of your countenance reflected in your words. Indeed, God is too exalted and sublime for me to enumerate His Book through the obedience of a servant in His path while the means have not flowed for him as befits the throne of glory and attributes. I beseech God, my Lord and your Lord, to remove sorrow from your heart and to unite me with the people of His obedience in a land of security and holiness. Verily, He is the Powerful, the Forbearing.

108 و لما رايت اثر مدادك فى كتابك قد تلجلجت بما  
تجلى طلعة وجهك فى خطابك و ان الله اجل و  
اعلى شانا من ان احصى كتابه بطاعة عبد فى سبيله  
و لم يجز له الاسباب بما هو عليه فى عرش العزة  
و الصفات فارجو الله ربى و ربك ان يذهب من  
قلبك الحزن و يجمع بينى و بين اهل طاعته فى  
ارض امن و قدس انه هو المقتدر الحكيم

- 109 Praise be to God that I have read your letter, which speaks from your countenance as though the Holy Spirit were breathing its spirit therein. Exalted is the station of my Lord, the Possessor of Glory and Honor, above being known through the love of any of His servants while the means have not flowed for

109 فله الحمد بما طالعت كتابك الذى يحكى من طلعة  
وجهك كان فيه روح القدس بنفس بروحه  
فنعلى شان ربي ذو الجلال و الاكرام من ان  
يعلم بحب احد من عباد و لم يجز الاسباب له

him in what is better for him than aught else. I beseech God on your behalf for that which He loves and with which He is well-pleased. Verily, He is the Mighty, the Wise.

GOH.064x

بما هو خير له من غيره فاستل الله لجناحك بما هو  
يحب ويرضى انه هو العزيز الحكيم

INBA14:283-320, INBA53:125-156,  
INBA67:052-085, INBA86:154-193,  
INBA\_3006C:058-096, INBA\_6010C:274-  
310, INBA\_4002C, PR02.193v14-200v02,  
PR03.065r28-067r27x, PR07.092v-102r,  
BYC\_collect3.116-126x, ASAT1.190x,  
ASAT5.158-159x, ASAT5.163-164x,  
HNMJ.081-086x, HNMJ.086-093x

## BB00073

*Letter to Mulla Muhammad Ja'far Kirmani*

*Date: 1262 (mid to late) [1845-1846]*

- 1 In the Name of God, the Most Merciful, the Most Compassionate
- 2 Praise be unto God Who caused the letter Kaf to speak of Him, through Him, unto Him, before His Book was fulfilled by His leave. Then He established it in the station of Command as accepted by His Own Self, that thereby the signs of the divine realms might be distinguished from the vengeance of the mortal world, and that through it might be proclaimed the signs of the Fourth Citadel in the thicket of the Realm of Might, and the goodly leaf from the Third Tree in the grove of sovereignty and dominion. Glory be unto Him! How great is His power and how noble His proof! He hath sent down a Criterion and made it a distinction between His friends and His enemies, wherein are the signs of Manifestation and the evidences of the Tree of Sinai, that it might be a healing for hearts and an appearance of the hidden Light, and a fulfillment of what the All-Forgiving promised concerning those who fabricated lies and came with falsehood and calumny, that all might know that the Hidden Manifest One is the Zealous Lord. And He hath sent down all that creation desired in a recorded Book and an outstretched parchment, and verily it is the Frequented House in the horizon of Manifestation, and through such as this doth God expose the deed of the weary lie.
- 3 God's blessings be upon Muhammad and his family, the root of the Tree of Light and all Manifestation, by that which causeth

1 بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

2 الحمد لله الذى استنطق حرف الكاف من نفسه  
بنفسه الى نفسه قبل ما اقضت كتابه باذن الله  
ثم جعله فى مقام الامر بما قبلت نفسه ليمين بها  
آيات اللاموات عن نعمات الناسوت و تعلن  
بها بالآيات قصبة الرابعة فى اجمة الجبروت و  
الورقة الطيبة من الشجرة الثالثة فى اجمة الملك  
و الملكوت فسبحانه ما اعظم قدرته و اكرم حجتّه  
فقد نزل فرقانا و جعله بين اوليائه و اعدائه فيه  
آيات الظهور و بينات شجرة الطور ليكون شفاء  
للصدور و ظهورا للنور الشكو و محققا لما وعد  
الغفور لمن اقتربى و كذب و جاء باثم و زور  
ليعلم الكل ان المبين المستور هو السيد الغيور و  
نزل كل ما اراد الخلق فى كتاب مسطور و رق  
منشور و انه لهُ البيت المعمور فى افق الظهور و  
ان بمثل ذلك فيعلن الله عمل الكذب الفتور

the surging ocean to glorify Him by leave of God, the Most High, the All-Forgiving.

3 و صلی الله علی محمد وآله اصل شجرة النور و کلّ  
الظهور بما یسبح بحر المسجور باذن الله العلی الغفور

4 O God! I bear witness before Thee and all who are in Thy presence that I believe in Thee as Thou art in Thyself. I love naught save for Thy love's sake, I hate naught save through Thy hatred, I fear none save Thy justice, I desire naught save Thyself, and I see naught but as Thou seest in the presence of the mirror of Thy might which Thou hast caused to be reflected in my soul. Thou knowest that a letter hath come unto me from one about whom Thou knowest more than I, and this is a copy of his letter which he wrote with knowledge and a preserved scripture:

4 اللهم انی اشهدک و کلّ من لیدیک من الاشهاد  
وانی مؤمن بک کما انت انت و لا احب شیئا الا  
لحبک و لا ابغض شیئا الا بغضک و لا اخاف  
من احد الا من عدلک و لا اردت شیئا الا  
نفسک و لا اری ما سواک الا بمثل ما ترى فی  
تلقاء مدین عزتک الذی تجلیت بمثاله فی نفسی و  
انک لتعلم نزل الی کتاب من الذی انت اعلم به  
منی و ان هذا [ه] صورة کتابه الذی نزله بعلم و  
کتاب حفیظ

5 In the Name of God, the Most Merciful, the Most Compassionate

5 بسم الله الرحمن الرحیم

6 Peace be upon thee, O Gate of God, through whom the people are guided - whoso cometh unto him is saved and whoso turneth away from him perisheth. Here am I come unto thee, O my Master and my Lord, acknowledging my limitations and confessing my shortcomings, yet taking refuge with thee, relying upon thee, seeking support through thee, hoping from thee, beseeching from thy presence that thou wouldst intercede for me with God that He might make me among those who recognize thy rights and who attain unto thy bounties, and that He might endear to me every deed, word, or act that draweth me near to thee, and might protect me from every deed, word, or act from which I fear an evil consequence and fear thy displeasure concerning it, lest Thou turn Thy noble face away from me and I thereby deserve a diminution of my portion with Thee, O Kind One, O Merciful One!

6 السلام علیک یا باب الله المتبع به الناس من  
اتاه فقد نجی و من تخلف عنه فقد هلك فها  
انا قد اتیتک یا سیدی و مولای مقرا بالقصیر  
معترفا بالتقصیر لکن لاجیا لیدیک معتمدا علیک  
عاندا بک راجیا منک سائلا من جنابک ان  
تشفع لی عندالله لئن یجعلنی من العارفين بحقک  
ثم الفائزين بکراماتک و ان یجیبنی کل عمل او  
قول او فعل یباعدنی منک و ان یجلبنی الی کل  
عمل او قول او فعل یقریبنی منک و ان یمنعنی  
من کل عمل او قول او فعل یكون منی اخاف  
ضرر عاقبة و اخاف مقتک ایای علیہ حذار ان  
تصرف وجهک الکریم عنی فاستوجب به نقصا  
من حظّ لی عندک یا رؤف یا رحیم

7 O my Master, O my Lord! I beseech Thee not to deprive me of one glance from Thy glances, and not to turn me away from Thy gate, for even if I deserve none of this, yet Thou art of the people of generosity, bounty, and forgiveness. O my Master! I beseech Thee by Thy right and Thy holiness to make my times, night and day, filled with Thy remembrance, connected to Thy service, and my deeds accepted before Thee, until all my deeds and devotions become one single devotion and my service to Thee eternal.

7 یا سیدی یا مولای اسئلك ان لا تحرمنی من  
نظرة من نظاراتک و لا ترونی عن بابک فانی و  
ان لم استحق شیئا من ذلك الا انک من اهل  
الجود و الکریم و العفو یا سیدی اسئلك بحقک و  
قدسک ان تجعل اوقاتی فی اللیل و النهار بذکرک  
معمورة و بخدمتک موصولة و اعمالی عندک  
مقبولة حتی تكون اعمالی و اورادی کلها وردا  
و احسدا و قام خدمتک سرمداً

8 O thou precise questioner! Verily a light hath broken forth from the direction of the East, as though it were the light of the steed of light which derived its radiance from the light of the Eternal Morn that gleamed upon the temples of all, among them are the people of concord, who, when they inquire into the letter standing between the two B's and contemplate

8 فیا ایها السائل الدقیق قد اشرق برق من شطر  
المشرق کانه هو نور براق الذی استضاء من نور  
صبح الازل الذی لاح علی هیاکل الكل اثاره  
فتمهم اهل الوفاق و انهم اذا استنطقوا من حرف  
القائم بین البائین و استکعبوا فیشاهدون يوم الذی

deeply, witness the Day whereon God shall reveal that ‘the leg shall be bared’ on the Day of Meeting. And when they awaken to the light of the Bayan, they say: “Glory be to Thee! There is no God but Thee, and we are but a people who turn unto Thee.”

نَزَلَ اللَّهُ فِي يَوْمِ التَّلَاقِ بَانَ السَّاقُ يَكْشِفُ عَنِ  
السَّاقِ وَأَنَّهُمْ لَمَّا افْتَقُوا مِنْ تَجَلَّى نَوْرِ الْبَيَانِ يَقُولُونَ  
سُبْحَانَكَ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ وَمَا نَحْنُ إِلَّا قَوْمٌ تَابِثُونَ

- 9 And among them are the people of the Covenant, who, when they become established at the point beneath the letter B and immerse themselves in what God hath placed within that letter of the light of Glory, witness the Day when the Herald shall call forth from the chains of bondage, and they say: “Glory be to Thee! There is no God but Thee, and we are but a people who fall prostrate before Thee.”

9 وَ مِنْهُمْ أَهْلُ الْمِيثَاقِ وَأَنَّهُمْ إِذَا اسْتَقَرُّوا فِي نَقْطَةِ  
تَحْتِ الْبَاءِ وَ اسْتَلْجَلُوا بِمَا جَعَلَ اللَّهُ فِي ذَلِكَ  
الْحَرْفِ مِنْ نَوْرِ الْبَهَاءِ فَيُشَاهِدُونَ يَوْمَ الَّذِي يَنَادِي  
الْمُنَادِي مِنْ أَيْدِي الْوُثَاقِ وَ يَقُولُونَ سُبْحَانَكَ لَا  
إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ وَمَا نَحْنُ إِلَّا قَوْمٌ سَاجِدُونَ

- 10 And among them are the people of discord, who, when they hear a verse, turn away as though they forget the Day when the leg shall be bared by the leg, and they are veiled from the light that hath filled all souls and horizons. They fear not the Covenant’s bond, nor do they look to the letters of utterance, nor perceive the deeds of the people of concord. I seek refuge with God from the evil that hath rent asunder discord and hypocrisy, by the Lord of Daybreak, from all He hath created and revealed concerning the transgressors.

10 وَ مِنْهُمْ أَهْلُ الشَّقَاقِ وَأَنَّهُمْ إِذَا سَمِعُوا آيَةً يُعْرَضُوا  
كَأَنَّهُمْ يَنْسَوْنَ يَوْمَ الَّذِي يَكْشِفُ السَّاقَ بِالسَّاقِ  
وَ يَحْجِبُونَ مِنْ نَوْرِ الَّذِي مَلَأَهُ كُلَّ الْإِنْفُسِ وَ  
الْأَفَاقِ وَ لَا يَخَافُونَ مِنْ عَهْدِ الْمِيثَاقِ وَ لَا يَنْظُرُونَ  
إِلَى أَحْرِفِ الْإِسْتِنْقَاقِ وَ لَا يَشْعُرُونَ بِأَعْمَالِ أَهْلِ  
الْوَفَاقِ فَاعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنْ شَرِّ مَا فَتَقَ بَيْنَ الشَّقَاقِ وَ  
النَّفَاقِ بَرِبَ الْفُلُقِ مِنْ كُلِّ مَا خَلَقَ وَ نَزَلَ فِي  
الْفَسَاقِ

- 11 I beseech God of His bounty to transform the realities of the people of discord into the deeds of the people of the Covenant, by Muhammad and His family, the lights of the Eternal Sun that hath illumined the cloud and all who dwell in the kingdoms of earth and heaven, of souls and horizons.

11 فَاسْتَلِ اللَّهَ مِنْ جُودِهِ بَانَ يَبْدُلُ حَقَائِقَ أَهْلِ  
[النِّفَا] الشَّقَاقِ بِأَعْمَالِ أَهْلِ الْمِيثَاقِ بِمُحَمَّدٍ وَ آلِهِ  
أَنْوَارِ شَمْسِ الْأَزَلِ الَّتِي أَضَاءَ بِهَا الْعَمَاءُ ثُمَّ مِنْ  
فِي مَلَكُوتِ الْأَرْضِ وَ السَّمَاءِ مِنَ الْإِنْفُسِ وَ  
الْأَفَاقِ

- 12 O thou who dost gaze upon the subtle splendors, who dost ascend unto the ladder of inner realities, and who dost cast from thy hands the veils of light and the claims of understanding! Attain unto a certitude luminous and unclouded – nay, as though thou wert standing within the very eye of certainty – like unto this rising sun. If thou be of the companions of KĀizim – may the blessings of God rest upon him – I beseech thee, O my lord, to have mercy upon me, lest I be numbered among those who, in thy presence, have presumed, and thereby exposed themselves to thy wrath. Verily I cherish hope in thy bounties – thou who didst dispatch the pages and other gifts – and, through thy grace, suffer not my hope to be cut off, O my desire and my refuge. Deal with me as befitteth Thee, and not as befitteth me....

12 فَيَا أَيُّهَا النَّازِرُ إِلَى سُبُحاتِ الرِّقَائِقِ وَ الْمُتَعَارِجِ إِلَى  
مَعْرَاجِ الْحَقَائِقِ وَ الْمُلْقَى مَا فِي يَدَيْكَ مِنْ سُبُحاتِ  
النُّورِ وَ الْحَقَائِقِ فَايْقِنْ بِالْيَقِينِ الْأَمْعِ كَأَنَّكَ فِي  
عَيْنِ الْيَقِينِ بِمَثَلِ هَذَا الشَّمْسِ الطَّالِعِ بَانَ كُنْتُ  
مِنْ أَصْحَابِ كَاطِمِ صَلَوَاتِ اللَّهِ عَلَيْهِ اسْتَثْلِكَ  
يَا سَيِّدِي إِنْ تَرَحَّمْنِي لَثَلُّوا كُنْ مَنْسِيبًا عِنْدَكَ  
مُتَعَرِّضًا لِسَخَطِكَ ثُمَّ إِنِّي أَرْجُو كَرَمَاتِكَ مِنْ  
أَرْسَلِ الصَّحَافِ وَ غَيْرِهِ وَ لَا تَقْطَعْ بِفَضْلِكَ  
رَجَائِي يَا أَمَلِي وَ مَنَآئِي أَفْعَلْ بِي مَا أَنْتَ أَهْلُهُ وَ لَا  
تَقْعَلْ بِي مَا أَنَا أَهْلُهُ .....

- 13 If thou seekest the outward path concerning the Bearer of this radiant Pillar, it hath been established by the consensus of this community that none can be its Bearer save from the lineage

13 وَ إِنْ أَرَدْتَ مَسْلَكَ الظَّاهِرِ فِي حَامِلِ ذَلِكَ  
الرَّكْنِ الْأَصْعَقِ قَدْ ثَبَتَ بِالْإِجْمَاعِ الْحَقِيقِ عِنْدَ هَذِهِ  
الْفَتْنَةِ إِلَّا يَقْدَرُ أَنْ يَكُونَ حَامِلُهُ إِلَّا ذُرِّيَّةُ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ  
كَأَمْ صَرَحَ بِذَلِكَ كَاطِمٌ وَ أَحْمَدٌ مِنْ قَبْلِهِ وَ شَرَطَ

of God's Messenger, as Kazim and Ahmad before him explicitly stated. He must be free from physical defects that would repel hearts, possessed of strength, modesty, dignity and reverence, endowed with beautiful names and sublime attributes, showing signs of knowledge and piety, and manifesting tokens of supreme justice - all of which the people of discernment recognize through the light of their hearts.

- 14 When God knew that Satan would whisper in the hearts of His friends to rise against His trustees, God granted me what He had given to no one before: The Book of Justice, wherein are detailed verses of decisive proof such that should all humans and jinn gather to produce the like of a single verse thereof, they would be unable, even if they all assisted one another. And from it are the scrolls of intimate prayers that have, by God's leave, filled the East and the West of the earth in a manner none before me hath spoken. As the Balance is established, there flow from my hands a thousand verses every six hours when rendered in proper Arabic - a proof none in the heavens or earth can match.

- 15 As the compiler of the certain truths hath declared that all scholars have agreed that the Sahifah Sajjadiyyah is the Psalms of the House of Muhammad and sufficient as proof for those who see not their miracles, this indeed is the certain truth. For none save the Family of God have brought forth such supreme proof. The nobility therein lies not in the arrangement of words or allusions, but in the celestial spirit God created therein, which warbles in every state and soars in the thickets of divinity without qualification or indication. My intimate prayers to God suffice as proof in this world and the next.

- 16 As for the scholarly matters and sermon-verses that none, not even Ahmad and Kazim (God's blessings upon them both), could surpass - behold what We have revealed in the commentary on Surah al-Kawthar, for verily a single letter thereof equals not all the books of former times, nor what We revealed in the commentary on al-Baqarah for the weak among the believers. Therein, by the verses of the Qur'an and the reports of the People of God, I have established mention of this Cause wheresoever thou dost will, in the heavens and on the earth; and verily it is exalted, full of wisdom.

- 17 And thou hast heard that he wrote, for the "calf-body" - that lowing thing - some few letters. By thy Lord! I asked of him two proofs - nay, a single hadith - and he brought it not.

الا يكون في ظاهر جسده عيب يتنفر منه القلوب وله قوة والحياة وهيبته وقار واسماء حسنى وصفات عليا واثار علم وتقوى وايات عدل كبرى حيث يعلم كل ذلك رجال الاعراف بنور الفواد

- 14 ولما علم الله ان الشيطان بوسوس في صدور اوليائه بالقيام على مقام امانائه قد اعطاني الله ما لم يؤت احدا من قبل منه كتاب العدل الذي فصلت في ايات محكمات التي لو اجتمع جن والانس على ان ياتوا بمثل آية منها لن يستطيعوا ولن يقدروا ولو كانوا كل الارض ومثلهم معهم على الامر ظهيرا ومنه صحف المناجات حيث قد ملئت باذن الله شرق الارض وغربها بشأن الذي لم ينطق احد من قبلى وكما ثبت الميزان يخرج من يدي في كل ستة ساعات الف بيت اذ انت عربته بالاعراب وهي حجة لا يقوم بها احد من في السموات والارض

- 15 كما صرح جامع اخبار حق اليقين بان العلماء كلهم قد ذهبوا بان صحيفة السجادية زبور ال محمد وهي تكفي لدى الحجة لمن لا يرى معجزاتهم وان ذلك هو الحق اليقين لان بتلك الحجة الكبرى لم يأت احد الا الله وان الشرف فيها ليس من ترتيب الكلمات ولا الاشارات بل هي روح المملوكية التي خلق الله فيها التي تغرد في كل شان تبغر وطير العماء في اجمة اللاهوت بلا كيف ولا اشارة وكفى بمناجات لله لى حجة في الدنيا والاخرة [لم]

- 16 شئون العلمية وايات الخطبية التي لا يسبقها احد لا احمد وكاظم صلوات الله عليهما انظر الى ما نزلنا في شرح سورة الكوثر فانه لكتاب لم يعدل حرفا منها كل كتب الاولين ولا ما انا نزلته في شرح البقرة للضعفاء من المؤمنين وانه فيه قد اثبت بايات القرءان واخبار الله ذكر هذا الامر حيث شئ في السموات ولا في الارض وانه لعل حكيم

- 17 وان سمعت انه كتب للجسد العجل الذي هو خوار بعض حرف فوربك انى طلبت منه ايتان حديث وحده وانه لم يأت وبعد ذلك حمل

Thereafter he bore the wrath of God, laden with the anger of God; and for him is a painful chastisement. Behold the champions of that band and their wolves who turned not unto any of the perfect ones. How they believed and testified and proclaimed and stood firm upon the path like an encompassing mountain - neither storms could move them nor signs of tempests affect them. They are the bearers of religion and the guardians of knowledge. Were it not for them, God would not have revealed a single verse of the Book, nor would a letter flow from My pen. May God grant Me their meeting in a seat of truth before a mighty King. From Him are the conditions of piety, the attributes of holiness, the manifestations of divinity, and the traces of servitude which none can comprehend save as fire in the essence of water, or as air in the presence of the element of earth. Glorified be God, their Creator, the Lord of the heavens and earth, above what they describe.

18 O thou who art endowed with insight! Purify thy vision and refine thy sight. Verily God hath manifested the Cause from a station that hath never occurred to any heart, and He was unlettered in respect to those verses, prayers, addresses and allusions, for He saw no teacher for Himself except what the All-Merciful promised in the Surah of the All-Merciful: "The All-Merciful hath taught the Qur'an, created man, taught him clear expression." And that is the word of the All-Merciful: "Fear God and He will give you discernment." This honor sufficeth for that band, for He Who appeared by nature, aided by God's grace, was none other than the confirmer of Ahmad, then Kazim, then their followers - may God's blessings be upon them both - as long as the sun of creation hath risen and set in creation.

19 If thou wouldst purify thy vision, thou wouldst see today all the deniers in the fire, and thou wouldst read unto them the verse of the Almighty: "Verily hell shall encompass the unbelievers." For God hath completed His proof with a true proof wherein was the Shi'ih sect, and today there is no escape for them except to either deny what they believed before, or believe in what hath been revealed afterward as they believed before, or become stones glorifying without religion. For the Cause is like this sun rising, and the handiwork of the Lord cannot be confused with the handiwork of creation, for He Who came with those verses readeth in all things, when He willeth, what was revealed in the Book of Justice without thought, and writeth without reflection. And whatever people said about Him, the word returneth upon them in the Qur'an, letter for letter. And from the day He manifested His verses, none hath produced a verse, and all denied and were amazed, while some believed

سخط الله رباً بغضب من الله وله عذاب اليم انظر الى ابطال تلك الفئة ثم ذؤبانهم الذين لم يلتفتوا بالاحد من الكائن فكيف امنوا وصدقوا وبلغوا وقاموا على الصراط كمثل جبل المحيط لا يحركهم العواصف ولا يؤثر فيهم آيات القواصف وانهم حملة الدين وحفاظ العلم ولو لا هم لم ينزل الله اية من الكتاب ولا يجز من قلبى حرف رزقنى الله لقاءهم في مقعد صدق عند مليك مقتدر ومنه شئون التقية وصفات القدسية وتجليات الربانية واثار العبودية التي لم تقدر ان تدرك شيئاً منها الا ان ترى كأنه هو نار في حيوة عنصر الماء وهواء في حين عنصر عنصر التراب فسبحان الله موجد رب السموات والارض عما يصفون

18 فيها ايها البصير صف نظرك و الطف بصرك ان الله قد اظهر الامر من مقام لم يخطر بقلب احد و كان [أى] امياً من شان تلك الايات و المناجات و الخطابات و الاشارات لانه ما راي معلماً لنفسه الا ما وعد الرحمن [اتقوا الله يجعل لكم فر] في سورة الرحمن الرحمن علم القرآن خلق الانسان علمه البيان و ان ذلك قول الرحمن اتقوا الله يجعل لكم فرقانا و كفى بذلك الشرف تلك الفئة لان الذى ظهر بالقطرة مؤيداً من فضل الله لم يك فى شان الا مصدق احمد ثم كاظم ثم شيعتهما صلوات الله عليهما ما طلعت شمس الابداع بالابداع و ما غربت

19 و انك ان صفت نظرك لترى اليوم كل الجاحدين فى النار و تقرأ عليهم اية القهار و ان جهنم محيطه بالكافرين لان الله قد تم حجته بحجة حق كان فرقة الشيعة فيها و ان اليوم لا مفر لهم الا ان يكفروا بما امنوا من قبل او امنوا بما نزل من بعد بمثل ما امنوا من قبل او يكونوا حجارة سحيين بلادين لان الامر مثل هذه الشمس طالعه و ان صنع الرب لم يشته بصنع الخلق لان الذى جاء بتلك الايات يقرء فى كل شئ اذا شاء بما نزل فى كتاب العدل من دون فكر و يكتب من دون ان يتامل و كما قال الناس فيه انه يرجع القول عليهم فى القرآن حتى الحرف بالحرف و ان من يوم الذى اظهر اياته لم يات احد باية و كل كفروا و بهتوا و بعض امنوا

and acknowledged their impotence. By thy Lord! There is no escape for anyone except through belief or through denying what they believed before in the All-Merciful.

و اعترفوا بالعجز فو ربك لا محيص لاحد الا  
بالايمان او يكفر بما امن به من قبل

- 20 I take refuge in God! Is He Who revealed the Book of Justice more worthy to be followed, or one who cannot produce a verse? And if he were able, why did he not send to Me the like of My letter to him, and wrote like what the Roman followed, as though he had not read the Book? "Thou canst warn only him who followeth the Reminder and feareth the All-Merciful in secret; so give him glad tidings of forgiveness and a noble reward." Then His word, exalted be His station: ["It beseemeth him not to speak poetry"]. Far, far be it from those who think evil thoughts about God! Upon them be the evil turn of fortune, and God's wrath be upon them, and His curse, and He hath prepared Hell for them – a woeful destination.

20 بالرحمن الضف بالله من نزل كتاب العدل احق  
ان يتبع افن لا يقدر ان ياتي باية و انه لو يقدر  
فكيف لم يرسل الى بمثل رقتي اليه و كتب بمثل  
ما سلك الرومي كانه لم يقرء كتاب تم و لا تنذر  
الا من اتبع الذكر و خشى الرحمن بالغيب فبشره  
بمغفرة و اجر كريم ثم قوله جل شأنه [ و لا ينبغي  
له الشعر ] فهيات هيات من الظايني بالله ظن  
السوء عليهم دائرة السوء و غضب الله عليهم و  
لعمهم و اعد لهم جهنم و ساءت مصيرا

- 21 This is a manifest matter – were anyone able to produce even a single verse, let him present it to me. The people are as dead, though they perceive it not. Look thou to God and His power, and turn away from all people. God knoweth this matter without doubt, and were He to know that I speak without His leave, He would create someone to stand against me and recite verses like mine to invalidate my proof. Nay, by thy Lord! God hath not created any learned one who doth not love these verses and proclaim His Cause, though the idolaters detest it.

21 و ان هذا امر ظاهر لو يقدر احد بايتان ايه ليرسلها  
الى و ان الناس اموات من حيث لا يشعرون  
انظر الى الله و قدرته و اعرض عن كل الناس  
لا شك ان الله يعلم ذلك الامر و لو علم اني  
اكتب بغير اذنه ليخلق بشرا يقوم معي و يقرء مثل  
اياي ليبتل حقي لا و ربك لما ما خلق الله بشر  
الا ديب انه يحب تلك الايات و يعلن امره و لو  
كره المشركون

- 22 Think not this is an easy matter. Nay, by thy Lord! God hath used similar proofs in the Qur'an. This is a matter that would render powerless all who are in the heavens and on earth, save whom God willeth.

22 و لا تزعم ان هذا امر سهل لا و ربك قد احتج  
الله بمثل ذلك في القران و ان هذا امر يعجز  
كل من في السموات و الارض الا من شاء الله

- 23 That group hath emerged from the abasement of mere words, for now the proof is in their hands through union, unlike the time of Ahmad and Kazim, God's mercy be upon them both. Though the corrupt ones seek to abase them today, they stand upon truth. Even if all should oppress them, they shall never be truly abased, for might belongeth unto God and unto all the believers.

23 و ان تلك الفتنه قد خرجوا من ذلة الكلام لان  
الآن كانت الحجّة في ايديهم بالفة و ليس بمثل زمن  
احمد و كاظم رحمة الله عليهما و لو ان اليوم ذلهم  
المفسدون ولكنهم على حق لو ظلموا كلهم لن  
يدلوا ابدا بحق و ان العزة لله ثم للمؤمنين جميعا

- 24 Whenever I raise my voice in the realm of heaven with words of praise, is there any challenger who would challenge me with clear verses like those whereby God formerly established the religion of His Messenger, peace be upon him and his family? None hath answered me, until my breast was straitened and my cries multiplied, as though every particle of dust I walked upon was proclaiming similar words, as if they were beings illumined by God's light.

24 و ان كلها ارفعت صوتي في جو العماء بتلك  
الكلمة الثناء فهل من مبارز يارزني بالايات  
البينات التي اثبت الله بها من قبل دين رسول  
الله صلى الله عليه و آله لم يجنى احد حتى ضاق  
صدرى و كثر ضجيجي كان ذرات تراب التي  
اني مشيت عليها كلهم يقولون بمثل تلك الكلمة  
كانهن حيوان من نور الله

- 25 And if anyone were in the field of utterance to challenge Me, let him arise with Me and bring down a book of justice with all his might. But since I have heard from no one, I am certain that all are powerless, confounded, and in denial. They can neither respond nor make excuses, nor do they find a way.
- 25 وان لو كان احد في ميدان البيان وما علمناه الشعر وما يتبعني له ان هو آلا ذكر و قرآن مبين يقدر ان يارزني لا شك ليقوم معي و ينزل مثل كتاب العدل في الات حربه و لما ما سمعت من احد ايقنت ان الكل قد عجزوا و بهتوا و كفروا و لا يقدر ان يجيبوا او يعتدوا و لا يهتدون سبيلا
- 26 Glory be to God! The Islamic clergy have fallen into such depths of ignorance as were not reached by Pharaoh of old nor by the pagan Arabs. For when Pharaoh sought to deny the proof of the Lord, he at least produced some sorcery, and the pagan Arabs would compose poems and display them around the House. But behold the condition of the clergy and the extent of their knowledge! Having failed in every way, they resort to slander, saying these verses do not follow the rules of the people and lack proper connection. May God destroy them! They are more astray than cattle.
- 26 فسبحان الله من علماء الاسلام لقد وقعوا انفسهم في مبلغ من الجهل ما بلغ فرعون من قبل و لا اعراب الجاهلية لان فرعون لما اراد ان ينكر حجة الرب ات بشئ من السحر و ان اعراب الجاهلية ينشأون قصايد و يظهرونها في حول البيت و ان العلماء ترى شانهم و مبلغ علمهم قلما عجزوا عن كل الجهات ليفترون و يقولون ان تلك الايات ما سطر بقواعد القوم و لا بينهما ربط بمثل ربط المعلوم قتلهم الله كأنهم اضل من الانعام
- 27 They said all this about the Qur'an before, and all perished and entered the fire of hell, and today they have no intercessor forever. Say: The abasement of this world is better than the punishment of the next, for one passes away while the other endures.
- 27 كل ذلك قالوا في القرآن من قبل و كل ما توا و دخلوا نار جهنم و لا اليوم لهم من شفيع ابد اقل ان ذلة الدنيا لاحسن من عذاب الاخرة لانه يتي و ذلك يفي
- 28 I have claimed neither authority nor its opposite, neither revelation nor the Qur'an. I have not opposed the Law by a single letter, nor have I broken any of it. Rather, these verses are a blessing from my Lord. I have spoken to people what God has permitted in the Qur'an, that God's religion might triumph over those Arabs who denied the Imams of Justice. Woe to those who know not God's purpose and spread corruption in the land without right, saying "We are but reformers!" Nay, they are the corrupters, but they perceive not.
- 28 و انا ما ادعيت الولاية و لا اخيتها و لا الوحي و الا القرآن و ما رذت على الشريعة حرفا و ما نقضت منها حرفا بل حبت بتلك الايات نعمة من ربّي و اني حدثت الناس بما اذن الله في القرآن ليظهر دين الله على الاعراب الذين كفروا بانهم العدل فويل للذين لا يعلمون مراد الله و يفسدون في الارض بغير حق و يقولون انا نحن مصلحون الا انهم هم المفسدون ولكنهم قوم لا يشعرون
- 29 By your Lord, most people know not the reality of this Cause, else they would have no escape but to acknowledge it, for they cannot establish any criterion except by that Balance. And by that Balance do I act, and I act only according to what has been revealed in the Law. I am upon truth, and none can say why or how, for whoever seeks to argue against this proof must doubt the proof of God's Messenger before, and whoever seeks to produce a verse has sought to war with God and His Messenger and deny the judgment of the Qur'an.
- 29 فو ربك ان اكثر الناس لا يعلمون حقيقة الامر و الا لا مفر لهم الا بالتصديق لانهم لم يقدر ان يثبتوا ميزانا الا بذلك القسطاس و اني بذلك القسطاس كما افعل و لا افعل الا بما نزل في الشريعة لكنك على حق و لا يقدر احد ان يقول لم و يم لان من اراد ان يتاقل في تلك الحجة فرض عليه بان يشك في حجة رسول الله صلى الله عليه و آله من قبل و ان اراد يؤتي باية فقد اراد ان يحارب مع الله و رسوله و يحجد حكم القرآن
- 30 Glory be to God! God is Most Great! What heedlessness has seized the people! God has taken them to a station where they

cannot reflect, much less deny, contemplate, slander or harm. O Lord! Judge between all with justice and hasten the days of meeting You, for people have become my enemies through evil thoughts. I am an enemy to all Your enemies and am innocent of them, as if I desired their station.

30 فسبحان الله الله اكبر من غفلة الناس قد اخذهم الله في مقام لم يقدروا ان يتأملوا فكيف ان يحجدوا [اذا] او يتفكروا او يفتروا او اذوا رب فاحكم بين الكل بالقسط و قرب ايام لقائك فان الناس عادوني بظن السوء و انا اعد و لا عدائك كلهم و برئ و منهم كافي اردت مقامهم

31 By Him in whose hand is my soul, if God were to subject all the kingdom of this world to me, it would not equal a single letter of these verses, nor a word glorifying before the Divine Majesty. The highest stations of this world are to me but like the wing of a dead gnat.

31 فوالذي نفسي بيده ان كل ملك الدنيا لو سخر الله لي لم يعدل بحرف من تلك الايات و لا كلمة تسبح في تلقاء الجلال و ليس لدي اعلی مقامات الدنيا الا بمثل جناح بعوضة ميتة

32 Know, O people, the truth of these days, for the sun has never risen upon their like. Aid God's Cause with your souls and wealth, revere it and honor it, and deprive not yourselves of your portion in this worldly life. For, if God wills, I shall assuredly ascend there; while ye shall say: "Alas for us, for how we have failed in our duty to God!" On this day no decree shall avail you; and when ye have died, unto God shall ye be gathered.

32 و اعرفوا يا ايها الناس حق تلك الايام فان الشمس ما طلعت عليها بمثلها فانصروا امر الله بانفسكم و اموالكم و وقروه و عزروه و لا تحرموا نصيبكم في الحيرة الدنيا فاني اذا شاء الله لا صعد اليه هنا لك انتم تقولون يا حسرتا على ما فرطنا في جنب الله و لا ينفعكم اليوم حكم و انتم اذ امتم الى الله لتحشرون

33 O inquirer! If you are among the people of justice, it is incumbent upon you to possess the Book of Justice and the Commentary on Kawthar, both written in the finest calligraphy and craftsmanship. No one is permitted other than excellent workmanship therein, and God knows all that people know. By Him Who created me! If God were to transform every atom within His knowledge into living beings and place in their hearts the hardness of the murderer of my grandfather Husayn, peace be upon him, and bestow upon them the power of all who are in the heavens and earth, and if they were to gather together with drawn swords to deny my proof and harm me, it would not diminish my certitude in the least. I would see them all in their falsehood as insignificant as the black spot in a mosquito's eye, for truth with its clear proof is in my hand. And if they should prevail through oppression, God would be my Consoler and Helper, and I would still triumph over them, even as it is revealed in the Qur'an: "God hath written, 'Verily I will prevail, I and My Apostles.' Verily God is Powerful, Mighty."

33 فيا ايها السائل ان كنت من اصحاب العدل حق عليك ان يكون عندك كتاب العدل ثم شرح الكوثر هم الالفين باحسن خط و صنع و لا اذن لاحد غير صنيع الحسن فيه و الله يعلم كل ما كان الناس من يعلمون فوالذي خلقتني لو جعل الله كل ذرات ما احاط عليه عبادا احياء و جعل [في] قساوة قلوبهم بمثل قاتل جدی الحسين عليه السلام و جعل قوتهم قوة من في السموات و الارض و انهم اجتمعوا بالسيوف المتلاء لمجدي و ضرى لم ينقص من يقيني بعض شئ و لا رى كلهم في مقال الباطل بمثل سواد عين بعوضه متية لان الحق بالحجة الواضحة في يدي و ان غلبت [بايديهم] فكان الله معزى و ناصرى و انى لكنت غالبا عليهم كما نزل في القرآن كتب الله لا غلبن انا و رسلى ان الله لقوى عزيز

34 Alas! Alas! What was to reach hath reached, what was to be prevented hath been prevented, what was to occur hath occurred, and what was to be cut off hath been cut off. We read His Book in every condition: "Nothing shall befall us save what God hath decreed for us. He is our Master, and on God

34 فاه آه بلغ ما بلغ و منع ما منع و وقع ما وقع و قطع ما قطع فانالله [3] اقرء كتابه في كل شأن لن يصيبنا الا ما كتب الله لنا هو مولينا و على الله فيتوكل المؤمنون حسبى الله لا اله الا هو عليه

let the believers rely.” God sufficeth me; there is no God but Him. In Him I have placed my trust, and He is the Lord of the mighty throne. And praise be to God, the Lord of all worlds.

توكلت و هو ربّ العرش العظيم و الحمد لله رب العالمين نفس منهم بظلم و اناذا

TZH3.402.15-405.13x

## BB00644

*To Mulla Ahmad Mu'allim Hisari*

1 In the name of God, the Most Merciful, the Most Compassionate

1 بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ الحمد

2 Praised be God – He Who commandeth no one to attain unto the recognition of the Dawning-Place of His own Essence, nor to make mention of the Presence of His Being, nor to celebrate the beauty of His Selfhood, nor to describe His “I-ness.” From everlasting He hath never conjoined His reality with created essences, nor hath He been described by names and attributes; for the Manifestation of His “I am” confesseth the incapacity of material things to utter His praise, and the Presence of His Essence forbiddeth created substances from attaining unto His knowledge. The splendor of His Selfhood hath cut off all contingent beings from certitude, and the exaltation of His Being is sanctified above the sensible attribution of existent things. Even as He is, He shall not be known by identity, nor described by oneness, nor indicated by self-subsistence, nor characterized by eternity; for the very essence of creation beareth witness to its severance from His description. How then can He, beside Whom in the beginning of beginnings there existed no peer, be said to be “He is He,” or “Thou art Thou”? Exalted and glorified is He beyond my power to reckon His praise, beyond my knowledge to comprehend His station; nor can any one affirm His oneness, nor attain unto His Presence. Even as He hath revealed in the Qur’an, in the station of exposition: “Vision perceiveth Him not, but He perceiveth all vision; and He is the Subtle, the All-Aware.”

2 اللَّهُ الَّذِي لَا يَأْمُرُ بِأَحَدٍ بِعَرَفَانِ طَلْعَةِ ذَاتِهِ وَلَا بِذِكْرِ حُضْرَةِ كَيُونِيَّتِهِ وَلَا بِثَنَاءِ جَمَالِ نَفْسَانِيَّتِهِ وَلَا بِوَصْفِ آيَاتِهِ إِذْ أَنَّهُ لَمْ يَزَلْ لَنْ يَقْرَنَ لِجَعْلِ الْجَوْهَرِيَّاتِ وَلَا يَوْصَفُ بِالْأَسْمَاءِ وَالصِّفَاتِ إِذْ طَلَعَتْ آيَاتُهُ مُعْتَرِفَةً بِالْمَادِيَّاتِ عَنِ الْبَيَانِ وَأَنَّ حُضْرَتَ ذَاتِيَّتِهِ مُمْتَنِعَةٌ الْجَوْهَرِيَّاتِ عَنِ الْعَرَفَانِ وَأَنَّ بَهَاءَ نَفْسَانِيَّتِهِ مُنْقَطِعَةٌ الْمَمَكَّاتِ عَنِ الْإِيقَانِ وَأَنَّ عُلُوَّ كَيُونِيَّتِهِ مُقَدَّسَةٌ عَنْ نَعْتِ الْمَوْجُودَاتِ بِالْعَيَانِ وَهُوَ كَمَا هُوَ عَلَيْهِ لَنْ يَعْرِفَ بِالْهُيُوتِ وَلَنْ يَوْصَفَ بِالْأَحَادِيَةِ وَلَنْ يُشِيرَ بِالصِّمْدَانِيَّةِ وَلَنْ يَنْعَتَ بِالْأَزَلِيَّةِ لِأَنَّ ذَاتِيَّةَ الْخَالِقِ بِنَفْسِهَا شَاهِدَةٌ بِالتَّقْطِيعِ عَنْ وَصْفِهِ فَكَيْفَ مِنْ لَا يَكُ فِي رَتَبَتِهِ شَيْءٌ فِي أَزْلِ الْأَزَالِ يُمْكِنُ أَنْ يُقَالَ أَنَّهُ هُوَ هُوَ أَوْ أَنَّهُ أَنْتَ أَنْتَ فَسُبْحَانَهُ وَتَعَالَى لَا أَحْصَى ثَنَاءَ نَفْسِهِ وَلَا أَعْلَمُ بِشَانِهِ وَلَا يَقْدِرُ أَحَدٌ أَنْ يُوحِدَ ذَاتَهُ وَلَا أَنْ يَعْرِفَ جَنَابَهُ وَهُوَ كَمَا نَزَلَ فِي الْقُرْآنِ فِي مَقَامِ الْبَيَانِ لَا يَدْرِكُهُ الْأَبْصَارُ وَهُوَ يَدْرِكُ الْأَبْصَارَ وَهُوَ اللَّطِيفُ الْخَبِيرُ

3 And I invoke blessings upon Muhammad, the Messenger of God, and thereafter upon His Family – His honored servants – who precede Him not in speech and act by His command; through the verses of the Godhead, the signs of the Realm of Might, the evidences of the Kingdom and the Dominion, and the true stations manifested within the materials of the human realm; and through the breaths made luminous in fragments of

3 وَ أَصَلَّى عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ثُمَّ عَلَى آلِ اللَّهِ عِبَادِهِ الْمَكْرُمُونَ الَّذِينَ لَا يُسَبِّقُونَهُمْ بِالْقَوْلِ وَ هُمْ بِأَمْرِهِ يَعْمَلُونَ بَايَاتِ الْأَوهُوتِ وَ عِلَامَاتِ الْجَبَرُوتِ وَ دَلَالَاتِ الْمَلِكِ وَ الْمَلَكُوتِ وَ الْمَقَامَاتِ الْحَقَّةِ فِي مَادِيَّاتِ النَّاسُوتِ وَ النِّفَعَاتِ [الْمُتَجِّ] الْمُتَجَلِّيَّةِ فِي

ruby, according to that which God hath known and ordained for them. Verily He is the Most High, the All-Thankful.

قطعات الياقوت بما علم الله وقدر في حقهم انه هو العلي الشكور

- 4 And I offer greeting unto Ahmad, from the shore of the right-hand Valley, in the blessed Spot, above the Ark of Testimony, on the right of the Fire; and unto Kazim, from the Tree of Sinai upon the dome of time, from the Dawning-Place of Oneness made manifest through the Being of Light; and unto the Hidden Name, the concealed and veiled, the secret and inscribed symbol – the fearful yet awaited, the renowned – who removeth from inner sight the clouds of light, who speaketh among men with the same authority as Sinai, and who judgeth by the leave of God between the faithful zealot and him veiled from light amid those dusky darknesses. O my Lord! Pour upon me patience, for Thou art indeed the Forgiving, the All-Thankful. And peace be upon those who followed Him beneath the sombre shadows of the Garden of Beauty, and within the effulgences of the Germ of the Paradise of Majesty, according to God's will at the beginning and at the end. Verily He is the Most High, the Exalted. We implore forgiveness through His Book, out of bounty; verily He is the Compassionate, the All-Forgiving.

4 ثم اسلم على احمد عن شاطئ وادي اليمين في البقعة المباركة فوق تابوت الشهادة عن يمين النار ثم على كاظم عن شجرة الطور على قبة الزمان من طلعة الاحدية المتجلية عن كينونية النور ثم على اسم المكنون المستور والرمز المستتر المسطور الخائف المرتقب المشهور الذي يكشف عن البصائر غمايم النور وينطق في الناس بمثل شأن الطور ويحكم باذن الله عن المؤمن الغيور والمحجوب عن النور في تلك الظلمات الديجور رب افرغ علي صبرا فانك انت الغفور الشكور ثم على الذين اتبعوه في ظلال مكتهرات افريدوس الجمال وفي تجليات جرسوم فردوس الجلال بما شاء الله في المبدء والمآل انه هو العلي المتعال نستغفر في كتابه جوداً انه هو الرحيم الغفار

- 5 And now – thy letter hath descended in the likeness of a lowly spirit; and by reason of that House, its decree is at this hour uplifted, as though it were a star that waneth not. That which once summoned utterance from the rising-places hath been eclipsed; that which dawned upon the lofty horizons hath withdrawn; and that which lay silent within the essences of beginnings hath spoken – crying aloud, humbled and imploring – calling: Where are the radiant lights upon the heights? Where is he who ascendeth unto the ladder of exaltations? Where is the shining one from the horizon of profit? Where is the one who uplifteth the useful from the depths of holiness and elevation?

5 و بعد فقد نزل كتابك بمثل روح خاشع و لما كان من ذلك البيت اصعد حكمه الآن كانه هو كوكب لايج فقد ما يستنطق في الطوالع و غاب ما يستشرق في افق الشواخ و نطق ما يضمن في جوهرات الطاليع كانه يضح و يخشع ثم ينادي فاين اللوامع في الشواخ و اين الرافع الى معراج الدواخ و اين الساطع عن افق النافع و اين الرافع النافع في حضيض القدس و الروافع

- 6 O thou trustworthy and lowly seeker! God hath confirmed thee by that which He bestowed upon thee of His grace, and hath raised thee, His servant, unto His presence. Thy letter I read aforetime and answered thee with a prayer, declaring that the unseen belongeth unto God, and that I of myself know nothing in the heavens nor on the earth save as God willeth. Abide, then, within the House, and sorrow not.

6 فيا ايها السائل الامين الخاشع وفقك الله بما اتاك من فضله و ارفعك عبد الى جواره قد قرئت كتابك من قبل و اجبتك في دعاء بان الغيب لله و اتنى انا لا اعلم شيئاً في السموات و لا في الارض الا اذا شاء الله و اصبر في البيت و لا تحزن

- 7 Now have I read thy letter anew and discerned what thou didst intend in the path of religion concerning the knowledge of the Kaf. Know thou that the Kaf is the appearance of the effulgences of the Ha in the grades of the oneness of Essence, of attributes, of acts, and of worship. In every state it turneth

7 ثم قرئت كتابك الآن و عرفت ما اردت في منهاج الدين من علم الكاف فاعرف ان الكاف هو ظهور تجليات الهاء في مراتب توحيد الذات و الصفات و الافعال و العبادة لانه هو في كل شأن

upon itself and draweth sustenance from itself by itself – not from aught else – after the manner of itself; for God created the Will by itself, from nothing, without cause other than itself. It moveth upon itself with the motion of succession unto itself – not upon its Lord – from the beginning without beginning: first, the causalities of agency in the essences; then the material causalities in being; thereafter the formal causalities in selfhood; and finally the final causalities in identity – according to that which God's knowledge hath encompassed. And with a motion other than succession, for the existence of the many from the infinite unto the finite, in both stations doth the Kaf – which is the rank of the Will – revolve upon itself, receiving in every moment its aid from God, not from aught else: by itself, for itself, from itself. God sustaineth it by itself, for itself, from nothing else – even as He created it on the first day without cause beyond itself, and without any mention equal to it.

- 8 If thou wouldst apply the revolution of the Kaf to the totalities of the eightfold chain, thou wouldst be right; and likewise in particulars thou wouldst be truthful – even unto the ink itself – for it, too, turneth like the Kaf upon itself and speaketh of the Greatest Depth whereunto God revealed Himself. Recognize, then, the truth of that elixir; quicken thereby whatsoever thou desirest; behold that interpretation in the creation of the heavens and the earth; and let thy heart be at rest in the existence of Being, without distinguishing the absent from the present. This allusion sufficeth thee upon the path of exposition by way of union in summary. And shouldst thou love the path of separation in detail, drawn from the splendors of majesty, then consider what We have revealed in the commentary on al-Kawthar; for it is indeed the Water of Life that issueth from the Fountain of Salsabil, drawing the signs unto the court of nearness and beauty – without mention and without proof.

- 9 Yet I counsel thee: rejoice not at the confirmation of any from among the people of perfection, nor be grieved at the denial of any from among the people of idle talk. We have known the way of all: whoso willeth, let him believe; and whoso willeth, let him disbelieve. God, thy Lord, is verily the Self-Sufficient, the Most Exalted. And as to what thou hast mentioned of fear of the people – leave them to their plunging; turn not toward them; sorrow not over the deeds of the disputers. Study the verses of the knowledge of Majesty; for today there is no escape for him whom God willeth – and for His loved ones – save to enter that House. Be not heedless of the fruits of the Tree of Justice, nor of the ordinances of the Household; deal kindly in their laws; forget not their command. Convey from Me greetings unto them; and say to her who did well in

يدور على نفسه ويستمدد المدد من نفسه بنفسه لا من شيء بمثل نفسه لا من شيء لأن الله خلق المشية بنفسها لا من شيء ولا علة لها دون نفسها وهي تدور على نفسها بحركة التوالى له لا [على ربها في ازل الازال تجليات علل الفاعلية في الذاتيات ثم علل المادية في الكينونيات ثم علل الصودية في النفسانيات ثم علل الغائية في الانيات على ما احاط علم الله سبحانه وبحرمة غير التوالى لوجود الكثرات من اللاتهايات الى النهايات وفي كلتا المقامين يدور الكاف الذي هو رتبة المشية على نفسها يستمدد المدد في كل حين من الله لا من شيء بنفسها لنفسها عن نفسها وان الله يمدّها بنفسها لنفسها لا من شيء كما خلقها يوم الاول بلا علة دونها ولا ذكر يعادلها

- 8 و أنك لو اردت ان تصرف دوران الكاف في كليّات سلسلة الثمانية لحق بل في الجزئيات لمصدق حتى في ذلك المداد لانه يدور بمثل الكاف على نفسه ويحكي عن عمق الاكبر الذي تجلّى الله له به فاعرف حتى ذلك الاكسير و احى به كل ما اردت و شاهد ذلك التاويل بمثل خلق السموات والارض و اطمئن قلبك بوجود الوجود من دون ان يعرف المفقود عن الوجود و كفاك تلك الاشارة في سبيل الحكاية على منهج الوصل بالاجمال و ان تحب منهج الفصل بالتفصيل من سبحات الجلال فانظر فيما زلنا في شرح الكوثر فانه هو الماء الحيوان الذي يخرج [بخروج] عن عين السلسبيل و يجذب الاشارات الى ساحة القرب و الجمال [بدون ذكر ولا دليل]

- 9 ولكن اوصيك ألا تفرح بتصديق احد من اهل الكمال ولا تكذب نفس من اهل القيل والقال فانا عرفنا الكل سبيلهم فمن شاء ان يؤمن ومن شاء فليكفروا ان الله ربك هو الغني المتعال و ان ما اشرت من خوف الناس ذرهم في خوضهم و لا تلتفت اليهم و لا تحزن باعمال اصحاب الجدل و ادرس بايات علم [الجمال] الجلال فان اليوم لا مفر لمن اراد الله و اوليائه الا و ان يدخل في ذلك البيت عليك و لا تغفل من ثمرات شجرة العدل و لا حكم اهل البيت و احسن في احكامهم و لا تنس امرهم و سلم مني عليهم و قل للتي احسنت عملها قد علمت بما ارسلت في سبيل الله

her deed: I have known that which thou didst send, in the path of God, of the holy earth and the pure perfume; God willing, when it reacheth Us, We shall send thee of the purified clay whatsoever thou desirest. Fear God and be patient; verily God is the Truth, Possessor of the Glorious Throne. And as for that which thou desirest in the path of God – be patient, and depart not from that House until We command one of the leaders of that company to enter it by God's leave.

- 10 It is incumbent upon thee and upon all who follow Me to visit the Imams of Justice – there is from Me a right – then the resting-place of Kazim, peace be upon him, so long as the Sun of creation riseth by creation and the sun of invention setteth by invention. Observe the ordinance of prudent dissimulation; write of that which the people do upon that land in matters of essential geometry and accidental affairs. Greet the community of the Shi'ah; and say unto 'Ali: We sent unto thee a Book before; and unto Ibrahim, in that which was revealed in the first Book; and greet him again in that which hath been revealed secondly from His presence. Greet the people of justice; preserve their names; greet the beneficent one in the Sanctuary of Moses, peace be upon him; then Bashir in the Sanctuary of 'Ali, peace be upon him; and greet those who followed Me. Verily God blesseth you, and the angels of the heavens and the Throne also, saying: Give thanks unto God, and say: Praise be to God, the Lord of the worlds.

من التربة المقدسة والعطر الخالص فانشاء الله اذا بلغ اليانا نرسل اليك من الطين المطهرة ما اردت ان اتقين الله واصبري فان الله هو الحق ذو العرش المجيد وان ما اردت في سبيل الله فاصبر ولا تخرج من تلك البيت حتى تأمر باحد من رؤساء تلك الفئة بان يدخل البيت باذن الله

10 و عليك و على كل من اتبعني حق بان يزور ائمة العدل هنا لك متى ثم مرقد كاظم سلام الله عليه بما طلعت شمس الابداع بالابداع و بما غربت شمس الاختراع بالاختراع و انت راقب حكم التقية و اكتب [لمن] ما يعمل الناس على تلك الارض من الهندسة الجهرية و الشئون العرضية و سلم على معشر الشيعة و قل لعل نزلنا اليك كتابا من قبل ثم الى ابراهيم بما نزل كتاب اوله و انت سلم عليه مما نزل على ثانيا من عنده ثم الى اصحاب العدل و احفظ اسمائهم و سلم على المحسن في حرم موسى عليه السلام ثم على بشير في حرم علي عليه السلام ثم على الذين اتبعوني فان الله يصلي عليكم ثم ملائكة السموات و العرش ان اشكروا الله و قولوا ان الحمد لله رب العالمين

INBA\_5019C:275-279

## BB00477

To: Azim

Date: 1262 [1845-1846]

- 1 In the Name of the Exalted, the Most Great.

- 2 Praise be to God Who sendeth down the Book unto whomsoever He willeth among His servants. Verily, there is no God but Him, the Mighty, the Wise. We have indeed read the books that were sent down unto Us, and We bear witness to what transpireth upon the earth, and God is the All-Knowing, the All-Informed. Say: For whomsoever it hath been sent down this day, permitted unto thee is the food of those who have disbelieved among the People of the Book. If thou art able

1 ... بسمه العلي العظيم

2 الحمد لله الذي نزل الكتاب على من يشاء من عباده و انه لا اله الا هو لعزیز حکیم و لقد قرئنا كتب التي نزلت اليانا و انا نحن نشهد لما يحدث في الارض و الله خبير عليم قل لمن نزل اليوم حلّ عليك طعام الذين كفروا من اهل الكتاب ان استطعت ان تصلح ما يفسد الناس و لكن قل اتقوا الله الا تحدث فتنة بما اردت فانا نحن

to set aright what people corrupt - yet say: Fear ye God lest tribulation arise through what thou hast intended, for We this day were among the fearful. And indeed the Book which he sent down hath been revealed, and if God had willed He would have made firm his heart upon a straight path. We have read the book of Joseph and then his brother.

اليوم كما خائفين ولقد نزل كتاب الذي ارسله و  
ان الله لو شاء ليثبت قلبه على صراط مستقيم و  
لقد قرئنا كتاب يوسف ثم اخيه

- 3 Say: Work ye in the religion of God, for this is the path of God in the heavens and on earth, calling the people unto the decree of a manifest balance. Verily I desired not to call thee, but for all things there is an appointed time. I have sought forgiveness for him who desired in the Book, and at night I desired to attend their house, but God ordained not a known decree. Therefore intercede for whomsoever desireth the religion of God and fear not, for verily We shall overtake them. We have read the book of the land of Sad.

3 قل اعملوا في دين الله فان هذا صراط الله  
في السموات و الارض يدعو الناس الى حكم  
قسطاس مبين و انني انا ما اردت دعوتك و  
لكن لكل شيء اجل مكتوب ولقد استغفرت  
للذي اراد في الكتاب و ان الليل اردت ان  
احضر بيتهم و لكن الله لم يقضي لحكم معلوم  
فاشفع لمن اراد دين الله و لا تخف فانا نحن  
لمدركون ولقد قرئنا كتاب ارض الصاد

- 4 Say: Attend thou the throne of the remembrance of thy Lord's name, for God preserveth what He willeth by His command, and He is verily the Strong, the Mighty. Write thou unto whomsoever desireth the decree, and follow the remembrance of him who followeth God's command and performed pilgrimage to the Sacred House. When thou hearest the decree of justice, verily the decree of the oppressors this day shall diminish. Greet the servants who follow God's command and say: Be ye patient, for soon shall I sit before you if ye fear God, and say: Praise be to God, the Lord of the worlds. And verily on the night of the middle hath been sent down the book of the letters of the countenance.

4 قل احضر عرش ذكر اسم ربك فان الله يحفظ ما  
يشاء بامرته و انه لقوي عزيز و اكتب لمن اراد  
الحكم فاتبع ذكر من اتبع امر الله و حج بيت الحرام  
اذا سمعت حكم العدل فان اليوم حكم الظالمين  
لمنقوص و سلم عباد الذين اتبعوا امر الله و قل  
اصبروا فسوف اقع بين ايديكم ان اتقوا الله و قولوا  
ان الحمد لله رب العالمين و لقد نزل ليلة النصف  
كتاب احرف الوجه

- 5 Say: God forgiveth the believing men and believing women among thy kindred, and verily there is no God but Him, the Lord of mighty grace.

5 قل الله يغفر للمؤمنين و المؤمنات من ذي قرابتك  
و انه لا اله الا هو ذو فضل عظيم

CMB\_F20.014r07-014v03, BYC\_tablets.069.15-  
070.13

## BB00585

To: Azim

Date: 1262 [1845-1846]

- 1 In the Name of the Most High, the Most Great

1 ... بسمه العلي العظيم

2 الحمد لله الذي يمن على من يشاء بامرته قل ان  
العاقبة للمتقين

- 2 Praise be to God Who bestows His favor upon whomsoever He willeth through His command. Say: The end belongs to the God-fearing.
- 3 We have indeed read the letter which thou didst send down by God's leave, and We have learned of the mention of the name of Abraham and then of him who sent down the oil. Say: God will recompense the doers of good.
- 4 And verily what was said regarding Moses in the Qur'an is the truth, and in like manner God, thy Lord, doth teach His servants who are possessed of certitude. Say to those who desire to strike thee for love of the mention of God's name: Strike ye him who hath come between the people, and be patient, for unto everything there is an appointed time.
- 5 Send some copies to that land and say to those who follow Me: Fear ye God and be patient and say: Praise be to God, the Lord of the worlds.
- 3 ولقد قرئنا كتاب الذي نزلته باذن الله وعلينا بذكر اسم ابراهيم ثم بمن نزل الدهن قل ان الله يجزي المحسنين
- 4 وان ما قال في ذكر موسى في القرآن لحق و ان بمثل ذلك فليعلم الله ربك عباده الموقنين قل للذين يريدون ان يضربوك لحب ذكر اسم الله ان اضربوا من حال بين الناس واصبروا فان لكل اجل مكتوب
- 5 ان ارسل بعض النسخ الى تلك الارض و قل للذين اتبعوني ان اتقوا الله واصبروا و قولوا ان الحمد لله رب العالمين

CMB\_F23.133v05-133v12 (36), CMB\_F20.014v05-014v10, BYC\_tablets.070.15-071.03

## BB00548

To: Azim ?

Date: 1262 [1845-1846]

- 1 He is the Mighty
- 2 Praise be to God Who aideth with His victory whomsoever He willeth among His servants. Rejoice and be patient, for the end belongeth to the God-fearing.
- 3 We have now sent down unto you this letter. Conceal the Cause of God and follow His decree that ye may prosper. Fear God and mention not your own conjectures regarding the religion of God, and be of the people who possess knowledge.
- 4 We have commanded in this letter that Taqi and then Ali should present themselves before the one possessed of manifest wisdom when He summoneth you according to God's decree. Be ye among those who preserve the Cause.
- 5 And We have commanded the one who readeth this letter unto you both with commandments in the religion of God. When
- 1 ... هو العزيز
- 2 الحمد لله الذي يؤيد بنصره من يشاء من عباده ان ابشروا واصبروا فان العاقبة للمتقين
- 3 ولقد نزلنا الان اليكم ذلك الكتاب ان اكنتموا امر الله و اتبعوا حكمه لعلكم تفلحون ان اتقوا الله و لا تذكروا ظن انفسكم في دين الله و كونوا من قوم عالمين
- 4 ولقد امرنا في الكتاب لتقي ثم علي ان احضرا بين يدي ذي حكم مبين اذا ارادكما بحكم الله و كونا من قوم من قوم حافظين
- 5 ولقد امرنا من يقرء ذلك الكتاب عليكم باحكام في دين الله اذا امركما بامر فاعلموا انه ما ينطق الا

He commandeth you with a command, know that He speaketh naught except by My command. Preserve the Cause of God and make peace with Him. Be not heedless of dissension and wait, for We are waiting.

بأمرى واحفظا أمر الله وأصلحوا معه ولا تغفلا  
من الفتنة وارقبوا فانا كما مرتقبين

- 6 Say: Fear God, O concourse, and doubt not in the Cause of God after ye have believed in it. O Ali, thou trusted one, extend greetings to those servants who follow Me and say: Give thanks unto God for having guided you and say: All praise be to God, the Lord of the worlds.

6 قل ان اتقوا الله يا ايها الملا ولا تشكوا في امر الله  
بعد ما انتم به مؤمنون علي ايها الامين سلم عباد  
الذين اتبعوني وقل اشكروا الله كما هداكم وقولوا  
ان الحمد لله رب العالمين

CMB\_F23.132v03-132v12 (32), CMB\_F20.013v16-  
014r05, BYC\_tablets.069.05-069.13

## BB00121

*Prayer for Haji Isma'il*

*Date: 1262 [1845-1846]*

- 1 In the Name of God, the All-Merciful, the Compassionate.

1 بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

- 2 Praise be to God Who created me by His behest, then nourished me through His bounty, then gave me to eat after I hungered. There is no God but He, the Almighty, the All-Wise.

2 الحمد لله الذي خلقني بأمره ثم رزقني بفضله ثم  
أطعمني من جوع لا اله الا هو العزيز الحكيم

- 3 O my God! How shall I call upon Thee, when the utmost end of my supplication returns unto my own soul, plaintive over the vile deeds I have wrought? And how shall I not call upon Thee, when my heart hath been ever enraptured with Thy love, unable to endure Thy separation, to be silent from communion with Thee, or to remain far from the seats of Thy nearness?

3 يا الهى كيف ادعوك وان متتهى دعائى يرجع  
الى نفسى شاكيا من قبيح ما عملت لا ادعوك  
وان قلبي كان متيمما بحبك لا يزال ولا يقدر ان  
يصبر بفراقك ولا الصمت عن مناجاتك ولا  
البعد عن مقاعد قربك

- 4 O my God! Thou art the Beloved, there is none besides Thee, and Thou art the Intended One, there is none other than Thee. I have known Thee through Thee and called upon Thee through Thy love for me. Were it not for Thee, I would be nothing, neither could I remember Thee, nor drink from the pure wine of Thy love, nor dwell in the precincts of Thy bounty, nor be established upon the throne of Thy sovereignty, nor mention Thy favors before Thy favored servants.

4 فيا الهى انت المحبوب لا سواك وانت المقصود  
لا دونك عرفتك بك ودعوتك بحبك لى لو  
لا انت لم اك شيئا ولا ادر ذكرتك ولا اشرب  
من صافى محبتك ولا اسكن فى جوار كرامتك  
ولا استقر على كرسي سلطنتك ولا اذكر الا لك  
بين يدي عبادك المقربين

- 5 All good is from Thee and in Thy grasp. From the first day Thou didst honor me with every favor, with the sweetness of Thy remembrance and the beauty of Thy beneficence. Thou art God, there is none other God save Thee. Thy handiwork

5 فيا الهى كل الخير منك وبيدك وانت قد  
اكرمتنى كل الاثك فى يوم الاول بلذيد ذكرك  
وجميل احسانك انت الله لا اله الا

hath ever been perfect, Thy generosity forever all-embracing. If I say, "I praise Thee," in that same moment it is Thy remembrance that enables me to praise Thee, and Thy mercy that encompasses me, and Thy bounties that surround me; for hadst Thou not remembered me, I had not remembered Thee; and hadst Thou not shown me gratitude, I had not shown Thee thanks; and hadst Thou not unveiled Thyself to me according to Thy Will, the core of my heart had not found rest in the presence of Thy Self-Sufficiency. Thy justice hath, from everlasting, encompassed me; Thy trials abide within my inmost being; the chastisement of Thy equity hath, before now and at every moment, stood before mine eyes.

- 6 Alas! Alas! Shouldst Thou will my punishment, or desire my chastisement, or resolve to call me to account, or determine to seize me – glorified art Thou, glorified art Thou! – then, when I behold Thy dealings with Thy sincere and unified servants, my heart is set at rest, my breast is emptied of disquiet, my secret is stilled, and my soul entreateth Thee: "O my God, admit me to Thy neighborhood among the near ones; cheer me with the meeting with Thee among the triumphant; give me to drink the water of Thy mercy from the goblet of Thy care among the pure in heart; and honor me with Thy favors among the faithful." Verily, Thou art God, my Lord and the Lord of all the worlds.

- 7 But when I behold Thy vengeance upon the idolaters, the pillars of my heart are shaken; the very flesh within my breast is confounded; my skin shuddereth; my eyes and bowels weep; and my inmost being crieth out: "How could I enter the fire? And if I were to endure therein, how could I endure to be parted from the meeting with my Lord?" Nay, by His might! I have no endurance, nor can I bear it. And if Thou dost cast me therein, I shall cry out among its folk such cries as shall cause them all to gasp; I shall burn therein in such wise that the people of torment shall be struck down; and I shall cry: "O my Lord, my Master, my God! Thou art independent of my punishment; I am poor for Thy good-pleasure and Thy forgiveness. If Thou forgivest me and deliverest me from the fire, naught of Thy dominion is diminished; and if Thou feedest me with the fruits of Thy Paradise, naught in the heavens and the earth addeth aught to Thee." I am he who is afflicted by his sin, O my God; I am he who confesseth his trespasses, O my Master; I am the negligent, the derelict, who felt no shame before Thee in solitude, nor watched for Thee in the assembly.

أَنْتَ صَنَعْتَ لَمْ يَزَلْ تَأْمُ وَ كَرَامَتِكَ لَا تَزَالُ عَامٌّ  
إِنْ قُلْتُ أَحْمَدُكَ فَفِي الْحَيْنِ اذْكُرْنِي ذِكْرَكَ وَ  
وَسَعْنِي رَحْمَتِكَ وَ احَاطَتْنِي الْآثَانُ لَأَنَّكَ لَوْ لَمْ  
تَذْكُرْنِي لَمْ أَذْكُرْكَ وَ لَوْ لَمْ تُشْكِرْنِي لَمْ أَشْكُرْكَ وَ لَوْ  
لَا تَجَلَّيْتُ لِي تَلْقَاءَ مَشِيَّتِكَ لَمْ أَسْكُنْ فَوَادِي فِي  
تَلْقَاءَ صِدَائِيَّتِكَ اذْ عَدْلُكَ لَمْ يَزَلْ قَدْ احَاطَنِي وَ  
بَدَائِكَ لَا يَزَالُ فِي كِبْدِي وَ عَذَابُ عَدْلِكَ مِنْ  
قَبْلُ وَ فِي كُلِّ حَيْنٍ فِي عَيْنِي

6 فَاه آه ان انت تريد عذابي او انت تريد عقابي او  
انت تريد ان تحاسبني او انت تريد ان تؤاخذني  
فسبحانك سبحانك لما انظر الى معاملتك مع  
عبادك الموحدين يستقر فؤادي و يفرغ قلبي و  
يسكن سري و تدعوك نفسي بانك يا الهى  
ادخلني في جوارك مع المقربين و انسني بلقائك  
مع الفائزين و اشربني ماء رحمتك في كأس  
عنايتك مع المخلصين و اكرمني بالآياتك مع  
المؤمنين انك انت الله ربى و رب العالمين

7 و اذا شاهد نعماتك مع المشركين تزلزل اركان  
قلبي و تبلبل لحم القلب في كبدى و اقشعر بذلك  
جلدى و تفيض من عيني و معى و تنادى سري  
كيف ادخل في النار و ان اصبر فيها فكيف اصبر  
عن لقاء ربى لا و عزته لا صبر لى و لا اصبر  
فيها و ان ادخلني للنعر؟ بين اهل النار نعرانا  
ليشبهن من في النار كلهم و نضجن بين اهلها على  
شأن ليعصقن من في العذاب اجمعهم و انادى  
يا ربى و مولائى و الهى انك غنى عن عذابي و  
انا فقير الى رضوانك و غفرانك ان تغفر لى و  
تخرجنى من النار لن ينقص من ملكك شئ  
و ان اطعمتنى آلاء فردوسك لن ينفعك في  
السّموات و الارض شئ انا المبتلى بذنبى يا الهى  
و انا المعترف بخطيئاتى يا مولائى و انا المقصر  
المفرط الذى لا استحييت عنك في خلأ و لا  
أراقبك في ملأ

- 8 I am he who disobeyed Thee after Thou hadst made me to know Thy vengeance; who sinned in Thy presence, though aware that Thou seest me and beholdest my station. I am he who waxed heedless of the stations of them who draw nigh, though not even for a fleeting moment didst Thou withhold from me Thy promptings, Thy attracting breath, Thy sweet savors, and the tokens of Thy intimacy.
- 9 With what tongue, then, shall I confess my sin? With what eye shall I read my offences inscribed in the scrolls of the angels, before Thy face? With what pen shall I record my deeds? With what heart shall I survey my trespasses while life yet remaineth in me? Hallowed be Thy Name, hallowed be Thy Name!
- 10 Thou knowest, O my God, my condition; Thou lookest upon my misdeeds; Thou countest my works. I am he who banished his own self from Thy neighborhood; I am he who debarred himself from the meeting with Thee; I am he who, through ignorance, turned away from Thy promises. I bartered the life of the hereafter for this first life that perisheth; I busied myself with its trappings and adornments after I had read in Thy Book the bounties of Thy Paradise and heard from Thy near ones that "they who purchase the life of this world with the hereafter – their chastisement shall not be lightened, nor shall they be helped."
- 11 Alas! Alas! I am he who offended the Lord of heaven and earth; I am he who transgressed against the King of Paradise and the Throne; I am he who denied the signs of the All-Compelling, Lord of the kingdom of the heavens and the earth. I am he who repented unto my Lord, then sinned again; who sought Thy forgiveness, then relapsed; who lamented his crimes, then returned unto them. I yearned for Thy unity, yet by that very yearning I recalled my own self in the presence of Thy wrath; I desired to worship Thee, and thereby I set my soul before Thy might; I sought to remember Thee, and my remembrance proved but a remembrance of myself, veiling me from Thy Countenance; I would exalt Thy holiness, and thus I likened Thee to an attribute of Thy creatures; I would proclaim Thy transcendence, and thus I described Thee with what ill befitteth Thy sanctity in the realm of Thy might. I would glorify Thee, yet by my glorification I ascribed a partner to Thee – after Thou hadst taught me that none describeth Thee but Thyself, none knoweth Thee save Thee, none can conjoin with Thy Essence, none comprehend the core of Thy Being; that Thou canst not be worshipped by a selfhood like mine, nor pointed to by an identity such as mine; that naught can
- 8 انا الذي عصيتك بعد ما عرفتني نعماتك و انا الذي اذنبت بين يديك بعد ما اعلم انك ترائي و تشهد مقامي و انا الذي غفلت عن مقامات المقربين بعد ما لا ترفع عني لمح الهامك و لا جدائيتك و لا نفحاتك و لا آيات انسك
- 9 فيا الهى باي لسان اذكر ذنبي و باي عين اقرء خطيئاتي في صحف الملائكة بين يديك و باي قلم اكتب اعمالى و باي قلب اطلع بخطيئاتي و كنت حيانا فسبحانك سبحانك
- 10 يا الهى انك تعلم مقامى و تطلع بجزيراتي و تحصى اعمالى انا الذي بعد نفسي عن جوارك و انا الذي حرمت نفسي عن لقاءك و انا الذي نظرت بجهلى عن مواعيدك و انا الذي اشتريت حيوه الآخرة بالاولى التي لا بقاء لها و اشتغلت بالآنها و زخرتها بعد ما قرئت في كتابك آلاء فردوسك و سمعت عن المقربين من عبادك ان الذي اشتروا الحيوه الدنيا بالآخرة لم يخفف عنهم العذاب و لا هم ينصرون
- 11 فاه آه انا الذي عصيت جبار السموات و الارض و انا الذي اجترحت على ملكي الفردوس و العرش و انا الذي بجدت آيات قهار من في ملكوت السموات و الارض و انا الذي تبنت الى ربى ثم عصيت و انا الذي استغفرت الى الله ثم عدت و انا الذي ندمت عن جزيراتي ثم رجعت اليها و انا الذي اردت توحيدك و بذلك ذكرت نفسي لقاء قهاريتك و انا الذي اردت عبادتك و بذلك ذكرت نفسي لقاء جبروتيتك و انا الذي اردت ذكرك و بذلك كنت ذا كرفسي من حيث تحجب عن وجهك و انا الذي اردت تقديسك و بذلك اقرنك بوصف من خلقك و انا الذي اردت تنزيهك و بذلك اصفك بما لا يليق بجلالتك في لقاء قدس عزتك و انا الذي اردت تسبيحك و بذلك نعتك ؟ و اشركت ؟ بك بعد ما عرفتني نفسك بانك لن توصف

match the majesty of Thy Will, nor any thing depart from the beauty of Thy Self-Sufficiency.

بغيرک و لن تعرف بسواک و لن يقارن احد  
ذاتيتک و لن يدرك احد کنه کينويتک و لن  
تعبد بحق نفسايتک و لن تشير بعز انيتک ؟ و  
لن يعادل شيء جلال مشيتک و لن يفارق شيء  
جمال صمدايتک

- 12 Glorified art Thou! I would intend Thy praise, yet by so doing I rehearsed for Thee the qualities of Thy creation, after Thou hadst taught me that Thou hast eternally been without the mention of aught, and wilt forever be without the description of aught; that Thou hast, from everlasting, been such that naught ascendeth unto Thee; and wilt, unto everlasting, remain such that naught is lifted up unto Thee; that the ultimate goal of such as seek Thee leadeth back to the station of Thy origination; that the end of the journey of the unitarians halteth before the beauty of Thy splendor; that the highest essences of being, in the days of their ascent, are returned unto the court of Thy invention; and that the loftiest summits of possibles revolve, like unto the letter Kaf about itself, when they intend Thy gate, and descend into the abyss of the ocean of Thy signs.

فسبحانک سبحانک و انا الذي اردت تعجيدک  
و بذلك ذكرت اوصاف الخلق لنفسک بعد ما  
علمتني بانک لم تزل كنت بلا ذکر شيء و لا تزال  
تكون بلا وصف شيء و انک كنت کائناً لم تزل  
لن يصعد اليک شيء و انک قائم لا تزال لن يرفع  
اليک شيء و ان منتهى مقصد الطالبين يرجع الى  
مقام ابداعک و ان منتهى سير الموحدين يتوقف  
في تلقاء جمالک و ان اعلى جواهر الموجودات  
يرجع في ايام صعودهم الى مقام اختراعک و ان  
اجل شواخ الممکات تدور بمثل الکاف على نفسه  
اذا اراد بابک و ينزل الى قعر طمطام آياتک

- 13 Glorified art Thou! I would assert Thy oneness, yet by that claim I regarded my own self in the presence of the majesty of Thy singleness – after Thou hadst inspired me that unity cannot be established by the twofold realm of mention; that the word of justice cannot be contained within the two names; that the mystery of meeting cannot be mirrored in two mirrors; that Thou art too exalted to be known by Thy creation, or described by Thy servants, or indicated by Thy signs, or affirmed in Thine indivisible unity by aught that is of Thy Names. Thou art He Who, in the pre-eternal eternity, is unknowable; in the flux of time, indescribable; unto Whom no sign may be lifted; upon Whom no token may bear testimony; Whose essential mirror no thing can confront; from Whose essential justice no thing can depart – inasmuch as Thou hast manifested Thyself unto them in the realm of indication, descended upon them from the heaven of signs, looked upon them in the kingdom of the Cloud, of the Names and the Attributes, with a gaze no one among the denizens of endless realms and hallowed veils can compass.

فسبحانک سبحانک و انا الذي اردت  
توحيدک و بذلك نظرت الى نفسي في تلقاء عز  
وحدانيتک بعد ما اهتمتني بان التوحيد لن يثبت  
في الذکرين و ان كلمة العدل لن تدل في الاسمين  
و ان سر اللقاء لن يحكى في المرأتين و انک اجل  
من ان تعرف بخلقک او ان توصف بعبادک او  
ان تشير اليک بآياتک او ان اوحدک بوصف  
من اسمائک انت الذي لن تعرف في ازل الازال  
و لن توصف فيما يزمن من الاحداث و لن يرفع  
اليک شيء من الدلالات و لن يحكى عليك  
شيء من العلامات و لن يقدر ان يقابل شيء  
مرآة کينويتک و لا ان يفارق عدل ذاتيتک  
بما تجليت له في صقع الدلالات و نزلت عليه في  
سما العلامات و نظرت اليه في ملکوت العماء  
و الاسماء و الصفات حيث لا يحيط ان يطلع بها  
احد من اهل الانهايات و السبحات

- 14 Glorified art Thou! I would magnify Thy Self, yet thereby I made small Thy greatness, reducing it to a thing my feeble soul can behold – weak is the seeker and the Sought! Woe is

فسبحانک سبحانک يا الهی و انا الذي اردت  
تكبير نفسك و بذلك صغرت عظمتک و

me for that which I have accounted of Thy majesty: my soul is lowly, my vision paltry. How, then, can I extol the grandeur of Thy glory with the weakness of my soul and the littleness of my deeds? Thou alone canst know the greatness of Thine own Self; for all besides Thee – what is the utmost of their portion save the point of denial? what is the farthest reach of their favor save the point of severance? – are, and all they conceive of magnifying Thy majesty is, small before Thy glory and naught before Thy beauty.

جعلتُ عظمتك شيئاً ما تراها نفسى ضعف  
الطالب والمطلوب فالويل لى وما جعلته عن  
كبريائك نفسى ضعيف وما ترى اصغر عنها  
فكيف اكبر جلال عظمتك بضعف نفسى و  
صغر آثارى انت الذى لن يقدر ان يعرف عظمة  
نفسك احد سواك اذ ما سواك مبلغ حظهم  
قد كان من نقطة المنع وان انتهى مبلغ فضلهم  
قد كان من نقطة القطع وانهم وما يدركون من  
تعظيم كبريائك صغير عند جلالك ومعدوم  
عند جمالك

- 15 I know not, O my God, how it is that I stand a stranger before Thee, addressing Thee with such words that, were any other to comprehend them, he would say of me what ‘Ali, son of al-Husayn – Thy Proof, son of Thy Proof – said regarding one in his day; or, should I attain the court of Thy nearness and drink of the cup of Thy sweetness, I find myself unable to ascribe aught to Thee: if I would glorify Thee, the bounds of my being rebuke me; if I would sanctify Thee, the limits of my station strike fear into me; if I would affirm Thy unity, my estate chastiseth me; if I would magnify the majesty of Thy Being, those in heaven and earth make me small until I am as though I were not, as a mote, and they upbraid me, saying: “With this littleness thou magnifiest thy Lord and feelest no shame before His court!” Alas, alas! The right was with them, the sin with me. How shall I say, “I am he who sinned, and Thou art He Who forgave”? How shall I say, “I erred, and Thou didst conceal”? How shall I say, “I forgot Thy remembrance,” when Thou hast ever remembered Thy fearful servants? How shall I say, “I grew distant,” when Thou art nearer unto me than all things? Nay, by Thy might! I will not say “I,” nor blush at the avowal thereof; rather will I say: Thou art my God and my Beloved; Thou art my Master and my Desire; Thou art my Lord and my Summoner; Thou art my Chief and the end of all my hopes; Thou art my Possessor and the goal of my longing.

15 فما ادر يا الهى اتى سرت غريباً بين يديك و  
اناجيك بتلك الكلمات التى لو يعقلها احد  
سواى ليقول فى حقى ما قال على بن الحسين  
جئتك ابن حجتك فى حقه او ان دخلت ساحة  
قربك واشربت من كأس حلاوتك حيث لم  
اقدر ان اصفك بشئ ان اسبح نفسك يزجرنى  
حدى وان اقدس ذاتك يخوفنى حدى وان  
اوحده نفسائيتك يعذبني مقامى وان اكبر عظمة  
كينونيتك يصغرنى من فى السموات والارض  
بشان كائى لست وبمثل ذره ويحجدهننى بانك  
بذلك الصغر تكبر ربك ولا تستحي عن  
جنابه فاه آه فالحق كان معهم والذنب كان  
معى فكيف اقول انا الذى اذنبت وانك انت  
الذى غفرت وكيف اقول انا الذى اخطأت و  
انك انت الذى سترت وكيف اقول انا الذى  
نسيت ذكرك وانت لم تزل كنت ذاكر عبادك  
الخائفين وكيف اقول انا الذى بعدت وانك  
اقرب الى من كل شئ لا وعزتك لا اقول انا  
ولا اخجل بذلك بل اقول انت الهى ومحبوبى و  
انت مولائى ومقصودى وانك ربى ومنادى  
وانت سيدى ومنتهى املى وانت مالكى وغاية  
امالى

- 16 If I say, “From everlasting Thou hast ever been – Thou, Thou,” the sweetness of Thy remembrance will not affright my heart; nay, at every recurrence I taste a second rapture of love that no memory can compare with that first remembrance. Blessed

16 ان قلت لم تزل انت انت لن يفزع فؤادى من  
حلاوة ذكرك بل لا ذوق فى كل مره ثان لذة

then am I, and yet again how blessed, how peerlessly blessed, by Thy grace and the sweetness of my communion with Thee!

حَبِّ لَنْ يَعَادِلَ ذِكْرَ الْاَوَّلِ فِيَا طَوْبِي لِي ثُمَّ بَاهِيَا  
ثُمَّ بَاهِيَا مِنْ اَمْتَانِكَ وَلَذِيذِ مَنَاجَاتِكَ

- 17 I praise Thee for that Thou hast silenced me in the Abode of Eternity within Thy neighborhood, and given me to drink of the wine of nearness from Thy two hands, O Beloved of those who know, O Companion of the desolate, O Goal of the seekers! If Thou hast made me oppressed in the hands of the transgressors, yet, from Thy bounty, Thou hast inspired me with such supplications as wherein I find repose in Thy neighborhood and patience in my meeting with Thee. By Thy might! A single letter thereof, with me, is more glorious than were all who are in heaven and on earth subjected unto me, and I then made a witness over all that are on earth, and Thou didst exact vengeance upon my enemies altogether, to the delight of mine eyes – for these invocations shall remain in the Tablets of them who draw nigh; and they – if God will – shall recall me after my passing by chanting them before Thee; and Thou, after my death, shalt glory in these prayers amidst Thy righteous servants, and shall send down upon me, at every instant, the recompense befitting Thy generosity and grace.

17 وَ اَحْمَدُكَ بِمَا اسْكَنْتَنِي دَارَ الْخُلْدِ فِي جَوَارِكِ وَ  
اشْرَبْتَنِي مِنْ مَاءِ نَحْرِ الْقَرَبِ بِيَدَيْكَ يَا مَحْبُوبَ  
الْعَارِفِينَ وَيَا اَنْيْسَ الْمُسْتَوْحِشِينَ وَيَا مَنْتَهَى رَغْبَةِ  
الطَّالِبِينَ اِنْ جَعَلْتَنِي مَظْلُومًا فِي اَيْدِي الْمُعْتَدِينَ وَ  
لَكَتُكَّ مِنْ جُودِكَ الْهَمْتَنِي مِثْلَ تِلْكَ الْمَنَاجَاتِ  
لَا سَكْنَ بِهَا فِي جَوَارِكِ وَ اصْبِرْ فِي لِقَائِكَ  
بِعِزَّتِكَ اِنَّ حَرْفًا مِنْهَا لَدَيَّ لَا عَرَّ مِنْ اَنْ تَسْخَرَ  
كُلَّ مَنْ فِي السَّمَوَاتِ وَ الْاَرْضِ لِي ثُمَّ تَجْعَلَنِي  
شَاهِدًا لِمَنْ عَلَى الْاَرْضِ كُلِّهِمْ وَ تَنْقَمَ مِنْ اَعْدَائِي  
اجْمَعِهِمْ لِتَقَرُّبِهِ عَيْنِي لِاَنَّ تِلْكَ الْمَنَاجَاتَ تَبْقَى  
فِي الْوَحْيِ الْمَقْرُوبِينَ وَ اَنْهُمْ اَنْشَاءَ اللّٰهُ يَذْكُرُونِي بَعْدَ  
مَمَاتِي بِتَلَاوُثِهَا بَيْنَ يَدَيْكَ وَ اَنَّكَ تُبَاهِي بَعْدَ مَوْتِي  
بِتِلْكَ الدَّعَوَاتِ بَيْنَ عِبَادِكَ الْعَامِلِينَ وَ تُنْزِلُ عَلَيَّ  
فِي كُلِّ اَنْ جَزَاءَ تِلْكَ الدَّعَوَاتِ مَا اَنْتَ تَسْتَحِقُّ  
بِهِ مِنَ الْعَطَاءِ وَ الْاَمْتِنَانِ

- 18 Glorified art Thou, O my God! Thine be praise, in the kingdom of Command and Creation – praise that transcendeth the praise of all beings and is exalted above the praise of all besides Thee: a praise gleaming, radiant, resplendent, hallowed, scintillating, ringing forth – everlasting, eternal, perpetual – as Thou lovest and art well-pleased; as Thou art, in Thine exaltation, Thy oneness, Thy majesty, and Thy might – beyond the reach of all comprehension.

18 فَسُبْحَانَكَ يَا اَلٰهِي لَكَ الْحَمْدُ فِي مَلَكُوتِ الْاَمْرِ  
وَ الْخَلْقِ حَمْدًا يَفُوقُ حَمْدَ الْخَلَائِقِ كُلِّهِمْ وَ اسْتَغْنَى  
عَنْ حَمْدِ مَا سِوَاكَ اَجْمَعِهِمْ حَمْدًا لَا مَعًا شَعْشَعَانِيًا  
مَتَلَامَعًا مُتَقَدِّسًا مُتَلَاثًا مُتَلَجَلَجَلًا دَائِمًا سَرْمَدًا اَبَدًا  
كَأَنَّكَ تَحِبُّ وَ تَرْضَى وَ كَمَا اَنْتَ عَلَيْهِ مِنَ الْعِزِّ وَ  
الْوَحْدَةِ وَ الْجَلَالِ وَ الْقُدْرَةِ حَيْثُ لَا يَحِيطُ

PR03.068v25-070v08, MKI4511.038r-  
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BYC\_collect3.102-111, HN MJ.136-150

**BB00547***To: Ibn'i-Va'iz**Date: 1262 ? [1845-1846]*

- 1 In the name of God, the Most Merciful, the Most Compassionate. 1 بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ
- 2 Praise be to God Who doeth whatsoever He willeth through His command. Glorified and exalted is He above what they describe. 2 الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ ... يَفْعَلُ مَا يَشَاءُ بِأَمْرِهِ سُبْحَانَهُ وَتَعَالَى عَمَّا يُصِفُونَ
- 3 O my God! Thou art God Who hath testified concerning Thyself before all things that Thou art God, there is no God but Thee, alone with no partner. Thou hast ever been the Knower of all things before their existence, and powerful over all things after their manifestation. I beseech Thee, O God, by the right of Muhammad and his family, to bestow upon this soul who beareth these words that which befitteth Thy majesty, glory, grandeur and beauty. Verily, Thou art God, the All-Bountiful, the Most Exalted. 3 يَا إِلَهِي أَنْتَ اللَّهُ الَّذِي قَدْ شَهِدْتَ لِنَفْسِكَ قَبْلَ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ بِأَنَّكَ أَنْتَ اللَّهُ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ وَحْدَكَ لَا شَرِيكَ لَكَ لَمْ تَزَلْ كُنْتَ عَالِمًا بِكُلِّ شَيْءٍ قَبْلَ وَجُودِهِ وَقَادِرًا عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ بَعْدَ ظُهُورِهِ فَاسْتَثْنِ اللَّهُمَّ بِحَقِّ مُحَمَّدٍ وَآلِهِ أَنْ تَمُنَّ عَلَى هَذِهِ النَّفْسِ الَّتِي تَحْمِلُ هَذِهِ الْكَلِمَاتِ بِمَا أَنْتَ عَلَيْهِ مِنَ الشَّانِ وَالْجَلَالِ وَالْعِظَمَةِ وَالْجَمَالِ إِنَّكَ أَنْتَ اللَّهُ الْجَوَادُ الْمُتَعَالِ
- 4 O my God! Thou art He Who ordaineth not any trial for anyone except that Thou hast ordained for him a reward through Thy grace and bounty. Therefore, pour forth upon him, O Lord, patience and deliver us from every affliction through Thy grace. Verily, Thou art God Who bringeth together Thy servants when Thou willest according to Thy wisdom, and verily Thou art God, the All-Bountiful, the Most Merciful. 4 يَا إِلَهِي أَنْتَ الَّذِي لَا يَقْدِرُ تَقْدِيرُ أَحَدٍ بِلَاءٌ إِلَّا وَ قَدْ قَدَّرْتَ لَهُ جَزَاءً بِفَضْلِكَ وَ جُودِكَ فَافْرَغْ عَلَيْهَا يَا رَبِّ صَبْرًا وَ خَلِّصْنَا مِنْ كُلِّ بَلِيَّةٍ بِفَضْلِكَ إِنَّكَ أَنْتَ اللَّهُ الَّذِي يَجْمَعُ بَيْنَ عِبَادِكَ إِذَا شِئْتَ لِحُكْمِكَ وَأَنْتَ اللَّهُ الْجَوَادُ الرَّحِيمِ
- 5 In the name of God, the Most Merciful, the Most Compassionate. O God! Forgive the one who seeketh prayer from Thee and let Thy mercy and care continue to rest upon him. Verily, Thou art God, the All-Bountiful, the Most Generous. 5 بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ اللَّهُمَّ اغْفِرْ لِمَنْ أَرَادَ الدُّعَاءَ مِنْ عِنْدِكَ وَلَا تَزَالْ عَلَيْهِ رَحْمَتُكَ وَ عَنَانُكَ إِنَّكَ أَنْتَ اللَّهُ الْجَوَادُ الْكَرِيمُ ...

KHSH6.005

**BB00113***To: Muhammad Hasan al-Natnazi**Date: 1262 [1845-1846]*

- 1 In the Name of God, the Most Merciful, the Most Compassionate  
 2 Praise be to God Who caused to shine forth that which illumined the essences of material things and permitted it to radiate when it spoke forth, and Who spread enlightenment without cause or decree from the people of the Covenant.  
 3 O God! Thou knowest that one of Thy believing servants hath beseeched me to bestow upon him an eloquent word and all-embracing mercy concerning the visitation of the chosen ones who act according to Thy command.  
 4 O thou who wouldst do good! When thou desirest to bestow beneficence upon the servants of the All-Merciful through the Word of exposition, then before thou manifestest what is within thy being to outward view, purify thy outer self such that no excess hair remaineth upon thy face, and thy inner self such that thy heart remaineth unattached to any of thine affairs therein. Then perform ablutions and don the finest raiment with which God hath favored thee in this earthly life, apply perfume and walk upon the earth with tranquility, glorifying the name of thy Lord within thyself until thou approachest the portico.  
 5 When thou arriveth there, magnify God, thy Lord, thirty times. Then walk with spirit and grace, mindful of origin and justice, until thou drawest nigh unto the shrine.  
 6 When thou standest before His Majesty say "Allah'u'Akbar" forty times within a space of five feet, and stand in silence until your soul returns to you. There the light of your Lord descended upon the cloud, with angels surrounding Him, and the matter was decreed, and the promise was fulfilled. Say: In the name of God, and by God, and unto God, and in the path of God. O God! Thou art Peace, and from Thee cometh peace, and unto Thee returneth peace, and Thou art the Mine of peace, and the Lord of peace in the hereafter and in this world.  
 7 O my God! Here am I, standing at Thy gate, seeking refuge at Thy threshold, and uttering Thy praise through Thy names by which Thou hast revealed Thyself to me and described Thy Self. There is no God but Thee. Glorified art Thou, O my
- 1 بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ  
 2 الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ الَّذِي أَشْرَقَ مَا الْإِحْ بِه جَوَاهِرِ الْمَادِيَّاتِ  
 وَ أَذِنَ لَهُ بِأَنْ يَسْتَشْرِقَ إِذَا اسْتَنْطَقَ وَ أَفَاقَ مِنْ  
 دُونِ سَبَبٍ وَ لَا حَكْمٍ مِنْ أَهْلِ الْمِيثَاقِ  
 3 اللَّهُمَّ أَنْتَ لَتَعْلَمَ أَنَّ عَبْدًا مِنْ عِبَادِكَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ بِكَ  
 قَدْ سَأَلَ مِنْكَ أَنْ تُبَيِّنَ لَهُ كَلِمَةً بِالْغَايَةِ وَ رَحْمَةً جَامِعَةً  
 فِي زِيَارَةِ أَبْوَابِ الْمُصْطَفِينَ الَّذِينَ هُمْ بِأَمْرِكَ يَعْمَلُونَ  
 4 يَا أَيُّهَا الْحَسَنُ إِذَا أَرَدْتَ أَنْ تَحْسِنَ بِالْإِحْسَانِ عِبَادَ  
 الرَّحْمَنِ بِالْكَلِمَةِ الْبَيِّنَةِ فَمَنْ قَبْلُ أَنْ تَظْهَرَ مَا فِي الْكَيَانَ  
 إِلَى الْعَيَانِ طَهِّرْ ظَاهِرَكَ بِحَيْثُ لَا يَحْصِي فِيكَ شَعْرٌ  
 زَائِدٌ فِي وَجْهِكَ وَ بَاطِنَكَ بِحَيْثُ لَا يَتَعَلَّقُ فُؤَادُكَ  
 بِشَيْءٍ مِنْ أُمُورِكَ هُنَاكَ فَاغْتَسِلْ وَ الْبَسِ احْسِنَ مَا  
 أَنْعَمَ اللَّهُ عَلَيْكَ فِي الْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا وَ اسْتَعْمِلِ الْعَطْرَ  
 وَ امْشِ عَلَى الْأَرْضِ بِالسَّكُونِ وَ سَبِّحْ بِاسْمِ رَبِّكَ  
 فِي نَفْسِكَ حَتَّى قَرُبْتَ الرِّوَاقَ  
 5 فَإِذَا نَزَلْتَ هُنَاكَ كَبِّرِ اللَّهَ رَبَّكَ ثَلَاثِينَ مَرَّةً ثُمَّ  
 امْشِ بِالرُّوحِ وَ الْفَضْلِ لَعَلَّكَ بِالْبَدَاءِ وَ الْعَدْلِ  
 حَتَّى قَرُبْتَ الْمَرْقَدَ  
 6 فَإِذَا قُتِ تَلَقَّاءَ الْجَلَالِ الْجَلَالِ كَبِّرِ اللَّهَ أَرْبَعِينَ مَرَّةً  
 قَرِبْ خَمْسَةَ أَقْدَامٍ وَ قُمْ صَامِتًا حَتَّى تَرْجِعَ إِلَيْكَ  
 نَفْسُكَ هُنَاكَ جَاءَ نُورُ رَبِّكَ عَلَى الْعَمَاءِ وَ الْمَلَائِكَةِ  
 مِنْ حَوْلِهِ وَ قُضِيَ الْأَمْرُ وَ كَانَ الْوَعْدُ مَفْعُولًا قُلْ  
 بِسْمِ اللَّهِ وَ بِاللَّهِ وَ إِلَى اللَّهِ وَ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ اللَّهُمَّ  
 أَنْتَ السَّلَامُ وَ مِنْكَ السَّلَامُ وَ إِلَيْكَ السَّلَامُ وَ أَنْتَ  
 مَعْدِنُ السَّلَامِ وَ رَبُّ السَّلَامِ فِي الْآخِرَةِ وَ الْأُولَى  
 7 يَا إِلَهِي أَنَا ذَا فِي مَوْقِفِي هَذَا وَاقِفْ بِبَابِكَ وَ لَا تَذْ  
 بِجَنَابِكَ وَ نَاطِقٌ بِثَنَاتِكَ بِمَا تَجَلَّيْتُ لِي بِأَسْمَائِكَ الَّتِي  
 بِهَا وَصَفْتَ نَفْسَكَ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ فَسُبْحَانَكَ يَا  
 إِلَهِي لَا أَقْدِرُ بِثَنَاتِكَ إِذْ ثَنَاتُكَ أَنْ كَانَ عَلَى قَدَرِ

God! I am unable to praise Thee, for if my praise were to match Thy glory, it could not proceed from me nor befit my station, and if it were according to my capacity, it would be unworthy of Thy gate and could not ascend to Thy presence.

بهائك لا يصدر مني ولا يكون في شاني وان كان  
على قدرى لا يليق ببائك ولا يرفع الى جنابك

- 8 Glorified, glorified art Thou! Here am I, uttering Thy praise as Thou art in Thyself, though I can neither comprehend nor know, nor can any of Thy creatures encompass it with their knowledge. I know that Thou desirest nothing less from creation, nor accepteth less from anyone, for this is the primary station of my existence which Thou created from nothing by Thy power. And now it returns to the station of nothingness, as though it had never been mentioned.

8 فسبحانك سبحانك انا ذا ناطق بثناءك بما انت انت  
من حيث لا اقدر ولا اعرف ولا يحيط به علم  
احد من خلقك ولا علم انك لن تريد في شان  
الخلق دون ذلك ولا يقبل تقبل من احد ادنى  
من ذلك لانه بما هو عليه رتبة اول وجودى الذى  
انت خلقته لا من شئ بقدرتك والان يرجع الى  
مقام النفى كيوم لم يك منه شيئاً مذكوراً

- 9 Glorified art Thou, O my God! How sweet is Thy praise, how resplendent Thy glory, how exalted Thy station, and how hidden are Thy favors! I bear witness that there is no God but Thee, alone with no partner. Nothing is like unto Thee, and nothing in the heavens or earth equals Thee, and Thou art God, the Lord of the worlds.

9 فسبحانك يا اللهى فما احلى ثنائك وما اجلى بهائك  
وما اعل شانك وما اخفى الاثك اشهد ان لا اله  
الا انت وحدك لا شريك لك ليس كمثلك شئ  
ولا يعادلک في السموات والارض شئ وانك  
انت الله رب العالمين

- 10 O my God! As I know I have no share in praising Muhammad and His successors - Thy blessings be upon them - before Thee, lest I be silent in describing them, O God, praise Thou Muhammad and the family of Muhammad, the places of Thy knowledge, the pillars of Thy unity, the mines of Thy sanctification, and the manifestations of Thy glorification, with the might, divinity, grandeur, and power that belongeth to Thee, which none but Thee can comprehend. Verily, Thou art the Lord of the worlds.

10 يا اللهى لما اعلم لا حظ لى في ثناء محمد واوصيائه  
صلواتك عليهم بين يديك لاجترح في وصفهم لثلا  
اكون من الصامتين اللهم انت فائز على محمد و  
آل محمد محال معرفتك واركان توحيدك ومعادن  
تقديسك ومظاهر تجييدك ما انت عليه من العزة  
واللاهوت والعظمة والجبروت حيث لا يحيط  
بعلم ذلك احد سواك انك انت رب العالمين

- 11 Peace be upon you, O Family of La, this Book containeth remembrance and justice for the devout! Peace be upon you, O leaves of the Divine Tree, fruits of the holy and glorious trees, fruits of the Tree of Sinai and of the Kingdom, gardens of the Tree of Justice, and pearls of bounty in the thicket of the human realm, and the mercy of God and His blessings! Peace be upon you, O ye whom God hath chosen for His religion, accepted for His wisdom, elected for His Cause, and made successors to the best of His creation, and the mercy of God and His blessings! Peace be upon you, O ye whom God hath selected for the knowledge of the Qur'an, taught the inner meanings of the Furqan, chosen for the mystery of the people of the Bayan, and protected from the steps of Satan, and the mercy of God and His blessings! Peace be upon you, O ye whom God hath created to preserve His revelation, manifest His Word, exalt His glory and His hidden grace, and the mercy of God and His blessings! Peace be upon you, O ye whose words God hath joined with obedience to His loved ones, whose knowledge with the knowledge of His trusted ones, whose love with the love of

11 قل الحمد لله الذى جعل السلام لنفسه على نفسه  
ثم على محمد وآل الله عباده المكرمين الذين لا  
يسبقونهم احد بالقول وهم من خشيته يشفقون  
الله فائز بثناء نفسك على جنتك القائم بامرک  
و المنتظر حکمک و الخائف المرتقب في ايامک و  
الراجى بفضلك و بدائك بما انت عليه من البهاء و  
السناء و الثناء و البداء انك انت الله رب الانشاء  
لا يتعاطمك شئ في السموات ولا في الارض  
وانك انت الله رب العالمين ثم انظر سرک الى  
المستقر على كرسى الجلال فوق العرش و بطرف  
علائيتك الى السكن تحت التراب و الناطق بثناء  
رب الاسماء و الصفات و قل السلام عليكم يا  
ال الم ذلك الكتاب لا ريب فيه هدى للمتقين  
السلام عليكم يا ال المص ذلك الكتاب فيه ذكرى  
و بشرى للخاشعين السلام عليكم يا ال المرا ذلك  
الكتاب فيه هدى و رحمة للخلصين السلام عليكم  
يا ال الرا ذلك الكتاب فيه ذكرى و عدل للقائين

His chosen ones, and whose friendship with the friendship of the best of His servants, and the mercy of God and His blessings! Peace be upon you, O pillars of religion, support of the believers, stronghold of the God-fearing, and refuge of those who fear, and the mercy of God and His blessings! Peace be upon you, O tidings of the ancients, example to those who come after, and the Word of those who follow, and excellence of those who preceded, and the mercy of God and His blessings! Peace be upon you, O pillars of the cornerstone of unity, branches of the Tree of oneness, virgin gardens of the Tree of detachment, and verses of the letters of the Word of praise before glorification and after declaration of unity and at the time of magnification, and the mercy of God and His blessings!

السلام عليكم يا اوراق شجرة اللاهوت و فواكه اشجار القدس والجبروت و اثمار شجرة السيناء و الملكوت و حدائق شجرة العدل و جواهر الفضل في اجمة الناسوت و رحمة الله و بركاته السلام عليكم يا من اصطفىكم الله لدينه و ارتضىكم لحكمه و اختارهم اختاركم لامره و جعلكم خلفاء خير بريته و رحمة الله و بركاته السلام عليكم يا من انتخبكم الله لعلم القراء و علمكم بواطن الفرقان و انتخبكم لسراهل البيان و عصمكم من خطوات الشيطان و رحمة الله و بركاته السلام عليكم يا من خلقكم الله لحفظ وحيه و ظهور كلمته و علو جلالته و خفي نعمته و رحمة الله و بركاته

- 12 Peace be upon you, O ye whose utterance is God – whose obedience is obedience unto His chosen ones, whose recognition is the recognition of His trusted stewards, whose love is love for His purified friends, whose affection is affection for the noblest of His servants. And the mercy of God and His blessings be upon you.

12 السلام عليكم يا من قولكم ... الله طاعتكم بطاعة اوليائه و معرفتكم بمعرفة امتائه و محبتكم بحبة اصفياه و مودتكم بمودة خير عباديه و رحمة الله و بركاته

- 13 Peace be upon you, O stronghold of the Faith, support of the believers, firm handle of the God-fearing, refuge of the fearful; and the mercy of God and His blessings be upon you.

13 السلام عليكم يا منة الدين و عضد المؤمنين و عروة المتقين و كهف الخائفين و رحمة الله و بركاته

- 14 Peace be upon you, O Tidings of the ancients and Pattern of the latter days, O Word that followeth after the words – conjoined and crowned, the excellence of the forerunners; and the mercy of God and His blessings be upon you.

14 السلام عليكم يا نبأ الاولين و المثل الاخرين و الكلمة اللاحقين ... و فضل السابقين و رحمة الله و بركاته

- 15 Peace be upon you, O pillars of the Pillar of Oneness, branches of the Tree of Singleness, first fruits of the gardens of the Tree of Detachment, signs of the letters of the Word of Praise – before the glorification, after the declaration of unity, and at the moment of magnification; and the mercy of God and His blessings be upon you.

15 السلام عليكم يا اركان ركن التوحيد و اغصان شجرة التفريد و اباكار حدائق شجرة التجريد و ايات احرف كلمة التحميد قبل التسبيح و بعد التهليل و حين التكبير و رحمة الله و بركاته

- 16 I call God to witness – His angels, His Prophets, and His chosen ones – that ye are the foremost; that ye are the elect, the elect; that ye are the sincere, the sincere; that ye are the first, the first. Through you hath shone whatsoever hath shone in the Kingdom of the heavens and the earth; through you hath dawned whatsoever hath dawned in the inward lights of the Footstool and the Throne; through you hath appeared whatsoever hath appeared in the orbits of the heavens and the Throne; and through you hath been illumined whatsoever hath been

16 اشهد الله و ملائكته و انبيائه و اوليائه بانكم السابقون و انكم المصطفون المصطفون و انكم المخلصون المخلصون و انكم الاولون الاولون فبكم الاح ما الاح في ملكوت السموات و الارض و بكم اشرق ما اشرق في بواطن انوار الكرسي و العرش و بكم اطلع ما اطلع في افلاك السموات و العرش و بكم اضاء ما اضاء في غياهب ملكوت الامر و الخلق فما احلى اسمائكم و اجلى كلماتكم و اعلى كينونياتكم و اخفى انيتكم

illuminated in the depths of the Kingdom of command and creation. How sweet are your names, how manifest your words, how exalted your being, and how hidden your "I-ness."

- 17 Unto God belongeth the right for the kindness of your beneficent ones; unto God pertaineth the remembrance of your majesty; unto God is the thanksgiving in your praise; and unto God is the justice for your adversaries. Through you did the Holy Spirit take up abode, in the gardens of al-Saqrurah, the orchards of manifestation; through you did the Trustworthy Spirit descend upon Sinai with a Book laid open; through you did the Spirit of Command take its place in Paradise with a Book inscribed; and through you did the Spirit and the angels descend, by God's leave, from the Frequented House.
- 18 Thus every just one today dealeth justly among mankind by your judgment; every possessor of grace today speaketh your praise; every ruler today ruleth by your permission; and every doer today acteth for God, out of love for you. Through you was the Word made complete, mercy was sent down, division was reconciled, and the Word was distinguished. How sweet is your remembrance, how exalted your station, how resplendent your glory, and how hidden your days.
- 19 May my father and mother be a sacrifice unto you! Through you did the Light speak and then taste, through you was Moses thunderstruck and then recovered, through you did Jonah glorify God in the belly of the whale and then was delivered, through you did Jesus speak in the cradle and then was established. Whosoever desires God finds your Cause, whosoever seeks Him recognizes your truth, whosoever unifies Him bears witness to your justice, and whosoever knows Him learns of your bounty. You are the Way and the Guide to Muhammad and the Family of God. Through you were revealed the hidden traditions, erased the manifest seditions, magnified the signs of the people of wisdom, and perfected the trials for the people of tribulation.
- 20 May my father be a sacrifice unto you! You are the Way in the heavens and on earth. Through you does the sky send down its water, the earth bring forth its vegetation, and people relate their tidings that their Lord, the All-Merciful, has inspired it.
- 21 May my father be a sacrifice unto you! You are the rising suns, the illuminating moons, the brilliant stars, and the orbiting spheres. May my father and mother be a sacrifice unto you! Through you do moving things move, written things become written, manifest things become distinguished, and scattered things become gathered. I cannot count the radiance of your praise, nor reach the pinnacle of your attributes, nor can any
- 17 فله حق لمحسنكم والله ذكر لجلالتكم والله شكر في ثنائكم والله عدل لثنائكم بكم اخذ روح القدس في جنان الصاقورة حدائق الظهور وبكم نزل روح الامين على الطور بكاب منشور وبكم اخذ روح الامر في الفردوس كآب مسطور وبكم نزل الروح والملائكة باذن الله من بيت المعمور
- 18 فكل ذى عدل يعدل اليوم بين الناس بحكمكم وكل ذى فضل ينطق اليوم بثنائكم وكل ذى حكم يحكم اليوم باذنكم وكل ذى عمل يعمل اليوم لله لحبكم بكم تمت الكلمة ونزلت الرحمة واثملت الفرقة وانفصلت الكلمة فما احلى ذكركم واعلى شأنكم واجلى بهائكم واخفى ايامكم
- 19 بابي اتم وامى بكم نطق النور ثم اذاق وبكم صعب موسى ثم افاق وبكم سبى يونس في بطن الحوت ثم اساق وبكم نطق عيسى في المهد ثم افاق فمن اراد الله وجد امركم ومن قصده عرف حقكم ومن وحده شهد لعدلكم ومن عرفه علم بفضلكم فانتم السبيل والدليل لمحمد وآل الله بكم ظهرت خفيات السنن ومحت جليات الفتن وعظمت علامات اهل الفطن واكملت البلاء لاهل المحن
- 20 بابي اتم اتم السبيل في السموات والارضين بكم نزل السماء مائها وتخرج الارض نباتها وتحدث الناس اخبارها بان ربكم الرحمن اوحى لها
- 21 بابي اتم اتم الشمس الطالعة والاقمار المنيرة والانجم الزاهرة والافلاك المسيرة بابي اتم وامى بكم تحركت المتحركات وسطرت المسطرات وفصلت المتجليات واجتمعت المتفارقات فما احصى سناء ثنائكم ولا ابلى الى ذروة نعتكم ولا

bird's wing ascend to the atmosphere of your glory, nor can the essence of any allusion rise up to you, so great is your praise and sanctification.

- 22 May my father and mother be a sacrifice unto you! I cannot enumerate your praise in the manner that you yourselves know your own station. I bear witness before you that when God desired to manifest Himself to Moses and those with him on the Mount, He revealed a light from your majesty whereupon the mountain was crushed and Moses fell down thunderstruck. And God, through the essence of the mountain which became animate from the manifestation of the light of one of you, created the life of all existing things, placing some in the earth for the life of those therein, some in the water for the life of aquatic creatures, and some in the air - and I witness in this atmosphere the life of humanity and all those on earth and in the air together. How manifest is your light, how exalted your station, how great your worth, and how noble your beneficence! Were it not for you, neither I nor any living soul on earth would exist.

- 23 May the blessings of God, His angels, His Prophets, and His chosen ones be upon you according to what God has willed concerning your right, and what Muhammad the Messenger of God has established regarding your right, and what the Family of God has ordained concerning your station. You are purified in your inner and outer being, and I hereby bear witness that I believe in you and in your outer manifestation, and I believe that you have manifested the decree of the Family of Ta-Ha and Ya-Sin, then Ta-Sin-Mim and Alif-Lam-Sad.

- 24 By the wise Qur'an! I bear witness that those who have believed in you are more blessed than those who believed in the Imams of Justice, and those who have shown patience during your dispensation are more excellent than those who showed patience in the days of the Imams of Grace.

- 25 The deeds of those who act without obedience to you shall profit them not, for God has made obedience to you identical with obedience to the Imams who are guided by His command. He has joined the knowledge of you with knowledge of them, and disobedience to you with disobedience to them. Whosoever opposes you has opposed them, and whosoever wages war against you has waged war against them. Whosoever advances before you or lags behind you has advanced before them or lagged behind them. They have gone astray who harbor thoughts of ignorance concerning you or speak of you in terms other than servitude. He who knows you not has no path to God, and he who submits to your Cause shall find no barrier in God's decree. They have indeed denied the truth who have

يرقى طير احد الى هواء عزتكم ولا يصعد اليكم  
جوهر اشارة لعظم ثنائكم وتقدسكم

22 بابي انتم وامي لا احصى ثنائكم بمثل ما انتم تعلمون  
مقام انفسكم واني لا شهد بين ايديكم بان الله لما  
اراد ان يتجلى لموسى ومن معه على الطور اظهر نورا  
من جلالته فحينئذ اندك الجبل وخر موسى صعقا  
وان الله بذوات الجبل التي صارت حيوانا من  
تجلى نور احد منكم قد خلق حيات الموجودات و  
جعل بعضها في الارض لحيات من فيها ثم بعضها  
في الماء لحيات حيوان الماء ثم بعضها في الهواء  
وانا اذا شاهد في هذه الجو لحيات الانسان و  
من على الارض والهواء كلهم اجمعين فما اجلى  
نوركم واعلى شانكم واعظم قدركم واکرم احسانكم  
فلولاكم ما كنت انا ولا ذوروح في الارض

23 فضلى الله و ملائكته و انبيائه و اوليائه عليكم بما  
شاء الله في حكمكم و جعل محمد رسول الله في  
حكمكم و قدروا آل الله في شانكم و انتم تطهرون في  
سرکم و علايتکم و انا اذا اشهدکم بابي مؤمن بکم و  
بعلايتکم و مؤمن بانکم قد اظهريتم حکم آل طه و  
يس

24 ثم طسم و الص و القرآن الحكيم و اشهد ان  
الذين صدقوكم لاحسن طوبى من الذين صدقوا  
ائمة العدل و ان الذين صبروا في دولتكم لاحسن  
من الذين صبروا في ايام ائمة الفضل

25 ولا ينفع الذين عملوا بغير طاعتكم اعمالهم لان الله  
قد جعل طاعتكم طاعة ائمة الذين يهتدون بامرهم و  
قرن معرفتكم بمعرفتهم و معصيتكم بمعصيتهم و من  
حاذكم فكانما حاربهم و من حارب معكم فكانما  
حارب بهم و من تقدم عليكم او تاخر منكم فقد  
تقدم عليهم و تاخر منهم فقد ضل الذين يظنون  
فيكم ظن الجاهلية او يقولون في حكمكم غير كلمة  
العبودية من لم يعرفكم لا سبيل له الى الله و من  
يسلم امرکم لا راد في حقه من قضاء الله و لقد

transgressed against you, or denied your rights, or rejected your grace, or shown enmity to your friends, or befriended your enemies.

- 26 I seek refuge in God and His words, then in you, from the deeds of those who have wronged you, betrayed your Cause, obeyed what you forbade, and denied your rights. Through you do I hold fast in exalting your word, the word of mercy for your friends, and the word of vengeance and wrath for your enemies.

- 27 Thus do I beseech God for your victory and await your sovereignty, certain of God's promise concerning you. You have ever been those who act according to God's command and will, who hope for God's grace and promise, and who fear God's justice and decree. I am with you, and you are for God, and all shall return to God. Glorified be God, the Lord of the Throne, above what they describe. Peace be upon the Messengers. And praise be to God, the Lord of the worlds.

كفر الذين اعتدوا عليكم او جحدوا حقكم او انكروا فضلكم او عادوا اوليائكم او ولوا اعدائكم

26 فبالله وبكلماته ثم بكم اعوذ من عمل الذين ظلموا عليكم و خانوا امركم و اطاعوا نهيكم و جحدوا حقكم و بكم اعتصم في اعلاء كلمتكم و كلمة الرحمة لاوليائكم و كلمة النعمة و الغضب لاعدائكم

27 و انا ذا ادعو الله لفرجكم و ارتقب دولتكم و ايقن بوعد الله في حقكم لم يزل كنتم عاملين بامر الله و ارادته و راجين بفضل الله و وعده و خائفين من عدل الله و حكمه و اني بكم و انتم لله و كل الى الله يرجعون و سبحان الله رب العرش عما يصفون و سلام على المرسلين و الحمد لله رب العالمين

PR03.054v04-056r17, MKI4499.001

## BB00320

*To: Siyyid Buka' and Haji Muhammad-i-Kharraz*

*Date: 1262-07-15 [1846-Jul-9]*

- 1 In the Name of God, the Most Merciful, the Most Compassionate
- 2 O God! I bear witness before Thee to that whereby Thou bearest witness to Thine Own Essence before the creation of all things, and to that which Thou art in Thine Eternal Identity which none knoweth save Thee. Thou art God, the Single, the Self-Subsisting, the One, the Most Exalted.
- 3 O my God! How can I praise Thee and call upon Thee when my knowledge of Thine Essence hath cut me off from praise, and my remembrance before the court of Thy Self-Subsistence causeth me to be forbidden by decree? I have no path, O my God, except through Thy remembrance of me, Thy manifestations unto me, and Thy breathings in my inmost being and my outward self.

1 بسم الله الرحمن الرحيم

2 اللهم اني اشهدك بما انت تشهد لكونيتك بذاتيتك قبل خلق الاشياء و بما انت عليه من انية الازلية التي لا يعرفها احد سواك انك انت الله الفرد الصمد الواحد المتعال

3 فيا اللهى كيف اثنى عليك و ادعوك و ان على بذاتيتك انقطعنى عن الشاء و ان ذكرى تلقاء مدين صمدانيتك تلهنى المنع بالقضاء و لا سبيل لى يا اللهى دون ذكرى لى و تجلياتك لى و نفحاتك فى سرى و علانيتى

4 فاسئلك اللهم بعز الازلية و جلال الابدية ان تصلى على محمد و آل محمد بالايات اللاهوتية و

4 I beseech Thee, O God, by the might of eternity and the majesty of everlastingness, to send Thy blessings upon Muhammad and the family of Muhammad with the divine verses, the celestial signs, the heavenly stations, and the earthly proofs, in such wise that none save Thee can encompass their knowledge. Send down upon them in every condition Thy breathings, Thy manifestations, and Thy will through the ultimate reaches of Thy power, the furthest extent of Thy purpose, and the endless expressions of Thy Command, such that none can encompass any portion thereof save through Thy knowledge. Verily Thou art God, the All-Knowing, the Ancient, the Powerful, the Wise, Who brought creation into being from nothing through Thy creative power, and Who sustaineth them at every moment as at the first instant. Thou art He Who made known to them the path of Thy will and the way of Thy love, and revealed unto them in Thy Book all that they need for their journey toward Thy good pleasure, lest any soul go astray except after having recognized Thy truth and become certain of Thy decree, and lest anyone say "Had God made known His power unto me, I would have been among the believers."

5 O my God! The paths of supplication leading to Thy holy court descend from above, and the essences of petition rise up toward the heaven of Thy grandeur. Thou knowest that this night is the middle night of this sacred month of Rajab, which Thou hast honored above many other days through the excellence of Thy will over the degrees of Thy adornments, and which Thou hast magnified through the signs of Thy love for those who follow Thy good pleasure.

6 O God! I beseech Thee by the Great Birth and the Ancient Name and the Noble Origin whom Thou didst create for Thyself, chose for Thy Cause, selected for Thy will, and elected for Thy good pleasure - he who standeth by Thy Command, is absent by Thy leave, is concealed within Thy veil, awaiteth Thy promise, and seeketh forgiveness for Thy loved ones - by all that Thou art in might and majesty and grandeur and beauty. O my God! Grant unto me and unto all Thy servants from the treasures of Thy mercy that which becometh the presence of Thy grandeur and the majesty of Thy Self-Subsistence.

7 O God! Thou knowest that affairs have reached their ordained severity. Show us his concealed countenance in these dark nights, for verily Thou art God, the All-Forgiving, the All-Appreciating. O God! I cannot reckon the praise due to Thy Proof who standeth by Thy Command, nor the praise due to any of his infallible signs, the completers of religion and guides of all creation. O God! Through Thy bounty, praise them with all Thy breathings, verses, favors and signs, by all that

العلامات الجبروتية و المقامات المكنوتية و الدلالات الملكية حيث لا يحيط يعلمها علم احد سواك و ان تنزل عليهم في كل شأن نفعاتك و تجلياتك و اراداتك بغايات قدرتك و نهايات مشيتك و اللانهايات من امرك حيث لا يحيط بشئ منها دون علمك انك انت الله العالم القديم و المقتدر الحكيم الذي ابدعت الخلق لا من شئ بابداعك و تمدهم في كل آن بمثل شأن الاول و انت الذي عرفتهم منهاج مشيتك و سبيل محبتك و نزلت عليهم كل ما هم يحتاجون في سبيل سلوكهم الى رضوانك في كتابك لئلا يضل نفس الا ما بعد ان يعرف حقك و يوقن بحكمك و لا يقول احد لو عرفني الله قدرته لكنت من المؤمنين

5 يا الله ان سبل مطالب الى ساحة قدسك نازلة و ان جوهرات المسائل الى هواء كبرياتك رافعة و انك لتعلم ان الليل هذه ليلة النصف من الشهر الحرام هذا الرجب المرجب الذي شرفته على كثير من الايام بتفضيل [بمن] مشيتك على مراتب تحلياتك و عظمته بابات محبتك لمن اتبع مرضاتك

6 اللهم اني اسئلك بالمولود العظيم و الاسم القديم و الاصل الكرم الذي خلقته لنفسك و اصطفيته لامرك و اتخبته لارادتك و اتخبته لرضائك القائم بامرک و الغائب باذنك و المستتر في حجابك و المنتظر لوعدك و المستغفر لاوليائك بما انت عليه من العز و الجلال و العظمة و الجمال و انت يا الله بلغ مني و من كل عبادك من خزائن رحمتك ما انه يستحق في تلقاء كبرياتك و جلال صمدانيتك

7 اللهم انك لتعلم ان الامور في الشدة على قدر مقدور فارنا طلعتاه المستور في تلك الظلمات الديجور فانك انت الله الغفور الشكور اللهم لا احصي ثناء على حجتك القائم بامرک و لا ثناء احد من اياته المعصومين ائمة الدين و هداة الخلق اجمعين اللهم انت بجدك فائن عليهم بكل نفعاتك و اياتك و كراماتك و علاماتك ما

Thou art in unity and might and glory. Forgive us through their right, relieve us through their grace, cause us to die in obedience to them after having recognized them, bring us to life in their return, make us secure in their dominion, steadfast in their rule during their absence, thankful for their bounties, content with their decree, patient under their trials, mindful of their traditions, following their traces, and keeping their secrets - through Thy favor and bounty, O my God and God of my forefathers: Muhammad, Ali, Fatima, Hasan, Husayn, Ali, Muhammad, Ja'far, Musa, Ali, Muhammad, Ali, Hasan and the Proof, the Qa'im - God's blessings be upon them and upon their cherubic followers.

انت عليه من الوحدة والجبروت والعزة واغفر  
لنا بحقهم وفرج عنا بفضلهم وامتنا في طاعتهم  
بعد معرفتهم واحينا في رجعتهم واجعلنا امنين  
في دولتهم والمستقرين على حكمهم في غيبتهم و  
الشاكين لالاتهم والراضين بقضائهم والصابرين  
على باسائهم والذاكرين لاختبارهم والمقتدين  
بآثارهم والكاظمين على اسرارهم بمك وجودك  
يا الله والى ابائى محمد وعلى وفاطمة والحسن  
والحسين وعلى ومحمد وجعفر وموسى وعلى و  
محمد وعلى والحسن والحجة القائم صلوات الله  
عليهم وعلى شيعتهم الكروبيين

- 8 And may Thy unity, the settings of Thy sanctification, the signs of Thy praise, the tokens of Thy glorification, and the proofs of Thy transcendence be through all that Thou art in splendor and praise and cloud and radiance and decree and change and execution. Verily Thou art God, Lord of creation. Nothing in the heavens or earth is too great for Thee. Thou art God, the Most High, the Most Exalted. Glory be to God, Lord of the Throne, above what they describe. Peace be upon the Messengers. And praise be to God, Lord of the worlds.

8 او كان توحيدك وموادن تقديسك وايات  
تحيديك وعلامات تحييدك ودلالات تنزيهك  
بما انت عليه من البهاء والثناء والعماء والثناء  
والقضاء والبداء والامضاء انك انت الله رب  
الانشاء لا يتعاظمك شئ في السموات ولا في  
الارض وانك انت الله العلى المتعال وسبحان  
الله رب العرش عما يصفون وسلام على المرسلين  
والحمد لله رب العالمين

MKI4499.010

## BB00337

*Ziyarat*

*Date: 1262 ? [1845-1846]*

- 1 I bear witness that there is no God but God, alone without partner, even as His Essence hath testified unto His Essence that there is no God but Him, the Mighty, the All-Wise. And I bear witness that Muhammad is Thy servant whom Thou didst choose for Thyself, and didst fashion for Thy Cause, and didst select for Thy good pleasure, and didst make him to stand in Thy stead in both initiation and response, for Thine Essence transcendeth all description of substance, and Thy Reality surpasseth all material knowledge. Verily Thou art God, the Mighty, the Bestower.

1 اشهد ان لا اله الا الله وحده لا شريك له كما  
شهد ذاته لذاته انه لا اله الا هو العزيز الحكيم و  
اشهد ان محمدا عبدك الذى استخلصته لنفسك و  
اصطنعته لولايتك واصطفيته لمرضايتك وجعلته  
مقام نفسك فى الابداء والبداء اذ ذاتيتك مقطعة  
الجوهريات عن البيان وان كينونيتك مفرقة  
الماديات عن العرفان وانك انت الله المقتدر  
العزيز الوهاب

- 2 Peace be upon you, O essence and core of religion, ultimate goal and reality of the Cause, fruit and quintessence of creation,

2 السلام عليكم يا اصل الدين وجوهره وغاية الامر  
وحقيقته وثمره الابداع وكنهه وسر الاختراع  
وذاتيته ورحمة الله وبركاته

secret and reality of invention, and the mercy of God and His blessings.

3 O Family of Mercy and Letters of the Word! I cannot reckon your praise nor can I comprehend the description of your power, for all attributes fall short before the court of your nearness and all descriptions are false before the might of your sanctified being. If I say you are unity itself and the signs of abstraction, I have only described my own state and testified to my heart's incapacity, for your reality ever transcends mention of names and attributes, and your being has always surpassed reference to similitudes and essences. Too glorious is the majesty of your reality for me to indicate it through created attributes, too lofty the elevation of your being for me to compare it to existential descriptions.

4 I beseech God to raise me to the summit of detachment through nearness to your countenance, to grant me perpetual connection to your service, engagement in what draws me closer to you, contentment with what descends from the clouds of your power, certitude in what God has revealed in the Qur'an concerning your station, acceptance of what the transmitters of your traditions have spoken about you, drawing near to your friends and dissociating from your enemies - those who would deceive God and His chosen ones, and from what God has decreed concerning them.

5 I call God, His angels, His Prophets and His Messengers to witness that when you will, the Will manifests by God's leave among all wills, when you intend, intention dissolves into its goals, when you determine, things are determined in the kingdom of names and attributes. No decree is established except through your sanction, no erasure occurs except through your alteration. So glory be to God your Creator! None knows your measure for it is God's measure, nor your station for it is God's station. None can encompass your description for it is God's description, nor your attributes for they are God's attributes. Glory be to God your Fashioner! Whoever knows His oneness bows before your countenance, whoever recognizes Him submits at your gate, whoever stands firm upon His holy carpet humbles himself before your command, whoever acknowledges His justice and grace bears witness to your deed.

6 For those sheltered beneath the dark shadows of Paradise and those reclining upon whitened thrones in the gardens of Paradise, when they reached the depths of majestic justice and drank from the spring of pure water and became detached unto the nearness of beauty's countenance, they bore witness through you to the praise of your power, even as the angels

3 فيا ال الرحمة و احرف الكلمة لا احصى ثنائكم و لا اقدر ان اعرف وصف قدرتكم اذ كل النعت مردود عن ساحة قربكم و كل الوصف كذب لعز قدس انيتكم ان قلت اتم التوحيد و علامات التجريد ما عرفت الا امر نفسى و ما شهدت الا بعجز فؤادى اذ كينونيتكم لا تزال ممتعة الذاتيات عن ذكر الاسماء و الصفات و ان نفسانيتكم لم تزل مسددة الكينونيات عن ذكر الامثال و الذوات بجلت جلالة ذاتيتكم من ان اشير اليها بنعت الممككات و علت علو انيتكم من ان اقرنها بوصف الموجودات

4 فن الله اسئل ان يصعدنى الى ذروة الانقطاع بقرب طلعة حضرتكم و الدوام فى الاتصال بخدمتكم و الاشتغال بما يقربنى اليكم و الرضا بما ينزل من سخائب قدرتكم و اليقين بما نزل الله فى القرآن من شانكم و التصديق بما نطق فيكم رواة احاديثكم و التقرب باوليائكم و البراءة من اعدائكم و الذين يخادعون الله و اوليائه و بما ارد الله فى حقهم

5 فاشهد الله و ملائكته و انبيائه و رسله بانكم اذا شئتم وجدت المشية باذن الله سبحانه فى المشيئات و اذا اردتم ذوت الارادة فى الغايات و اذا قدرتم قدرت الاشياء فى ملكوت الاسماء و الصفات و ما من قضاء مثبت الا وقد اجرى بامضاءكم و لا من محو الا و قد بدل ببدايتكم فسيحان الله موجدكم لا يعلم احد قدركم لانه قدر الله و لا شانكم لانه شان الله و لا يحيط احد بوصفكم لانه وصف الله و لا بنعتكم لانه نعت الله فسيحان الله بارئكم من وحده ذل لوجهكم و من عرفه خضع لبابكم و من استقر على بساط قدسه خضع لامركم و من اقر له بالعدل و الفضل شهد بفعلكم

6 لان المستظلون فى ظلال مكفهرات الافريدوس و المتكئون على سرير المبيضة فى جنات الفردوس لما اتصلوا الى لجة عدل الجلال و شربوا من عين ماء السلسال و انقطعوا الى قرب طلعة فضل الجمال استشهدوا منكم لثناء قدرتكم بها شهدت الملائكة و اولو العلم من عباد الله له فى مشهد

and those possessed of knowledge among God's servants bore witness to Him in the primal scene. Glory be to God! None knows what He has bestowed upon you save Him, none can describe you save Him. Here I stand in this station bearing witness to what God has ordained concerning you of the signs of power and divinity and unity and might and grandeur and sovereignty and glory and dominion, and that which none save Him can encompass in knowledge.

- 7 I seek forgiveness of God, my Lord and your Lord, for my shortcomings in knowing you and my soul's remoteness from the nearness of your presence, and for what your knowledge encompasses of my transgressions which none knows save you and none can alter save you. I turn unto God in repentance from my existence and what I have acquired before you, certain that after my confession of incapacity I shall not be questioned about any sin.

- 8 Therefore I say: Glory be to God, Lord of the Throne, above what they describe! Peace be upon the Messengers! Praise be to God, Lord of the worlds!

الاول فسبحان الله ما يعلم ما انه اعطاكم الا هو ولا يقدر بوصفكم الا هو فانا ذا في مقامى هذا اشهد لكم بما قدر الله في حقكم من آيات القدرة واللاهوت والوحدة والجبروت والعظمة والملك والعزة والملوك وما لا يحيط علم احد سواه

7 واستغفر الله ربي وربكم عما قصرت في معرفتكم وبعدت نفسي عن قرب حضرتكم وما احاط علمكم من جرياتي التي لا يعلمها الا انتم ولا يقدر ان يبدلها الى احد غيركم واتوب الى الله عن وجودي وما اكتسبت بين ايديكم ولايقن ان بعد اعترافي بالعجز لا يستلون عني من ذنب

8 وانا اقول لذلك سبحان الله رب العرش عما يصفون و سلام على المرسلين والحمد لله رب العالمين

PR03.057v13-058r20, MKI4499.018

## BB00341

*Du'a Tawassul*

*Date: 1262 ? [1845-1846]*

- 1 In the name of God, the Most Merciful, the Most Compassionate
- 2 Praise be to God Who sends down whatsoever He willeth by His command. Glorified and exalted is He above what they describe.
- 3 O my God! How can I praise Thee, knowing that all are cut off from knowing Thee? And how can I not call upon Thee when my heart finds no rest save in Thy remembrance? I testify that Thou art God, the Beloved, Whom nothing can know and none can find a way unto, for Thy Essence is the Camphor-like Reality which by its very nature severs all substances from expression, and Thy Being is the Simple Reality which by its very nature prevents all material things from knowing Thee.

1 بسم الله الرحمن الرحيم

2 الحمد لله الذي ينزل ما يشاء بامرهِ سبحانه وتعالى عما يصفون

3 يا الله كيف اثني عليك بعد علمي بقطع الكل عن عرفانك وكيف لا ادعوك وان فؤادي لم يستقر الا بذكرك فاشهد انك انت الله المحبوب الذي لن يعرفك شيء ولا قدرت لاحد سبيلا اليك اذ ذاتيتك هي الكينونية الكافورية التي هي بنفسها مقطعة الجوهرات عن البيان وان كينونيتك هي الذاتية الساذجية التي هي بنفسها ممتنعة الماديات عن العرفان

- 4 Glorified art Thou! Having realized there is no way for me to reach Thee, I turn to Thee through Muhammad and the Family of Muhammad, the loci of Thy knowledge, the seats of Thy grace, the signs of Thy oneness, and the manifestations of Thy mercy. O God! By their right in Thy Book and their station in Thy knowledge, I beseech Thee to bless them with all Thy revelations, breezes, manifestations and stations which know no cessation, and to fulfill this need of mine now, now, now! For hope has been cut off from all else besides Thee, and necessity has reached the ultimate degree of impossibility.
- 5 Thou art my Lord, my God, my Master, my Protector and my Trust. If Thou dost not have mercy upon me, who will have mercy upon me? And if Thou dost not answer me, who will answer me? O God! I adjure Thee by the countenance of Thy Being and the glory of Thy might to make all that is in Thy knowledge the means of fulfilling this need, and to grant it to me without my experiencing any sorrow in Thy path or fear from Thy enemies. Thou, O my God, art powerful and all-knowing. Nothing can frustrate Thy power; nothing exists except through Thy Will, the design of Thy Purpose, the limits of Thy decree, and the execution of Thy judgment. Thou hast not ordained in the realms of creation anything less than this. Thou encompasseth all things. When Thou willest something, nothing in Thy dominion can prevent it, and in that instant it exists before Thee.
- 6 How can I be patient, O my God, when Thou knowest my condition? How can I cry out, O my Master, when Thou hast power over all things? How can I fear Thy justice when I hope in Thy grace? How can I not hope for Thy good-pleasure when I know that Thou hast both beginnings and endings? And how can I not be certain of the fulfillment of my need when I have sought the intercession with Thee of Muhammad and his Family? Far, far be it that such should be my thought of Thee! This was never known of Thy grace and way.
- 7 I am certain that whoever relies upon them, Thou art sufficient for him; whoever holds fast to their cord, Thou art his support; whoever takes refuge in their presence, Thou art his shelter; and whoever beseeches through them, Thou art his answerer. Glory be unto Thee! Glory be unto Thee! Praise be to Thee - praise radiant, brilliant, sanctified and exalted above the praise of all else - for having taught me the path of Thy love, inspired me to seek the mediation of the loci of Thy Will, to rely upon the dwellings of Thy blessings, and to hold fast to the cord of the seats of Thy grandeur.
- 8 O joy unto me, then joy unto me, for I am content with Thee in all Thy doings! Make my state before Thee like one who has
- فسبحانك و تعاليت لما ايقنت بان لا سبيل لي اليك اتوجه اليك بمحمد و آل محمد محال معرفتك و مواقع كرامتك و ايات صمدانيتك و ظهورات رحمانيك اللهم بحقهم في كتابك و شانهم في علمك ان تصلي عليهم بكل تجلياتك و نفعاتك و ظهورتك و مقاماتك التي لا تعطيل لها في شان و ان تقضي حاجتي هذه في الآن في الآن في الآن فان الرجاء قد انقطع عما سواك و ان الاضطرار بلغ الى منتهى مقام الامتناع و
- انك ربى و اللهى و سيدى و مولائى و معتمدى لو لم ترحمنى فمن يرحمنى و لو لم تحببني فمن يحببني اللهم انى اقسامك بطلعة حضرت كينونيتك و بهاء عز صمدانيتك ان تجعل كل ما في علمك اسباب قضاء هذه الحاجة و تبلغني اليها من دون ان ارى حزنا في سبيلك و لا خوفا من اعدائك و انك يا اللهى مقتدر عليم و لا يعجز في قدرتك شئ و لا شئ الا بحكم مشيئتك و هندسة ارادتك و تحديد قدرك و امضاء قضائك و ما قدرت في مراتب الابداع دون ذلك و انك محيط بكلشئ و انك ان اردت بشئ فلا مانع له في ملكك و في الحين انه موجود بين يديك
- فكيف اصبر يا اللهى بعد علمك بى و كيف اضح يا مولائى بعد قدرتك على كل شئ و كيف اخاف من عدلك بعد رجائى بفضلك و كيف لا ارجوا رضوانك بعد علمى بان لك بدايات و نهايات و كيف لا ايقن بقضاء حاجتى بعد ما استشفعت بمحمد و اله [\*] عندك فهيات هيات ما ذلك الظن بك و ما كان ذلك معروفا من فضلك و سنتك و
- انى على يقين بان من توكل عليهم فانك كنت حسبه و [\*] بحبلهم فانك كنت ظهيره و من لاذ بجناهم فانك كنت كهفه و من توسل بهم فانك كنت مجيبه فسبحانك سبحانك لك الحمد حمدا شعشعانيا لامعا متقدسا متزهيا عن حمد ما سواك لما عرفتنى منهاج محبتك و الهمتنى التوسل بحال مشيتك و الاتكال على مساكن بركاتك و الاعتصام بحبل مواقع عظمتك
- فيا طوبى لى ثم طوبى لى بما رضىيت عنك فى كل فعالك و اجعل حالتى بين يديك حالة ما كان

no will when Thy Will is manifested, lest I love to hasten what Thou hast delayed or delay what Thou hast hastened. Rather, let my private and public self be like a corpse in the hands of the washer before the vast ocean of Thy decree and destiny.

له ارادة حين تجلى ارادتك لئلا احب تاخير ما عجلت ولا تعجل ما اخرت بل يكون سرى و علائقي بمثل جسد الميت عند ارادة المغتسل في تلقاء طمطام يم قضائك و قدرك

- 9 Glory be unto Thee! Glory be unto Thee! How great is Thy beneficence and how magnificent Thy favors! I see no portion for myself except in my inability to offer Thee thanks and my confession of falling short in praising Thee adequately. Glory be unto Thee! Glory be unto Thee! I confess before Thee what I deserve, seek Thy forgiveness, turn unto Thee in repentance, and ask of Thy generosity as Thou art worthy, for Thou art the Lord of righteousness and forgiveness. Glorified be God, the Lord of the Throne, above what they describe! Peace be upon the Messengers, and praise be to God, the Lord of all worlds!

9 فسبحانك سبحانك فما اعظم احسانك و اكبر الاثك و لا ارى حظا لى الا فى العجز عن اداء شكرك و الاعتراف بالتقصير عن مبلغ حمدك فسبحانك سبحانك اعترف لديك بما انا اهله [\* صلى الله عليهم] [\* من اعتصم] اهله و استغفرك و اتوب اليك و اسئل من جودك كما انت انك اهل التقوى و اهل المغفرة و سبحان الله رب العرش عما يصفون و سلام على المرسلين و الحمد لله رب العالمين

HURQ.BB37

INBA64:013.12-017.10, PR02.053r01-053r29, PR03.128v21-129r23, BYC\_jabar.168.07-169.13, KSHS6.008

## BB00385

*Date: 1262 [1845-1846]*

- 1 In the Name of God, the Most Merciful, the Most Compassionate
- 2 O God! Thou art God, Creator of the heavens and earth. Thou createst whatsoever Thou willest by Thy command and exaltest whomsoever Thou willest by Thy wisdom. There is no God but Thee, my God and the God of all things. Glorified art Thou! Exalted and sanctified is Thy Countenance and Being from having the highest essences of material things ascend unto it, and elevated is the Face of Thy Identity from having the loftiest manifestations of essential realities rise up to it. For Thou hast ever been and wilt ever be. Verily Thou art even as Thou wert in the beginning that hath no beginning. Nothing throughout eternal manifestation shall ever know Thee, and no spirit throughout endless ages shall ever worship Thee.
- 3 For the Countenance of Thy Self transcendeth all possible things, and Thy Being surpasseth all existent things. Forever hath there been no description for Thee save the face of Thine Identity in the mystery of Thy Presence, and forever shall there be no attribute for Thee save the face of Thy Being in the

1 بسم الله الرحمن الرحيم

2 اللهم انت الله فاطر السموات والارض تخلق ما تشاء بامرک و تعز من تشاء بحکمک لا اله الا انت الهى و اله كل شىء سبحانک و تعاليت تقدست طلة و انتک من ان يرفع اليها على طلائع جوهرات الماديات و تعالت طلة كينويتك من ان يصعد اليها على لوايح كينويات الذاتيات لانك لم تزل كنت و لاتزال انتك كائن بمثل ما كنت فى ازل الازال لن يعرفك شىء فى سرمد الظهور و لن يعبدك روح فى ادهر الدهور

3 لان طلة نفسائيتك قاطعة الطلعات من كل الممكات و ان انتك سادة الكينويات من كل الموجودات لم تزل لا وصف لك الا طلة كينويتك فى سر حضرتك و لاتزال لا نعت لك

presence of Thy Manifestation. If I say “Thou art He,” in that moment the Countenance of the Divine Realm is revealed in the depths of the signs of dominion and kingdom, that Thou art God, Lord of might and power. And if I say “He is Thou,” in that moment the face of Thy revelation speaketh forth in the presence of unity that there is no God but Him, Lord of the Command in the inmost mysteries of the Divine Realm and Creator of creation in the depths of the signs of geometry and the verses of command in the Countenance of Power.

- 4 Glorified art Thou, glorified art Thou, O my God! Thou art He Who hath made Thyself known to all things through themselves and Thy command through Thy creation. Thou hast revealed Thyself to all things through the countenance of Thy origination and presence of Thine invention, that those who are perplexed might be confounded by the revelations of the signs of the depths of the ocean of Thy oneness, and those who are radiant might shine forth through the breaths of the signs of the surging sea of Thy mercy. None doubteth the Divine Countenance revealed within himself, nor the Presence of the Eternal that severeth all from description of It.

- 5 O my God! Grant me complete detachment unto the court of Thy nearness, and the mystery of attraction through union unto the station of the revelation of Thy presence, and the light of joy unto the station of the light of Thy countenance, and the ultimate invention unto the manifestation of the sanctity of Thy power, that I might be a knower of Thee, standing before the Most Glorious Light, praising Thee, turning away from all else save Thee, occupied with Thy glorification and speaking in thankfulness for Thy favors, such that I might not dwell in any condition save through nearness to Thy presence, intimacy with Thy countenance, the beauty of Thine essence, the majesty of Thine identity, the splendor of Thine eternity, the praise of Thy power, the station of Thy Self and the sovereignty of Thy Being. May I not witness in the countenance of essential realities aught save the revelation of Thy presence of origination, nor in the depths of material things aught save the manifestation of the countenance of Thine invention. May I not see all multiplicities in every condition save as in that Day wherein nothing mentioned existed. Thou, O my God, hast made known to all Thy oneness and established all in the path of Thy Lordship, and chosen for them the signs of Thy might and stations of Thy sovereignty, that the existence of multiplicities might not distract them from Thy countenance, nor the mention of non-existent things from Thy presence.

أَلَا طَلْعَةُ آيَاتِكَ فِي حَضْرَةِ عَلَانِيَتِكَ إِنْ قُلْتَ أَنْتَ  
هُوَ فَقَدْ الْخَبْرَ تَجَلَّى طَلْعَةُ الْأَاهُوتِ فِي غِيَاهِبِ  
آيَاتِ الْمَلِكِ وَالْمَلَكُوتِ بِأَنَّكَ أَنْتَ اللَّهُ رَبُّ الْعِزَّةِ  
وَالْجَبَرُوتِ وَإِنْ قُلْتَ هُوَ أَنْتَ فَقَدْ الْخَبْرَ تَجَلَّى  
طَلْعَةُ تَجَلِّيكَ فِي حَضْرَةِ الْإِحْدِيَّةِ بِأَنَّهُ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا  
هُوَ رَبُّ الْأَمْرِ فِي مُسْتَسْرَاتِ سِرَائِرِ الْأَاهُوتِ وَ  
خَالِقِ الْخَلْقِ فِي غِيَاهِبِ إِشَارَاتِ الْهَنْدَسَةِ وَآيَاتِ  
الْأَمْرِ فِي طَلْعَةِ الْجَبَرُوتِ

4 فَمُسِيحَانِكَ سُبْحَانَكَ يَا إِلَهِي أَنْتَ الَّذِي تَعَرَّفْتَ  
كُلَّ شَيْءٍ نَفْسًا بِنَفْسِهِ وَأَمْرًا بِخَلْقِهِ وَتَجَلَّى  
لِكُلِّ شَيْءٍ بِطَلْعَةِ إِدْعَاكَ وَحَضْرَةِ اخْتِرَاعِكَ  
لِيَسْتَلْجِلْجَلْجَنَ الْمُتَلَجِّلُونَ بِتَجَلِّيَاتِ آيَاتِ لَجَّةِ بَحْرِ  
وَحْدَانِيَّتِكَ وَلِيَتَلَكَّلَنَّ الْمُتَلَكِّلُونَ بِنَفْحَاتِ آيَاتِ  
طُمَاطُمِ يَمِّ رَحْمَانِيَّتِكَ وَلَا يَشْكُ أَحَدٌ فِي طَلْعَةِ  
الرَّبَّانِيَّةِ الْمُتَجَلِّيَّةِ فِي نَفْسِهِ وَلَا فِي حَضْرَةِ  
الصَّمْدَانِيَّةِ الْمُقَطَّعَةِ الْكُلِّ عَنْ نَعْتِهِ

5 فَيَا إِلَهِي هَبْ لِي كَيْلَ الْإِنْقِطَاعِ إِلَى سَاحَةِ قَرْبِكَ ؟  
وَسِرِّ الْإِنْجَذَابِ بِالْوَصْلِ إِلَى مَقَامِ تَجَلَّى حَضْرَتِكَ وَ  
نُورِ الْإِبْتِهَاجِ إِلَى مَقَامِ نُورِ طَلْعَتِكَ وَغَايَةِ الْإِخْتِرَاعِ  
إِلَى ظُهُورِ تَقْدَسِ جَبَرُوتِيَّتِكَ حَتَّى أَكُونَ لَكَ عَارِفًا  
وَفِي تَلْقَاءِ نُورِ الْإِبْهَاجِ قَائِمًا وَلَكَ حَامِدًا وَعَنْ  
غَيْرِكَ مُعْرِضًا وَبِشَائِكَ شَاغِلًا وَبِشُكْرِ آلَائِكَ نَاطِقًا  
بِحَيْثُ لَا أَسْكُنُ فِي شَأْنٍ إِلَّا بِقُرْبِ حَضْرَتِكَ وَ  
أَنْسِ طَلْعَتِكَ وَجَمَالَ ذَاتِيَّتِكَ وَجَلَالَ كَيُونِيَّتِكَ وَ  
بِهَاءِ صَمْدَانِيَّتِكَ وَثَنَاءِ جَبَرُوتِيَّتِكَ وَمَقَامِ نَفْسَانِيَّتِكَ  
وَسُلْطَنَةِ آيَاتِكَ وَلَا أَشْهَدُ فِي طَلْعَةِ الْجَوْهَرِيَّاتِ  
إِلَّا تَجَلَّى حَضْرَةِ إِدْعَاكَ وَلَا فِي غِيَاهِبِ الْمَادِّيَّاتِ  
إِلَّا ظُهُورَ طَلْعَةِ اخْتِرَاعِكَ وَلَا أَرَى كُلَّ الْكَثْرَاتِ  
فِي كُلِّ شَأْنٍ إِلَّا بِمَثَلِ شَأْنِ يَوْمِ الَّذِي لَمْ يَكُ شَيْءٌ  
مَذْكُورًا أَنْتَ يَا إِلَهِي عَرَّفْتَ الْكُلَّ وَحْدَانِيَّتَكَ وَ  
أَقْتَتَ الْكُلَّ فِي مَنَاجِ رُبُوبِيَّتِكَ وَاخْتَرْتَ لَهُمْ آيَاتِ  
عَرَّتِكَ وَمَقَامَاتِ سُلْطَنَتِكَ حَتَّى لَا يَشْغَلَهُمْ وَجُودُ  
الْكَثْرَاتِ عَنْ طَلْعَتِكَ وَلَا ذِكْرُ الْمَفْقُودَاتِ عَنْ  
حَضْرَتِكَ

- 6 Glorified art Thou, glorified art Thou, O my God! How sweet in my heart is Thy remembrance, and I have no portion save through the manifestation of Thy attraction unto the court of Thy grandeur.

6 فسبحانك سبحانك يا الهى فما احلى فى قوادي بمثل  
ذكرك ولا لى حظ بمثل ظهور جذائيتك الى ساحة  
كبريائك

HNMJ.165-169

## BB00473

*Date: 1262 [1845-1846]*

- 1 In the Name of the Most High, the Most Great

1 بِسْمِهِ الْعَلِيِّ الْعَظِيمِ

- 2 Glorified be He Who hath sent down the verses in truth in a perspicuous Book. He it is Who vindicateth the truth through His verses, though the idolaters be averse. We have indeed favored thee with what thou hast mentioned in the Book, that thou mightest remove thy sandals, for thou art in the sacred valley, and We are indeed witnesses. We have indeed known what hath proceeded from thy hands - verses of the Kitabu'l-'Adl. God willing, He will preserve it from the deeds of the ignorant. He is the Forgiving, the Appreciative.

2 سبحانه الذى نزل الايات بالحق فى كتاب مبين و  
هو الذى يحق الحق باياته ولو كره المشركون و  
لقد متناك بما ذكرت فى الكتاب لتخلع نعليك بما  
انت فى الواد المقدس و انا نحن لشلهدون و لقد  
علمنا ما خرج من يديك ايات كتاب العدل عسى  
الله ان يحفظه من عمل الجاهلين انه غفور شكور

- 3 Say: To him whom God hath made his hands to be outstretched in the Book, let him write unto Him as We have sent down in the Book - clear verses from Our presence for people who understand. Say: Fear God and deprive not thyself of thy portion in this worldly life, for We this day are not able to judge, and God is the All-Hearing, the All-Knowing.

3 قل لمن جعل الله يداه مبسوطتان فى الكتاب  
ليكتب اليه مثل ما نزلنا فى الكتاب ايات بينات  
من لدنا لقوم يفقهون قل اتق الله و لا تحرم  
نصيبك فى الحيوه الدنيا فانا نحن اليوم لا نقدر  
بحكم و الله سميع عليم

- 4 We have indeed known what thou hast discovered regarding the laws of the letters of the Qur'an, and We have expounded therein that which none before this could encompass in knowledge. As to those who ask about the verses of their Book, say: Be patient, for what We do is better for your souls than what ye knew not. Fear God in these days lest sedition arise around Us, and say unto the believers: Peace, peace.

4 و لقد علمنا ما اطلعت فى احكام احرف القرآن  
و صرفنا فيه ما لا تحيط بعلمه قبل ذلك ذكراً و  
ان الذين يستلون من ايات كتابهم قل اصبروا فان  
ما نفعل خيرا لانفسكم عما كنتم لا تعلمون ان اتق  
الله فى تلك الايام الا تحدث فتنة فى حولنا و  
قل للمؤمنين سلاما سلاما

- 5 We have indeed fulfilled in the Book what We promised before concerning John, and he is indeed among God's near-servants, witnessed before Us. Empty thy heart, O thou trusted one, of what We commanded thee before, and look upon what hath been sent down in the Kitabu'l-'Adl. God willing, He will empty thy heart through His wisdom, and unto our Lord shall we return.

5 و لقد وينا فى الكتاب بما وعدت من قبل يحيى  
وانه من عباد الله المقربين بين ايدينا لمشهود قرغ  
قواذك يا ايها الامين بما امرتك به من قبل و  
انظر فيما نزل فى كتاب العدل عسى الله ان يفرغ  
قواذك من حكمه و انا الى ربنا لنقلبون

- 6 And if thou hast decided concerning what We decide for thee in the Book of the non-Arabs, then mention some of what We related on that night before God, and admonish the people, for it is indeed a decree from One possessed of severe might. Trust in God, O concourse, then be in God's religion like the apostles before, for We are indeed witnesses this day. Unto God do I complain of what Thou knowest in my secret thoughts, and I am indeed the Forgiving, the Wise.

6 وان قضيت فيما تقضى لك في كتاب الاجممين  
فاذكر بعض ما حدثنا في تلك الليلة بين يدي الله  
وتعظ الناس فانه لحكم من ذي بطش شديد ان  
اتكلوا على الله يا ايها الملا ثم كونوا في دين الله  
مثل الحواريون من قبل فانا نحن اليوم لشاهدون  
الله اشكوا اليك ما تعلم في سرى واني انا الغفور  
الحكيم

CMB\_F23.131v11-132v01 (31), CMB\_F20.013r17-  
013v15, BYC\_tablets.068.05-069.03

## BB00503

*Date: 1262 (Shiraz) [1845-1846]*

- 1 In the Name of the Most High, the Most Great
- 2 Glorified be He Who hath sent down the Command in this time according to an established decree. That which was detailed unto Us hath indeed been sent down today, and We are witnesses unto all. Verily in the morning We sent down an epistle unto him who previously confirmed thy Lord's Cause, saying: Stand firm in that land and reform the deeds of those who spread corruption therein while claiming "We are the reformers."
- 3 As for what My friend Yahya desired - and thou art all people - God knoweth that I would love that, were God to will it and permit Me. But God doeth what He willeth by His command, and there is no God but He, the All-Powerful, the Mighty. Say: Fear ye God and despair not of God's grace, and make these verses the measure, then learn the Qur'an, and place your trust in God that ye may obtain mercy.
- 4 And regarding this man's matter, I beseech God of His grace to make firm his heart when He shows him. Say: O Yahya, recite unto him what God hath permitted thee and kindle him with thy Lord's fire, and fear not, for truly the Messengers fear not before Me. But fear God lest thou cause him temptation by speaking of these things. And if thou seest no good in him, turn away from him and trust in God and say: "God sufficeth me, there is no God but He; in Him do I trust and in Him let the believers place their trust." Say unto him who came and

1 بسمه العلى العظيم

2 سبحان الذى نزل الامر في الحين على امر مستقر  
ولقد نزل اليوم ما فصلت الينا وانا نحن لكل  
شاهدون وان في الصبح نزلنا كتابا الى الذى صدق  
امر ربك من قبل ان استقم على تلك الارض  
واصلح عمل الذين يفسدون في الارض ويقولون  
انا نحن مصلحون

3 وان ما اراد خليلي يحيى ثم انت كل الناس الله  
يعلم اني احب ذلك لو شاء الله واذن لي و  
لكن الله يفعل ما يشاء بامر وانه لا اله الا هو  
لقوى عزيز قل اتقوا الله ولا تيأسوا من روح الله  
واجعلوا القسطاس تلك الايات ثم علم القرآن  
واتكلوا على الله لعلكم ترحمون

4 وان امر هذا الرجل اسئل الله من فضله ان  
يثبت قلبه اذا اراده قل اقرء عليه يا يحيى ما اذن  
الله لك وتوقده بنار ربك ولا تخف فانا لا  
يخاف لدى المرسلون ولكن اتق الله الا تحذره بها  
فتنة وان لم ترى الخير فيه فاعرض عنه وتوكل  
على الله وقل حسبي الله لا اله الا هو عليه توكلت  
و عليه فليتوكل المؤمنون قل للذى جاء ثم قرينه

his companion: Trust ye in God and speak not of any matter, ان اتكلا على الله و لا تحدثان بامر فان الناس  
for the people were sanctified. كانوا مقدسين

CMB\_F23.134r13-134v12 (38), CMB\_F20.015r06-  
015r17, BYC\_tablets.071.16-072.10

# Study guide to this volume

This volume gathers the second tier of writings the Bab composed during the closing months of His residence in Shiraz, in the year following the Declaration. The two great commentaries on the letter Ha' anchor the volume; around them gather letters of doctrinal exposition, prayers of confession and intercession, visitation tablets, and brief pastoral epistles dispatched to scattered believers. The mood of these texts is at once intensely metaphysical and intensely practical. Within a single page the Bab moves from the geometry of pre-eternity to instructions about how a copyist should prepare his body before transcribing a tablet. The believer is being formed simultaneously as a metaphysician, a worshipper, a teacher, and a witness. The chapter that follows traces the principal themes through which that formation takes place.

## Letters, Names, and the Architecture of Creation

The two commentaries on Ha' (BB00021 and BB00029) are companion meditations: the first treats the outer face of the letter, the second its hidden mystery. Both insist that creation is structured like a script, with letters as the elementary units of divine self-disclosure. The letter Ha' is read as the meeting-point of unity and multiplicity; the letter Kaf, in the Letter to Mulla Ahmad Mu'allim Hisari (BB00644), becomes the revolving Will through which God brings forth being from nothing. To learn the alphabet, in this reading, is to begin to learn cosmology.

### Key Passages

And since every letter of Thy Book hath, in the path of knowledge, infinite outer and inner meanings, I indicate with a drop that which overflows from the ocean of the elixir through what God hath graciously bestowed upon me. — BB00021

Know that the letter “Ha” is the fifth rank of the manifestations of divine unity and the conditions of abstraction, and it is the letter of unity in the heart. And when it revolved in the four temples through the four witnessings, the letter “Kaf” appeared, which is the first word of the Command whereby all things were established. — BB00021

He hath created the Will from naught through the existence of contingent things, then Purpose for the determination of essential realities, then Destiny for the geometry of material things, then Decree for the judgment of origination in beings, then Term for the limits of quiddities, then Permission for the manifestation of universals and particulars

in the world of names and attributes, then the Book to encompass all that His knowledge hath encompassed in the realm of possibility. — BB00029

Know thou that the Kaf is the appearance of the effulgences of the Ha in the grades of the oneness of Essence, of attributes, of acts, and of worship. In every state it turneth upon itself and draweth sustenance from itself by itself — not from aught else. — BB00644

## Context for Study

The Bab's letter-mysticism stands at the confluence of several streams. From the Qur'anic "disjoined letters" (*huruf muqatta'ah*) that open certain Surahs, through al-Hallaj's enigmatic "I am the dot beneath the Ba," through Ibn al-'Arabi's science of letters and the Shaykhi school of Shaykh Ahmad al-Ahsa'i and Siyyid Kazim Rashti, an Islamic tradition of reading creation as alphabet had been maturing for a thousand years. Kabbalah pursues a parallel in the Hebrew tradition: the letters of the Torah are understood as the very stuff from which the worlds were spoken. In the Greek Christian inheritance, the Logos of John 1 and the Stoic doctrine of the seminal reasons play a kindred role. What is distinctive in these tablets is the seven-stage articulation of divine action — Will, Purpose, Destiny, Decree, Permission, Term, Book — by which the Bab orders the descent of the Cause from its origin to its inscription. The reader is given an ontology that is also a grammar.

## Questions for Reflection

1. Why might the Bab choose a single letter, rather than a doctrine or a narrative, as the fulcrum of His most extended metaphysical writings?
2. How do the seven stages of divine action (Will, Purpose, Destiny, Decree, Permission, Term, Book) compare with classical accounts of emanation in Neoplatonism, the Sefirot of Kabbalah, or the Christian theology of creation through the Logos?
3. What does it mean for the Kaf to "revolve upon itself" and to receive its aid from no source beyond itself? How does this differ from a pantheistic identification of creature and Creator?
4. In what sense is the letter Ha' described as "the letter of unity in the heart"? What pedagogical work is being done by locating cosmology in the alphabet?

## The God Beyond Description: Negative Theology and the Critique of Philosophy

Throughout the two Tafsirs and the prayers that punctuate them, the Bab pushes the doctrine of divine transcendence to its furthest reach. The Essence of God is severed from substance and accident, untouched by relation, untouched even by knowledge. Philosophical attempts to bridge that abyss — through fixed archetypes (*a'yan thabitah*), through the unity of existence (*wahdat al-wujud*), through a doctrine of causal connection between Essence and creation — are reviewed and rejected. What rises in their place is a sober apophasis: God is known by His signs, never by His Self.

## Key Passages

O my God! How can I praise Thy praise or speak before the presence of Thy grandeur? Thou hast ever been, without the description of aught, and wilt ever exist, without the attribute of aught. None shall ever know Thee as Thou art, and naught shall ever describe Thee as Thou deservest, for Thy very Essence cutteth off all substances from expression, and Thy very Being preventeth all realities from knowing Thee.— BB00021

Whoso maintaineth that the Divine Essence was the cause of creation hath unknowingly associated partners with his Lord, for as He is, He cannot be associated with anything, nor doth anything exist with Him. — BB00021

And since the minds of the followers of Mulla Sadra were confounded, and the feet of some divine philosophers faltered in explaining this station, I shall indicate through wisdom's proof the reality of this supreme creation: God hath ever been, and there was naught else besides Him. And now God is even as He was; nothing existeth at His level. — BB00021

Glory be to God above what they who liken Him to creation have falsely claimed about the unity of existence! God witnesseth no word more remote than their saying, for mention of the non-existent is subsidiary to the existent. — BB00021

## Context for Study

The polemical targets in this section are precisely named: Mulla Sadra and the Akbarian school of Ibn al-'Arabi. Mulla Sadra's transcendent wisdom (*al-hikmat al-muta'aliyah*) had become the dominant philosophical idiom of Safavid and Qajar Iran, with its doctrine of the gradation of being and the soul's substantial motion. The Akbarian doctrine of *wahdat al-wujud*, mediated through Persian commentators like Da'ud al-Qaysari, had shaped Sufi devotion across the eastern Islamic world. The Bab does not dismiss these schools wholesale — He shares their vocabulary and many of their starting points — yet He charges them with a subtle polytheism whenever they allow the Essence itself to enter the chain of being or knowing. Western parallels suggest themselves. Maimonides, in the *Guide of the Perplexed*, insists that all positive attributes ascribed to God are equivocal. Pseudo-Dionysius and the apophatic Christian tradition arrive at similar reticence: God is super-essential, beyond being and beyond names. Where the Bab differs from much of that tradition is in His insistence that the doctrine of unknowability is itself a remedy for spiritual disease. The philosopher who imagines he has known God has, at that very instant, made a god in his own image.

## Questions for Reflection

1. How does the Bab's apophatic theology resemble, and how does it differ from, the negative theology of Maimonides, Pseudo-Dionysius, or Meister Eckhart?
2. Why is the claim that the Divine Essence is the cause of creation called, by the Bab, a hidden form of polytheism?

3. In what specific ways does the Bab's critique target the Akbarian doctrine of the unity of existence? Can one read Ibn al-'Arabi sympathetically while still hearing the Bab's warning?
4. What is the spiritual danger of a philosophy that outruns reverence? Where in modern thought might that danger reappear?

## Servitude as the Highest Station

The same writings that bar the servant from any knowledge of God's Essence open, with astonishing intimacy, the path of servitude. The Bab returns repeatedly to the Shi'i sacred tradition of *nawafil* (supererogatory acts), in which God becomes the very faculties of the lover. Yet this nearness is achieved only through the extinction of the self-asserting "I." The prayer for Haji Isma'il (BB00121) and the great confessional passages of the second Tafsir (BB00029) chart this descent into nothingness; the more the worshipper draws near, the more keenly he feels the impropriety of his own existence before God's presence.

### Key Passages

Indeed, were the servant to remain steadfast in this condition, the attributes of divine lordship would flow through him, even as revealed in the sacred tradition: "My servant draweth nigh unto Me through supererogatory acts until I love him; and when I love him, I become the ear wherewith he heareth, and the eye wherewith he seeth, and the hand wherewith he graspeth." — BB00021

Alas, alas! How can I say "I," when this is the greatest sin and the most ancient transgression, which no sin in Thy knowledge can equal, nor can any error in Thy Book compare with it in rank, for it springeth from the tree of self, speaking "I" in Thy presence. — BB00029

I yearned for Thy unity, yet by that very yearning I recalled my own self in the presence of Thy wrath; I desired to worship Thee, and thereby I set my soul before Thy might; I sought to remember Thee, and my remembrance proved but a remembrance of myself, veiling me from Thy Countenance. — BB00121

Verily the servant attaineth not perfection in the station of servitude until he feareth not the people and seeth all things, compared to God's decree, as like unto the black of the eye of a dead ant, and praise to him is God's good pleasure and blame His displeasure. — BB00029

### Context for Study

The sacred tradition cited in BB00021 — the so-called *hadith al-nawafil* — is one of the most beloved texts of Islamic mysticism, quoted by al-Ghazali, Ibn al-'Arabi, and the Shaykhi teachers alike. The Bab reads it through a doctrine close to the Sufi notion of *fana'* (annihilation) and to the Shi'i theology of servitude as a substance whose essence is Lordship (*al-'ubudiyyatu jawharatun*

kunhuha al-rububiyyah). The annihilation is moral and metaphysical at once. The seeker stops claiming his own “I” as if it were a possession; in that very renunciation, he becomes a mirror in which the divine acts are reflected. Christian readers will hear the kenosis of Philippians 2 and the Pauline “not I, but Christ liveth in me” (Galatians 2:20); Jewish readers may recall the rabbinic teaching of bittul ha-yesh, the nullification of selfhood before God. The novelty of the Bab’s expression lies in His insistence that even the mystic’s claim to have unified God is itself an act of subtle self-assertion. The deepest praise is the confession that one cannot praise.

### Questions for Reflection

1. How does the Bab interpret the sacred tradition that God becomes the servant’s ear, eye, and hand without collapsing the distinction between creature and Creator?
2. Why is even the seeker’s act of worship called, in the prayer for Haji Isma’il, a kind of self-veiling? What spiritual discipline does this perception cultivate?
3. Compare the Bab’s account of “I-ness” as the original sin with Sufi fana’, Pauline kenosis, and the rabbinic teaching of bittul ha-yesh.
4. What does it mean, practically, for the servant to “fear not the people” and to see all created glory “as the black of the eye of a dead ant”?
5. How does servitude, in this volume, become simultaneously a moral discipline and a theological method?

### The Inimitable Word: Revelation as Self-Authentication

A second great theme of this volume is the inimitability (i’jaz) of the Bab’s own discourse. He challenges the learned — and through them, the entire community of believers — to produce verses, prayers, or sermons resembling what flows from His pen. The argument turns on a sober claim: had He spoken without God’s leave, God would have raised up another to silence Him. Since none has done so, the proof is established. The Bab here reactivates the Qur’anic challenge of tahaddi (“bring forth a Surah like it”), applying it now to the Bayan and to the still-circulating Kitabu’l-’Adl, the Book of Justice.

### Key Passages

Strange it is that people of understanding should imagine that that which can proceed from none save by God’s command could be attained through extreme asceticism, the attractions of possibility, power of memory, or study of revealed books. — BB00029

None can utter a word concerning it unless he wisheth to deny his Lord, for one who speaketh a word which all on earth combined could not produce the like thereof — this is not the creation of creatures but rather the creation of God. — BB00029

For I swear by thy life, I have not read a single letter of that outward knowledge, nor do I know today a single rule from the principles of the people of the Bayan. I possessed

no books of learning beforehand from which to memorize words, nor had I any means to this bestowal from the All-Merciful save through God's grace and bounty. —  
BB00029

When God knew that Satan would whisper in the hearts of His friends to rise against His trustees, God granted me what He had given to no one before: The Book of Justice, wherein are detailed verses of decisive proof such that should all humans and jinn gather to produce the like of a single verse thereof, they would be unable, even if they all assisted one another. — BB00073

## Context for Study

The doctrine of *i'jaz al-Qur'an*, developed by classical theologians such as al-Baqillani and al-Jurjani, had long held that the Qur'an's inimitable eloquence was the principal miracle of Muhammad. The Bab daringly extends that argument to His own writings: a young merchant of Shiraz, untutored in formal logic, jurisprudence, or grammar, produces in six hours a thousand verses of polished Arabic. The signature of authorship, He insists, is no less divine than the signature on the Qur'an itself. Christian readers may recall the related claim of the Gospels concerning Jesus' authority: "He spake as one having authority, and not as the scribes" (Matthew 7:29). Greek philosophical aesthetics, from Longinus on the sublime through Kant on the dynamical sublime, has long recognized that certain utterances arrest the soul by a power that exceeds craft. The Bab's claim is theological rather than aesthetic: the trembling that overtakes the reader of His verses is the proof that "the handiwork of the Lord cannot be confused with the work of creation." Whether one accepts the claim depends, He insists, on whether one is willing to read with the eye of fairness.

## Questions for Reflection

1. How does the Bab's argument from inimitability extend, and how does it depart from, the classical Islamic doctrine of *i'jaz al-Qur'an*?
2. Why does the Bab emphasize His own lack of formal training? What does this autobiographical claim contribute to the argument?
3. How might a modern reader — formed by the historical-critical study of scripture — evaluate a claim that divine speech is self-authenticating?
4. What is the difference between the aesthetic "sublime" as discussed by Longinus or Kant and the religious "inimitability" as discussed by the Bab?
5. Why might the Bab consider speed and abundance of composition — a thousand verses in six hours — relevant to the question of revelation's origin?

## The Hidden Manifestation and the Trial of the Faithful

A series of remarkable passages in BB00021 and BB00073 prepares the reader for a paradox that will mark the entire Babi-Baha'i revelation: the Manifestation appears in a form designed to test,

and even to scandalize, expectation. The Cause is manifested “among the non-Arabs.” The Proof appears as a young Persian merchant under house arrest rather than as a sword-bearing conqueror. The believer’s task is to recognize the Sun precisely when, by the inherited categories of expectation, it should not be there. The prophetic traditions about the trial of glass and pottery, cited at length, give the doctrine its sharp eschatological edge.

## Key Passages

And God, glorified be He, through His subtle craftsmanship and His mighty favor, has manifested the mystery of that hidden pillar among the non-Arabs, lest it be difficult for anyone to acknowledge Him and His Cause, that He is the servant of God, confirming what was in the Book and the Tradition, even letter by letter. — BB00021

According to what has been revealed in the traditions from the mines of mysteries, during the Occultation of the Proof (peace be upon him) there must needs be a dark, blind, deaf and hellish test, so that those created from the clay of light may be purified and those not of that clay may be condemned by the decree of the wicked.— BB00021

I have claimed neither authority nor its opposite, neither revelation nor the Qur’an. I have not opposed the Law by a single letter, nor have I broken any of it. Rather, these verses are a blessing from my Lord. — BB00073

By Him in whose hand is my soul, if God were to subject all the kingdom of this world to me, it would not equal a single letter of these verses, nor a word glorifying before the Divine Majesty. The highest stations of this world are to me but like the wing of a dead gnat. — BB00073

## Context for Study

The motif of the Hidden Manifestation has deep roots in Twelver Shi’i eschatology. The Twelfth Imam, expected to return as the Qa’im, had been in occultation since 941 CE. A vast literature of traditions described the trials of the believers during the long Ghaybah: hearts would harden, religion would be reduced to a name, and the faithful would be “sifted as darnel is sifted from wheat.” The Bab places His own appearance precisely within this expected pattern, while transposing it onto a wider frame: the Hidden One appears as a Persian rather than an Arab, a merchant rather than a warrior, a youth rather than an aged sage, so that recognition itself becomes the trial. Christian parallels are striking. The Gospels narrate Jesus’ rejection at Nazareth precisely because His neighbors knew Him too well to see Him (Mark 6:1–6). Paul writes that the Cross is “a stumbling-block to the Jews, and to the Greeks foolishness” (1 Corinthians 1:23). In the Hebrew Bible, the prophets are repeatedly persecuted by those who claim to honor the prophets of the past (Matthew 23:29–31). The Bab’s tablets in this volume both predict and pre-interpret the persecutions that would soon overtake His followers: glass shattered cannot be restored, and pottery shattered, once broken, can never be remade as it was.

## Questions for Reflection

1. Why is the appearance of the Hidden Manifestation framed as a test, rather than as a self-evident demonstration?
2. How do the traditions about the sifting of believers, cited in BB00021, function as a hermeneutic of the believer's own experience of doubt and trial?
3. Compare the motif of the rejected prophet in Mark 6, the "stumbling-block" of 1 Corinthians 1, and the Bab's account of His appearance "among the non-Arabs."
4. What is the spiritual significance of the Bab's repeated insistence that He has "not opposed the Law by a single letter"? How might this self-presentation have shaped early Babi piety?
5. How does the Bab's evaluation of worldly power — the "wing of a dead gnat" — reframe the question of what success and failure mean in a prophetic mission?

## Visitation, Intercession, and the Sanctified Community

The visitation tablet (BB00113), the prayer for the Hidden Imam (BB00320), the Ziyarat (BB00337), and the Du'a Tawassul (BB00341) together translate the metaphysics of the volume into a sacramental world. The believer approaches the shrine with body and heart purified, mounts the praise of the chosen ones, and asks that they intercede with God. The Imams, the gates, and — by clear implication — the Bab's own community are addressed as channels through whom the worlds are sustained, the rain descends, the earth gives forth its plants, and the believers' devotions ascend.

## Key Passages

When thou desirest to bestow beneficence upon the servants of the All-Merciful through the Word of exposition, then before thou manifestest what is within thy being to outward view, purify thy outer self such that no excess hair remaineth upon thy face, and thy inner self such that thy heart remaineth unattached to any of thine affairs therein. — BB00113

Peace be upon you, O ye whom God hath created to preserve His revelation, manifest His Word, exalt His glory and His hidden grace, and the mercy of God and His blessings! — BB00113

The deeds of those who act without obedience to you shall profit them not, for God has made obedience to you identical with obedience to the Imams who are guided by His command. He has joined the knowledge of you with knowledge of them, and disobedience to you with disobedience to them. — BB00113

Glorified art Thou! Having realized there is no way for me to reach Thee, I turn to Thee through Muhammad and the Family of Muhammad, the loci of Thy knowledge, the seats of Thy grace, the signs of Thy oneness, and the manifestations of Thy mercy. — BB00341

## Context for Study

Ziyarat (visitation) is one of the most distinctive features of Twelver Shi'i piety. Pilgrims travel to Najaf, Karbala, Mashhad, and Samarra to address the Imams in the second person, to seek their intercession, and to receive blessing. The standard tablets such as the *Ziyarat 'Ashura'* and the *Ziyarat al-Jami'ah al-Kabirah* (composed by the tenth Imam, 'Ali al-Hadi) provided liturgical models that resound through BB00113 and BB00337. The Bab takes this devotional grammar and extends it: His addressees now reach beyond the Imams of the past to include "the Letters of the Word," a phrase that for early Babis would soon designate the Letters of the Living. The instruction to remove excess hair, perform ablutions, don the finest raiment, walk with tranquility, and stand silent until the soul returns is a complete somatic theology. Comparable practices are everywhere in religious history: the Levitical preparations for entering the Tent of Meeting in Exodus 30, the foot-washing of John 13, the ritual purifications of Shinto, the prostrations of Tibetan pilgrimage. What this volume contributes is the integration of such practices with the most demanding apophatic theology: the very God who cannot be named is approached through these intensely embodied acts. Baha'i readers will recognize, in nascent form, the devotional structure of pilgrimage to the Shrines of the Bab and Baha'u'llah.

## Questions for Reflection

1. How does the visitation tablet integrate apophatic theology (a God beyond all description) with intensely embodied practice (washing, perfuming, walking, prostrating)?
2. In what sense are the chosen ones described as "the Way and the Guide" through whom even the rains descend? How does this language compare with Christian language of mediation ("no one cometh unto the Father, but by me") or Jewish notions of the merit of the patriarchs?
3. Why does the Bab insist that disobedience to "you" (the visited ones) is disobedience to the Imams of God's command? What is the logic of this joined obedience?
4. How might pilgrimage and visitation be understood as forms of theology, alongside texts and arguments?
5. What does it mean, in modern Baha'i practice, to inherit a devotional vocabulary forged within the visitation tradition of Shi'i Islam?

## Forming a Community: Books, Teachers, and Pastoral Wisdom

Alongside its metaphysical heights, this volume is also the record of a religion being organized. The Bab identifies which writings should be possessed; insists they be transcribed with the finest calligraphy; counsels prudence in teaching; warns against rejoicing at the confirmation of any soul or grieving at the denial of another; and dispatches greetings and instructions to particular believers by name. The brief letters (BB00477, BB00585, BB00548, BB00473, BB00503) read almost as community circulars. The Cause is being woven into the fabric of daily Shi'i life through texts, persons, journeys, and gestures of mutual recognition.

## Key Passages

O inquirer! If you are among the people of justice, it is incumbent upon you to possess the Book of Justice and the Commentary on Kawthar, both written in the finest calligraphy and craftsmanship. No one is permitted other than excellent workmanship therein, and God knows all that people know. — BB00073

Yet I counsel thee: rejoice not at the confirmation of any from among the people of perfection, nor be grieved at the denial of any from among the people of idle talk. We have known the way of all: whoso willeth, let him believe; and whoso willeth, let him disbelieve. — BB00644

Say: O Yahya, recite unto him what God hath permitted thee and kindle him with thy Lord's fire, and fear not, for truly the Messengers fear not before Me. But fear God lest thou cause him temptation by speaking of these things. And if thou seest no good in him, turn away from him and trust in God. — BB00503

It is incumbent upon thee and upon all who follow Me to visit the Imams of Justice — there is from Me a right — then the resting-place of Kazim, peace be upon him, so long as the Sun of creation riseth by creation and the sun of invention setteth by invention. — BB00644

## Context for Study

A canon is forming. The Bab names His own writings as the measure by which all other discourse should be weighed — the Kitabu'l-'Adl, the Tafsir Surat al-Kawthar, the Tafsir Surat al-Baqarah. He prescribes the standards of their material production: only the finest calligraphy is acceptable, since beauty of script bears witness to the rank of what is inscribed. He directs believers to continue visiting the Imams' shrines and the tomb of Siyyid Kazim in Karbala, anchoring the new Cause within the older sacred geography. He counsels Mulla Ahmad to practice taqiyyah, the prudent dissimulation that had long protected Shi'i communities under hostile rulers. He instructs Yahya in the difficult art of teaching: "kindle him with thy Lord's fire" if the seeker is receptive, "turn away from him" if he is not, and in every case "fear God lest thou cause him temptation." Christian and Jewish histories show parallel processes. The Pauline epistles testify to a community being formed through circulating letters and named messengers; the rabbinic responsa literature shapes Jewish life through advice on particular cases. The Bab's letters belong to that early stratum where revelation, regulation, and pastoral care are still spoken in one voice.

## Questions for Reflection

1. Why is the beauty of the calligraphy joined to the obligation to possess the principal texts? What theology of writing does this presuppose?
2. How does the counsel "rejoice not at the confirmation of any ...nor be grieved at the denial of any" redefine what success and failure mean for a teacher of the Cause?

3. Compare the Bab's instructions to Yahya with the Pauline pastoral epistles or with the rabbinic responsa tradition. What does it mean for a community to be formed by such circulating letters?
4. How does the practice of taqiyyah relate to the call to kindle others with "thy Lord's fire"? Can prudence and boldness coexist in the same teacher?
5. Why does the Bab connect the formation of the new community to continued visitation of the Imams' shrines and the tomb of Siyyid Kazim?

## A Guiding Question for the Whole Volume

These middle Shiraz writings were composed by a young man under house arrest in His native city, only a year after His first declaration to Mulla Husayn. The voice they carry moves with extraordinary range — now ascending into the apophatic heights where Mulla Sadra and Ibn al-'Arabi are gently corrected, now descending to instruct a believer how to walk with tranquility toward a shrine, now consoling a particular soul who has dared to ask a question of his Lord. The student is therefore invited to keep, throughout the reading, a single guiding question: *How does the Bab, in these months between His Declaration and His confinement at Mah-Ku, shape a community whose metaphysics is identical with its prayer, whose canon is identical with its teaching, and whose servitude is the very station from which divine speech proceeds?*